

THE POETICAL WORKS
OF
WILLIAM WORDSWORTH

EDITED BY
WILLIAM KNIGHT

VOL. VIII



London
MACMILLAN AND CO., LTD.
NEW YORK: MACMILLAN & CO.
1896

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**THE POETICAL WORKS
OF
WILLIAM WORDSWORTH**

VOL. VIII



William Wordsworth

after Thomas Woolner

Printed by Ch Wittmann Paris

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OF
WILLIAM WORDSWORTH

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Gallow Hill

Yorkshire

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PREFATORY NOTE

The American Bibliography is almost entirely the work of Mrs. St. John of Ithaca, and is the result of laborious and careful critical research on her part. The French Bibliography is not so full. I have been assisted in it mainly by M. Legouis at Lyons, and by workers at the British Museum. I have also collected a German Bibliography, but it is in too incomplete a state for publication in its present form.

The English Bibliography is fuller than any of its predecessors; but there is no such thing as finality in such work, especially when an addition to the literature of the subject is made nearly every week. Many kind friends, and coadjutors, have assisted me in it, amongst whom I may mention Dr. Garnett of the British Museum, and *very specially* Mr. Tutin, of Hull, and also Mr. John J. Smith, St. Andrews, and Mr. Maclauchlan, Dundee. If I omit, either here or elsewhere, to record the assistance which I have received from any one, in my efforts to make this edition of Wordsworth as perfect as is possible at this stage of literary criticism and editorship, I sincerely regret it; but many of my correspondents have specially requested that no mention should be made of their names or their services.

In the Preface to the first volume of this edition there was an unfortunate omission. In returning the final proofs to press, I accidentally transmitted an uncorrected one, in which two names did not appear. They were those of Mr. Thomas Hutchinson, Dublin, and Mr. S. C. Hill, of Hughli College, Bengal. The former kindly revised most of the sheets of Volumes I. and II., and corrected errors, besides making other valuable suggestions and additions. When his own Clarendon Press edition of Wordsworth was being prepared for press, Mr. Hutchinson asked permission to incorporate in it materials which were not afterwards inserted. This I granted cordially, as a similar permission had been given to Professor Dowden for his Aldine edition. The unfortunate omission of Mr. Hutchinson's name was not discovered by me till after the issue of volumes I. and II. (which appeared simultaneously), and it was first brought under my notice by Mr.

Hutchinson's own letters to the newspapers. My debt to Mr. Hutchinson is great; and, although I have already thanked him for the services which he has rendered to the world in connection with Wordsworthian literature, I may perhaps be allowed to repeat the acknowledgment now. The revised sheets of Vols. I. and II. of this edition were, however, submitted to others at the same time that they were sent to Mr. Hutchinson; more especially to the late Mr. Dykes Campbell, and on his death to Mr. Belinfante, and then to the late Mr. Kinghorn, all of whom were engaged by my publishers to assist in the work entrusted to me. They "turned on the microscope" on my own work, and Mr. Hutchinson's; and to them I have been indebted in many ways.

Mr. Hill's services, in tracing the sources of numerous quotations from other poets which occur in Wordsworth's text, have been great. He sent me his discoveries, unsolicited, and I wish to express very cordially my indebtedness to him. To discover some of these quotations—there are several hundreds of them—cost me much labour, before I had the pleasure of hearing from, or knowing, Mr. Hill; and his assistance in this matter has been greater than that of any other person. It will be seen that I have failed—after much study and extensive correspondence—to discover them all.

In addition to actual quotations—indicated by Wordsworth by inverted commas in his poems—to trace parallel passages from other poets, or phrases which may have suggested to him what he recast and glorified, has seemed to me work not unworthy of accomplishment. At the same time, and in the same connection, to discover the somewhat similar debts of later poets to Wordsworth, and to indicate this here and there in footnotes, may not be wholly useless to posterity.

My obligations to my friend, Mr. Dykes Campbell, are greater than I can adequately express. He supplied me with much material, drawn from many quarters; and, although he did not always mention his sources, I had implicit confidence in him, both as a literary man and a friend. After his death, through the kindness of Mrs. Campbell, I examined some MS. volumes of *Wordsworthiana* written by him, which were of much use to me.

Some of these were from unknown sources, which I should perhaps have traced out before making use of them, but, in all my Wordsworth work, I have acted from first to last on the legal opinion of a distinguished Judge,

that the heir of the writer of literary work could alone authorise its subsequent publication; and, since the heirs of the Poet had kindly given me permission to collect and publish his works, I did so, with a view to the benefit of posterity.

Some of Mr. Campbell's material was derived from MSS. now in the possession of Mr. T. Norton Longman, and I have to express my sincere regret that in the earlier volumes I copied from Mr. Campbell's transcripts of these MSS.—which were lent to him on the condition that no public use should be made of them without Mr. Longman's permission—some variations of the text, without mentioning the source whence they were derived.

I was unaware that these MSS. were lent to Mr. Campbell with the condition attached, and regret very much that I am unable to trust my memory to indicate now what variations of text I have quoted from them. But I may add that Mr. Longman is about to publish a work which will enable Wordsworth students to become practically acquainted with the contents of his MSS.

In reference to the poems not published by Wordsworth or his sister during their lifetime, I have included in this volume not only fugitive pieces printed in Magazines and elsewhere, but also those which have been since recovered from numerous manuscript sources. They are of varying merit. It would be interesting to know, and to record in every instance, where these manuscripts now are; but this is impossible. In many cases the manuscripts have recently changed ownership. I have obtained a sight of many of them, and have been granted permission to transcribe them, from the fortunate possessors of large autograph collections, and also from dealers in autographs; but, after the sale of manuscripts at public auction-rooms, it is, as a rule, impossible to trace them.

In many cases the MS. variants which have been published in previous volumes occur in copies of the poems, transcribed by the Wordsworth household in private letters to friends. I have occasionally indicated this in footnotes; but, to have done so always would have disfigured the pages, and frequently the notes would have been longer than the text. To trace the present possessors of the MSS. would be well-nigh impossible. It is perhaps worth mentioning that in several cases Wordsworth entered as "misprints"

in future editions, what some of his editors have considered “new readings.” E.g. in *The Excursion*, book ix. l. 679, “wild” demeanour, instead of “mild” demeanour.

On Nov. 4, 1893, Mr. Aubrey de Vere wrote to me—

“I earnestly hope that, in your ‘monumental edition,’ you will restore the *Ode, Intimations of Immortality*, to the place which Wordsworth always assigned to it, that of the High Altar of his poetic Cathedral; remitting Quillinan’s laureate Ode on an unworthy, because ‘occasional,’ subject to an Appendix, as a work that at the time of publication was attributed to Wordsworth, but was written by another, though it probably was seen by him, and had a line or two of his in it, and corrections by him.

“This is certainly the truth; and I should think that he probably himself told all that truth to the officials, when transmitting the Ode; but that they concealed the circumstance; and that Wordsworth, then profoundly depressed in spirits, gave no more thought to the subject, and soon forgot all about it....

“Yours very sincerely,

“AUBREY DE VERE.”

It was in compliance with Mr. Aubrey de Vere’s request that, in this edition, I departed, in a single instance, from the chronological arrangement of the poems.

It may not be too trivial a detail to mention that I gladly gave permission to other editors of Wordsworth to make use of any of the material which I discovered, and brought together, in former editions; e.g. to Mr. George, in Boston, for his edition of *The Prelude* (in which, if the reader, or critic, compares my original edition with his notes, he will see what Mr. George has done); and to Professor Dowden, Trinity College, Dublin, for his most admirable Aldine edition. For the latter—which will always hold a high

place in Wordsworth literature—I placed everything asked from me at the disposal of Mr. Dowden.

While these sheets are passing through the press, Dr. Garnett, of the British Museum—one of the kindest and ablest of bibliographers—has forwarded to me a contribution, previously sent by him to *The Academy*, and printed in its issue of January 2, 1897.

I have no means of knowing—or of ultimately discovering—whether that sonnet, printed as Wordsworth’s, is really his. Dr. Garnett says, in his letter to me, “The verses were undoubtedly in Wordsworth’s hand”; and, he adds, “I think they should be preserved, because they are Wordsworth’s, and as an additional proof of his regard for Camoens, whom he enumerates elsewhere among great sonnet-writers. I have added a version of the quatrains, that the piece may be complete. From the character of the handwriting, the lines would seem to have been written down in old age; and I am not quite certain of the word which I have transcribed as ‘Austral.’”

Vasco, whose bold and happy mainyard spread
Sunward thy sails where dawning glory dyed
Heaven’s Orient gate; whose westering prow the tide
Clove, where the day star bows him to his bed:
Not sterner toil than thine, or strife more dread,
Or nobler laud to nobler lyre allied,
His, who did baffled Polypheme deride;
Or his, whose scaring shaft the Harpy fled.
Camoens, he the accomplished and the good,
Gave to thy fame a more illustrious flight
Than that brave vessel, though she sailed so far.
Through him her course along the Austral flood
Is known to all beneath the polar star,
Through him the Antipodes in thy name delight.

WILLIAM KNIGHT.

WORDSWORTH'S POETICAL WORKS

1834

LINES

SUGGESTED BY A PORTRAIT FROM THE PENCIL OF F. STONE

Composed 1834.—Published 1835

[This Portrait has hung for many years in our principal sitting-room, and represents J. Q.[\[1\]](#) as she was when a girl. The picture, though it is somewhat thinly painted, has much merit in tone and general effect: it is chiefly valuable, however, from the sentiment that pervades it. The anecdote of the saying of the monk in sight of Titian's picture was told in this house by Mr. Wilkie, and was, I believe, first communicated to the public in this poem, the former portion of which I was composing at the time. Southey heard the story from Miss Hutchinson, and transferred it to the *Doctor*; but it is not easy to explain how my friend Mr. Rogers, in a note subsequently added to his *Italy*, was led to speak of the same remarkable words having many years before been spoken in his hearing by a monk or priest in front of a picture of the Last Supper, placed over a Refectory-table in a convent at Padua.—I.F.]

One of the "Poems of Sentiment and Reflection."—ED.

Beguiled into forgetfulness of care
Due to the day's unfinished task; of pen
Or book regardless, and of that fair scene
In Nature's prodigality displayed
Before my window, oftentimes and long 5
I gaze upon a Portrait whose mild gleam
Of beauty never ceases to enrich
The common light; whose stillness charms the air,
Or seems to charm it, into like repose;
Whose silence, for the pleasure of the ear, 10
Surpasses sweetest music. There she sits
With emblematic purity attired
In a white vest, white as her marble neck
Is, and the pillar of the throat would be
But for the shadow by the drooping chin 15
Cast into that recess—the tender shade,
The shade and light, both there and every where,
And through the very atmosphere she breathes,
Broad, clear, and toned harmoniously, with skill
That might from nature have been learnt in the hour 20
When the lone shepherd sees the morning spread
Upon the mountains. Look at her, whome'er
Thou be that, kindling with a poet's soul,
Hast loved the painter's true Promethean craft
Intensely—from Imagination take 25
The treasure,—what mine eyes behold see thou,
Even though the Atlantic ocean roll between.

A silver line, that runs from brow to crown
And in the middle parts the braided hair,
Just serves to show how delicate a soil 30
The golden harvest grows in; and those eyes,

Soft and capacious as a cloudless sky
Whose azure depth their colour emulates,
Must needs be conversant with upward looks,
Prayer's voiceless service; but now, seeking nought 35
And shunning nought, their own peculiar life
Of motion they renounce, and with the head
Partake its inclination towards earth
In humble grace, and quiet pensiveness
Caught at the point where it stops short of sadness. 40

Offspring of soul-bewitching Art, make me
Thy confidant! say, whence derived that air
Of calm abstraction? Can the ruling thought
Be with some lover far away, or one
Crossed by misfortune, or of doubted faith? 45
Inapt conjecture! Childhood here, a moon
Crescent in simple loveliness serene,
Has but approached the gates of womanhood,
Not entered them; her heart is yet unpierced
By the blind Archer-god; her fancy free: 50
The fount of feeling, if unsought elsewhere,
Will not be found.

Her right hand, as it lies
Across the slender wrist of the left arm
Upon her lap reposing, holds—but mark
How slackly, for the absent mind permits 55
No firmer grasp—a little wild-flower, joined
As in a posy, with a few pale ears
Of yellowing corn, the same that overtopped
And in their common birthplace sheltered it
'Till they were plucked together; a blue flower 60
Called by the thrifty husbandman a weed;
But Ceres, in her garden, might have sworn

But Ceres, in her garland, might have worn
That ornament, unblamed. The floweret, held
In scarcely conscious fingers, was, she knows,
(Her Father told her so) in youth's gay dawn 65
Her Mother's favourite; and the orphan Girl,
In her own dawn—a dawn less gay and bright,
Loves it, while there in solitary peace
She sits, for that departed Mother's sake.
—Not from a source less sacred is derived 70
(Surely I do not err) that pensive air
Of calm abstraction through the face diffused
And the whole person.

Words have something told
More than the pencil can, and verily
More than is needed, but the precious Art 75
Forgives their interference—Art divine,
That both creates and fixes, in despite
Of Death and Time, the marvels it hath wrought.

Strange contrasts have we in this world of ours!
That posture, and the look of filial love 80
Thinking of past and gone, with what is left
Dearly united, might be swept away
From this fair Portrait's fleshly Archetype,
Even by an innocent fancy's slightest freak
Banished, nor ever, haply, be restored 85
To their lost place, or meet in harmony
So exquisite; but *here* do they abide,
Enshrined for ages. Is not then the Art
Godlike, a humble branch of the divine,
In visible quest of immortality, 90
Stretched forth with trembling hope?—In every realm,
From high Gibraltar to Siberian plains,
Thousands in each variety of tongue

Thousands, in each variety of tongue
That Europe knows, would echo this appeal;
One above all, a Monk who waits on God 95
In the magnific Convent built of yore
To sanctify the Escorial palace. He—
Guiding, from cell to cell and room to room,
A British Painter (eminent for truth
In character,[\[2\]](#) and depth of feeling, shown 100
By labours that have touched the hearts of kings,
And are endeared to simple cottagers)—
Came, in that service, to a glorious work,[\[3\]](#)
Our Lord's Last Supper, beautiful as when first
The appropriate Picture, fresh from Titian's hand, 105
Graced the Refectory: and there, while both
Stood with eyes fixed upon that masterpiece,
The hoary Father in the Stranger's ear
Breathed out these words:—"Here daily do we sit,
Thanks given to God for daily bread, and here 110
Pondering the mischiefs of these restless times,
And thinking of my Brethren, dead, dispersed,
Or changed and changing, I not seldom gaze
Upon this solemn Company unmoved
By shock of circumstance, or lapse of years, 115
Until I cannot but believe that they—
They are in truth the Substance, we
the Shadows."[\[4\]](#)

So spake the mild Jeronymite, his griefs
Melting away within him like a dream
Ere he had ceased to gaze, perhaps to speak: 120
And I, grown old, but in a happier land,
Domestic Portrait! have to verse consigned
In thy calm presence those heart-moving words:

Words that can soothe, more than they agitate;
Whose spirit, like the angel that went down 125
Into Bethesda's pool, with healing virtue
Informs the fountain in the human breast
Which[5] by the visitation was disturbed.
——But why this stealing tear? Companion mute,
On thee I look, not sorrowing; fare thee well, 130
My Song's Inspirer, once again farewell![6]

[1] Jemima Quillinan, the eldest daughter of Edward Quillinan, Wordsworth's future son-in-law. The portrait was taken when she was a school-girl, and while her father resided at Oporto.—ED.

[2] Wilkie. See the Fenwick note.—ED.

[3] 1837.

Left not unvisited a glorious work,
1835.

[4] “When Wilkie was in the Escorial, looking at Titian's famous picture of the Last Supper, in the Refectory there, an old Jeronymite said to him: ‘I have sate daily in sight of that picture for now nearly three score years; during that time my companions have dropt off, one after another—all who were my seniors, all who were my contemporaries, and many, or most of those who were younger than myself; more than one generation has passed away, and there the figures in the picture have remained unchanged! I look at them till I sometimes think that they are the realities, and we but shadows!’

I wish I could record the name of the monk by whom that natural feeling was so feelingly and strikingly expressed.

The shows of things are better than themselves,

says the author of the tragedy of Nero, whose name also I could wish had been forthcoming; and the classical reader will remember the lines of Sophocles:

ὁρῶ γὰρ ἡμᾶς οὐδὲν ὄντας ἄλλο, πλὴν
εἶδωλ', ὅσοι περ ζῶμεν, ἢ κούφην σκιάν.

These are reflections which should make us think

Of that same time when no more change shall be
But steadfast rest of all things, firmly stayd
Upon the pillars of Eternity,
That is contrain to mutability;
For all that moveth doth in change delight:
But henceforth all shall rest eternally
With Him that is the God of Sabaoth hight,
O that great Sabaoth God grant me that Sabbath's sight.

SPENSER."

(Southey, *The Doctor*, vol. iii. p. 235.)—ED.

[5] 1837.

That ...

1835.

[6] The pile of buildings, composing the palace and convent of San Lorenzo, has, in common usage, lost its proper name in that of the *Escorial*, a village at the foot of the hill upon which the splendid edifice, built by Philip the Second, stands. It need scarcely be added, that Wilkie is the painter alluded to.—W.W. 1835.

THE FOREGOING SUBJECT RESUMED

Composed 1834.—Published 1835.

One of the "Poems of Sentiment and Reflection."—ED.

Among a grave fraternity of Monks,
For One, but surely not for One alone,
Triumphs, in that great work, the Painter's skill,
Humbling the body, to exalt the soul;
Yet representing, amid wreck and wrong 5
And dissolution and decay, the warm
And breathing life of flesh, as if already
Clothed with impassive majesty, and graced
With no mean earnest of a heritage
Assigned to it in future worlds. Thou, too, 10
With thy memorial flower, meek Portraiture!
From whose serene companionship I passed
Pursued by thoughts that haunt me still; thou also—
Though but a simple object, into light
Called forth by those affections that endear 15
The private hearth; though keeping thy sole seat
In singleness, and little tried by time,
Creation, as it were, of yesterday—
With a congenial function art endued
For each and all of us, together joined 20
In course of nature under a low roof
By charities and duties that proceed
Out of the bosom of a wiser vow.
To a like salutary sense of awe
Or sacred wonder, growing with the power 25
Of meditation that attempts to weigh,
In faithful scales, things and their opposites,
Can thy enduring quiet gently raise
A household small and sensitive,—whose love,
Dependent as in part its blessings are 30
Upon frail ties dissolving or dissolved
On earth, will be revived, we trust, in heaven.[\[7\]](#)

[7] In the class entitled “Musings,” in Mr. Southey’s Minor Poems, is one upon his own miniature picture, taken in childhood, and another upon a landscape painted by Gaspar Poussin. It is possible that every word of the above verses, though similar in subject, might have been written had the author been unacquainted with those beautiful effusions of poetic sentiment. But, for his own satisfaction, he must be allowed thus publicly to acknowledge the pleasure those two poems of his Friend have given him, and the grateful influence they have upon his mind as often as he reads them, or thinks of them.—W.W. 1835.

TO A CHILD WRITTEN IN HER ALBUM[8]

Composed 1834.—Published 1835

[This quatrain was extempore on observing this image, as I had often done, on the lawn of Rydal Mount. It was first written down in the Album of my God-daughter, Rotha Quillinan.—I.F.]

In 1837 this was one of the “Inscriptions.” In 1845 it was transferred to the “Miscellaneous Poems.”—ED.

Small service is true service while it lasts:
Of humblest Friends, bright Creature! scorn not one![9]
The Daisy, by the shadow that it casts,
Protects the lingering dew-drop from the Sun.[10]

[8] The original title (1835) was “Written in an Album.” In 1837 it was “Written in the Album of a Child.” In 1845 the title was reconstructed as above.

[9] 1845.

Of Friends, however humble, scorn not one:

1835.

[10] Compare the lines, written in 1845, beginning—

So fair, so sweet, withal so sensitive.

ED.

LINES

**WRITTEN IN THE ALBUM OF THE COUNTESS OF LONSDALE,[\[11\]](#) NOV. 5,
1834**

Composed 1834.—Published 1835

[This is a faithful picture of that amiable Lady, as she then was. The youthfulness of figure and demeanour and habits, which she retained in almost unprecedented degree, departed a very few years after, and she died without violent disease by gradual decay before she reached the period of old age.—I.F.]

This was placed, in 1845, among the “Miscellaneous Poems.”—ED.

Lady! a Pen (perhaps with thy regard,
Among the Favoured, favoured not the least)
Left, 'mid the Records of this Book inscribed,
Deliberate traces, registers of thought
And feeling, suited to the place and time 5
That gave them birth:—months passed, and still this hand,
That had not been too timid to imprint
Words which the virtues of thy Lord inspired,
Was yet not bold enough to write of Thee.
And why that scrupulous reserve? In sooth 10
The blameless cause lay in the Theme itself.
Flowers are there many that delight to strive
With the sharp wind, and seem to court the shower,
Yet are by nature careless of the sun
Whether he shine on them or not; and some, 15
Where'er he moves along the unclouded sky,
Turn a broad front full on his flattering beams:
Others do rather from their notice shrink,
Loving the dewy shade,—a humble band,
Modest and sweet, a progeny of earth, 20
Congenial with thy mind and character,
High-born Augusta!

Witness Towers, and Groves!
And Thou, wild Stream, that giv'st the honoured name^[12]
Of Lowther to this ancient Line, bear witness^[13]
From thy most secret haunts; and ye Parterres, 25
Which She is pleased and proud to call her own,
Witness how oft upon my noble Friend
Mute offerings, tribute from an inward sense
Of admiration and respectful love,
Have waited—till the affections could no more 30
Endure that silence, and broke out in song,

Snatches of music taken up and dropt
Like those self-solacing, those under, notes
Trilled by the redbreast, when autumnal leaves
Are thin upon the bough. Mine, only mine, 35
The pleasure was, and no one heard the praise,
Checked, in the moment of its issue, checked
And reprehended, by a fancied blush
From the pure qualities that called it forth.

Thus Virtue lives debarred from Virtue's meed; 40
Thus, Lady, is retiredness a veil
That, while it only spreads a softening charm
O'er features looked at by discerning eyes,
Hides half their beauty from the common gaze;
And thus,[\[14\]](#) even on the exposed and breezy hill 45
Of lofty station, female goodness walks,
When side by side with lunar gentleness,
As in a cloister. Yet the grateful Poor
(Such the immunities of low estate,
Plain Nature's enviable privilege, 50
Her sacred recompense for many wants)
Open their hearts before Thee, pouring out
All that they think and feel, with tears of joy;
And benedictions not unheard in heaven:
And friend in the ear of friend, where speech is free 55
To follow truth, is eloquent as they.

Then let the Book receive in these prompt lines
A just memorial; and thine eyes consent
To read that they, who mark thy course, behold
A life declining with the golden light 60
Of summer, in the season of sere leaves;[\[15\]](#)
See cheerfulness undamped by stealing Time;

See studied kindness flow with easy stream,
Illustrated with inborn courtesy;
And an habitual disregard of self 65
Balanced by vigilance for others' weal.

And shall the Verse not tell of lighter gifts
With these ennobling attributes conjoined
And blended, in peculiar harmony,
By Youth's surviving spirit? What agile grace! 70
A nymph-like liberty, in nymph-like form,
Beheld with wonder; whether floor or path
Thou tread; or sweep—borne on the managed steed—[\[16\]](#)
Fleet as the shadows, over down or field,
Driven by strong winds at play among the clouds. 75

Yet one word more—one farewell word—a wish
Which came, but it has passed into a prayer—
That, as thy sun in brightness is declining,
So—at an hour yet distant for *their* sakes
Whose tender love, here faltering on the way 80
Of a diviner love, will be forgiven—
So may it set in peace, to rise again
For everlasting glory won by faith.

[\[11\]](#) 1837.

Countess of ——
1835.

[\[12\]](#) The Lowther stream passes the Castle, and joins the Eamont below Brougham Hall, near Penrith.—ED.

[\[13\]](#) 1837.

Towers, and stately Groves,
Bear witness for me; thou, too, Mountain-stream!

1835.

[\[14\]](#)

When hence ...

C.

[\[15\]](#) Compare *September, 1819*, and *Upon the Same Occasion*, vol. vi. pp. 201, 202, especially the lines in the latter—

Me, conscious that my leaf is sere,
And yellow on the bough, etc.

ED.

[\[16\]](#) 1837.

Thou tread, or on the managed steed art borne,

1835.

1835

Two Evening Voluntaries, two Elegies (on the deaths of Charles Lamb and James Hogg), the lines on the Bird of Paradise, and a few sonnets, make up the poems belonging to the year 1835.—ED.

“WHY ART THOU SILENT? IS THY LOVE A PLANT”

Composed 1835 (or earlier).—Published 1835

[In the month of January,—when Dora and I were walking from Town-end, Grasmere, across the Vale, snow being on the ground, she espied, in the thick though leafless hedge, a bird's nest half-filled with snow. Out of this comfortless appearance arose this Sonnet, which was, in fact, written without the least reference to any individual object, but merely to prove to myself that I could, if I thought fit, write in a strain that Poets have been fond of. On the 14th of February in the same year, my daughter, in a sportive mood, sent it as a Valentine, under a fictitious name, to her cousin C.W.—I.F.]

One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

Why art thou silent? Is thy love a plant
Of such weak fibre that the treacherous air
Of absence withers what was once so fair?
Is there no debt to pay, no boon to grant?
Yet have my thoughts for thee been vigilant— 5
Bound to thy service with unceasing care,[\[17\]](#)
The mind's least generous wish a mendicant
For nought but what thy happiness could spare.
Speak—though this soft warm heart, once free to hold
A thousand tender pleasures, thine and mine, 10
Be left more desolate, more dreary cold
Than a forsaken bird's-nest filled with snow
'Mid its own bush of leafless eglantine—
Speak, that my torturing doubts their end may know!

[\[17\]](#) 1845.

... with incessant care,

C.

(As would my deeds have been) with hourly care,

1835.

**TO THE MOON
(COMPOSED BY THE SEA-SIDE,—ON THE COAST OF
CUMBERLAND)**

Composed 1835.—Published 1837

One of the “Evening Voluntaries.”—ED.

Wanderer! that stoop'st so low, and com'st so near
To human life's unsettled atmosphere;
Who lov'st with Night and Silence to partake,
So might it seem, the cares of them that wake;
And, through the cottage-lattice softly peeping, 5
Dost shield from harm the humblest of the sleeping;
What pleasure once encompassed those sweet names
Which yet in thy behalf the Poet claims,
An idolizing dreamer as of yore!—
I slight them all; and, on this sea-beat shore 10
Sole-sitting, only can to thoughts attend
That bid me hail thee as the SAILOR'S FRIEND;
So call thee for heaven's grace through thee made known
By confidence supplied and mercy shown,
When not a twinkling star or beacon's light 15
Abates the perils of a stormy night;
And for less obvious benefits, that find
Their way, with thy pure help, to heart and mind;
Both for the adventurer starting in life's prime;
And veteran ranging round from clime to clime, 20
Long-baffled hope's slow fever in his veins,
And wounds and weakness oft his labour's sole remains.

The aspiring Mountains and the winding Streams,
Empress of Night! are gladdened by thy beams;
A look of thine the wilderness pervades, 25
And penetrates the forest's inmost shades;
Thou, chequering peaceably the minster's gloom,
Guid'st the pale Mourner to the lost one's tomb;
Canst reach the Prisoner—to his grated cell
Welcome, though silent and intangible!— 30
And lives there one, of all that come and go

On the great waters toiling to and fro,
One, who has watched thee at some quiet hour
Enthroned aloft in undisputed power,
Or crossed by vapoury streaks and clouds that move 35
Catching the lustre they in part reprove—
Nor sometimes felt a fitness in thy sway
To call up thoughts that shun the glare of day,
And make the serious happier than the gay?

Yes, lovely Moon! if thou so mildly bright 40
Dost rouse, yet surely in thy own despite,
To fiercer mood the phrenzy-stricken brain,
Let me a compensating faith maintain;
That there's a sensitive, a tender, part
Which thou canst touch in every human heart, 45
For healing and composure.—But, as least
And mightiest billows ever have confessed
Thy domination; as the whole vast Sea
Feels through her lowest depths thy sovereignty;
So shines that countenance with especial grace 50
On them who urge the keel her *plains* to trace
Furrowing its way right onward. The most rude,
Cut off from home and country, may have stood—
Even till long gazing hath bedimmed his eye,
Or the mute rapture ended in a sigh— 55
Touched by accordance of thy placid cheer,
With some internal lights to memory dear,
Or fancies stealing forth to soothe the breast
Tired with its daily share of earth's unrest,—
Gentle awakenings, visitations meek; 60
A kindly influence whereof few will speak,
Though it can wet with tears the hardest cheek.

And when thy beauty in the shadowy cove

And when thy beauty in the shadowy cave
Is hidden, buried in its monthly grave;^[18]
Then, while the Sailor, 'mid an open sea 65
Swept by a favouring wind that leaves thought free,
Paces the deck—no star perhaps in sight,
And nothing save the moving ship's own light
To cheer the long dark hours of vacant night—
Oft with his musings does thy image blend, 70
In his mind's eye thy crescent horns ascend,
And thou art still, O Moon, that SAILOR'S FRIEND!

^[18] Compare—

When thou wert hidden in thy monthly grave,

in the lines *Written in a Grotto*, p. 235.—ED.

TO THE MOON (RYDAL)

Composed 1835.—Published 1837

One of the “Evening Voluntaries.”—ED.

Queen of the stars!—so gentle, so benign,
That ancient Fable did to thee assign,
When darkness creeping o'er thy silver brow
Warned thee these upper regions to forego,
Alternate empire in the shades below— 5
A Bard, who, lately near the wide-spread sea
Traversed by gleaming ships, looked up to thee
With grateful thoughts, doth now thy rising hail
From the close confines of a shadowy vale.
Glory of night, conspicuous yet serene, 10
Nor less attractive when by glimpses seen
Through cloudy umbrage, [\[19\]](#) well might that fair face,
And all those attributes of modest grace,
In days when Fancy wrought unchecked by fear,
Down to the green earth fetch thee from thy sphere, 15
To sit in leafy woods by fountains clear!

O still belov'd (for thine, meek Power, are charms
That fascinate the very Babe in arms,
While he, uplifted towards thee, laughs outright,
Spreading his little palms in his glad Mother's sight) 20
O still belov'd, once worshipped! Time, that frowns
In his destructive flight on earthly crowns,
Spare thy mild splendour; still those far-shot beams
Tremble on dancing waves and rippling streams
With stainless touch, as chaste as when thy praise 25
Was sung by Virgin-choirs in festal lays;
And through dark trials still dost thou explore
Thy way for increase punctual as of yore,
When teeming Matrons—yielding to rude faith
In mysteries of birth and life and death 30
And painful struggle and deliverance—prayed

Of thee to visit them with lenient aid.
What though the rites be swept away, the fanes
Extinct that echoed to the votive strains;
Yet thy mild aspect does not, cannot, cease 35
Love to promote and purity and peace;
And Fancy, unproved, even yet may trace
Faint types of suffering in thy beamless face.

Then, silent Monitress! let us—not blind
To worlds unthought of till the searching mind 40
Of Science laid them open to mankind—
Told, also, how the voiceless heavens declare
God's glory; and acknowledging thy share
In that blest charge; let us—without offence
To aught of highest, holiest, influence— 45
Receive whatever good 'tis given thee to dispense.
May sage and simple, catching with one eye
The moral intimations of the sky,
Learn from thy course, where'er their own be taken,
"To look on tempests, and be never shaken";[20] 50
To keep with faithful step the appointed way
Eclipsing or eclipsed, by night or day,
And from example of thy monthly range
Gently to brook decline and fatal change;
Meek, patient, steadfast, and with loftier scope, 55
Than thy revival yields, for gladsome hope![21]

[19] Compare *The Triad*, vol. vii. p. 181.—ED.

[20] Compare l. 6 of Shakespeare's sonnet, beginning—

Let me not to the marriage of true minds.

[\[21\]](#) See a fragment of ten lines, which was written by Wordsworth in MS. after the above, in a copy of his poems. They are printed in the Appendix to this volume.—ED.

WRITTEN AFTER THE DEATH OF CHARLES LAMB

[Light will be thrown upon the tragic circumstance alluded to in this poem when, after the death of Charles Lamb's Sister, his biographer, Mr. Sergeant Talfourd, shall be at liberty to relate particulars which could not, at the time his Memoir was written, be given to the public. Mary Lamb was ten years older than her brother, and has survived him as long a time. Were I to give way to my own feelings, I should dwell not only on her genius and intellectual powers, but upon the delicacy and refinement of manner which she maintained inviolable under most trying circumstances. She was loved

and honoured by all her brother's friends; and others, some of them strange characters, whom his philanthropic peculiarities induced him to countenance. The death of C. Lamb himself was doubtless hastened by his sorrow for that of Coleridge, to whom he had been attached from the time of their being school-fellows at Christ's Hospital. Lamb was a good Latin scholar, and probably would have gone to college upon one of the school foundations but for the impediment in his speech. Had such been his lot, he would most likely have been preserved from the indulgences of social humours and fancies which were often injurious to himself, and causes of severe regret to his friends, without really benefiting the object of his misapplied kindness.—I.F.]

In the edition of 1837, these lines had no title. They were printed privately,—before their first appearance in that edition,—as a small pamphlet of seven pages without title or heading. A copy will be found in the fifth volume of the collection of pamphlets, forming part of the library bequeathed by the late Mr. John Forster to the South Kensington Museum. There are several readings to be found only in this privately-printed edition. The poem was placed among the “Epitaphs and Elegiac Pieces.”—ED.

Composed November 19, 1835.—Published 1837

To a good Man of most dear memory[22]
This Stone is sacred.[23] Here he lies apart
From the great city where he first drew breath,
Was reared and taught; and humbly earned his bread,
To the strict labours of the merchant's desk 5
By duty chained. Not seldom did those tasks
Tease, and the thought of time so spent depress,
His spirit, but the recompense was high;
Firm Independence, Bounty's rightful sire;
Affections, warm as sunshine, free as air; 10
And when the precious hours of leisure came,
Knowledge and wisdom, gained from converse sweet
With books, or while he ranged the crowded streets
With a keen eye, and overflowing heart:
So genius triumphed over seeming wrong, 15
And poured out truth in works by thoughtful love
Inspired—works potent over smiles and tears.
And as round mountain-tops the lightning plays,
Thus innocently sported, breaking forth
As from a cloud of some grave sympathy, 20
Humour and wild instinctive wit, and all
The vivid flashes of his spoken words.
From the most gentle creature nursed in fields[24]
Had been derived the name he bore—a name,
Wherever christian altars have been raised, 25
Hallowed to meekness and to innocence;
And if in him meekness at times gave way,
Provoked out of herself by troubles strange,
Many and strange, that hung about his life;[25]
Still, at the centre of his being, lodged 30
A soul by resignation sanctified:
And if too often self-renounced he felt

And in too often, self-reproached, he felt
That innocence belongs not to our kind,
A power that never ceased to abide in him,
Charity, 'mid the multitude of sins[26] 35
That she can cover, left not his exposed
To an unforgiving judgment from just Heaven.
O, he was good, if e'er a good Man lived!

From a reflecting mind and sorrowing heart
Those simple lines flowed with an earnest wish, 40
Though but a doubting hope, that they might serve
Fitly to guard the precious dust of him
Whose virtues called them forth. That aim is missed;
For much that truth most urgently required
Had from a faltering pen been asked in vain: 45
Yet, haply, on the printed page received,
The imperfect record, there, may stand unblamed
As long as verse of mine shall breathe the air
Of memory, or see the light of love.[27]

Thou wert a scorner of the fields, my Friend, 50
But more in show than truth;[28] and from the fields,
And from the mountains, to thy rural grave
Transported, my soothed spirit hovers o'er
Its green untrodden turf, and blowing flowers;
And taking up a voice shall speak (tho' still 55
Awed by the theme's peculiar sanctity
Which words less free presumed not even to touch)
Of that fraternal love, whose heaven-lit lamp
From infancy, through manhood, to the last
Of threescore years, and to thy latest hour, 60
Burnt on with ever-strengthening light, enshrined[29]
Within thy bosom.

“Wonderful” hath been

The love established between man and man,
“Passing the love of women;” and between
Man and his help-mate in fast wedlock joined 65
Through God,[\[30\]](#) is raised a spirit and soul of love
Without whose blissful influence Paradise
Had been no Paradise; and earth were now
A waste where creatures bearing human form,
Direst of savage beasts, would roam in fear, 70
Joyless and comfortless. Our days glide on;[\[31\]](#)
And let him grieve who cannot choose but grieve
That he hath been an Elm without his Vine,
And her bright dower of clustering charities,
That, round his trunk and branches, might have clung 75
Enriching and adorning. Unto thee,
Not so enriched, not so adorned, to thee
Was given (say rather thou of later birth
Wert given to her) a Sister—’tis a word
Timidly uttered, for she *lives*, the meek, 80
The self-restraining, and the ever-kind;
In whom thy reason and intelligent heart
Found—for all interests, hopes, and tender cares,
All softening, humanising, hallowing powers,
Whether withheld, or for her sake unsought— 85
More than sufficient recompense!

Her love

(What weakness prompts the voice to tell it here?)
Was as the love of mothers; and when years,
Lifting the boy to man’s estate, had called
The long-protected to assume the part 90
Of a protector, the first filial tie
Was undissolved; and, in or out of sight,
Remained imperishably interwoven

With life itself. 'Thus, 'mid a shifting world,
Did they together testify of time[32] 95
And season's difference—a double tree
With two collateral stems sprung from one root;
Such were they—such thro' life they *might* have been
In union, in partition only such;
Otherwise wrought the will of the Most High; 100
Yet, thro' all visitations and all trials,
Still they were faithful; like two vessels launched
From the same beach one ocean to explore[33]
With mutual help, and sailing—to their league
True, as inexorable winds, or bars 105
Floating or fixed of polar ice, allow.[34]

But turn we rather, let my spirit turn
With thine, O silent and invisible Friend!
To those dear intervals, nor rare nor brief,
When reunited, and by choice withdrawn 110
From miscellaneous converse, ye were taught
That the remembrance of foregone distress,
And the worse fear of future ill (which oft
Doth hang around it, as a sickly child
Upon its mother) may be both alike 115
Disarmed of power to unsettle present good
So prized, and things inward and outward held
In such an even balance, that the heart
Acknowledges God's grace, his mercy feels,
And in its depth of gratitude is still. 120

O gift divine of quiet sequestration!
The hermit, exercised in prayer and praise,
And feeding daily on the hope of heaven,
Is happy in his vow, and fondly cleaves

to life-long singleness; but happier far 125
Was to your souls, and, to the thoughts of others,
A thousand times more beautiful appeared,
Your *dual* loneliness. The sacred tie
Is broken; yet why grieve? for Time but holds
His moiety in trust, till Joy shall lead 130
To the blest world where parting is unknown.[35]

[22] 1837.

To the dear memory of a frail good Man

In privately printed edition.

[23] Charles Lamb died December 27, 1834, and was buried in Edmonton Churchyard, in a spot selected by himself.—ED.

[24] This way of indicating the *name* of my lamented friend has been found fault with, perhaps rightly so; but I may say in justification of the double sense of the word, that similar allusions are not uncommon in epitaphs. One of the best in our language in verse, I ever read, was upon a person who bore the name of Palmer†; and the course of the thought, throughout, turned upon the Life of the Departed, considered as a pilgrimage. Nor can I think that the objection in the present case will have much force with any one who remembers Charles Lamb's beautiful sonnet addressed to his own name, and ending—

No deed of mine shall shame thee, gentle name!

W. W. 1837.

† 1840. Pilgrim; 1837.

Professor Henry Reed, in his edition of 1837, added the following note to Wordsworth's. "In *Hierologus*, a Church Tour through England and Wales, I have met with an epitaph which is probably the one alluded to above ... a Kentish epitaph on one Palmer:

Palmer all our fathers were;
I, a Palmer lived here,
And traveyled sore, till worn with age,
I ended this world's pilgrimage,
On the blest Ascension Day
In the cheerful month of May."

The above is Professor Reed's note. The following is an exact copy of the epitaph:—

Palmers all our faders were;
I, a *Palmer* livyd here
And travyld still till worne wyth age,
I endyd this world's pylgramage,
On the blyst assention day
In the cherful month of May;
A thowsand wyth fowre hundryd seven,
And took my jorney hense to heven.
(Printed by Weever.)

ED.

[25] Compare Talfourd's *Final Memorials of Charles Lamb*, *passim*.—ED.

[26] 1837.

He had a constant friend—in Charity;
HER who, among a multitude of sins,
In privately printed edition.

[27] 1837.

From a reflecting mind and sorrowing heart
This tribute flow'd, with hope that it might guard
The dust of him whose virtues call'd it forth;
But 'tis a little space of earth that man,
Stretch'd out in death, is doom'd to occupy;
Still smaller space doth modest custom yield,
On sculptured tomb or tablet, to the claims
Of the deceased, or rights of the bereft.
'Tis well; and tho', the record overstepped
Those narrow bounds, yet on the printed page
Received, there may it stand, I trust, unblamed
As long as verse of mine shall steal from tears
Their bitterness, or live to shed a gleam
Of solace over one dejected thought.

In privately printed edition.

Professor Dowden quotes, from “a slip of MS. in the poet’s hand-writing,” the following variation of these lines—

’Tis well, and if the Record in the strength
And earnestness of feeling, overpass’d
Those narrow limits and so miss’d its aim,
Yet will I trust that on the printed page
Received, it there may keep a place unblamed.

ED.

[28] Lamb’s indifference to the country “was a sort of ‘mock apparel,’ in which it was his humour at times to invest himself.” (H. N. Coleridge, Supplement to the *Biographia Literaria*, p. 333.)—ED.

[29] 1837.

Burned, and with ever-strengthening light, enshrined
In privately printed edition.

[30] 1837.

By God, ...
In privately printed edition.

[31] 1837.

... Our days pass on;
In privately printed edition.

[32] 1837.

Together stood they witnessing of time
In privately printed edition.

[33] 1837.

Yet, in all visitations, through all trials
Still they were faithful, like two goodly ships
Launch'd from the beach, ...

In privately printed edition.

[34] Compare the testimony borne to Mary Lamb by Mr. Procter (Barry Cornwall), and by Henry Crabb Robinson.—ED.

[35] 1837.

... The sacred tie
Is broken, to become more sacred still.

In privately printed edition.

Wordsworth originally meant to write an epitaph on Charles Lamb, but his verse grew into an elegy of some length. A reference to the circumstance of its “composition” will be found in one of his letters, in a later volume.—ED.

EXTEMPORE EFFUSION UPON THE DEATH OF JAMES HOGG

Composed 1835.—Published 1835

[These verses were written extempore, immediately after reading a notice of the Ettrick Shepherd's death, in the Newcastle paper, to the Editor of which I sent a copy for publication. The persons lamented in these verses were all either of my friends or acquaintance. In Lockhart's *Life of Sir Walter Scott*, an account is given of my first meeting with him in 1803. How the Ettrick Shepherd and I became known to each other has already been mentioned in these notes. He was undoubtedly a man of original genius, but of coarse manners and low and offensive opinions. Of Coleridge and Lamb I need not speak here. Crabbe I have met in London at Mr. Rogers's, but more frequently and favourably at Mr. Hoare's upon Hampstead Heath. Every spring he used to pay that family a visit of some length, and was upon terms of intimate friendship with Mrs. Hoare, and still more with her daughter-in-law, who has a large collection of his letters addressed to herself. After the Poet's decease, application was made to her to give up these letters to his biographer, that they, or at least part of them,

might be given to the public. She hesitated to comply, and asked my opinion on the subject. "By no means," was my answer, grounded not upon any objection there might be to publishing a selection from these letters, but from an aversion I have always felt to meet idle curiosity by calling back the recently departed to become the object of trivial and familiar gossip. Crabbe obviously for the most part preferred the company of women to that of men, for this among other reasons, that he did not like to be put upon the stretch in general conversation: accordingly in miscellaneous society his *talk* was so much below what might have been expected from a man so deservedly celebrated, that to me it seemed trifling. It must upon other occasions have been of a different character, as I found in our rambles together on Hampstead Heath, and not so much from a readiness to communicate his knowledge of life and manners as of natural history in all its branches. His mind was inquisitive, and he seems to have taken refuge from the remembrance of the distresses he had gone through, in these studies and the employments to which they led. Moreover, such contemplations might tend profitably to counterbalance the painful truths which he had collected from his intercourse with mankind. Had I been more intimate with him, I should have ventured to touch upon his office as a minister of the Gospel, and how far his heart and soul were in it so as to make him a zealous and diligent labourer: in poetry, though he wrote much as we all know, he assuredly was not so. I happened once to speak of pains as necessary to produce merit of a certain kind which I highly valued: his observation was—"It is not worth while." You are quite right, thought I, if the labour encroaches upon the time due to teach truth as a steward of the mysteries of God: if there be cause to fear *that*, write less: but, if poetry is to be produced at all, make what you do produce as good as you can. Mr. Rogers once told me that he expressed his regret to Crabbe that he wrote in his later works so much less correctly than in his earlier. "Yes," replied he, "but then I had a reputation to make; now I can afford to relax." Whether it was from a modest estimate of his own qualifications, or from causes less creditable, his motives for writing verse and his hopes and aims were not so high as is to be desired. After being silent for more than twenty years, he again applied himself to poetry, upon the spur of applause he received from the periodical publications of the day, as he himself tells us in one of his prefaces. Is it not to be lamented that a man who was so conversant with permanent truth, and whose writings are so valuable an acquisition to our

When first, descending from the moorlands,
I saw the Stream of Yarrow glide
Along a bare and open valley,
The Ettrick Shepherd was my guide.[\[36\]](#)

When last along its banks I wandered, 5
Through groves that had begun to shed
Their golden leaves upon the pathways,
My steps the Border-minstrel led.

The mighty Minstrel breathes no longer,[\[37\]](#)
'Mid mouldering ruins low he lies;[\[38\]](#) 10
And death upon the braes of Yarrow,
Has closed the Shepherd-poet's eyes:[\[39\]](#)

Nor has the rolling year twice measured,
From sign to sign, its stedfast course,
Since every mortal power of Coleridge 15
Was frozen at its marvellous source;[\[40\]](#)

The rapt One, of the godlike forehead,[\[41\]](#)
The heaven-eyed creature sleeps in earth:
And Lamb, the frolic and the gentle,
Has vanished from his lonely hearth.[\[42\]](#) 20

Like clouds that rake the mountain-summits,[\[43\]](#)
Or waves that own no curbing hand,
How fast has brother followed brother,
From sunshine to the sunless land!

Yet I, whose lids from infant slumber[\[44\]](#) 25
Were earlier raised, remain to hear
A timid voice, that asks in whispers,

“Who next will drop and disappear?”

Our haughty life is crowned with darkness,
Like London with its own black wreath, 30
On which with thee, O Crabbe! forth-looking,
I gazed from Hampstead’s breezy heath.

As if but yesterday departed,
Thou too art gone before;[\[45\]](#) but why,
O’er ripe fruit, seasonably gathered, 35
Should frail survivors heave a sigh?

Mourn rather for that holy Spirit,
Sweet as the spring, as ocean deep;
For Her who, ere her summer faded,
Has sunk into a breathless sleep.[\[46\]](#) 40

No more of old romantic sorrows,
For slaughtered Youth or love-lorn Maid!
With sharper grief is Yarrow smitten,
And Ettrick mourns with her their Poet dead.[\[47\]](#)

[\[36\]](#) Compare *Yarrow Visited* (September, 1814), vol. vi. p. 35.—ED.

[\[37\]](#) Compare *Yarrow Revisited* (1831), vol. vii. p. 278.—ED.

[\[38\]](#) Scott died at Abbotsford, on the 21st September 1832, and was buried in Dryburgh Abbey.—ED.

[\[39\]](#) Hogg died at Altrive, on the 21st November 1835.—ED.

[\[40\]](#) Coleridge died at Highgate, on the 25th July 1834.—ED.

[\[41\]](#) Compare the *Stanzas written in my Pocket Copy of Thomson’s “Castle of Indolence”* (vol. ii. p. 307)—

Profound his forehead was, though not severe.

ED.

[\[42\]](#) Lamb died in London, on the 27th December 1834.—ED.

[43] “This expression is borrowed from a sonnet by Mr. G. Bell, the author of a small volume of poems lately printed at Penrith. Speaking of Skiddaw he says

Yon dark cloud ‘rakes,’ and shrouds its noble brow.”

(Henry Reed, 1837.)—ED.

[44] 1845.

... slumbers

1837.

[45] George Crabbe died at Trowbridge, Wiltshire, on the 3rd of February 1832.—ED.

[46] Felicia Hemans died 16th May 1835.—ED.

[47]

Grieve rather for that holy Spirit
Pure as the sky, as ocean deep;
For her who ere the summer faded
Has sunk into a breathless sleep.
No more of old romantic sorrows
For slaughtered Youth or love-lorn Maid!
With sharper grief is Yarrow smitten,
And Ettrick mourns her Shepherd Poet dead.

C.

UPON SEEING A COLOURED DRAWING OF THE BIRD OF PARADISE IN AN ALBUM

Composed 1835.—Published 1836

[I cannot forbear to record that the last seven lines of this Poem were composed in bed during the night of the day on which my sister Sara Hutchinson died about 6 P.M., and it was the thought of her innocent and beautiful life that, through faith, prompted the words——

On wings that fear no glance of God's pure sight,
No tempest from his breath.

The reader will find two poems on pictures of this bird among my Poems. I will here observe that in a far greater number of instances than have been mentioned in these notes one poem has, as in this case, grown out of another, either because I felt the subject had been inadequately treated, or that the thoughts and images suggested in course of composition have been such as I found interfered with the unity indispensable to every work of art, however humble in character.—I.F.]

One of the "Poems of Sentiment and Reflection."—ED.

Who rashly strove thy Image to portray?
Thou buoyant minion of the tropic air;
How could he think of the live creature——gay
With a divinity of colours, drest
In all her brightness, from the dancing crest 5
Far as the last gleam of the filmy train
Extended and extending to sustain
The motions that it graces——and forbear
To drop his pencil! Flowers of every clime
Depicted on these pages smile at time; 10
And gorgeous insects copied with nice care
Are here, and likenesses of many a shell
Tossed ashore by restless waves,
Or in the diver's grasp fetched up from caves
Where sea-nymphs might be proud to dwell: 15
But whose rash hand (again I ask) could dare,
'Mid casual tokens and promiscuous shows,
To circumscribe this Shape in fixed repose;
Could imitate for indolent survey,
Perhaps for touch profane, 20
Plumes that might catch, but cannot keep, a stain;
And, with cloud-streaks lightest and loftiest, share
The sun's first greeting, his last farewell ray!

Resplendent Wanderer! followed with glad eyes
Where'er her course; mysterious Bird! 25
To whom, by wondering Fancy stirred,
Eastern Islanders have given
A holy name——the Bird of Heaven!
And even a title higher still,
The Bird of God![\[48\]](#) whose blessed will 30
She seems performing as she flies

Over the earth and through the skies
In never-wearied search of Paradise——
Region that crowns her beauty with the name
She bears for *us*——for us how blest, 35
How happy at all seasons, could like aim
Uphold our Spirits urged to kindred flight
On wings that fear no glance of God's pure sight,
No tempest from his breath, their promised rest
Seeking with indefatigable quest 40
Above a world that deems itself most wise
When most enslaved by gross realities!

[48] Compare, in Robert Browning's poem on Guercino's picture of *The Guardian-Angel at Fano*——

Thou bird of God.

ED.

“DESPONDING FATHER! MARK THIS ALTERED BOUGH”

Composed 1835.—Published 1835

One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

Desponding Father! mark this altered bough,[\[49\]](#)
So beautiful of late, with sunshine warmed,
Or moist with dews; what more unsightly now,
Its blossoms shrivelled, and its fruit, if formed,
Invisible? yet Spring her genial brow 5
Knits not o'er that discolouring and decay
As false to expectation. Nor fret thou
At like unlovely process in the May
Of human life: a Stripling's graces blow,
Fade and are shed, that from their timely fall 10
(Misdemean it not a cankerous change) may grow
Rich mellow bearings, that for thanks shall call:
In all men, sinful is it to be slow
To hope——in Parents, sinful above all.

[\[49\]](#) Compare *The Excursion* (book iii. l. 649), and the sonnet (vol. vi. p. 72) beginning——

Surprised by joy——impatient as the Wind.

ED.

“FOUR FIERY STEEDS IMPATIENT OF THE REIN”

Composed 1835.—Published 1835

[Suggested on the road between Preston and Lancaster where it first gives a view of the Lake country, and composed on the same day, on the roof of the coach.—I.F.]

One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

Four fiery steeds impatient of the rein
Whirled us o'er sunless ground beneath a sky
As void of sunshine, when, from that wide plain,
Clear tops of far-off mountains we descry,
Like a Sierra of cerulean Spain, 5
All light and lustre. Did no heart reply?
Yes, there was One;—for One, asunder fly
The thousand links of that ethereal chain;
And green vales open out, with grove and field,
And the fair front of many a happy Home; 10
Such tempting spots as into vision come
While Soldiers, weary of the arms they wield
And sick at heart^[50] of strife-ful Christendom,
Gaze on the moon by parting clouds revealed.

^[50] 1837.

While Soldiers, of the weapons that they wield
Weary, and sick of strife-ful ...

1835.

TO —

Composed 1835.—Published 1835

[The fate of this poor Dove, as described, was told to me at Brinsop Court, by the young lady to whom I have given the name of Lesbia.—I.F.]

[Miss not the occasion: by the forelock take
That subtle Power, the never-halting Time,
Lest a mere moment's putting-off should make
Mischance almost as heavy as a crime.]

One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

“Wait, prithee, wait!” this answer Lesbia^[51] threw
Forth to her Dove, and took no further heed.
Her eye was busy, while her fingers flew
Across the harp, with soul-engrossing speed;
But from that bondage when her thoughts were freed 5
She rose, and toward the close-shut casement drew,
Whence the poor unregarded Favourite, true
To old affections, had been heard to plead
With flapping wing for entrance. What a shriek
Forced from that voice so lately tuned to a strain 10
Of harmony!——a shriek of terror, pain,
And self-reproach! for, from aloft, a Kite
Pounced,——and the Dove, which from its ruthless beak
She could not rescue, perished in her sight!

^[51] Miss Loveday Walker, daughter of the Rector of Brinsop. See the Fenwick note to the next sonnet.—ED.

ROMAN ANTIQUITIES DISCOVERED AT BISHOPSTONE, HEREFORDSHIRE

Composed 1835.—Published 1835

[My attention to these antiquities was directed by Mr. Walker, son to the itinerant Eidouranian Philosopher. The beautiful pavement was discovered within a few yards of the front door of his parsonage, and appeared from the site (in full view of several hills upon which there had formerly been Roman encampments) as if it might have been the villa of the commander of the forces, at least such was Mr. Walker's conjecture.—I.F.]

One of the "Miscellaneous Sonnets."—ED.

While poring Antiquarians search the ground
Upturned with curious pains, the Bard, a Seer,
Takes fire:—The men that have been reappear;
Romans for travel girt, for business gowned;
And some recline on couches, myrtle-crowned, 5
In festal glee: why not? For fresh and clear,
As if its hues were of the passing year,
Dawns this time-buried pavement. From that mound
Hoards may come forth of Trajans, Maximins,
Shrunk into coins with all their warlike toil: 10
Or a fierce impress issues with its foil
Of tenderness—the Wolf, whose suckling Twins
The unlettered ploughboy pities when he wins
The casual treasure from the furrowed soil.

ST. CATHERINE OF LEDBURY

Composed 1835.—Published 1835

[Written on a journey from Brinsop Court, Herefordshire.—I.F.]

One of the "Miscellaneous Sonnets."—ED.

When human touch (as monkish books attest)
Nor was applied nor could be, Ledbury bells
Broke forth in concert flung adown the dells,
And upward, high as Malvern's cloudy crest;^[52]
Sweet tones, and caught by a noble Lady blest 5
To rapture! Mabel listened at the side
Of her loved mistress: soon the music died,
And Catherine said, Here I set up my rest.
Warned in a dream, the Wanderer long had sought
A home that by such miracle of sound 10
Must be revealed:—she heard it now, or felt
The deep, deep joy of a confiding thought;
And there, a saintly Anchoress, she dwelt
Till she exchanged for heaven that happy ground.

^[52] The Ledbury bells are easily audible on the Malvern hills.—ED.

“BY A BLEST HUSBAND GUIDED, MARY CAME”^[53]

Published 1835

[This lady was named Carleton; she, along with a sister, was brought up in the neighbourhood of Ambleside. The epitaph, a part of it at least, is in the church at Bromsgrove, where she resided after her marriage.—I.F.]

One of the “Epitaphs and Elegiac Pieces.”—ED.

By a blest Husband guided, Mary came
From nearest kindred, Vernon^[54] her new name;
She came, though meek of soul, in seemly pride
Of happiness and hope, a youthful Bride.
O dread reverse! if aught *be* so, which proves 5
That God will chasten whom he dearly loves.
Faith bore her up through pains in mercy given,
And troubles that were each a step to Heaven:
Two Babes were laid in earth before she died;
A third now slumbers at the Mother's side; 10
Its Sister-twin survives, whose smiles afford
A trembling solace to her widowed Lord.

Reader! if to thy bosom cling the pain
Of recent sorrow combated in vain;
Or if thy cherished grief have failed to thwart 15
Time still intent on his insidious part,
Lulling the mourner's best good thoughts asleep,
Pilfering regrets we would, but cannot, keep;
Bear with Him—judge *Him* gently who makes known
His bitter loss by this memorial Stone; 20
And pray that in his faithful breast the grace
Of resignation find a hallowed place.

^[53] 1837.

In the edition of 1835 the title was "Epitaph."

^[54] 1837.

From nearest kindred, ...

1835.

“OH WHAT A WRECK! HOW CHANGED IN MIEN AND SPEECH!”

Composed 1835.—Published 1838

[The sad condition of poor Mrs. Southey^[55] put me upon writing this. It has afforded comfort to many persons whose friends have been similarly affected.—I.F.]

One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

Oh what a Wreck! how changed in mien and speech!
Yet—though dread Powers, that work in mystery, spin
Entanglings of^[56] the brain; though shadows stretch
O’er the chilled heart—reflect; far, far within
Hers is a holy Being, freed from Sin. 5
She is not what she seems, a forlorn wretch,
But delegated Spirits comfort fetch
To Her from heights that Reason may not win.
Like Children, She is privileged to hold
Divine communion;^[57] both do live and move, 10
Whate’er to shallow Faith their ways unfold,
Inly illumined by Heaven’s pitying love;
Love pitying innocence not long to last,
In them—in Her our sins and sorrows past.

^[55] Mrs. Southey died 16th November 1837. She had long been an invalid. See Southey’s *Life and Correspondence*, vol. vi. p. 347.—ED.

^[56] 1842.

... for ...

1838.

^[57] Compare a remark of Wordsworth’s that he never saw those with mind unhinged, but he thought of the words, “Life hid in God.” It is a curious oriental

belief that idiots are in closer communion with the Infinite than the sane are.—
ED.

1836

So far as can be ascertained, only one sonnet was written by Wordsworth in 1836. The verses *To a Redbreast*, by his sister-in-law, Sarah Hutchinson, may however be placed alongside of the sonnet addressed to her.—ED.

NOVEMBER 1836

Composed 1836.—Published 1837.

One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

Even so for me a Vision sanctified
The sway of Death; long ere mine eyes had seen
Thy countenance—the still rapture of thy mien—
When thou, dear Sister![\[58\]](#) wert become Death’s Bride:
No trace of pain or languor could abide 5
That change:—age on thy brow was smoothed—thy cold
Wan cheek at once was privileged to unfold
A loveliness to living youth denied.
Oh! if within me hope should e’er decline,
The lamp of faith, lost Friend! too faintly burn; 10
Then may that heaven-revealing smile of thine,
The bright assurance, visibly return:
And let my spirit in that power divine
Rejoice, as, through that power, it ceased to mourn.

[\[58\]](#) Sarah Hutchinson—Mrs. Wordsworth’s sister—died at Rydal on the 23rd June 1836. It was after her that the poet named one of the two “heath-clad rocks” referred to in the “Poems on the naming of Places,” and which he called

respectively “Mary-Point” and “Sarah-Point.” In 1827 he inscribed to her the sonnet beginning—

Excuse is needless when with love sincere,

and the lines she wrote *To a Redbreast*, beginning—

Stay, little cheerful Robin! stay,

were published among Wordsworth’s own poems.

The sonnet written in 1806, beginning—

Methought I saw the footsteps of a throne,

was, Wordsworth tells us, a great favourite with S. H. He adds, “When I saw her lying in death I could not resist the impulse to compose the sonnet that follows it.” (See vol. iv. p. 46.)

In a letter to Southey (unpublished), Wordsworth refers to her death, and adds: “I saw her within an hour after her decease, in the silence and peace of death, with as heavenly an expression on her countenance as ever human creature had. Surely there is food for faith in these appearances: for myself, I can say that I have passed a wakeful night, more in joy than in sorrow, with that blessed face before my eyes perpetually as I lay in bed.”

TO A REDBREAST—(IN SICKNESS)

Published 1842

[Almost the only verses by our lamented sister Sara Hutchinson.—I.F.]

One of the “Miscellaneous Poems.”—ED.

Stay, little cheerful Robin! stay,
And at my casement sing,
Though it should prove a farewell lay
And this our parting spring.

Though I, alas! may ne'er enjoy 5
The promise in thy song;
A charm, *that* thought can not destroy,
Doth to thy strain belong.

Methinks that in my dying hour
Thy song would still be dear, 10
And with a more than earthly power
My passing Spirit cheer.

Then, little Bird, this boon confer,
Come, and my requiem sing,
Nor fail to be the harbinger 15
Of everlasting Spring.

S.H.

1837

The poems belonging to the year 1837 include the “Memorials of a Tour in Italy” with Henry Crabb Robinson in that year, and one or two additional sonnets.—ED.

“SIX MONTHS TO SIX YEARS ADDED HE REMAINED”

Published 1837

One of the “Epitaphs and Elegiac Pieces.”—ED.

Six months to six years added he remained
Upon this sinful earth, by sin unstained:
O blessed Lord! whose mercy then removed
A Child whom every eye that looked on loved;
Support us, teach us calmly to resign 5
What we possessed, and now is wholly thine![\[59\]](#)

[\[59\]](#) This refers to the poet’s son Thomas, who died December 1, 1812. He was buried in Grasmere churchyard, beside his sister Catherine; and Wordsworth placed these lines upon his tombstone. They may have been written much earlier than 1836, probably in 1813, but it is impossible to ascertain the date, and they were not published till 1837.—ED.

MEMORIALS OF A TOUR IN ITALY 1837

Composed 1837.—Published 1842

[During my whole life I had felt a strong desire to visit Rome and the other celebrated cities and regions of Italy, but did not think myself justified

in incurring the necessary expense till I received from Mr. Moxon, the publisher of a large edition of my poems, a sum sufficient to enable me to gratify my wish without encroaching upon what I considered due to my family. My excellent friend H.C. Robinson readily consented to accompany me, and in March 1837, we set off from London, to which we returned in August, earlier than my companion wished or I should myself have desired had I been, like him, a bachelor. These Memorials of that tour touch upon but a very few of the places and objects that interested me, and, in what they do advert to, are for the most part much slighter than I could wish. More particularly do I regret that there is no notice in them of the South of France, nor of the Roman antiquities abounding in that district, especially of the Pont de Degard, which, together with its situation, impressed me full as much as any remains of Roman architecture to be found in Italy. Then there was Vaucluse, with its Fountain, its Petrarch, its rocks of all seasons, its small plots of lawn in their first vernal freshness, and the blossoms of the peach and other trees embellishing the scene on every side. The beauty of the stream also called forcibly for the expression of sympathy from one who, from his childhood, had studied the brooks and torrents of his native mountains. Between two and three hours did I run about climbing the steep and rugged crags from whose base the water of Vaucluse breaks forth. “Has Laura’s Lover,” often said I to myself, “ever sat down upon this stone? or has his foot ever pressed that turf?” Some, especially of the female sex, would have felt sure of it: my answer was (impute it to my years) “I fear, not.” Is it not in fact obvious that many of his love verses must have flowed, I do not say from a wish to display his own talent, but from a habit of exercising his intellect in that way rather than from an impulse of his heart? It is otherwise with his Lyrical poems, and particularly with the one upon the degradation of his country: there he pours out his reproaches, lamentations, and aspirations like an ardent and sincere patriot. But enough: it is time to turn to my own effusions such as they are.—I.F.]

TO HENRY CRABB ROBINSON[\[60\]](#)

Companion! by whose buoyant Spirit cheered,
In[61] whose experience trusting, day by day
Treasures I gained with zeal that neither feared
The toils nor felt the crosses of the way,
These records take, and happy should I be
Were but the Gift a meet Return to thee
For kindnesses that never ceased to flow,
And prompt self-sacrifice to which I owe
Far more than any heart but mine can know.

W. WORDSWORTH.

RYDAL MOUNT, *Feb. 14th, 1842.*

[60] The following is the Itinerary of the Italian Tour of 1837, supplied by Mr. Henry Crabb Robinson. (See *Memoirs of Wordsworth*, vol. ii. pp. 316, 317.) The spelling of the names of places is Robinson's.

March, 1837.

19. By steam to Calais.
20. Posting to Samer.
21. Posting to Granvilliers.
22. Through Beauvais to Paris.
26. To Fontainebleau.
27. Through Nemours to Cosne.
28. To Moulins.
29. To Tarare.
30. To Lyons.
31. Through Vienne to Tain.

April.

1. Through Valence to Orange.
2. To Avignon; to Vaucluse and back.
- 3, 4. By Pont du Gard to Nismes.
- 5, 6. By St. Remi to Marseilles.

7. To Toulon.
8. To Luc.
9. By Frejus to Cannes.
- 10, 11. To Nice.
12. Through Mentone to St. Remo.
13. Through Finale to Savone.
- 14-16. To Genoa.
17. To Chiaveri.
18. To Spezia.
19. By Carrara to Massa.
20. To Lucca.
21. To Pisa.
22. To Volterra.
23. By Castiglionaccio and Sienna.
24. To Radicofani.
25. By Aquapendente to Viterbo.
26. To Rome.

May.

13. Excursion to Tivoli with Dr. Carlyle.
- 17-21. Excursion to Albano, etc., etc., with Miss Mackenzie.
23. To Terni.
24. After seeing the Falls, to Spoleto.
25. To Cortona and Perugia.
26. To Arezzo.
27. To Bibiena and Laverna.
28. To Camaldoli.
29. From Muselea to Ponte Sieve.
30. From Ponte Sieve to Val Ombrosa and Florence.

June.

- 6, 7. To Bologna.
8. Parma.
9. Through Piacenza to Milan.
11. To the Certosa and back.

12. To the Lake of Como and back.
13. To Bergamo.
14. To Pallazuola and Isco.
15. Excursion to Riveri and back.
16. To Brescia and Desinzano.
17. On Lake of Garda to Riva.
19. To Verona.
20. Vicenza.
21. Padua.
22. Venice.
28. To Logerone.
29. To Sillian.
30. Spittal (in Carinthia).

July.

1. Over Kazenberg to Tweng.
2. Through Werfen to Hallein.
3. Excursion to Konigsee.
- 4, 5. To Salzburg.
6. To Ischl. A week's stay in the Salzkammer Gut, viz.—
8. Gmund.
9. Travenfalls and back.
10. Aussee.
11. Excursion to lakes, then to Hallstadt.
13. Through Ischl to St. Gilgin.
14. Through Salzburg to Trauenstein.
15. To Miesbach.
16. To Tegernsee and Holzkirken.
17. To Munich.
21. To Augsburg.
22. To Ulm.
23. To Stuttgart.
24. To Besigham.
25. To Heidelberg.
28. Through Worms to Mayence.

29. To Coblenz.
30. To Bonn.
31. Through Cologne to Aix-la-Chapelle.

August.

1. To Louvain
2. To Brussels.
3. To Antwerp.
4. To Liege.
5. Through Lille to Cassell.
6. Calais.
7. London.

[\[61\]](#) 1845.

To ...

1842.

The Tour of which the following Poems are very inadequate remembrances was shortened by report, too well founded, of the prevalence of Cholera at Naples. To make some amends for what was reluctantly left unseen in the South of Italy, we visited the Tuscan Sanctuaries among the Apennines, and the principal Italian Lakes among the Alps. Neither of those lakes, nor of Venice, is there any notice in these Poems, chiefly because I have touched upon them elsewhere. See, in particular, *Descriptive Sketches*, "Memorials of a Tour on the Continent in 1820," and a Sonnet upon the extinction of the Venetian Republic.—W.W.

I MUSINGS NEAR AQUAPENDENTE

APRIL, 1837

[Not the less
Had his sunk eye kindled at those dear words
That spake of bards and minstrels.

His, Sir Walter Scott's, eye, *did* in fact kindle at them, for the lines, "Places forsaken now" and the two that follow, were adopted from a poem of mine which nearly forty years ago was *in part* read to him, and he never forgot them.

Old Helvellyn's brow
Where once together, in his day of strength,
We stood rejoicing.

Sir Humphry Davy was with us at the time. We had ascended from Patterdale, and I could not but admire the vigour with which Scott scrambled along that horn of the mountain called "Striding Edge." Our progress was necessarily slow, and was beguiled by Scott's telling many stories and amusing anecdotes, as was his custom. Sir H. Davy would have probably been better pleased if other topics had occasionally been interspersed, and some discussion entered upon: at all events he did not remain with us long at the top of the mountain, but left us to find our way down its steep side together into the Vale of Grasmere, where, at my cottage, Mrs. Scott was to meet us at dinner.

With faint smile
...
He said, "When I am there, although 'tis fair,
'Twill be another Yarrow."

See among these notes the one on *Yarrow Revisited*.

A few short steps (painful they were) apart
From Tasso's Convent-haven, and retired grave.

This, though introduced here, I did not know till it was told me at Rome by Miss Mackenzie of Seaforth, a lady whose friendly attentions during my residence at Rome I have gratefully acknowledged with expressions of sincere regret that she is no more. Miss M. told me that she accompanied Sir Walter to the Janicular Mount, and, after showing him the grave of Tasso in the church upon the top, and a mural monument, there erected to his memory, they left the church and stood together on the brow of the hill overlooking the City of Rome: his daughter Anne was with them, and she, naturally desirous, for the sake of Miss Mackenzie especially, to have some expression of pleasure from her father, half reproached him for showing nothing of that kind either by his looks or voice: "How can I," replied he, "having only one leg to stand upon, and that in extreme pain!" so that the prophecy was more than fulfilled.

Over waves rough and deep.

We took boat near the lighthouse at the point of the right horn of the bay which makes a sort of natural port for Genoa; but the wind was high, and the waves long and rough, so that I did not feel quite recompensed by the view of the city, splendid as it was, for the danger apparently incurred. The boatman (I had only one) encouraged me saying we were quite safe, but I was not a little glad when we gained the shore, though Shelley and Byron—one of them at least, who seemed to have courted agitation from any quarter—would have probably rejoiced in such a situation: more than once I believe were they both in extreme danger even on the lake of Geneva. Every man, however, has his fears of some kind or other; and no doubt they had theirs: of all men whom I have ever known, Coleridge had the most of passive courage in bodily peril, but no one was so easily cowed when moral firmness was required in miscellaneous conversation or in the daily intercourse of social life.

How lovely robed in forenoon light and shade,
Each ministering to each, didst thou appear,
Savona.

There is not a single bay along this beautiful coast that might not raise in a traveller a wish to take up his abode there, each as it succeeds seems more inviting than the other; but the desolated convent on the cliff in the bay of Savona struck my fancy most; and had I, for the sake of my own health or that of a dear friend, or any other cause, been desirous of a residence abroad, I should have let my thoughts loose upon a scheme of turning some part of this building into a habitation provided as far as might be with English comforts. There is close by it a row or avenue, I forget which, of tall cypresses. I could not forbear saying to myself—"What a sweet family walk, or one for lonely musings, would be found under the shade!" but there, probably, the trees remained little noticed and seldom enjoyed.

This flowering broom's dear neighbourhood.

The broom is a great ornament through the months of March and April to the vales and hills of the Apennines, in the wild parts of which it blows in the utmost profusion, and of course successively at different elevations as the season advances. It surpasses ours in beauty and fragrance,[\[62\]](#) but, speaking from my own limited observations only, I cannot affirm the same of several of their wild spring flowers, the primroses in particular, which I saw not unfrequently but thinly scattered and languishing compared to ours.

The note at the end of this poem, upon the Oxford movement, was entrusted to my friend, Mr. Frederick Faber.[\[63\]](#) I told him what I wished to be said, and begged that, as he was intimately acquainted with several of the Leaders of it, he would express my thought in the way least likely to be taken amiss by them. Much of the work they are undertaking was grievously wanted, and God grant their endeavours may continue to prosper as they have done.—I.F.]

Ye Apennines! with all your fertile vales
Deeply embosomed, and your winding shores
Of either sea, an Islander by birth,
A Mountaineer by habit, would resound
Your praise, in meet accordance with your claims 5
Bestowed by Nature, or from man's great deeds
Inherited:—presumptuous thought!—it fled
Like vapour, like a towering cloud, dissolved.
Not, therefore, shall my mind give way to sadness;—
Yon snow-white torrent-fall, plumb down it drops 10
Yet ever hangs or seems to hang in air,
Lulling the leisure of that high perched town,
AQUAPENDENTE, in her lofty site
Its neighbour and its namesake—town, and flood
Forth flashing out of its own gloomy chasm 15
Bright sunbeams—the fresh verdure of this lawn
Strewn with grey rocks, and on the horizon's verge,
O'er intervenient waste, through glimmering haze,
Unquestionably kenned, that cone-shaped hill
With fractured summit,[64] no indifferent sight 20
To travellers, from such comforts as are thine,
Bleak Radicofani![65] escaped with joy—
These are before me; and the varied scene
May well suffice, till noon-tide's sultry heat
Relax, to fix and satisfy the mind 25
Passive yet pleased. What! with this Broom in flower
Close at my side! She bids me fly to greet
Her sisters, soon like her to be attired
With golden blossoms opening at the feet
Of my own Fairfield.[66] The glad greeting given, 30
Given with a voice and by a look returned
Of old companionship, Time counts not minutes

Ere, from accustomed paths, familiar fields,
The local Genius hurries me aloft,
Transported over that cloud-wooing hill, 35
Seat Sandal, a fond suitor of the clouds,[\[67\]](#)
With dream-like smoothness, to Helvellyn's top,[\[68\]](#)
There to alight upon crisp moss and range,
Obtaining ampler boon, at every step,
Of visual sovereignty—hills multitudinous, 40
(Not Apennine can boast of fairer) hills
Pride of two nations, wood and lake and plains,
And prospect right below of deep coves shaped[\[69\]](#)
By skeleton arms, that, from the mountain's trunk
Extended, clasp the winds, with mutual moan 45
Struggling for liberty, while undismayed
The shepherd struggles with them. Onward thence
And downward by the skirt of Greenside fell,[\[70\]](#)
And by Glenridding-screes,[\[71\]](#) and low Glencoign,[\[72\]](#)
Places forsaken now, though[\[73\]](#) loving still 50
The muses, as they loved them in the days
Of the old minstrels and the border bards.—
But here am I fast bound; and let it pass,
The simple rapture;—who that travels far
To feed his mind with watchful eyes could share 55
Or wish to share it?—One there surely was,
“The Wizard of the North,” with anxious hope
Brought to this genial climate, when disease
Preyed upon body and mind—yet not the less
Had his sunk eye kindled at those dear words 60
That spake of bards and minstrels; and his spirit
Had flown with mine to old Helvellyn's brow,
Where once together, in his day of strength,
We stood rejoicing,[\[74\]](#) as if earth were free

From sorrow, like the sky above our heads. 65

Years followed years, and when, upon the eve
Of his last going from Tweed-side, thought turned,
Or by another's sympathy was led,
To this bright land, Hope was for him no friend,
Knowledge no help; Imagination shaped 70
No promise. Still, in more than ear-deep seats,
Survives for me, and cannot but survive
The tone of voice which wedded borrowed words
To sadness not their own, when, with faint smile
Forced by intent to take from speech its edge, 75
He said, "When I am there, although 'tis fair,
'Twill be another Yarrow." [75] Prophecy
More than fulfilled, as gay Campania's shores
Soon witnessed, and the city of seven hills,
Her sparkling fountains, and her mouldering tombs; 80
And more than all, that Eminence [76] which showed
Her splendours, seen, not felt, the while he stood
A few short steps (painful they were) apart
From Tasso's Convent-haven, and retired grave. [77]

Peace to their Spirits! why should Poesy 85
Yield to the lure of vain regret, and hover
In gloom on wings with confidence outspread
To move in sunshine?—Utter thanks, my Soul!
Tempered with awe, and sweetened by compassion
For them who in the shades of sorrow dwell, 90
That I—so near the term to human life
Appointed by man's common heritage, [78]
Frail as the frailest, one withal (if that
Deserve a thought) but little known to fame—
Am free to rove where Nature's loveliest looks, 95

Art's noblest relics, history's rich bequests,
Failed to reanimate and but feebly cheered
The whole world's Darling—free to rove at will
O'er high and low, and if requiring rest,
Rest from enjoyment only.

Thanks poured forth 100

For what thus far hath blessed my wanderings, thanks
Fervent but humble as the lips can breathe
Where gladness seems a duty—let me guard
Those seeds of expectation which the fruit
Already gathered in this favoured Land 105
Enfolds within its core. The faith be mine,
That He who guides and governs all, approves
When gratitude, though disciplined to look
Beyond these transient spheres, doth wear a crown
Of earthly hope put on with trembling hand; 110
Nor is least pleased, we trust, when golden beams,
Reflected through the mists of age, from hours
Of innocent delight, remote or recent,
Shoot but a little way—'tis all they can—
Into the doubtful future. Who would keep 115
Power must resolve to cleave to it through life,
Else it deserts him, surely as he lives.
Saints would not grieve nor guardian angels frown
If one—while tossed, as was my lot to be,
In a frail bark urged by two slender oars 120
Over waves rough and deep,[\[79\]](#) that, when they broke,
Dashed their white foam against the palace walls
Of Genoa the superb—should there be led
To meditate upon his own appointed tasks,
However humble in themselves, with thoughts 125
Raised and sustained by memory of Him
Who oftentimes within those narrow bounds

Rocked on the surge, there tried his spirit's strength
And grasp of purpose, long ere sailed his ship
To lay a new world open.

Nor less prized 130

Be those impressions which incline the heart
To mild, to lowly, and to seeming weak,
Bend that way her desires. The dew, the storm—
The dew whose moisture fell in gentle drops
On the small hyssop destined to become, 135
By Hebrew ordinance devoutly kept,
A purifying instrument—the storm
That shook on Lebanon the cedar's top,
And as it shook, enabling the blind roots
Further to force their way, endowed its trunk 140
With magnitude and strength fit to uphold
The glorious temple—did alike proceed
From the same gracious will, were both an offspring
Of bounty infinite.

Between Powers that aim

Higher to lift their lofty heads, impelled 145
By no profane ambition, Powers that thrive
By conflict, and their opposites, that trust
In lowliness—a mid-way tract there lies
Of thoughtful sentiment for every mind
Pregnant with good. Young, Middle-aged, and Old, 150
From century on to century, must have known
The emotion—nay, more fitly were it said—
The blest tranquillity that sunk so deep
Into my spirit, when I paced, enclosed
In Pisa's Campo Santo,[\[80\]](#) the smooth floor 155
Of its Arcades paved with sepulchral slabs,[\[81\]](#)
And through each window's open fret-work looked
Over the black Area of sacred earth

Over the blank Area of sacred earth
Fetched from Mount Calvary,[\[82\]](#) or haply delved
In precincts nearer to the Saviour's tomb, 160
By hands of men, humble as brave, who fought
For its deliverance—a capacious field
That to descendants of the dead it holds
And to all living mute memento breathes,
More touching far than aught which on the walls 165
Is pictured, or their epitaphs can speak,
Of the changed City's long-departed power,
Glory, and wealth, which, perilous as they are,
Here did not kill, but nourished, Piety.
And, high above that length of cloistral roof, 170
Peering in air and backed by azure sky,
To kindred contemplations ministers
The Baptistry's dome,[\[83\]](#) and that which swells
From the Cathedral pile;[\[84\]](#) and with the twain
Conjoined in prospect mutable or fixed 175
(As hurry on in eagerness the feet,
Or pause) the summit of the Leaning-tower.[\[85\]](#)
Nor[\[86\]](#) less remuneration waits on him
Who having left the Cemetery stands
In the Tower's shadow, of decline and fall 180
Admonished not without some sense of fear,
Fear that soon vanishes before the sight
Of splendour unextinguished, pomp unscathed,
And beauty unimpaired. Grand in itself,
And for itself, the assemblage, grand and fair 185
To view, and for the mind's consenting eye
A type of age in man, upon its front
Bearing the world-acknowledged evidence
Of past exploits, nor fondly after more
Struggling against the stream of destiny, 190

But with its peaceful majesty content.

—Oh what a spectacle at every turn

The Place unfolds, from pavement skinned with moss,

Or grass-grown spaces, where the heaviest foot

Provokes no echoes, but must softly tread; 195

Where Solitude with Silence paired stops short

Of Desolation, and to Ruin's scythe

Decay submits not.

But where'er my steps

Shall wander, chiefly let me cull with care

Those images of genial beauty, oft 200

Too lovely to be pensive in themselves

But by reflection made so, which do best

And fittest serve to crown with fragrant wreaths

Life's cup when almost filled with years, like mine.

—How lovely robed in forenoon light and shade, 205

Each ministering to each, didst thou appear

Savona,[\[87\]](#) Queen of territory fair

As aught that marvellous coast thro' all its length

Yields to the Stranger's eye. Remembrance holds

As a selected treasure thy one cliff, 210

That, while it wore for melancholy crest

A shattered Convent, yet rose proud to have

Clinging to its steep sides a thousand herbs

And shrubs, whose pleasant looks gave proof how kind

The breath of air can be where earth had else 215

Seemed churlish. And behold, both far and near,

Garden and field all decked with orange bloom,

And peach and citron, in Spring's mildest breeze

Expanding; and, along the smooth shore curved

Into a natural port, a tideless sea, 220

To that mild breeze with motion and with voice

Softly responsive and attuned to all

sooty responsive; and, attuned to all
Those vernal charms of sight and sound, appeared
Smooth space of turf which from the guardian fort
Sloped seaward, turf whose tender April green, 225
In coolest climes too fugitive, might even here
Plead with the sovereign Sun for longer stay
Than his unmitigated beams allow,
Nor plead in vain, if beauty could preserve,
From mortal change, aught that is born on earth 230
Or doth on time depend.

While on the brink
Of that high Convent-crested cliff I stood,
Modest Savona! over all did brood
A pure poetic Spirit—as the breeze,
Mild—as the verdure, fresh—the sunshine, bright— 235
Thy gentle Chiabrera![\[88\]](#)—not a stone,
Mural or level with the trodden floor,
In Church or Chapel, if my curious quest
Missed not the truth, retains a single name
Of young or old, warrior, or saint, or sage, 240
To whose dear memories his sepulchral verse[\[89\]](#)
Paid simple tribute, such as might have flowed
From the clear spring of a plain English heart,
Say rather, one in native fellowship
With all who want not skill to couple grief 245
With praise, as genuine admiration prompts.
The grief, the praise, are severed from their dust,
Yet in his page the records of that worth
Survive, uninjured;—glory then to words,
Honour to word-preserving Arts, and hail 250
Ye kindred local influences that still,
If Hope's familiar whispers merit faith,
Await my steps when they the breezy height

Shall range of philosophic Tusculum;[\[90\]](#)
Or Sabine vales[\[91\]](#) explored inspire a wish 255
To meet the shade of Horace by the side
Of his Bandusian fount;[\[92\]](#)—or I invoke
His presence to point out the spot where once
He sate, and eulogized with earnest pen
Peace, leisure, freedom, moderate desires; 260
And all the immunities of rural life
Extolled, behind Vacuna's crumbling fane.[\[93\]](#)
Or let me loiter, soothed with what is given
Nor asking more, on that delicious Bay,[\[94\]](#)
Parthenope's Domain—Virgilian haunt, 265
Illustrated with never-dying verse,[\[95\]](#)
And, by the Poet's laurel-shaded tomb,[\[96\]](#)
Age after age to Pilgrims from all lands
Endeared.

And who—if not a man as cold
In heart as dull in brain—while pacing ground 270
Chosen by Rome's legendary Bards, high minds
Out of her early struggles well inspired
To localize heroic acts—could look
Upon the spots with undelighted eye,
Though even to their last syllable the Lays 275
And very names of those who gave them birth
Have perished?—Verily, to her utmost depth,
Imagination feels what Reason fears not
To recognize, the lasting virtue lodged
In those bold fictions that, by deeds assigned 280
To the Valerian, Fabian, Curian Race,
And others like in fame, created Powers
With attributes from History derived,
By Poesy irradiate, and yet graced,

~~~~~

Through marvellous felicity of skill, 285  
With something more propitious to high aims  
Than either, pent within her separate sphere,  
Can oft with justice claim.

And not disdaining  
Union with those primeval energies  
To virtue consecrate, stoop ye from your height 290  
Christian Traditions! at my Spirit's call  
Descend, and, on the brow of ancient Rome  
As she survives in ruin, manifest  
Your glories mingled with the brightest hues  
Of her memorial halo, fading, fading, 295  
But never to be extinct while Earth endures.  
O come, if undishonoured by the prayer,  
From all her Sanctuaries!—Open for my feet  
Ye Catacombs, give to mine eyes a glimpse  
Of the Devout, as, 'mid your glooms convened 300  
For safety, they of yore enclasped the Cross<sup>[97]</sup>  
On knees that ceased from trembling, or intoned  
Their orisons with voices half-suppressed,  
But sometimes heard, or fancied to be heard,  
Even at this hour.

And thou Mamertine prison,<sup>[98]</sup> 305  
Into that vault receive me from whose depth  
Issues, revealed in no presumptuous vision,  
Albeit lifting human to divine,  
A saint, the Church's Rock, the mystic Keys  
Grasped in his hand;<sup>[99]</sup> and lo! with upright sword 310  
Prefiguring his own impendent doom,  
The Apostle of the Gentiles; both prepared  
To suffer pains with heathen scorn and hate  
Inflicted;—blessed Men, for so to Heaven  
They follow their dear Lord!

Nor stagnates, nor precipitates his course,  
 But many a benefit borne upon his breast  
 For human-kind sinks out of sight, is gone,  
 No one knows how; nor seldom is put forth  
 An angry arm that snatches good away, 320  
 Never perhaps to reappear. The Stream  
 Has to our generation brought and brings  
 Innumerable gains; yet we, who now  
 Walk in the light of day, pertain full surely  
 To a chilled age, most pitiably shut out 325  
 From that which *is* and actuates, by forms,  
 Abstractions, and by lifeless fact to fact  
 Minutely linked with diligence uninspired,  
 Unrectified, unguided, unsustained,  
 By godlike insight. To this fate is doomed 330  
 Science, wide-spread and spreading still as be  
 Her conquests, in the world of sense made known.  
 So with the internal mind it fares; and so  
 With morals, trusting, in contempt or fear  
 Of vital principle's controlling law, 335  
 To her purblind guide Expediency; and so  
 Suffers religious faith. Elate with view  
 Of what is won, we overlook or scorn  
 The best that should keep pace with it, and must,  
 Else more and more the general mind will droop, 340  
 Even as if bent on perishing. There lives  
 No faculty within us which the Soul  
 Can spare,[\[100\]](#) and humblest earthly Weal demands,  
 For dignity not placed beyond her reach,  
 Zealous co-operation of all means 345  
 Given or acquired, to raise us from the mire,  
 And liberate our hearts from low pursuits



And liberate our hearts from low pursuits.

By gross Utilities enslaved we need  
More of ennobling impulse from the past,  
If to the future aught of good must come 350  
Sounder and therefore holier than the ends  
Which, in the giddiness of self-applause,  
We covet as supreme. O grant the crown  
That Wisdom wears, or take his treacherous staff  
From Knowledge!—If the Muse, whom I have served 355  
This day, be mistress of a single pearl  
Fit to be placed in that pure diadem;  
Then, not in vain, under these chesnut boughs  
Reclined, shall I have yielded up my soul  
To transports from the secondary founts 360  
Flowing of time and place, and paid to both  
Due homage; nor shall fruitlessly have striven,  
By love of beauty moved, to enshrine in verse  
Accordant meditations, which in times  
Vexed and disordered, as our own, may shed 365  
Influence, at least among a scattered few,  
To soberness of mind and peace of heart  
Friendly; as here to my repose hath been  
This flowering broom's dear neighbourhood,[\[101\]](#) the light  
And murmur issuing from yon pendent flood, 370  
And all the varied landscape. Let us now  
Rise, and to-morrow greet magnificent Rome.[\[102\]](#)

[\[62\]](#) Wordsworth himself, his nephew tells us, had no sense of smell (see the *Memoirs*, by his nephew Christopher, vol. ii. p. 322).—ED.

[\[63\]](#) Afterwards Father Faber, priest of the Oratory of St. Philip Neri.—ED.

[\[64\]](#) Monte Amiata,—ED.

[\[65\]](#) On the old high road from Siena to Rome.—ED.

[\[66\]](#) The mountain between Rydal Head and Helvellyn.—ED.

[67] Seat Sandal is the mountain between Tongue Ghyll and Grisedale Tarn on the south and east, and the Dunmail Raise road on the west.—ED.

[68] Compare *The Eclipse of the Sun*, l. 78, in “Memorials of a Tour on the Continent in 1820” (vol. vi. p. 345).—ED.

[69] Keppelcove, Nethermost cove, and the cove in which Red Tarn lies bounded by the “skeleton arms” of Striding Edge and Swirrel Edge. Compare *Fidelity*, l. 17, vol. iii. p. 45—

It was a cove, a huge recess,  
That keeps, till June, December’s snow.

ED.

[70] Descending to Ullswater from Helvellyn, Greenside Fell and Mines are passed.—ED.

[71] The Glenridding Screes are bold rocks on the left as you descend Helvellyn to Patterdale.—ED.

[72] Glencoign is an offshoot of the Patterdale valley between Glenridding and Goldbarrow.—ED.

[73] 1845.

... but ...

1842.

[74] See the Fenwick note.—ED.

[75] These words were quoted to me from *Yarrow Unvisited*, by Sir Walter Scott, when I visited him at Abbotsford, a day or two before his departure for Italy: and the affecting condition in which he was when he looked upon Rome from the Janicular Mount, was reported to me by a lady who had the honour of conducting him thither.—W.W. 1842. See also the Fenwick note to this poem, and compare Lockhart's *Memoirs of the Life of Sir Walter Scott* (chapter lxxx. vol. x. p. 104).—ED.

[76] The Janicular Mount.—ED.

[77] See the Fenwick note prefixed to this poem.—ED.

[78] He was then sixty-seven years of age.—ED.

[79] See the Fenwick note.—ED.

[80] The Campo Santo, or Burial Ground, founded by Archbishop Ubaldo (1188-1200).—ED.

[81] "There are forty-three flat arcades, resting on forty-four pilasters.... In the interior there is a spacious hall, the open round-arched windows of which, with their beautiful tracery, sixty-two in number, look out upon a green quadrangle.... The walls are covered with frescoes by the Tuscan School of the fourteenth and fifteenth centuries, below which is a collection of Roman, Etruscan, and mediaeval sculptures.... The tombstones of persons interred here form the pavement." (Baedeker's *Northern Italy*, p. 324.)—ED.

[82] Ubaldo conveyed hither fifty-three ship-loads of earth from Mount Calvary, in the Holy Land, in order that the dead might repose in holy ground.—ED.

[83] The Baptistery in Pisa was begun in 1153 by Diotisalvi, and completed in 1278. It is a circular structure, covered by a conical dome, 190 feet high.—ED.

[84] The Cathedral of Pisa is a basilica, built in 1063, in the Tuscan style, and has an elliptical dome.—ED.

[85] The Campanile, or Clock-Tower, rises in eight stories to the height of 179 feet, and (from its oblique position) is known as the Leaning-Tower.—ED.

[86] 1845.

Not ...

1842.

[87] See the Fenwick note to this poem. Savona is a town on the Gulf of Genoa, capital of the Montenotte Department under Napoleon.—ED.

[88] The theatre in Savona is dedicated to Chiabrera, who was a native of the place.—ED.

[89] If any English reader should be desirous of knowing how far I am justified in thus describing the epitaphs of Chiabrera, he will find translated specimens of them in this Volume, under the head of “Epitaphs and Elegiac Pieces.”—W.W. 1842.

[90] Tusculum was the birthplace of the elder Cato, and the residence of Cicero.—ED.

[91] “Satis beatus unicus Sabinis.” *Odes*, ii. 18, 14.—ED.

[92] See Horace, *Odes*, iii. 13.—ED.

[93] See Horace, *Epistles*, i. 10, 49—

Haec tibi dictabam post fanum putre Vacunae.

Vacuna was a Sabine divinity. She had a sanctuary near Horace’s Villa. (Compare Pliny, *Nat. Hist.* iii. 42, 47.) A traveller in Italy writes: “Following a path along the brink of the torrent Digentia, we passed a towering rock, on which once stood Vacuna’s shrine.” See also Ovid, *Fasti*, vi. 307.—ED.

[94] The Bay of Naples. Neapolis (the new city) received its ancient name of Parthenope from one of the Sirens, whose body was said to have been washed ashore in that bay. *Sil.* 12, 33.—ED.

[95] See *Georgics*, iv. 564.—ED.

[96] Virgil died at Brundisium, but his remains were carried to his favourite residence, Naples, and were buried by the side of the road leading to Puteoli—the Via Puteolana. His tomb is still pointed out near Posilipo,—close to the sea, and about half way from Naples to Puteoli, the *Scuola di Virgilio*.

“The monument, now called the tomb of Virgil, is not on the road which passes through the tunnel of Posilipo; but if the Via Puteolana ascended the hill of Posilipo, as it may have done, the situation of the monument would agree very well with the description of Donatus.” (George Long, in Smith’s *Dictionary of Greek and Roman Biography*.)

The inscription said to have been placed on the tomb was as follows:—

Mantua me genuit, Calabri rapuere, tenet nunc  
Parthenope. Cecini pascua, rura, duces.

ED.

[97] The catacombs were subterranean chambers and passages, usually cut out of the solid rock, and used as places of burial, or of refuge. The early Christians made use of the catacombs in the Appian Way for worship, as well as for sepulture.—ED.

[98] The Carcer Mamertinus,—one of the most ancient Roman structures,—overhung the Forum, as Livy tells us, “imminens foro,” underneath the Capitoline hill. It still exists, and is entered from the sacristy of the church of S. Giuseppe de Falagnami, to the left of the arch of Severus. It was originally a well (the *Tullianum* of Livy), and afterwards a prison, in which Jugurtha was starved to death, and Catiline’s accomplices perished. There are two chambers in the prison, one beneath the other; the lower-most containing, in its rock floor, a spring, which rises nearly to the surface. For the legend connected with it see the next note.—ED.

[99] According to the legend, St. Peter, who was imprisoned in the *Carcer Mamertinus* under Nero, caused this spring to flow miraculously in order to baptize his jailors. Hence the building is called *S. Pietro in Carcere*.—ED.

[100] Compare “Despondency Corrected,” *The Excursion*, book iv. l. 1058—

Within the soul a faculty abides, etc.

ED.

[101] See the Fenwick note.—ED.

[102] It would be ungenerous not to advert to the religious movement that, since the composition of these verses in 1837, has made itself felt, more or less strongly, throughout the English Church;—a movement that takes, for its first principle, a devout deference to the voice of Christian antiquity. It is not my office to pass judgment on questions of theological detail; but my own repugnance to the spirit and system of Romanism has been so repeatedly and, I trust, feelingly expressed, that I shall not be suspected of a leaning that way, if I do not join in the grave charge, thrown out, perhaps in the heat of controversy, against the learned and pious men to whose labours I allude. I speak apart from controversy; but, with strong faith in the moral temper which would elevate the present by doing reverence to the past, I would draw cheerful auguries for the English Church from this movement, as likely to restore among us a tone of piety more earnest and real than that produced by the mere formalities of the understanding, refusing, in a degree, which I cannot but lament, that its own temper and judgment shall be controlled by those of antiquity.—W.W. 1842.

## II

### THE PINE OF MONTE MARIO<sup>[103]</sup> AT ROME

[Sir George Beaumont told me that, when he first visited Italy, pine-trees of this species abounded, but that on his return thither, which was more than thirty years after, they had disappeared from many places where he had been accustomed to admire them, and had become rare all over the country, especially in and about Rome. Several Roman villas have within these few years passed into the hands of foreigners, who, I observed with pleasure, have taken care to plant this tree, which in course of years will become a great ornament to the city and to the general landscape. May I venture to add here, that having ascended the Monte Mario, I could not resist embracing the trunk of this interesting monument of my departed friend's feelings for the beauties of nature, and the power of that art which he loved so much, and in the practice of which he was so distinguished?—I.F.]

I saw far off the dark top of a Pine  
Look like a cloud—a slender stem the tie  
That bound it to its native earth—poised high  
'Mid evening hues, along the horizon line,  
Striving in peace each other to outshine. 5  
But when I learned the Tree was living there,  
Saved from the sordid axe by Beaumont's care,[\[104\]](#)  
Oh, what a gush of tenderness was mine!  
The rescued Pine-tree, with its sky so bright  
And cloud-like beauty, rich in thoughts of home, 10  
Death-parted friends, and days too swift in flight,  
Supplanted the whole majesty of Rome  
(Then first apparent from the Pincian Height)[\[105\]](#)  
Crowned with St. Peter's everlasting dome.[\[106\]](#)

[\[103\]](#) The Monte Mario is to the north-west of Rome, beyond the Janiculus and the Vatican. The view from the summit embraces Rome, the Campagna, and the sea. It is capped by the villa Millini, in which the "magnificent solitary pine-tree" of this sonnet still stands, amidst its cypress plantations.—ED.

[\[104\]](#) "It was Mr. Theed, the sculptor, who informed us of the pine-tree being the gift of Sir George Beaumont." H.C. Robinson. (See *Memoirs of Wordsworth*, by his nephew, vol. ii. p. 330.)—ED.

[105] From the *Mons Pincius*, “collis hortorum,” where were the gardens of Lucullus, there is a remarkable view of modern Rome.—ED.

[106] Within a couple of hours of my arrival at Rome, I saw from Monte Pincio, the Pine tree as described in the sonnet; and, while expressing admiration at the beauty of its appearance, I was told by an acquaintance of my fellow-traveller, who happened to join us at the moment, that a price had been paid for it by the late Sir G. Beaumont, upon condition that the proprietor should not act upon his known intention of cutting it down.—W.W. 1842.

### III AT ROME

[Sight is at first sight a sad enemy to imagination and to those pleasures belonging to old times with which some exertions of that power will always mingle: nothing perhaps brings this truth home to the feelings more than the city of Rome; not so much in respect to the impression made at the moment when it is first seen and looked at as a whole, for then the imagination may be invigorated and the mind’s eye quickened; but when particular spots or objects are sought out, disappointment is I believe invariably felt. Ability to recover from this disappointment will exist in proportion to knowledge, and the power of the mind to reconstruct out of fragments and parts, and to make details in the present subservient to more adequate comprehension of the past.—I.F.]

Is this, ye Gods, the Capitolian Hill?  
Yon petty Steep in truth the fearful Rock,  
Tarpeian named of yore,[\[107\]](#) and keeping still  
That name, a local Phantom proud to mock  
The Traveller's expectation?—Could our Will  
Destroy the ideal Power within, 'twere done  
Thro' what men see and touch,—slaves wandering on,  
Impelled by thirst of all but Heaven-taught skill.  
Full oft, our wish obtained, deeply we sigh;  
Yet not unrecompensed are they who learn, 10  
From that depression raised, to mount on high  
With stronger wing, more clearly to discern  
Eternal things; and, if need be, defy  
Change, with a brow not insolent, though stern.

[\[107\]](#) The Tarpeian rock, from which those condemned to death were hurled, is not now precipitous, as it used to be: the ground having been much raised by successive heaps of ruin.—ED.

#### IV AT ROME—REGRETS—IN ALLUSION TO NIEBUHR AND OTHER MODERN HISTORIANS



Those old credulities, to nature dear,  
Shall they no longer bloom upon the stock  
Of History, stript naked as a rock  
'Mid a dry desert? What is it we hear?  
The glory of Infant Rome must disappear,[\[108\]](#) 5  
Her morning splendours vanish, and their place  
Know them no more. If Truth, who veiled her face  
With those bright beams yet hid it not, must steer  
Henceforth a humbler course perplexed and slow;  
One solace yet remains for us who came 10  
Into this world in days when story lacked  
Severe research, that in our hearts we know  
How, for exciting youth's heroic flame,  
Assent is power, belief the soul of fact.

[\[108\]](#) Niebuhr, in his *Lectures on Roman History* (1826-29), was one of the first to point out the legendary character of much of the earlier history, and its "historical impossibility." He explained the way in which much of it had originated in family and national vanity, etc.—ED.

## V CONTINUED

Complacent Fictions were they, yet the same  
Involved a history of no doubtful sense,  
History that proves by inward evidence  
From what a precious source of truth it came.  
Ne'er could the boldest Eulogist have dared 5  
Such deeds to paint, such characters to frame,  
But for coeval sympathy prepared  
To greet with instant faith their loftiest claim.  
None but a noble people could have loved  
Flattery in Ancient Rome's pure-minded style: 10  
Not in like sort the Runic Scald was moved;  
He, nursed 'mid savage passions that defile  
Humanity, sang feats that well might call  
For the blood-thirsty mead of Odin's riotous Hall.

## **VI**

### **PLEA FOR THE HISTORIAN**

Forbear to deem the Chronicler unwise,  
 Ungentle, or untouched by seemly ruth,  
 Who, gathering up all that Time's envious tooth  
 Has spared of sound and grave realities,  
 Firmly rejects those dazzling flatteries, 5  
 Dear as they are to unsuspecting Youth,  
 That might have drawn down Clio from the skies  
 To vindicate the majesty of truth.  
 Such was her office while she walked with men,[109]  
 A Muse, who,[110] not unmindful of her Sire 10  
 All-ruling Jove, whate'er the[111] theme might be  
 Revered her Mother, sage Mnemosyne,  
 And taught her faithful servants how the lyre  
 Should[112] animate, but not mislead, the pen.[113]

[109] Clio, daughter of Zeus and Mnemosyne, the first-born of the Muses, presided over History. It was her office to record the actions of illustrious heroes.—Ed.

[110] 1845.

Her rights to claim, and vindicate the truth.  
 Her faithful Servants while she walked with men  
 Were they who, ...

1842.

[111] 1845.

... their ...

1842.

[112] 1845.

And, at the Muse's will, invoked the lyre  
To animate, ...

1842.

[\[113\]](#)

Quem virum—lyra—  
—sumes celebrare Clio?

W. W. 1842.

## VII AT ROME

[I have a private interest in this Sonnet, for I doubt whether it would ever have been written but for the lively picture given me by Anna Ricketts of what she had witnessed of the indignation and sorrow expressed by some Italian noblemen of their acquaintance upon the surrender, which circumstances had obliged them to make, of the best portion of their family mansions to strangers.—I.F.]

They—who have seen the noble Roman's scorn  
Break forth at thought of laying down his head,  
When the blank day is over, garreted  
In his ancestral palace, where, from morn  
To night, the desecrated floors are worn 5  
By feet of purse-proud strangers; they—who have read  
In one meek smile, beneath a peasant's shed,  
How patiently the weight of wrong is borne;  
They—who have heard some learned Patriot treat [\[114\]](#)  
Of freedom, with mind grasping the whole theme 10  
From ancient Rome, downwards through that bright dream  
Of Commonwealths, each city a starlike seat  
Of rival glory; they—fallen Italy—  
Nor must, nor will, nor can, despair of Thee!

## VIII NEAR ROME, IN SIGHT OF ST. PETER'S

Long has the dew been dried on tree and lawn;  
 O'er man and beast a not unwelcome boon  
 Is shed, the languor of approaching noon;  
 To shady rest withdrawing or withdrawn  
 Mute are all creatures, as this couchant fawn, 5  
 Save insect-swarms that hum in air afloat,  
 Save that the Cock is crowing, a shrill note,  
 Startling and shrill as that which roused the dawn.  
 —Heard in that hour, or when, as now, the nerve  
 Shrinks from the note[115] as from a mis-timed thing, 10  
 Oft for a holy warning may it serve,  
 Charged with remembrance of *his* sudden sting,  
 His bitter tears, whose name the Papal Chair  
 And yon resplendent Church are proud to bear.

[114] 1845.

They—who have heard thy lettered sages treat  
 1842.

[115] 1845.

... voice ...  
 1842.

## IX AT ALBANO[116]

[This Sonnet is founded on simple fact, and was written to enlarge, if possible, the views of those who can see nothing but evil in the intercessions countenanced by the Church of Rome. That they are in many

respects lamentably pernicious must be acknowledged; but, on the other hand, they who reflect, while they see and observe, cannot but be struck with instances which will prove that it is a great error to condemn in all cases such mediation as purely idolatrous. This remark bears with especial force upon addresses to the Virgin.—I.F.]

Days passed—and Monte Calvo would not clear  
His head from mist; and, as the wind sobbed through  
Albano's dripping Ilex avenue,[\[117\]](#)  
My dull forebodings in a Peasant's ear  
Found casual vent. She said, "Be of good cheer; 5  
Our yesterday's procession did not sue  
In vain; the sky will change to sunny blue,  
Thanks to our Lady's grace." I smiled to hear,  
But not in scorn:—the Matron's Faith may lack  
The heavenly sanction needed to ensure 10  
Fulfilment; but, we trust, her upward track[\[118\]](#)  
Stops not at this low point, nor wants the lure  
Of flowers the Virgin without fear may own,  
For by her Son's blest hand the seed was sown.

[\[116\]](#) Albano, 10 miles south-east of Rome, is a small town and episcopal residence, a favourite autumnal resort of Roman citizens. It is on the site of the ruins of the villa of Pompey. Monte Carlo (the Monte Calvo of this sonnet) is the ancient *Mons Latialis*, 3127 feet high. At its summit a convent of Passionist Monks occupies the site of the ancient temple of Jupiter.—ED.

[\[117\]](#) The ilex-grove of the Villa Doria is one of the most marked features of Albano.—ED.

[\[118\]](#) 1845.

Its own fulfilment; but her upward track

1842.

X  
“NEAR ANIO’S STREAM, I SPIED A GENTLE DOVE”

Near Anio’s stream,[\[119\]](#) I spied a gentle Dove  
Perched on an olive branch, and heard her cooing  
’Mid new-born blossoms that soft airs were wooing,  
While all things present told of joy and love.  
But restless Fancy left that olive grove 5  
To hail the exploratory Bird renewing  
Hope for the few, who, at the world’s undoing,  
On the great flood were spared to live and move.  
O bounteous Heaven! signs true as dove and bough  
Brought to the ark are coming evermore, 10  
Given though we seek them not, but, while we plough[\[120\]](#)  
This sea of life without a visible shore,  
Do neither promise ask nor grace implore  
In what alone is ours, the living Now.[\[121\]](#)

[\[119\]](#) The Anio joins the Tiber north of Rome, flowing from the north-east past Tivoli.—ED.

[\[120\]](#) 1845.

Even though men seek them not, but, while they plough  
1842.

[\[121\]](#) 1845.

... the vouchsafed Now.  
1842.



## XI

### FROM THE ALBAN HILLS, LOOKING TOWARDS ROME

Forgive, illustrious Country! these deep sighs,  
Heaved less for thy bright plains and hills bestrown  
With monuments decayed or overthrown,  
For all that tottering stands or prostrate lies,  
Than for like scenes in moral vision shown, 5  
Ruin perceived for keener sympathies;  
Faith crushed, yet proud of weeds, her gaudy crown  
Virtues laid low, and mouldering energies.  
Yet why prolong this mournful strain?—Fallen Power,  
Thy fortunes, twice exalted,[\[122\]](#) might provoke 10  
Verse to glad notes prophetic of the hour  
When thou, uprisen, shalt break thy double yoke,  
And enter, with prompt aid from the Most High,  
On the third stage of thy great destiny.[\[123\]](#)

[\[122\]](#) The ancient Classic period, and that of the Renaissance.—ED.

[\[123\]](#) This period seems to have been already entered. Compare Mrs. Browning's "Poems before Congress," *passim*.—ED.

## XII

### NEAR THE LAKE OF THRASYMENE

When here with Carthage Rome to conflict came,[124]  
An earthquake, mingling with the battle's shock,  
Checked not its rage;[125] unfelt the ground did rock,  
Sword dropped not, javelin kept its deadly aim.—  
Now all is sun-bright peace. Of that day's shame, 5  
Or glory, not a vestige seems to endure,  
Save in this Rill that took from blood the name[126]  
Which yet it bears, sweet Stream! as crystal pure.  
So may all trace and sign of deeds aloof  
From the true guidance of humanity, 10  
Thro' Time and Nature's influence, purify  
Their spirit; or, unless they for reproof  
Or warning serve, thus let them all, on ground  
That gave them being, vanish to a sound.

[124] The Carthaginian general Hannibal defeated the Roman Consul C. Flaminius, near the lacus Trasimenus, 217 B.C., with a loss of 15,000 men. (See Livy, book xxii. 4, etc.)—ED.

[125] Compare *Hannibal, A Historical Drama*, by the late Professor John Nichol, act II. scene vi. p. 107—

Here shall shepherds tell  
To passing travellers, when we are dust,  
How, by the shores of reedy Thrasymene,  
We fought and conquered, while the earthquake shook  
The walls of Rome.

ED.

[126] Sanguinetto.—W.W. 1845.

### XIII NEAR THE SAME LAKE

For action born, existing to be tried,  
Powers manifold we have that intervene  
To stir the heart that would too closely screen  
Her peace from images to pain allied.  
What wonder if at midnight, by the side 5  
Of Sanguinetto or broad Thrasymene,[127]  
The clang of arms is heard, and phantoms glide,  
Unhappy ghosts in troops by moonlight seen;  
And singly thine, O vanquished Chief![128] whose corse,  
Unburied, lay hid under heaps of slain: 10  
But who is He?—the Conqueror. Would he force  
His way to Rome? Ah, no,—round hill and plain  
Wandering, he haunts, at fancy's strong command,  
This spot—his shadowy death-cup in his hand.[129]

[127] Lake Thrasymene is the largest of the Etrurian lakes, being ten miles in length and three in breadth.—ED.

[128] C. Flaminius.—ED.

[129] After the battle of Lake Thrasymene, Hannibal did not push on to Rome, but turned through the Apennines to Apulia, just as subsequently after the battle of Cannas he remained inactive.—ED.

## XIV THE CUCKOO AT LAVERNA[130]

MAY 25TH 1837

[Among a thousand delightful feelings connected in my mind with the voice of the cuckoo, there is a personal one which is rather melancholy. I was first convinced that age had rather dulled my hearing, by not being able to catch the sound at the same distance as the younger companions of my walks; and of this failure I had a proof upon the occasion that suggested these verses. I did not hear the sound till Mr. Robinson had twice or thrice directed my attention to it.]

List—'twas the Cuckoo.—O with what delight  
Heard I that voice! and catch it now, though faint,[\[131\]](#)  
Far off and faint, and melting into air,  
Yet not to be mistaken. Hark again!  
Those louder cries give notice that the Bird, 5  
Although invisible as Echo's self,[\[132\]](#)  
Is wheeling hitherward. Thanks, happy Creature,  
For this unthought-of greeting!

While allured

From vale to hill, from hill to vale led on,  
We have pursued, through various lands, a long 10  
And pleasant course; flower after flower has blown,  
Embellishing the ground that gave them birth  
With aspects novel to my sight; but still  
Most fair, most welcome, when they drank the dew  
In a sweet fellowship with kinds beloved, 15  
For old remembrance sake. And oft—where Spring  
Display'd her richest blossoms among files  
Of orange-trees bedecked with glowing fruit  
Ripe for the hand, or under a thick shade  
Of Ilex, or, if better suited to the hour, 20  
The lightsome Olive's twinkling canopy—[\[133\]](#)  
Oft have I heard the Nightingale and Thrush  
Blending as in a common English grove  
Their love-songs; but, where'er my feet might roam,  
Whate'er assemblages of new and old, 25  
Strange and familiar, might beguile the way,  
A gratulation from that vagrant Voice  
Was wanting;—and most happily till now.

For see, Laverna! mark the far-famed Pile,  
High on the brink of that precipitous rock,[\[134\]](#) 30

Implanted like a Fortress, as in truth  
It is, a Christian Fortress, garrisoned  
In faith and hope, and dutiful obedience,  
By a few Monks, a stern society,  
Dead to the world and scorning earth-born joys. 35  
Nay—though the hopes that drew, the fears that drove,  
St. Francis, far from Man's resort, to abide  
Among these sterile heights of Apennine, [\[135\]](#)  
Bound him, nor, since he raised yon House, have ceased  
To bind his spiritual Progeny, with rules 40  
Stringent as flesh can tolerate and live;[\[136\]](#)  
His milder Genius (thanks to the good God  
That made us) over those severe restraints  
Of mind, that dread heart-freezing discipline,  
Doth sometimes here predominate, and works 45  
By unsought means for gracious purposes;  
For earth through heaven, for heaven, by changeful earth,  
Illustrated, and mutually endeared.

Rapt though He were above the power of sense,  
Familiarly, yet out of the cleansed heart 50  
Of that once sinful Being overflowed  
On sun, moon, stars, the nether elements,  
And every shape of creature they sustain,  
Divine affections; and with beast and bird  
(Stilled from afar—such marvel story tells— 55  
By casual outbreak of his passionate words,  
And from their own pursuits in field or grove  
Drawn to his side by look or act of love  
Humane, and virtue of his innocent life)  
He wont to hold companionship so free, 60  
So pure, so fraught with knowledge and delight,  
As to be likened in his Followers' minds

[130] Laverna is a corruption of *Alverna* (now called Alverniac). It is about five or six hours' walk from Camaldoli, on a height of the Apennines, not far from the sources of the Anio. To reach it, "the southern height of the Monte Valterona is ascended as far as the chapel of St. Romaiald; then a descent is made to Moggiona, beyond which the path turns to the left, traversing a long and fatiguing succession of gorges and slopes; the path at the base of the mountain is therefore preferable. The market town of Soci in the valley of the Archiano is first reached, then the profound valley of the Corsaline; beyond it rises a blunted cone, on which the path ascends in windings to a stony plain with marshy meadows. Above this rises the abrupt sandstone mass of the *Vernia*, to the height of 850 feet. On its S.W. slope, one-third of the way up, and 3906 feet above the sea-level, is seen a wall with small windows, the oldest part of the monastery, built in 1218 by St. Francis of Assisi. The church dates from 1284.... One of the grandest points is the *Penna della Vernia* (4796 feet), the ridge of the Vernia, also known as *l'Apennino*, the 'rugged rock between the sources of the Tiber and Anio,' as it is called by Dante (*Paradiso*, ii. 106).... Near the monastery are the *Luoghi Santi*, a number of grottos and rock-hewn chambers in which St. Francis once lived." (See Baedeker's *Northern Italy*, 1886, p. 463.)

"The Monte Alverno, or Monte della Verni is situated on the border of Tuscany, near the sources of the Tiber and Anio, not far from the Castle of Chiusi, where Orlando lived." (Mrs. Oliphant's *Francis of Assisi*, chap. xvi. p. 248.)

See also Herzog's *Real-Encyklopädie für protestantische Theologie und Kirche*, vol. iv. p. 655.—ED.

[131] Compare *To the Cuckoo*, II. 3, 4 (vol. ii. p. 289)—

... Bird,  
Or but a wandering Voice?

ED.

[132] Compare *To the Cuckoo*, l. 15 (vol. ii. p. 290)—

No bird, but an invisible thing.

ED.

[133] From the difference in the colour of each side of the leaf, a grove of olives when *wind-tossed* is pre-eminently a "twinkling canopy."—ED.

[134] See note, p. 67.—ED.

[135] St. Francis of Assisi, founder of the order of Friars Minors, after establishing numerous monasteries in Italy, Spain, and France, resigned his office and retired to this, one of the highest of the Apennine heights. See note, p. 67. He was canonised in 1230. Henry Crabb Robinson tells us, "It was at Laverna that he" [W.W.] "led me to expect that he had found a subject on which

he could write, and that was the love which birds bore to St. Francis. He repeated to me a short time afterwards a few lines, which I do not recollect amongst those he has written on St. Francis in this poem. On the journey, one night only I heard him in bed composing verses, and on the following day I offered to be his amanuensis; but I was not patient enough, I fear, and he did not employ me a second time. He made inquiries for St. Francis's biography, as if he would dub him his Leibheiliger (body-saint), as Goethe (saying that every one must have one) declared St. Philip Neri to be his." (See the *Memoirs of William Wordsworth*, by his nephew, vol. ii. p. 331)—ED.

[136] The characteristic feature of the Franciscan order was its vow of Poverty, and Francis desired that it should be taken in the most rigorous sense, viz. that no individual member of the fraternity, nor the fraternity itself, should be allowed to possess any property whatsoever, even in things necessary to human use.—ED.

[137] The members of the Franciscan order were the Stoics of Christendom. The order has been powerful, and of great service to the Roman Church—alike in literature, and in practical action and enterprise.—ED.

## XV AT THE CONVENT OF CAMALDOLI

This famous sanctuary was the original establishment of Saint Romualdo (or Rumwald, as our ancestors saxonised the name) in the 11th century, the ground (campo) being given by a Count Maldo. The Camaldolensi, however, have spread wide as a branch of Benedictines, and may therefore be classed among the *gentlemen* of the monastic orders. The society comprehends two orders, monks and hermits; symbolised by their arms, two doves drinking out of the same cup. The monastery in which the monks here reside is beautifully situated, but a large unattractive edifice, not unlike a factory. The hermitage is placed in a loftier and wilder region of the forest. It comprehends between 20 and 30 distinct residences, each including for its single hermit an inclosed piece of ground and three very small apartments. There are days of indulgence when the hermit may quit his cell, and when old age arrives, he descends from the mountain and takes his abode among the monks.

My companion had, in the year 1831, fallen in with the monk, the subject of these two sonnets, who showed him his abode among the hermits. It is from him that I received the following[138] particulars. He was then about 40 years of age, but his appearance was that of an older man. He had been a painter by profession, but on taking orders changed his name from Santi to

Raffaello, perhaps with an unconscious reference as well to the great Sanzio d'Urbino as to the archangel. He assured my friend that he had been 13 years in the hermitage and had never known melancholy or ennui. In the little recess for study and prayer, there was a small collection of books. "I read only," said he, "books of asceticism and mystical theology." On being asked the names of the most famous<sup>[139]</sup> mystics, he enumerated *Scaramelli*, *San Giovanni della Croce*, *St. Dionysius the Areopagite* (supposing the work which bears his name to be really his),<sup>[140]</sup> and with peculiar emphasis *Ricardo di San Vittori*. The works of *Saint Theresa* are also in high repute among ascetics.<sup>[141]</sup> These names may interest some of my readers.

We heard that Raffaello was then living in the convent; my friend sought in vain to renew his acquaintance with him. It was probably a day of seclusion. The reader will perceive that these sonnets were supposed to be written when he was a young man.—W.W. 1842.

The monastery of Camaldoli is on the highest point of the hills near Naples (1476 feet), and commands one of the finest views in Italy.—ED.

Grieve for the Man who hither came bereft,  
And seeking consolation from above;  
Nor grieve the less that skill to him was left  
To paint this picture of his lady-love:  
Can she, a blessed saint, the work approve? 5  
And O, good Brethren of the cowl, a thing  
So fair, to which with peril he must cling,  
Destroy in pity, or with care remove.  
That bloom—those eyes—can they assist to bind  
Thoughts that would stray from Heaven? The dream must cease 10  
To be; by Faith, not sight, his soul must live;  
Else will the enamoured Monk too surely find  
How wide a space can part from inward peace  
The most profound repose his cell can give.



[\[138\]](#) 1845.

received these particulars.

1842.

[\[139\]](#) 1845.

famous Italian mystics,

1842.

[\[140\]](#) 1845.

*San Dionysia, Areopagitica*, and with

1842.

[\[141\]](#) 1845.

are among ascetics in high repute, but she was a Spaniard.

1842.

## XVI CONTINUED

The world forsaken, all its busy cares  
And stirring interests shunned with desperate flight,  
All trust abandoned in the healing might  
Of virtuous action; all that courage dares,  
Labour accomplishes, or patience bears— 5  
Those helps rejected, they, whose minds perceive  
How subtly works man's weakness, sighs may heave  
For such a One beset with cloistral snares.  
Father of Mercy! rectify his view,  
If with his vows this object ill agree; 10  
Shed over it thy grace, and thus subdue<sup>[142]</sup>  
Imperious passion in a heart set free:—  
That earthly love may to herself be true,  
Give him a soul that cleaveth unto thee.

<sup>[142]</sup> 1845.

... and so subdue

1842.

## **XVII**

### **AT THE EREMITES OR UPPER CONVENT OF CAMALDOLI**

What aim had they, the Pair of Monks, in size[143]  
Enormous, dragged, while side by side they sate,  
By panting steers up to this convent gate?  
How, with empurpled cheeks and pampered eyes,  
Dare they confront the lean austerities 5  
Of Brethren, who, here fixed, on Jesu wait  
In sackcloth, and God's anger deprecate  
Through all that humbles flesh and mortifies?  
Strange contrast!—verily the world of dreams,  
Where mingle, as for mockery combined, 10  
Things in their very essences at strife,  
Shows not a sight incongruous as the extremes  
That everywhere, before the thoughtful mind,  
Meet on the solid ground of waking life.[144]

[143] In justice to the Benedictines of Camaldoli, by whom strangers are so hospitably entertained, I feel obliged to notice, that I saw among them no other figures at all resembling, in size and complexion, the two Monks described in this Sonnet. What was their office, or the motive which brought them to this place of mortification, which they could not have approached without being carried in this or some other way, a feeling of delicacy prevented me from inquiring. An account has before been given of the hermitage they were about to enter. It was visited by us towards the end of the month of May; yet snow was lying thick under the pine-trees, within a few yards of the gate.—W.W. 1842.

[144] See note, pp. 72, 73.—ED.

## XVIII AT VALLOMBROSA[145]

[I must confess, though of course I did not acknowledge it in the few lines I wrote in the Strangers' book kept at the convent, that I was somewhat disappointed at Vallombrosa. I had expected, as the name implies, a deep and narrow valley overshadowed by enclosing hills; but the spot where the convent stands is in fact not a valley at all, but a cove or crescent open to an extensive prospect. In the book before mentioned, I read

the notice in the English language that if anyone would ascend the steep ground above the convent, and wander over it, he would be abundantly rewarded by magnificent views. I had not time to act upon this recommendation, and only went with my young guide to a point, nearly on a level with the site of the convent, that overlooks the Vale of Arno for some leagues. To praise great and good men has ever been deemed one of the worthiest employments of poetry, but the objects of admiration vary so much with time and circumstances, and the noblest of mankind have been found, when intimately known, to be of characters so imperfect, that no eulogist can find a subject which he will venture upon with the animation necessary to create sympathy, unless he confines himself to a particular part or he takes something of a one-sided view of the person he is disposed to celebrate. This is a melancholy truth, and affords a strong reason for the poetic mind being chiefly exercised in works of fiction: the poet can then follow wherever the spirit of admiration leads him, unchecked by such suggestions as will be too apt to cross his way if all that he is prompted to utter is to be tested by fact. Something in this spirit I have written in the note attached to the Sonnet on the King of Sweden; and many will think that in this poem and elsewhere I have spoken of the author of *Paradise Lost* in a strain of panegyric scarcely justifiable by the tenor of some of his opinions, whether theological or political, and by the temper he carried into public affairs, in which, unfortunately for his genius, he was so much concerned.—I.F.]

Thick as autumnal leaves that strew the brooks  
In Vallombrosa, where Etrurian shades  
High over-arch'd embower.

PARADISE LOST.[\[146\]](#)

“Vallombrosa—I longed in thy shadiest wood  
To slumber, reclined on the moss-covered floor!”[\[147\]](#)  
Fond wish that was granted at last, and the Flood,  
That lulled me asleep, bids me listen once more.  
Its murmur how soft! as it falls down the steep, 5  
Near that Cell—yon sequestered Retreat high in air—[\[148\]](#)  
Where our Milton was wont lonely vigils to keep  
For converse with God, sought through study and prayer.  
The Monks still repeat the tradition with pride,  
And its truth who shall doubt? for his Spirit is here;[\[149\]](#) 10  
In the cloud-piercing rocks doth her grandeur abide,  
In the pines pointing heavenward her beauty austere;  
In the flower-besprent meadows his genius we trace  
Turned to humbler delights, in which youth might confide,  
That would yield him fit help while prefiguring that Place 15  
Where, if Sin had not entered, Love never had died.

When with life lengthened out came a desolate time,  
And darkness and danger had compassed him round,  
With a thought he would[\[150\]](#) flee to these haunts of his prime,  
And here once again a kind shelter be found. 20  
And let me believe that when nightly the Muse  
Did[\[151\]](#) waft him to Sion, the glorified hill,[\[152\]](#)  
Here also, on some favoured height, he[\[153\]](#) would choose  
To wander, and drink inspiration at will.

Vallombrosa! of thee I first heard in the page 25  
Of that holiest of Bards, and the name for my mind  
Had a musical charm, which the winter of age  
And the changes it brings had no power to unbind.  
And now, ye Miltonian shades! under you  
I repose, nor am forced from sweet fancy to part, 30

While your leaves I behold and the brooks they will strew,  
And the realised vision is clasped to my heart.

Even so, and unblamed, we rejoice as we may  
In Forms that must perish, frail objects of sense;  
Unblamed—if the Soul be intent on the day 35  
When the Being of Beings shall summon her hence.  
For he and he only with wisdom is blest  
Who, gathering true pleasures wherever they grow,  
Looks up in all places, for joy or for rest,  
To the Fountain whence Time and Eternity flow. 40

[145] The name of Milton is pleasingly connected with Vallombrosa in many ways. The pride with which the Monk, without any previous question from me, pointed out his residence, I shall not readily forget. It may be proper here to defend the Poet from a charge which has been brought against him, in respect to the passage in *Paradise Lost*, where this place is mentioned. It is said, that he has erred in speaking of the trees there being deciduous, whereas they are, in fact, pines. The fault-finders are themselves mistaken; the *natural* woods of the region of Vallombrosa *are* deciduous, and spread to a great extent; those near the convent are, indeed, mostly pines; but they are avenues of trees *planted* within a few steps of each other, and thus composing large tracts of wood; plots of which are periodically cut down. The appearance of those narrow avenues, upon steep slopes open to the sky, on account of the height which the trees attain by being *forced* to grow upwards, is often very impressive. My guide, a boy of about fourteen years old, pointed this out to me in several places.—W.W. 1842.

[146] Compare *Paradise Lost*, book i. l. 302. Vallombrosa—the shady valley—is 18 miles distant from Florence. Wordsworth's quotation from Milton was from memory. It is not quite accurate.—ED.

[147] See for the two *first lines*, *Stanzas composed in the Simplon Pass*.—W.W. 1842. (See vol. vi. p. 357.)—ED.

[148] The monastery of Vallombrosa was founded about 1050, by S. Giovanni Gualberto. It was suppressed in 1869, and is now converted into the R. Istituto Forestale, or forest school. The “cell,” the “sequestered retreat” referred to by Wordsworth, is doubtless *Il Paradisino*, or *Le Celle*, a small hermitage 266 feet above the monastery, which is itself 2980 feet above the sea.—ED.

[149] Compare Milton's letter to Benedetto Bonmattei of Florence, written during his stay in the city, September 10, 1638.—ED.

[150] 1845.

... might ...

1842.

[151] 1845.

Would ...

1842.

[152] Compare *Paradise Lost*, book iii. l. 29—

... but chief

Thee, Sion, and the flourie Brooks beneath,  
That wash thy hallowed feet, and warbling flow,  
Nightly I visit.

ED.

[153] 1845.

... they ...

1842.

## **XIX AT FLORENCE**

[Upon what evidence the belief rests that this stone was a favourite seat of Dante, I do not know; but a man would little consult his own interest as a traveller, if he should busy himself with doubts as to the fact. The readiness with which traditions of this character are received, and the fidelity with which they are preserved from generation to generation, are an evidence of feelings honourable to our nature. I remember how, during one of my rambles in the course of a college vacation, I was pleased on being shown a seat near a kind of rocky cell at the source of the river, on which it was said that Congreve wrote his *Old Bachelor*. One can scarcely hit on any performance less in harmony with the scene; but it was a local tribute paid to intellect by those who had not troubled themselves to estimate the moral

worth of that author's comedies; and why should they? He was a man distinguished in his day; and the sequestered neighbourhood in which he often resided was perhaps as proud of him as Florence of her Dante: it is the same feeling, though proceeding from persons one cannot bring together in this way without offering some apology to the Shade of the great Visionary. —I.F.]

Under the shadow of a stately Pile,  
The dome of Florence, pensive and alone,  
Nor giving heed to aught that passed the while,  
I stood, and gazed upon a marble stone,  
The laurelled Dante's favourite seat.<sup>[154]</sup> A throne, 5  
In just esteem, it rivals; though no style  
Be there of decoration to beguile  
The mind, depressed by thought of greatness flown.  
As a true man, who long had served the lyre,  
I gazed with earnestness, and dared no more. 10  
But in his breast the mighty Poet bore  
A Patriot's heart, warm with undying fire.  
Bold with the thought, in reverence I sate down,  
And, for a moment, filled that empty Throne.

<sup>[154]</sup> The *Sasso di Dante* is built into the wall of the house, No. 29 Casa dei Canonici, close to the Duomo.—ED.

**XX**  
**BEFORE THE PICTURE OF THE BAPTIST, BY RAPHAEL, IN**  
**THE GALLERY AT FLORENCE<sup>[155]</sup>**

[It was very hot weather during the week we stayed at Florence; and, never having been there before, I went through much hard service, and am not therefore *ashamed* to confess I fell asleep before this picture and sitting with my back towards the Venus de Medicis. Buonaparte—in answer to one



who had spoken of his being in a sound sleep up to the moment when one of his great battles was to be fought, as a proof of the calmness of his mind and command over anxious thoughts—said frankly, that he slept because from bodily exhaustion he could not help it. In like manner it is noticed that criminals on the night previous to their execution seldom awake before they are called, a proof that the body is the master of us far more than we need be willing to allow. Should this note by any possible chance be seen by any of my countrymen who might have been in the gallery at the time (and several persons were there) and witnessed such an indecorum, I hope he will give up the opinion which he might naturally have formed to my prejudice.—I.F.]

The Baptist might have been ordain'd to cry  
Forth from the towers of that huge Pile, wherein  
His Father served Jehovah; but how win  
Due audience, how for aught but scorn defy  
The obstinate pride and wanton revelry 5  
Of the Jerusalem below, her sin  
And folly, if they with united din  
Drown not at once mandate and prophecy?  
Therefore the Voice spake from the Desert, thence  
To Her, as to her opposite in peace, 10  
Silence, and holiness, and innocence,  
To Her and to all Lands its warning sent,  
Crying with earnestness that might not cease,  
“Make straight a highway for the Lord—repent!”

[155] This sonnet refers to the picture of the young St. John the Baptist, now in the Tribuna, Florence, designed about the same time as the Madonna di San Sisto, for Cardinal Colonna, who is said to have presented it to his doctor, Jacopo da Carpi. It has been much admired, and often copied; but it is inferior, both in drawing and in colouring, to the great works of Raphael. How much of it was actually from his hand is uncertain; and Baptist is painted rather like a Bacchus than a Saint.—ED.

XXI  
AT FLORENCE—FROM MICHAEL ANGELO

[However at first these two sonnets from Michael Angelo may seem in their spirit somewhat inconsistent with each other, I have not scrupled to place them side by side as characteristic of their great author, and others with whom he lived. I feel, nevertheless, a wish to know at what periods of his life they were respectively composed.<sup>[156]</sup> The latter, as it expresses, was written in his advanced years, when it was natural that the Platonism that pervades the one should give way to the Christian feeling that inspired the other: between both there is more than poetic affinity.—I.F.]

Rapt above earth by power of one fair face,  
Hers in whose sway alone my heart delights,  
I mingle with the blest on those pure heights  
Where Man, yet mortal, rarely finds a place.  
With Him who made the Work that Work accords 5  
So well, that by its help and through his grace  
I raise my thoughts, inform my deeds and words,  
Clasping her beauty in my soul's embrace.  
Thus, if from two fair eyes mine cannot turn,  
I feel how in their presence doth abide 10  
Light which to God is both the way and guide;  
And, kindling at their lustre, if I burn,  
My noble fire emits the joyful ray  
That through the realms of glory shines for aye.

<sup>[156]</sup> The second of the two sonnets translated by Wordsworth is No. lxxiii. in Signor Cesare Guasti's edition of Michael Angelo (1863).

AT THE FOOT OF THE CROSS.

*Scaro d'un' importuna.*

It was evidently written in old age. The following is Mr. John Addington Symond's translation of the same sonnet.

Freed from a burden sore and grievous band,  
Dear Lord, and from this wearying world untied,  
Like a frail bark I turn me to Thy side,  
As from a fierce storm to a tranquil land.  
Thy thorns, Thy nails, and either bleeding hand,  
With Thy mild gentle piteous face, provide  
Promise of help and mercies multiplied,  
And hope that yet my soul secure may stand.  
Let not Thy holy eyes be just to see  
My evil part, Thy chastened ears to hear,  
And stretch the arm of judgment to my crime:  
Let Thy blood only love and succour me,  
Yielding more perfect pardon, better cheer,  
As older still I grow with lengthening time.

*The Sonnets of Michael Angelo Buonarroti and Tomaso Campanella*, by John Addington Symonds, p. 110.

Compare Wordsworth's translation of other three sonnets by Michael Angelo (vol. iii. pp. 380-384).—ED.

## XXII

### AT FLORENCE—FROM M. ANGELO

Eternal Lord! eased of a cumbrous load,  
And loosened from the world, I turn to Thee;  
Shun, like a shattered bark, the storm, and flee  
To thy protection for a safe abode.  
The crown of thorns, hands pierced upon the tree, 5  
The meek, benign, and lacerated face,  
To a sincere repentance promise grace,  
To the sad soul give hope of pardon free.  
With justice mark not Thou, O Light divine,  
My fault, nor hear it with thy sacred ear; 10  
Neither put forth that way thy arm severe;  
Wash with thy blood my sins; thereto incline  
More readily the more my years require  
Help, and forgiveness speedy and entire.

### XXIII

#### AMONG THE RUINS OF A CONVENT IN THE APENNINES

[The political revolutions of our time have multiplied, on the Continent, objects that unavoidably call forth reflections such as are expressed in these verses, but the Ruins in those countries are too recent to exhibit, in anything like an equal degree, the beauty with which time and nature have invested the remains of our Convents and Abbeys. These verses, it will be observed, take up the beauty long before it is matured, as one cannot but wish it may be among some of the desolations of Italy, France, and Germany.—I.F.]

Ye Trees! whose slender roots entwine  
Altars that piety neglects;  
Whose infant arms enclasp the shrine  
Which no devotion now respects;  
If not a straggler from the herd 5  
Here ruminant, nor shrouded bird,  
Chanting her low-voiced hymn, take pride  
In aught that ye would grace or hide—  
How sadly is your love misplaced,  
Fair Trees, your bounty run to waste! 10

Ye, too, [\[157\]](#) wild Flowers! that no one heeds,  
And ye—full often spurned as weeds—  
In beauty clothed, or breathing sweetness  
From fractured arch and mouldering wall—  
Do but more touchingly recal 15  
Man's headstrong violence and Time's fleetness,  
Making [\[158\]](#) the precincts ye adorn  
Appear to sight still more forlorn.

[\[157\]](#) 1845.

And ye, ...

1842.

[\[158\]](#) 1845.

And make ...

1842.

**XXIV**  
**IN LOMBARDY**

See, where his difficult way that Old Man wins  
Bent by a load of Mulberry leaves!—most hard  
Appears *his* lot, to the small Worm's compared,  
For whom his toil with early day begins.  
Acknowledging no task-master, at will 5  
(As if her labour and her ease were twins)  
*She* seems to work, at pleasure to lie still;—  
And softly sleeps within the thread she spins.  
So fare they—the Man serving as her Slave.  
Ere long their fates do each to each conform: 10  
Both pass into new being,—but the Worm,  
Transfigured, sinks into a hopeless grave;  
*His* volant Spirit will, he trusts, ascend  
To bliss unbounded, glory without end.

**XXV**  
**AFTER LEAVING ITALY**

[I had proof in several instances that the Carbonari, if I may still call them so, and their favourers, are opening their eyes to the necessity of patience, and are intent upon spreading knowledge actively but quietly as they can. May they have resolution to continue in this course! for it is the only one by which they can truly benefit their country. We left Italy by the way which is called the “Nuova Strada de Allmagna,” to the east of the high passes of the Alps, which take you at once from Italy into Switzerland. This road leads across several smaller heights, and winds down different vales in succession, so that it was only by the accidental sound of a few German words that I was aware we had quitted Italy, and hence the unwelcome shock alluded to in the two or three last lines of the latter sonnet.—I.F.]

Fair Land! Thee all men greet with joy; how few,  
Whose souls take pride in freedom, virtue, fame,  
Part from thee without pity dyed in shame:  
I could not—while from Venice we withdrew,  
Led on till an Alpine strait confined our view<sup>[159]</sup> 5  
Within its depths, and to the shore we came  
Of Lago Morto, dreary sight and name,  
Which o'er sad thoughts a sadder colouring threw.  
Italia! on the surface of thy spirit,  
(Too aptly emblemed by that torpid lake) 10  
Shall a few partial breezes only creep?—  
Be its depths quickened; what thou dost inherit  
Of the world's hopes, dare to fulfil; awake,  
Mother of Heroes, from thy death-like sleep!

<sup>[159]</sup> They left Venice by the Nuova Strada de Allmagna, resting at Logerone, Sillian, Spittal (in Carinthia), and thence on to Salzburg.—ED.

**XXVI**  
**CONTINUED**

As indignation mastered grief, my tongue  
Spake bitter words; words that did ill agree  
With those rich stores of Nature's imagery,  
And divine Art, that fast to memory clung—  
Thy gifts, magnificent Region, ever young 5  
In the sun's eye, and in his sister's sight  
How beautiful! how worthy to be sung  
In strains of rapture, or subdued delight!  
I feign not; witness that unwelcome shock  
That followed the first sound of German speech, 10  
Caught the far-winding barrier Alps among.  
In that announcement, greeting seemed to mock<sup>[160]</sup>  
Parting; the casual word had power to reach  
My heart, and filled that heart with conflict strong.

<sup>[160]</sup> See the Fenwick note to the last sonnet.—ED.

## AT BOLOGNA, IN REMEMBRANCE OF THE LATE INSURRECTIONS, 1837<sup>[161]</sup><sup>[162]</sup>

Composed 1837.—Published 1842

This was originally (1842) included in the “Memorials of a Tour in Italy,” but, in 1845, it was transferred, along with the two which follow it, to the “Sonnets dedicated to Liberty and Order.”—ED.



Ah why deceive ourselves! by no mere fit  
Of sudden passion roused shall men attain  
True freedom where for ages they have lain  
Bound in a dark abominable pit,  
With life's best sinews more and more unknit. 5  
Here, there, a banded few who loathe the chain  
May rise to break it: effort worse than vain  
For thee, O great Italian nation, split  
Into those jarring fractions.—Let thy scope  
Be one fixed mind for all; thy rights approve 10  
To thy own conscience gradually renewed;  
Learn to make Time the father of wise Hope;  
Then trust thy cause to the arm of Fortitude,  
The light of Knowledge, and the warmth of Love.

## II CONTINUED

Composed 1837.—Published 1842

Hard task! exclaim the undisciplined, to lean  
On Patience coupled with such slow endeavour,  
That long-lived servitude must last for ever.  
Perish the grovelling few, who, prest between  
Wrongs and the terror of redress, would wean 5  
Millions from glorious aims. Our chains to sever  
Let us break forth in tempest now or never!—  
What, is there then no space for golden mean  
And gradual progress?—Twilight leads to day,  
And, even within the burning zones of earth, 10  
The hastiest sunrise yields a temperate ray;  
The softest breeze to fairest flowers gives birth:  
Think not that Prudence dwells in dark abodes,  
She scans the future with the eye of gods.

### **III CONCLUDED**

Composed 1837.—Published 1842

As leaves are to the tree whereon they grow  
And wither, every human generation  
Is to the Being of a mighty nation,  
Locked in our world's embrace through weal and woe;  
Thought that should teach the zealot to forego 5  
Rash schemes, to abjure all selfish agitation,  
And seek through noiseless pains and moderation  
The unblemished good they only can bestow.  
Alas! with most, who weigh futurity  
Against time present, passion holds the scales: 10  
Hence equal ignorance of both prevails,  
And nations sink; or, struggling to be free,  
Are doomed to flounder on, like wounded whales  
Tossed on the bosom of a stormy sea.

[161] This date was omitted in the edition of 1842.

[162] The three sonnets, *At Bologna, in remembrance of the late Insurrections*, 1837, are printed as a sequel to the Italian Tour of that year.—ED.

## **“WHAT IF OUR NUMBERS BARELY COULD DEFY”**

Composed 1837.—Published 1837

One of the “Poems dedicated to National Independence and Liberty.”—ED.

What if our numbers barely could defy  
The arithmetic of babes, must foreign hordes,  
Slaves, vile as ever were befooled by words,  
Striking through English breasts the anarchy  
Of Terror, bear us to the ground, and tie 5  
Our hands behind our backs with felon cords?  
Yields every thing to discipline of swords?  
Is man as good as man, none low, none high?—  
Nor discipline nor valour can withstand  
The shock, nor quell[163] the inevitable rout, 10  
When in some great extremity breaks out  
A people, on their own beloved Land  
Risen, like one man, to combat in the sight  
Of a just God for liberty and right.

[163] 1837.

... nor stem ...

C.

## A NIGHT THOUGHT

Composed 1837.—Published 1837

[These verses were thrown off extempore upon leaving Mrs. Luff's house at Fox Ghyll one evening. The good woman is not disposed to look at the bright side of things, and there happened to be present certain ladies who had reached the point of life where *youth* is ended, and who seemed to contend with each other in expressing their dislike of the country and climate. One of them had been heard to say she could not endure a country where there was "neither sunshine nor cavaliers."—I.F.]

This poem was first published in *The Tribute, a Collection of Miscellaneous unpublished Poems by various Authors, edited by Lord Northampton*, in 1837, “for the benefit of the widow and family of the Rev. Edward Smedley.” (The same volume contained a poem by Southey on Brough Bells.) It next found a place in “Poems chiefly of Early and Late Years” (1842). A stanza given in *The Tribute*, No. 2 (see below), was omitted afterwards.—ED.

Lo! where the Moon along the sky  
Sails with her happy destiny;[\[164\]](#)  
Oft is she hid from mortal eye  
Or dimly seen,  
But when the clouds asunder fly 5  
How bright her mien![\[165\]](#)

Far different we—a froward race,[\[166\]](#)  
Thousands though rich in Fortune’s grace  
With cherished sullenness of pace  
Their way pursue, 10  
Ingrates who wear a smileless face  
The whole year through.

If kindred humours e’er would make[\[167\]](#)  
My spirit droop for drooping’s sake,  
From Fancy following in thy wake, 15  
Bright ship of heaven!  
A counter impulse let me take  
And be forgiven.[\[168\]](#)

[\[164\]](#) 1842.

The moon that sails along the sky  
Moves with a happy destiny,

1837.

[165] 1837.

Not flagging when the winds all sleep,  
Not hurried onward, when they sweep  
The bosom of th' ethereal deep,  
Not turned aside,  
She knows an even course to keep,  
Whate'er betide.

In the text of 1837 only.

[166] 1842.

Perverse are we—a froward race;

1837.

[167] 1842.

If kindred humour e'er should make

1837.

[168] Compare the poem *To the Daisy* (1802), beginning—

Bright Flower! whose home is everywhere.

ED.

## THE WIDOW ON WINDERMERE SIDE

Published 1842

[The facts recorded in this Poem were given me, and the character of the person described, by my friend the Rev. R. P. Graves, [169] who has long

officiated as curate at Bowness, to the great benefit of the parish and neighbourhood. The individual was well known to him. She died before these verses were composed. It is scarcely worth while to notice that the stanzas are written in the sonnet form, which was adopted when I thought the matter might be included in twenty-eight lines.—I.F.]

One of the “Poems founded on the Affections.”—ED.

## I

How beautiful when up a lofty height  
Honour ascends among the humblest poor,  
And feeling sinks as deep! See there the door  
Of One, a Widow, left beneath a weight  
Of blameless debt. On evil Fortune's spite 5  
She wasted no complaint, but strove to make  
A just repayment, both for conscience-sake  
And that herself and hers should stand upright  
In the world's eye. Her work when daylight failed  
Paused not, and through the depth of night she kept 10  
Such earnest vigils, that belief prevailed  
With some, the noble Creature never slept;  
But, one by one, the hand of death assailed  
Her children from her inmost heart bewept.

## II

The Mother mourned, nor ceased her tears to flow, 15  
Till a winter's noon-day placed her buried Son  
Before her eyes, last child of many gone—  
His raiment of angelic white, and lo!  
His very feet bright as the dazzling snow  
Which they are touching; yea far brighter, even 20  
As that which comes, or seems to come, from heaven,  
Surpasses aught these elements can show.  
Much she rejoiced, trusting that from that hour  
Whate'er befel she could not grieve or pine;  
But the Transfigured, in and out of season, 25  
Appeared, and spiritual presence gained a power  
Over material forms that mastered reason.  
Oh. gracious Heaven. in pity make her thine!



### III

But why that prayer? as if to her could come  
No good but by the way that leads to bliss 30  
Through Death,—so judging we should judge amiss.  
Since reason failed want is her threatened doom,  
Yet frequent transports mitigate the gloom:  
Nor of those maniacs is she one that kiss  
The air or laugh upon a precipice; 35  
No, passing through strange sufferings toward the tomb,  
She smiles as if a martyr's crown were won:  
Oft, when light breaks through clouds or waving trees,  
With outspread arms and fallen upon her knees  
The Mother hails in her descending Son 40  
An Angel, and in earthly ecstasies  
Her own angelic glory seems begun.

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[169] The late Archdeacon of Dublin, author of *Life of Sir William Rowan Hamilton*, etc. He gives the date of the composition of the poem as 1837.—ED.



## 1838

In 1838 Wordsworth wrote ten sonnets. These were published (along with the one suggested by Mrs. Southey) for the first time in the volume of collected Sonnets, several being inserted out of their intended place, while the book was passing through the press.

The *Protest against the Ballot*, which appeared in 1838, was never republished.—ED.

### TO THE PLANET VENUS UPON ITS APPROXIMATION (AS AN EVENING STAR) TO THE EARTH, JANUARY 1838

Composed 1838.—Published 1838[\[170\]](#)

One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

What strong allurements draw, what spirit guides,  
Thee, Vesper! brightening still, as if the nearer  
Thou com'st to man's abode the spot grew dearer  
Night after night? True is it Nature hides  
Her treasures less and less.—Man now presides 5  
In power, where once he trembled in his weakness;  
Science[171] advances with gigantic strides;  
But are we aught enriched in love and meekness?[172]  
Aught dost thou see, bright Star! of pure and wise  
More than in humbler times graced human story; 10  
That makes our hearts more apt to sympathise  
With heaven, our souls more fit for future glory,  
When earth shall vanish from our closing eyes,  
Ere we lie down in our last dormitory?[173]

[170] It was afterwards printed in the *Saturday Magazine*, Oct. 24, 1840.—ED.

[171] 1845.

Knowledge

1838.

[172] Compare Tennyson's *In Memoriam*, stanza cxx.—

Let Science prove we are, and then  
What matters Science unto men, etc.

ED.

[173] Compare the poem in vol. vii. p. 299, *To the Planet Venus, an Evening Star*.—ED.

**“HARK! ’TIS THE THRUSH, UNDAUNTED, UNDEPREST”**

Composed 1838.—Published 1838  
One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

Hark! 'tis the Thrush, undaunted, undeprest,  
By twilight premature of cloud and rain;  
Nor does that roaring wind deaden his strain<sup>[174]</sup>  
Who carols thinking of his Love and nest,  
And seems, as more incited, still more blest. 5  
Thanks; thou hast snapped a fire-side Prisoner's chain,  
Exulting Warbler! eased a fretted brain,  
And in a moment charmed my cares to rest.  
Yes, I will forth, bold Bird! and front the blast,  
That we may sing together, if thou wilt, 10  
So loud, so clear, my Partner through life's day,  
Mute in her nest love-chosen, if not love-built  
Like thine, shall gladden, as in seasons past,  
Thrilled by loose snatches of the social Lay.

RYDAL MOUNT, 1838.

<sup>[174]</sup> 1838.

... undaunted, unopprest,  
Struggling with twilight premature and rain.  
Loud roars the wind, but smothers not his strain

MS.

## “’TIS HE WHOSE YESTER-EVENING’S HIGH DISDAIN”

Composed 1838.—Published 1838  
One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

'Tis He whose yester-evening's high disdain  
Beat back the roaring storm—but how subdued  
His day-break note, a sad vicissitude!  
Does the hour's drowsy weight his glee restrain?  
Or, like the nightingale, her joyous vein 5  
Pleased to renounce, does this dear Thrush attune  
His voice to suit the temper of yon Moon  
Doubly depressed, setting, and in her wane?  
Rise, tardy Sun! and let the Songster prove  
(The balance trembling between night and morn 10  
No longer) with what ecstasy upborne  
He can pour forth his spirit. In heaven above,  
And earth below, they best can serve true gladness  
Who meet most feelingly the calls of sadness.

**COMPOSED AT RYDAL ON MAY MORNING, 1838**[\[175\]](#)

Composed 1st May 1838.—Published 1838

[This and the following sonnet were composed on what we call the “Far Terrace” at Rydal Mount, where I have murmured out many thousands of verses.—I.F.]

This sonnet was first published in the Volume of Collected Sonnets in 1838. In 1842 it was classed among the “Miscellaneous Sonnets”; but in 1845 it was transferred to the “Memorials of a Tour in Italy, 1837.”—ED.

If with old love of you, dear Hills! I share  
 New love of many a rival image brought  
 From far, forgive the wanderings of my thought:  
 Nor art thou wronged, sweet May! when I compare<sup>[176]</sup>  
 Thy present birth-morn with thy last,<sup>[177]</sup><sup>[178]</sup> so fair, 5  
 So rich to me in favours. For my lot  
 Then was, within the famed Egerian Grot  
 To sit and muse, fanned by its dewy air  
 Mingling with thy soft breath! That morning too,  
 Warblers I heard their joy unbosoming 10  
 Amid the sunny, shadowy, Coliseum;<sup>[179]</sup>  
 Heard them, unchecked by aught of saddening hue,<sup>[180]</sup>  
 For victories there won by flower-crowned Spring,<sup>[181]</sup>  
 Chant in full choir their innocent Te Deum.

<sup>[175]</sup> 1845.

The title in 1838 was “COMPOSED ON MAY-MORNING, 1838”; and “RYDAL MOUNT” was written at the foot of the sonnet.

<sup>[176]</sup> 1838.

May, if from these thy northern haunts I share  
 Fond looks of mind for images remote  
 Fetched out of milder climates, blame me not,  
 Nor that, upris'n thus early, I compare

MS.

Let those who will or can, dear May, forbear  
 To rise and hail thy coming, I could not.  
 The vivid images of scenes remote  
 Rushing on memory urge me to compare

MS.

Dear native Hills, the love of you I share  
With ...

MS.

Dear fields and native mountains, if I share  
My love of youth with love of objects brought  
{From far, by faithful memory, blame me not. }  
{Fetched from a milder climate, blame me not.}  
{From a distant land by memory, blame me not.}  
{Nor that, upris'n thus early, }  
{Nor be displeased, sweet May, if} I compare  
{May,}  
{Thy } present ...

MS.

[177] 1838.

... past,

MS.

[178] On May morning, 1837, Wordsworth was in Rome with Henry Crabb Robinson.—ED.

[179] The Flavian Amphitheatre, begun by Vespasian, A.D. 72, and continued by his son Titus, one of the noblest structures in Rome, now a ruin. —ED.

[180] 1845.

... of sombre hue,

1838.

... by thoughts of sombre hue,

MS.

[181] 1838.



... too,  
How my heart swelled when in the mighty ring,  
The mouldering, shadowy, sunny Collosseum,  
I heard with some sad thoughts of local hue  
Warblers there lodged, for victories won by spring

MS.

... too,  
Here did I a deathless joy embosoming,  
{Mid } the shadowy Collosseum,  
{Within}  
Hear not without sad thoughts of local hue

MS.

... too,  
Heard I, a deathless joy embosoming,  
Tho' not without sad thoughts of local hue,  
Amid the shadowy, sunny, Collosseum,  
Warblers there lodged, for victories won by Spring

MS.

## COMPOSED ON A MAY MORNING, 1838[\[182\]](#)

Composed 1838.—Published 1838[\[183\]](#)

This was one of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

Life with yon Lambs, like day, is just begun,  
 Yet Nature seems to them a heavenly guide.<sup>[184]</sup>  
 Does joy approach? they meet the coming tide;  
 And sullenness avoid, as now they shun<sup>[185]</sup>  
 Pale twilight's lingering glooms,—and in the sun 5  
 Couch near their dams, with quiet satisfied;<sup>[186]</sup>  
 Or gambol—each with his shadow at his side,<sup>[187]</sup>  
 Varying its shape wherever he may run.  
 As they from turf yet hoar with sleepy dew  
 All turn, and court the shining and the green, 10  
 Where herbs look up, and opening flowers are seen;  
 Why to God's goodness cannot We be true,  
 And so, His<sup>[188]</sup> gifts and promises between,  
 Feed to the last on pleasures ever new?

<sup>[182]</sup> 1845.

The title, in 1838, was “COMPOSED ON THE SAME MORNING”; referring to the previous sonnet in that edition, beginning—

If with old love of you, dear Hills! I share.

<sup>[183]</sup> There were so many tentative efforts in the construction of this sonnet, and the one which follows it, that I feel justified in printing them from MS. sources.—ED.

<sup>[184]</sup> 1838.

Life with yon mountain lambs is just begun,

MS.

Yon mountain Lambs whose life is just begun  
 Some guidance know to Man's grave years denied.

MS.

Your lives, ye mountain lambs, tho' just begun  
A guidance know to our best years denied.

MS. sent to Mr. Clarkson.

[185] 1838.

O that by Nature we were prompt the tide  
Of joy to meet, as {they} are who {now } shun  
                                  {ye }                                   {there}

MS. sent to Mr. Clarkson.

[186] 1838.

The lingering glooms of twilight, in the sun  
To couch, with sober quiet satisfied.

MS. sent to Mr. Clarkson.

... shun

Hollows unbrightened by the {rising} sun  
                                                {morning}

On slopes to couch with quiet satisfied.

MS.

To couch on slopes where he his beams has tried,  
Sporting and running wheresoe'er ye run.

MS.

[187] 1838.

Couch near their dams; or frisk in sportive pride  
Each with his playful shadow at his side,

MS.

[188] 1838.

As they from turf hoary with unsunned dew  
Turn and do one and all prefer the green  
To chilly nooks, knolls cheered with glistening sheen,  
Why may not we a kindred course pursue  
And so, God's ...

MS.

... shun  
Hollows {enlivened } by the rising sun  
          {unbrightened}  
On slopes to couch with quiet satisfied,  
Or gambol each, his shadow at his side,  
Running in sport wherever he may run.  
As from dull turf hoary with unsunned dew  
They turn, and one and all prefer the green  
To chilly nooks, knolls {warmed} with glistening sheen,  
                                  {cheered}  
Why may not we a kindred course pursue  
And so, Heaven's ...

MS.

... shun  
The lingering gloom of twilight in the sun,  
To couch with sober quiet satisfied,  
Or gambol each, his shadow at his side,  
Varying its shape wherever he may run.

MS.

As they from turf with thick and sleepy dew  
{ {Yet} whitened o'er, turn and}  
{ {All} } prefer the green  
{Turn, and do one and all }  
To chilly nooks, {slopes} warm with glistening sheen,  
                                  {knolls}  
Why may not we thro' life such course pursue  
And so, God's ...

MS.

As they from turf with thick and sleepy dew  
Yet whitened o'er, turn and prefer the green;  
To chilly nooks, slopes warm with glistening sheen,  
Why may not we such course through life pursue,  
And so, God's gifts and promises between,  
Feed ...

MS.

## A PLEA FOR AUTHORS, MAY 1838

Failing impartial measure to dispense  
To every suitor, Equity is lame;  
And social Justice, stript of reverence  
For natural rights, a mockery and a shame;  
Law but a servile dupe of false pretence, 5  
If, guarding grossest things from common claim  
Now and for ever, She, to works that came<sup>[189]</sup>  
From mind and spirit, grudge a short-lived fence.  
“What! lengthened privilege, a lineal tie,  
For *Books!*” Yes, heartless Ones, or be it proved 10  
That 'tis a fault in Us to have lived and loved  
Like others, with like temporal hopes to die;  
No public harm that Genius from her course  
Be turned; and streams of truth dried up, even at their source!<sup>[190]</sup>

<sup>[189]</sup> 1838.





Blest Statesman He, whose Mind's unselfish will  
Leaves him[191] at ease among grand thoughts: whose eye  
Sees that, apart from magnanimity,  
Wisdom exists not; nor the humbler skill  
Of Prudence, disentangling good and ill 5  
With patient care. What tho' [192] assaults run high,  
They daunt not him who holds his ministry,  
Resolute, at all hazards, to fulfil  
Its[193] duties;—prompt to move, but firm to wait,—  
Knowing, things rashly sought are rarely found; 10  
That, for[194] the functions of an ancient State—  
Strong by her charters, free because imbound,  
Servant of Providence, not slave of Fate—  
Perilous is sweeping change, all chance unsound.[195]

[191] 1842.

... her  
c. and 1838.

[192] 1838.

... if  
c.

[193] 1838.

His  
c.

[194] 1838.



... in

C.

[195]

All change is perilous, and all chance unsound.

SPENSER.—W.W. 1838.

The passage will be found in *The Faërie Queene*, book v. canto xii. stanza 36.  
—ED.

## VALEDICTORY SONNET [196]

Composed 1838.—Published 1838

One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

Serving no haughty Muse, my hands have here  
Disposed some cultured Flowerets (drawn from spots  
Where they bloomed singly, or in scattered knots),  
Each kind in several beds of one parterre;  
Both to allure the casual Loiterer, 5  
And that, so placed, my Nurslings may requite  
Studious regard with opportune delight,  
Nor be unthanked, unless I fondly err.  
But metaphor dismissed, and thanks apart,  
Reader, farewell! My last words let them be— 10  
If in this book Fancy and Truth agree;  
If simple Nature trained by careful Art  
Through It have won a passage to thy heart;  
Grant me thy love, I crave no other fee!

[196] This closed the volume of sonnets published in 1838.—ED.



## 1839

The fourteen “Sonnets upon the Punishment of Death” were originally published in the *Quarterly Review* (in December 1841), in an article on the “Sonnets of William Wordsworth” by the late Sir Henry Taylor, author of *Philip van Artevelde*, and other poems. Towards the close of this article (of 1841), after reviewing the volume of Sonnets published in 1838, Sir Henry adds, “There is a short series *written two years ago*, which we have been favoured with permission to present to the public for the first time. It was suggested by the recent discussions in Parliament, and elsewhere, on the subject of the ‘Punishment of Death.’”

When republishing this and other critical Essays on Poetry, in the collected edition of his works in 1878, Sir Henry omitted the paragraphs relating to these particular sonnets. Wordsworth published the sonnets in his volume of “Poems chiefly of Early and Late Years,” in 1842.—ED.

### SONNETS UPON THE PUNISHMENT OF DEATH IN SERIES

Composed 1839.—Published 1841

“In the session of 1836, a report by the Commissioners on Criminal Law—of which the second part was on this subject (the Punishment of Death)—was laid before Parliament. In the ensuing session this was followed by papers presented to Parliament by her Majesty’s command, and consisting of a correspondence between the Commissioners, Lord John Russell, and Lord Denman. Upon the foundation afforded by these documents, the bills of the 17th July 1837—(7th Gul. IV. and 1st Vict. cap. 84 to 89 and 91)—were brought in and passed. These acts removed the punishment of death from about 200 offences, and left it applicable to high treason,—murder and attempts at murder—rape—arson with danger to life—and to piracies, burglaries, and robberies, when aggravated by cruelty and violence.” (Sir

Henry Taylor, *Quarterly Review*, Dec. 1841, p. 39.) Some members of the House of Commons—Mr. Fitzroy Kelly, Mr. Ewart, and others—desired a further limitation of the punishment of death to the crimes of murder and treason only: and the question of the entire abolition of capital punishment being virtually before the country, Wordsworth dealt with it in the following series of sonnets.—ED.

**I**  
**SUGGESTED BY THE VIEW OF LANCASTER CASTLE (ON THE  
ROAD FROM THE SOUTH)**

This Spot—at once unfolding sight so fair  
Of sea and land, with yon grey towers that still  
Rise up as if to lord it over air—  
Might soothe in human breasts the sense of ill,  
Or charm it out of memory; yea, might fill 5  
The heart with joy and gratitude to God  
For all his bounties upon man bestowed:  
Why bears it then the name of “Weeping Hill”?[\[197\]](#)  
Thousands, as toward yon old Lancastrian Towers,  
A prison’s crown, along this way they past 10  
For lingering durance or quick death with shame,  
From this bare eminence thereon have cast  
Their first look—blinded as tears fell in showers  
Shed on their chains; and hence that doleful name.

[\[197\]](#) The name given to the spot from which criminals on their way to the Castle of Lancaster first see it.—ED.

**II**[\[198\]](#)  
**“TENDERLY DO WE FEEL BY NATURE’S LAW”**

Tenderly do we feel by Nature's law  
For worst offenders: though the heart will heave  
With indignation, deeply moved we grieve,  
In after thought, for Him who stood in awe  
Neither of God nor man, and only saw, 5  
Lost wretch, a horrible device enthroned  
On proud temptations, till the victim groaned  
Under the steel his hand had dared to draw.  
But O, restrain compassion, if its course,  
As oft befalls, prevent or turn aside 10  
Judgments and aims and acts whose higher source  
Is sympathy with the unforewarned, who died[199]  
Blameless—with them that shuddered o'er his grave,  
And all who from the law firm safety crave.

[198] “The first sonnet prepares the reader to sympathise with the sufferings of the culprits. The next cautions him as to the limits within which his sympathies are to be restrained.” (Sir Henry Taylor.)—ED.

[199] 1842.

... that died

1841.

### III[200]

## “THE ROMAN CONSUL DOOMED HIS SONS TO DIE”

The Roman Consul doomed his sons to die  
Who had betrayed their country.<sup>[201]</sup> The stern word  
Afforded (may it through all time afford)  
A theme for praise and admiration high.  
Upon the surface of humanity 5  
He rested not; its depths his mind explored;  
He felt; but his parental bosom's lord  
Was Duty,—Duty calmed his agony.  
And some, we know, when they by wilful act  
A single human life have wrongly taken, 10  
Pass sentence on themselves, confess the fact,  
And, to atone for it, with soul unshaken  
Kneel at the feet of Justice, and, for faith  
Broken with all mankind, solicit death.

<sup>[200]</sup> “In the third and fourth sonnets the reader is prepared to regard as low and effeminate the views which would estimate life and death as the most important of all sublunary conditions.” (Sir Henry Taylor.)—ED.

<sup>[201]</sup> Lucius Junius Brutus, who condemned his sons to die for the part they took in the conspiracy to restore the Tarquins. (See Livy, book ii.)—ED.

#### IV

**“IS *DEATH*, WHEN EVIL AGAINST GOOD HAS FOUGHT”**

Is *Death*, when evil against good has fought  
With such fell mastery that a man may dare  
By deeds the blackest purpose to lay bare?  
Is Death, for one to that condition brought,  
For him, or any one, the thing that ought 5  
To be *most* dreaded? Lawgivers, beware,  
Lest, capital pains remitting till ye spare  
The murderer, ye, by sanction to that thought  
Seemingly given, debase the general mind;  
Tempt the vague will tried standards to disown, 10  
Nor only palpable restraints unbind,  
But upon Honour's head disturb the crown,  
Whose absolute rule permits not to withstand  
In the weak love of life his least command.

## V

**“NOT TO THE OBJECT SPECIALLY DESIGNED”**

Not to the object specially designed,  
Howe'er momentous in itself it be,  
Good to promote or curb depravity,  
Is the wise Legislator's view confined.  
His Spirit, when most severe, is oft most kind; 5  
As all Authority in earth depends  
On Love and Fear, their several powers he blends,  
Copying with awe the one Paternal mind.  
Uncaught by processes in show humane,  
He feels how far the act would derogate 10  
From even the humblest functions of the State;  
If she, self-shorn of Majesty, ordain  
That never more shall hang upon her breath  
The last alternative of Life or Death.

**VI**[\[202\]](#)

**“YE BROOD OF CONSCIENCE—SPECTRES! THAT FREQUENT”**



Ye brood of conscience—Spectres! that frequent  
The bad man's restless walk, and haunt his bed—  
Fiends in your aspect, yet beneficent  
In act, as hovering Angels when they spread  
Their wings to guard the unconscious Innocent— 5  
Slow be the Statutes of the land to share  
A laxity that could not but impair  
Your power to punish crime, and so prevent.  
And ye, Beliefs! coiled serpent-like about  
The adage on all tongues, "Murder will out,"<sup>[203]</sup> 10  
How shall your ancient warnings work for good  
In the full might they hitherto have shown,  
If for deliberate shedder of man's blood  
Survive not Judgment that requires his own?

<sup>[202]</sup> "The sixth sonnet adverts to the effect of the law in preventing the crime of murder, not merely by fear, but by horror, by investing the crime itself with the colouring of dark and terrible imaginations." (Sir Henry Taylor.)—ED.

<sup>[203]</sup> See Chaucer, *The Nonnes Priestes Tale*, l. 232.—ED.

## VII

### "BEFORE THE WORLD HAD PAST HER TIME OF YOUTH"

Before the world had past her time of youth  
While polity and discipline were weak,  
The precept eye for eye, and tooth for tooth,  
Came forth—a light, though but as of day-break,  
Strong as could then be borne. A Master meek 5  
Proscribed the spirit fostered by that rule,  
Patience *his* law, long-suffering *his* school,  
And love the end, which all through peace must seek.  
But lamentably do they err who strain  
His mandates, given rash impulse to controul 10  
And keep vindictive thirstings from the soul,  
So far that, if consistent in their scheme,  
They must forbid the State to inflict a pain,  
Making of social order a mere dream.

#### VIII[204]

#### “FIT RETRIBUTION, BY THE MORAL CODE”

Fit retribution, by the moral code  
Determined, lies beyond the State's embrace,  
Yet, as she may, for each peculiar case  
She plants well-measured terrors in the road  
Of wrongful acts. Downward it is and broad, 5  
And, the main fear once doomed to banishment,  
Far oftener then, bad ushering worse event,  
Blood would be spilt that in his dark abode  
Crime might lie better hid. And, should the change  
Take from the horror due to a foul deed, 10  
Pursuit and evidence so far must fail,  
And, guilt escaping, passion then might plead  
In angry spirits for her old free range,  
And the "wild justice of revenge" [205] prevail.

[204] "In the eighth sonnet the doctrine, which would strive to measure out the punishments awarded by the law in proportion to the degrees of moral turpitude, is disavowed." (Sir Henry Taylor.)—ED.

[205] See Bacon's Essay *Of Revenge*, beginning, "Revenge is a sort of wild justice."—ED.

## IX

**"THOUGH TO GIVE TIMELY WARNING AND DETER"**

Though to give timely warning and deter  
Is one great aim of penalty, extend  
Thy mental vision further and ascend  
Far higher, else full surely shalt thou err.[\[206\]](#)  
What is a State? The wise behold in her 5  
A creature born of time, that keeps one eye  
Fixed on the statutes of Eternity,  
To which her judgments reverently defer.  
Speaking through Law's dispassionate voice the State  
Endues her conscience with external life 10  
And being, to preclude or quell the strife  
Of individual will, to elevate  
The grovelling mind, the erring to recal,  
And fortify the moral sense of all.

[\[206\]](#) 1845.

... thou shalt err.

1842.

## X

**“OUR BODILY LIFE, SOME PLEAD, THAT LIFE THE SHRINE”**

Our bodily life, some plead, that life the shrine  
Of an immortal spirit, is a gift  
So sacred, so informed with light divine,  
That no tribunal, though most wise to sift  
Deed and intent, should turn the Being adrift 5  
Into that world where penitential tear  
May not avail, nor prayer have for God's ear  
A voice—that world whose veil no hand can lift  
For earthly sight. "Eternity and Time"  
*They* urge, "have interwoven claims and rights 10  
Not to be jeopardised through foulest crime:  
The sentence rule by mercy's heaven-born lights."  
Even so; but measuring not by finite sense  
Infinite Power, perfect Intelligence.

XI[207]

**"AH, THINK HOW ONE COMPELLED FOR LIFE TO ABIDE"**

Ah, think how one compelled for life to abide  
Locked in a dungeon needs must eat the heart  
Out of his own humanity, and part  
With every hope that mutual cares provide;  
And, should a less unnatural doom confide 5  
In life-long exile on a savage coast,  
Soon the relapsing penitent may boast  
Of yet more heinous guilt, with fiercer pride.  
Hence thoughtful Mercy, Mercy sage and pure,  
Sanctions the forfeiture that Law demands, 10  
Leaving the final issue in *His* hands  
Whose goodness knows no change, whose love is sure,  
Who sees, foresees; who cannot judge amiss,  
And wafts at will the contrite soul to bliss.

[207] “In the eleventh and twelfth sonnets the alternatives of secondary punishment,—solitary imprisonment, and transportation,—are adverted to.” (Sir Henry Taylor.)—ED.

## XII

### “SEE THE CONDEMNED ALONE WITHIN HIS CELL”

See the Condemned alone within his cell  
And prostrate at some moment when remorse  
Stings to the quick, and, with resistless force,  
Assaults the pride she strove in vain to quell.  
Then mark him, him who could so long rebel, 5  
The crime confessed, a kneeling Penitent  
Before the Altar, where the Sacrament  
Softens his heart, till from his eyes outwell  
Tears of salvation. Welcome death! while Heaven  
Does in this change exceedingly rejoice; 10  
While yet the solemn heed the State hath given  
Helps him to meet the last Tribunal's voice  
In faith, which fresh offences, were he cast  
On old temptations, might for ever blast.

**XIII**[\[208\]](#)  
**CONCLUSION**

Yes, though He well may tremble at the sound  
Of his own voice, who from the judgment-seat  
Sends the pale Convict to his last retreat  
In death; though Listeners shudder all around,  
They know the dread requital's source profound; 5  
Nor is, they feel, its wisdom obsolete—  
(Would that it were!) the sacrifice unmeet  
For Christian Faith. But hopeful signs abound;  
The social rights of man breathe purer air;  
Religion deepens her preventive care; 10  
Then, moved by needless fear of past abuse,  
Strike not from Law's firm hand that awful rod,  
But leave it thence to drop for lack of use:  
Oh, speed the blessed hour, Almighty God!

[208] “In the thirteenth sonnet he anticipates that a time may come when the punishment of death will be needed no longer; but he wishes that the disuse of it should grow out of the absence of the need, not be imposed by legislation.” (Sir Henry Taylor.)—ED.

## XIV APOLOGY



The formal World relaxes her cold chain  
For One who speaks in numbers; ampler scope  
His utterance finds; and, conscious of the gain,  
Imagination works with bolder hope  
The cause of grateful reason to sustain; 5  
And, serving Truth, the heart more strongly beats  
Against all barriers which his labour meets  
In lofty place, or humble Life's domain.  
Enough;—before us lay a painful road,  
And guidance have I sought in duteous love 10  
From Wisdom's heavenly Father. Hence hath flowed  
Patience, with trust that, whatsoe'er the way  
Each takes in this high matter, all may move  
Cheered with the prospect of a brighter day.

1840.[\[209\]](#)

[\[209\]](#) In the editions of 1842, 1845, and 1850 the date “1840” follows this poem. It may have been written in that year.—ED.

## **“MEN OF THE WESTERN WORLD! IN FATE’S DARK BOOK”**

Published 1842

One of the “Sonnets dedicated to Liberty and Order.”—ED.

Men of the Western World! in Fate's dark book  
Whence these opprobrious leaves of dire portent?  
Think ye your British Ancestors forsook  
Their native Land, for outrage provident;  
From unsubmitive necks the bridle shook 5  
To give, in their Descendants, freer vent  
And wider range to passions turbulent,  
To mutual tyranny a deadlier look?  
Nay, said a voice, soft as the south wind's breath,  
Dive through the stormy surface of the flood 10  
To the great current flowing underneath;  
Explore the countless springs of silent good;  
So shall the truth be better understood,  
And thy grieved Spirit brighten strong in faith. [\[210\]](#)

[\[210\]](#) These lines were written several years ago, when reports prevailed of cruelties committed in many parts of America, by men making a law of their own passions. A far more formidable, as being a more deliberate mischief, has appeared among those States, which have lately broken faith with the public creditor in a manner so infamous. I cannot, however, but look at both evils under a similar relation to inherent good, and hope that the time is not distant when our brethren of the West will wipe off this stain from their name and nation.

ADDITIONAL NOTE.

I am happy to add that this anticipation is already partly realised; and that the reproach addressed to the Pennsylvanians is no longer applicable to them. I trust that those other states to which it may yet apply will soon follow the example now set them by Philadelphia, and redeem their credit with the world.—W.W. 1850.

“This editorial note is on a fly-leaf at the end of the fifth volume of the edition, which was completed only a short time before the Poet's death. It contains probably the last sentences composed by him for the press. It was promptly added by him in consequence of a suggestion from me, that the sonnet addressed “*To Pennsylvanians*” was no longer just—a fact which is mentioned to shew that the fine sense of truth and justice which distinguish his writings was active to the last.” (Note to Professor Reed's American Edition of 1851.)—ED.

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## 1840

Only four poems, viz. *Poor Robin*, two sonnets referring to Miss Gillies, and one on Haydon's portrait of the Duke of Wellington, belong to 1840.—ED.

### TO A PAINTER

Composed 1840.—Published 1842

[The picture which gave occasion to this and the following sonnet was from the pencil of Miss M. Gillies, who resided for several weeks under our roof at Rydal Mount.—I.F.]

One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

All praise the Likeness by thy skill portrayed;[\[211\]](#)  
But 'tis a fruitless task to paint for me,  
Who, yielding not to changes Time has made,  
By the habitual light of memory see  
Eyes unbedimmed, see bloom that cannot fade, 5  
And smiles that from their birth-place ne'er shall flee  
Into the land where ghosts and phantoms be;  
And, seeing this, own nothing in its stead.  
Couldst thou go back into far-distant years,  
Or share with me, fond thought! that inward eye,[\[212\]](#) 10  
Then, and then only, Painter! could thy Art  
The visual powers of Nature satisfy,  
Which hold, whate'er to common sight appears,  
Their sovereign empire in a faithful heart.

[\[211\]](#) Miss Gillies told me that she visited Rydal Mount in 1841, at the invitation of the Wordsworths, to make a miniature portrait of the poet on ivory, which had been commissioned by Mr. Moon, the publisher, for the purpose of engraving. An engraving of this portrait was published on the 6th of August 1841. The original is now in America. I think she must have been wrong in her memory of the year, which was 1840. Miss Gillies also told me that the Wordsworths were so pleased with what she had done for Mr. Moon that they wished a replica for themselves, with Mrs. Wordsworth added. She painted this; and a copy of it, subsequently taken for Miss Quillinan, was long in her possession at Loughrigg Holme. It now belongs to Mr. Gordon Wordsworth. It is to the portrait of Mrs. Wordsworth that this sonnet and the next refer.—ED.

[\[212\]](#) Compare the lines in vol. iii. p. 5—

They flash upon that inward eye  
Which is the bliss of solitude.

The fact that these two lines had been added by Mrs. Wordsworth (see note to the poem, p. 7) was doubtless remembered by the poet, when he wrote this sonnet suggested by her portrait.—ED.

## ON THE SAME SUBJECT

Composed 1840.—Published 1842  
One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

Though I beheld at first with blank surprise  
This Work, I now have gazed on it so long  
I see its truth with unreluctant eyes;  
O, my Belovèd! I have done thee wrong,  
Conscious of blessedness, but, whence it sprung, 5  
Ever too heedless, as I now perceive:  
Morn into noon did pass, noon into eve,  
And the old day was welcome as the young,  
As welcome, and as beautiful—in sooth  
More beautiful, as being a thing more holy: 10  
Thanks to thy virtues, to the eternal youth  
Of all thy goodness, never melancholy;  
To thy large heart and humble mind, that cast  
Into one vision, future, present, past.[\[213\]](#)

[\[213\]](#) Compare—

O dearer far than light and life are dear (1824).  
Let other bards of angels sing (1824).  
Such age how beautiful! O Lady bright (1827).  
What heavenly smiles! O Lady mine (1845).

ED.

## POOR ROBIN[\[214\]](#)

Composed March 1840.—Published 1842

[I often ask myself what will become of Rydal Mount after our day. Will the old walls and steps remain in front of the house and about the grounds,



Now when the primrose makes a splendid show,  
And lilies face the March-winds in full blow,  
And humbler growths as moved with one desire  
Put on, to welcome spring, their best attire,  
Poor Robin is yet flowerless; but how gay 5  
With his red stalks upon this sunny day!  
And, as his tufts[217] of leaves he spreads, content  
With a hard bed and scanty nourishment,  
Mixed with the green, some shine not lacking power  
To rival summer's brightest scarlet flower; 10  
And flowers they well might seem to passers-by  
If looked at only with a careless eye;  
Flowers—or a richer produce (did it suit  
The season) sprinklings of ripe strawberry fruit.  
But while a thousand pleasures come unsought, 15  
Why fix upon his wealth or want[218] a thought?  
Is the string touched in prelude to a lay  
Of pretty fancies that would round him play  
When all the world acknowledged elfin sway?  
Or does it suit our humour to commend 20  
Poor Robin as a sure and crafty friend,  
Whose practice teaches, spite of names to show  
Bright colours whether they deceive or no?—  
Nay, we would simply praise the free good-will  
With which, though slighted, he, on naked hill 25  
Or in warm valley, seeks his part to fill;  
Cheerful alike if bare of flowers as now,  
Or when his tiny gems shall deck his brow:  
Yet more, we wish that men by men despised,  
And such as lift their foreheads overprized, 30  
Should sometimes think, where'er they chance to spy  
This child of Nature's own humility,



What recompense is kept in store or left  
For all that seem neglected or bereft;  
With what nice care equivalents are given, 35  
How just, how bountiful, the hand of Heaven.

*March, 1840.*

[214] The small wild Geranium known by that name.—W.W. 1842.

[215] These things remain comparatively unaltered. Rydal Mount has suffered little in picturesqueness since Wordsworth's death; while the house, and the grounds, have gained in many ways by what the present tenant has done for them. It is impossible to keep such a place exactly as it was left by its greatest tenant; and Mr. Crewdson has certainly not injured, but wisely improved the place.—ED.

[216] Compare what is said of it in the *Memoirs of Wordsworth*, by his nephew, vol. i. p. 20.—ED.

[217] 1849.

... tuft

1842.

[218] 1845.

... want or wealth

1842.

## ON A PORTRAIT OF THE DUKE OF WELLINGTON UPON THE FIELD OF WATERLOO, BY HAYDON [219]

Composed August 31, 1840.—Published 1842

[This was composed while I was ascending Helvellyn in company with my daughter and her husband. She was on horseback, and rode to the top of the hill without once dismounting, a feat which it was scarcely possible to perform except during a season of dry weather; and a guide, with whom we

fell in on the mountain, told us he believed it had never been accomplished before by any one.—I.F.]

One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets”; but first published in the “Poems chiefly of Early and Late Years.”—ED.

By Art's bold privilege Warrior and War-horse stand  
On ground yet strewn with their last battle's wreck;  
Let the Steed glory while his Master's hand  
Lies fixed for ages on his conscious neck;  
But by the Chieftain's look, though at his side 5  
Hangs that day's treasured sword, how firm a check  
Is given to triumph and all human pride!  
Yon trophied Mound shrinks to a shadowy speck  
In his calm presence! Him the mighty deed  
Elates not, brought far nearer the grave's rest, 10  
As shows that time-worn face, for he such seed  
Has sown as yields, we trust, the fruit of fame  
In Heaven;[220] hence no one blushes for thy name,  
Conqueror, 'mid some sad thoughts, divinely blest!

[219] Haydon worked at this picture of Wellington from June to November, 1839. (See his Autobiography, vol. iii. pp. 108-131.) He writes under date, Sept. 4, 1840:—"Hard at work. I heard from dear Wordsworth, with a glorious sonnet on the Duke, and Copenhagen.† It is very fine, and I began a new journal directly, and put in the sonnet. God bless him." The following is part of Wordsworth's letter:—

"MY DEAR HAYDON,—We are all charmed with your etching. It is both poetically and pictorially conceived, and finely executed. I should have written immediately to thank you for it, and for your letter and the enclosed one, which is interesting, but I wished to gratify you by writing a sonnet. I now send it, but with an earnest request that it may not be put into circulation for some little time, as it is warm from the brain, and may require, in consequence, some little retouching. It has this, at least, remarkable attached to it, which will add to its value in your eyes, that it was actually composed while I was climbing Helvellyn last Monday."—ED.

† Wellington's war-horse.—ED.

[220] 1842.

... Since the mighty deed  
Him years have brought far nearer the grave's rest,  
He shows that face time-worn. But he such seed  
Has sowed that bears, we trust, the fruit of fame  
In Heaven....

From a copy sent to Haydon.

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**1841**

**EPITAPH**  
**IN THE CHAPEL-YARD OF LANGDALE, WESTMORELAND**

Composed 1841.—Published 1842

[OWEN LLOYD, the subject of this epitaph, was born at Old Brathay, near Ambleside, and was the son of Charles Lloyd and his wife Sophia (*née* Pemberton), both of Birmingham, who came to reside in this part of the country, soon after their marriage. They had many children, both sons and daughters, of whom the most remarkable was the subject of this epitaph. He was educated under Mr. Dawes, at Ambleside, Dr. Butler, of Shrewsbury, and lastly at Trinity College, Cambridge, where he would have been greatly distinguished as a scholar but for inherited infirmities of bodily constitution, which, from early childhood, affected his mind. His love for the neighbourhood in which he was born, and his sympathy with the habits and characters of the mountain yeomanry, in conjunction with irregular spirits, that unfitted him for facing duties in situations to which he was unaccustomed, induced him to accept the retired curacy of Langdale. How much he was beloved and honoured there, and with what feelings he discharged his duty under the oppression of severe malady, is set forth, though imperfectly, in the epitaph.—I.F.]

One of the “Epitaphs and Elegiac Pieces.”—ED.

By playful smiles, (alas! too oft  
A sad heart's sunshine) by a soft  
And gentle nature, and a free  
Yet modest hand of charity,  
Through life was OWEN LLOYD endeared 5  
To young and old; and how revered  
Had been that pious spirit, a tide  
Of humble mourners testified,  
When, after pains dispensed to prove  
The measure of God's chastening love, 10  
Here, brought from far, his corse found rest,—  
Fulfilment of his own request;—  
Urged less for this Yew's shade, though he  
Planted with such fond hope the tree;  
Less for the love of stream and rock, 15  
Dear as they were, than that his Flock,  
When they no more their Pastor's voice  
Could hear to guide them in their choice  
Through good and evil, help might have,  
Admonished, from his silent grave, 20  
Of righteousness, of sins forgiven,  
For peace on earth and bliss in heaven.

This commemorative epitaph to the Rev. Owen Lloyd—the friend of Hartley Coleridge and of Faber—is carved on the headstone over his grave in the churchyard at the small hamlet of Chapel Stile, Great Langdale, Westmoreland. The stone also carries the inscription, “To the memory of Owen Lloyd, M.A., nearly twelve years incumbent of this chapel. Born at Old Brathay, March 31, 1803, died at Manchester, April 18, 1841, aged 38.” See a letter of Wordsworth's referring to Lloyd amongst his letters in a subsequent volume. In a previous edition I erred by giving this poem an earlier date. Professor Dowden has shown the true one conclusively.

Writing from Rydal on 11th August 1841, to his brother Christopher, Wordsworth said, "I send you with the last corrections an epitaph which I have just written for poor Owen Lloyd. His brother Edward forwarded for my perusal some verses which he had composed with a view to that object; but he expressed a wish that I would compose something myself. Not approving Edward's lines altogether, though the sentiments were sufficiently appropriate, I sent him what I now forward to you, or rather the substance of it, for something has been added, and some change of expression introduced. I hope you will approve of it. I find no fault with it myself, the circumstances considered, except that it is too long for an Epitaph, but this was inevitable if the memorial was to be as conspicuous as the subject required, at least according to the light in which it offered itself to my mind."—ED.

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## 1842

The poems of 1842 include *The Floating Island*, *The Norman Boy*, *The Poet's Dream*, *Airey-Force Valley*, the lines *To the Clouds*, and a number of miscellaneous sonnets.—ED.

### **“INTENT ON GATHERING WOOL FROM HEDGE AND BRAKE”**

Composed 8th March 1842.—Published 1842

[Suggested by a conversation with Miss Fenwick, who along with her sister had, during their childhood, found much delight in such gatherings for the purposes here alluded to.—I.F.]

One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

Intent on gathering wool from hedge and brake  
Yon busy Little-ones rejoice that soon  
A poor old Dame will bless them for the boon:  
Great is their glee while flake they add to flake  
With rival earnestness; far other strife 5  
Than will hereafter move them, if they make  
Pastime their idol, give their day of life  
To pleasure snatched for reckless pleasure's sake.  
Can pomp and show allay one heart-born grief?  
Pains which the World inflicts can she requite? 10  
Not for an interval however brief;  
The silent thoughts that search for stedfast light,  
Love from her depths,[\[221\]](#) and Duty in her might,  
And Faith—these only yield secure relief.

*March 8th, 1842.*

[\[221\]](#) 1845.

Love from on high, ...

1842.

**PRELUDE,  
PREFIXED TO THE VOLUME ENTITLED “POEMS CHIEFLY OF EARLY  
AND LATE YEARS”**

Composed March 26, 1842.—Published 1842

[These verses were begun while I was on a visit to my son John at Brigham, and were finished at Rydal. As the contents of the volume, to which they are now prefixed, will be assigned to their respective classes when my poems shall be collected in one volume, I should be at a loss



where with propriety to place this prelude, being too restricted in its bearing to serve for a preface for the whole. The lines towards the conclusion allude to the discontents then fomented through the country by the agitators of the Anti-Corn-Law League: the particular causes of such troubles are transitory, but disposition to excite and liability to be excited are nevertheless permanent, and therefore proper objects for the poet's regard.—I.F.]

One of the "Miscellaneous Poems."—ED.

In desultory walk through orchard grounds,  
Or some deep chestnut grove, oft have I paused  
The while a Thrush, urged rather than restrained  
By gusts of vernal storm, attuned his song  
To his own genial instincts; and was heard 5  
(Though not without some plaintive tones between)  
To utter, above showers of blossom swept  
From tossing boughs, the promise of a calm,  
Which the unsheltered traveller might receive  
With thankful spirit. The descant, and the wind 10  
That seemed to play with it in love or scorn,  
Encouraged and endeared the strain of words  
That haply flowed from me, by fits of silence  
Impelled to livelier pace. But now, my Book!  
Charged with those lays, and others of like mood, 15  
Or loftier pitch if higher rose the theme,  
Go, single—yet aspiring to be joined  
With thy Forerunners that through many a year  
Have faithfully prepared each other's way—  
Go forth upon a mission best fulfilled 20  
When and wherever, in this changeful world,  
Power hath been given to please for higher ends  
Than pleasure only; gladdening to prepare  
For wholesome sadness, troubling to refine,  
Calming to raise; and, by a sapient Art 25  
Diffused through all the mysteries of our Being,  
Softening the toils and pains that have not ceased  
To cast their shadows on our mother Earth  
Since the primeval doom. Such is the grace  
Which, though unsued for, fails not to descend 30  
With heavenly inspiration; such the aim  
That Reason dictates; and, as even the wish

Has virtue in it, why should hope to me  
Be wanting that sometimes, where fancied ills  
Harass the mind and strip from off the bowers 35  
Of private life their natural pleasantness,  
A Voice—devoted to the love whose seeds  
Are sown in every human breast, to beauty  
Lodged within compass of the humblest sight,  
To cheerful intercourse with wood and field, 40  
And sympathy with man's substantial griefs—  
Will not be heard in vain? And in those days  
When unforeseen distress spreads far and wide  
Among a People mournfully cast down,  
Or into anger roused by venal words 45  
In recklessness flung out to overturn  
The judgment, and divert the general heart  
From mutual good—some strain of thine, my Book!  
Caught at propitious intervals, may win  
Listeners who not unwillingly admit 50  
Kindly emotion tending to console  
And reconcile; and both with young and old  
Exalt the sense of thoughtful gratitude  
For benefits that still survive, by faith  
In progress, under laws divine, maintained. 55

RYDAL MOUNT, *March 26, 1842.*

## FLOATING ISLAND

Published 1842

These lines are by the Author of the *Address to the Wind*, etc., published heretofore along with my Poems. Those to a Redbreast are by a deceased female Relative.—W.W. 1842.

[My poor sister takes a pleasure in repeating these verses, which she composed not long before the beginning of her sad illness.—I.F.]

One of the “Miscellaneous Poems.”—ED.

Harmonious Powers with Nature work  
On sky, earth, river, lake, and sea;  
Sunshine and cloud, whirlwind and breeze,  
All in one duteous task agree.

Once did I see a slip of earth 5  
(By throbbing waves long undermined)  
Loosed from its hold; how, no one knew,  
But all might see it float, obedient to the wind;

Might see it, from the mossy shore  
Dissevered, float upon the Lake, 10  
Float with its crest of trees adorned  
On which the warbling birds their pastime take.

Food, shelter, safety, there they find;  
There berries ripen, flowerets bloom;  
There insects live their lives, and die; 15  
A peopled world it is; in size a tiny room.

And thus through many seasons' space  
This little Island may survive;  
But Nature, though we mark her not,  
Will take away, may cease to give. 20

Perchance when you are wandering forth  
Upon some vacant sunny day,  
Without an object, hope, or fear,  
Thither your eyes may turn—the Isle is passed away;

Buried beneath the glittering Lake, 25  
Its place no longer to be found;  
Yet the lost fragments shall remain  
To fertilize some other ground

to reunite some other ground.

D. W.

There is one of these floating islands in Loch Lomond in Argyll, another in Loch Dochart in Perthshire, and another in Loch Treig in Inverness. Their origin is probably due to a mass of peat being detached from the shore, and floated out into the lake. A mass of vegetable matter, however, has sometimes risen from the bottom of the water, and assumed for a time all the appearance of an island. This has been probably due to an accumulation of gas, within or under the detached portion, produced by the decay of vegetation in extremely hot weather.

Southey, in an unpublished letter to Sir George Beaumont (10th July 1824), thus describes the Island at Derwentwater: "You will have seen by the papers that the Floating Island has made its appearance. It sank again last week, when some heavy rains had raised the lake four feet. By good fortune Professor Sedgewick happened to be in Keswick, and examined it in time. Where he probed it a thin layer of mud lies upon a bed of peat, which is six feet thick, and this rests upon a stratum of fine white clay,—the same I believe which Miss Barker found in Borrowdale when building her unlucky house. Where the gas is generated remains yet to be discovered, but when the peat is filled with this gas, it separates from the clay and becomes buoyant. There must have been a considerable convulsion when this took place, for a rent was made in the bottom of the lake, several feet in depth, and not less than fifty yards long, on each side of which the bottom rose and floated. It was a pretty sight to see the small fry exploring this new made strait and darting at the bubbles which rose as the Professor was probing the bank. The discharge of air was considerable here, when a pole was thrust down. But at some distance where the rent did not extend, the bottom had been heaved up in a slight convexity, sloping equally in an inclined plane all round: and there, when the pole was introduced, a rush like a jet followed, as it was withdrawn. The thing is the more curious, because as yet no example of it is known to have been observed in any other place."

Another of these detached islands used to float about in Esthwaite Water, and was carried from side to side of the pool at the north end of the lake—the same pool which the swans, described in *The Prelude*, used to frequent. This island had a few bushes on it: but it became stranded some time ago.

One of the old natives of Hawkeshead described the process of trying to float it off again, by tying ropes to the bushes on its surface,—an experiment which was unsuccessful. Compare the reference to the Floating or “Buoyant” Island of Derwentwater, and to the “mossy islet” of Esthwaite, in Wordsworth’s *Guide through the District of the Lakes*.—ED.

## **“THE CRESCENT-MOON, THE STAR OF LOVE”**

Published 1842

One of the “Evening Voluntaries.”—ED.

The Crescent-moon, the Star of Love,  
Glories of evening, as ye there are seen  
With but a span of sky between—  
Speak one of you, my doubts remove,  
Which is the attendant Page and which the Queen?

## **“A POET!—HE HATH PUT HIS HEART TO SCHOOL”**

Published 1842

[I was impelled to write this Sonnet by the disgusting frequency with which the word *artistical*, imported with other impertinences from the Germans, is employed by writers of the present day: for artistical let them substitute artificial, and the poetry written on this system, both at home and abroad, will be for the most part much better characterised.—I.F.]

One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

*A Poet!*—He hath put his heart to school,  
Nor dares to move unpropped upon the staff  
Which Art hath lodged within his hand—must laugh  
By precept only, and shed tears by rule.  
Thy Art be Nature; the live current quaff, 5  
And let the groveller sip his stagnant pool,  
In fear that else, when Critics grave and cool  
Have killed him, Scorn should write his epitaph.[\[222\]](#)  
How does the Meadow-flower its bloom unfold?  
Because the lovely little flower is free 10  
Down to its root, and, in that freedom, bold;  
And so the grandeur of the Forest-tree  
Comes not by casting in a formal mould,  
But from its *own* divine vitality.

[\[222\]](#) Compare *A Poet's Epitaph* (vol. ii. p. 75).—ED.

## **“THE MOST ALLURING CLOUDS THAT MOUNT THE SKY”**

Published 1842

[Hundreds of times have I seen, hanging about and above the vale of Rydal, clouds that might have given birth to this sonnet, which was thrown off on the impulse of the moment one evening when I was returning from the favourite walk of ours, along the Rotha, under Loughrigg.—I.F.]

One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.



The most alluring clouds that mount the sky  
Owe to a troubled element their forms,  
Their hues to sunset. If with raptured eye  
We watch their splendour, shall we covet storms,  
And wish the Lord of day his slow decline 5  
Would hasten, that such pomp may float on high?  
Behold, already they forget to shine,  
Dissolve—and leave to him who gazed a sigh.  
Not loth to thank each moment for its boon  
Of pure delight, come whencesoe'er[223] it may, 10  
Peace let us seek,—to stedfast things attune  
Calm expectations, leaving to the gay  
And volatile their love of transient bowers,  
The house that cannot pass away be ours.[224]

[223] 1849

... whencesoe'er ...

1842.

[224] Compare *To the Clouds*, I. 94, p. 145.—ED.

## “FEEL FOR THE WRONGS TO UNIVERSAL KEN”

Published 1842

[This Sonnet is recommended to the perusal of those who consider that the evils under which we groan are to be removed or palliated by measures ungoverned by moral and religious principles.—I.F.]

One of the “Sonnetts dedicated to Liberty and Order.”—ED.

Feel for the wrongs to universal ken  
Daily exposed, woe that unshrouded lies;  
And seek the Sufferer in his darkest den,  
Whether conducted to the spot by sighs  
And moanings, or he dwells (as if the wren 5  
Taught him concealment) hidden from all eyes  
In silence and the awful modesties  
Of sorrow;—feel for all, as brother Men!  
Rest not in hope want's icy chain to thaw  
By casual boons and formal charities; [225] 10  
Learn to be just, just through impartial law;  
Far as ye may, erect and equalise;  
And, what ye cannot reach by statute, draw  
Each from his fountain of self-sacrifice!

[225] 1845.

... Men!—  
Feel for the Poor,—but not to still your qualms  
By formal charity or dole of alms;  
Learn ...

1842.

## IN ALLUSION TO VARIOUS RECENT HISTORIES AND NOTICES OF THE FRENCH REVOLUTION

Published 1842

One of the “Sonnets dedicated to Liberty and Order.”—ED.

Portentous change when History can appear  
As the cool Advocate of foul device;[\[226\]](#)  
Reckless audacity extol, and jeer  
At consciences perplexed with scruples nice!  
They who bewail not, must abhor, the sneer 5  
Born of Conceit, Power's blind Idolater;  
Or haply sprung from vaunting Cowardice  
Betrayed by mockery of holy fear.  
Hath it not long been said the wrath of Man  
Works not the righteousness of God? Oh bend, 10  
Bend, ye Perverse! to judgments from on High,  
Laws that lay under Heaven's perpetual ban  
All principles of action that transcend  
The sacred limits of humanity.

[\[226\]](#) Wordsworth wrote this sonnet against Carlyle's *French Revolution* in particular. Carlyle knew it, and this may in part—although only in part—account for Carlyle's indifference to Wordsworth.—ED.

## CONTINUED

Published 1842

One of the "Sonnets dedicated to Liberty and Order."—ED.

Who ponders National events shall find  
An awful balancing of loss and gain,  
Joy based on sorrow, good with ill combined,  
And proud deliverance issuing out of pain  
And direful throes; as if the All-ruling Mind, 5  
With whose perfection it consists to ordain  
Volcanic burst, earthquake, and hurricane,  
Dealt in like sort with feeble human kind  
By laws immutable. But woe for him  
Who thus deceived shall lend an eager hand 10  
To social havoc. Is not Conscience ours,  
And Truth, whose eye guilt only can make dim;  
And Will, whose office, by divine command,  
Is to control and check disordered Powers?

## **CONCLUDED**

Published 1842

One of the “Sonnets dedicated to Liberty and Order.”—ED.

Long-favoured England! be not thou misled  
By monstrous theories of alien growth,  
Lest alien frenzy seize thee, waxing wroth,  
Self-smitten till thy garments reek dyed red  
With thy own blood, which tears in torrents shed 5  
Fail to wash out, tears flowing ere thy troth  
Be plighted, not to ease but sullen sloth,  
Or wan despair—the ghost of false hope fled  
Into a shameful grave. Among thy youth,  
My Country! if such warning be held dear, 10  
Then shall a Veteran's heart be thrilled with joy,  
One who would gather from eternal truth,  
For time and season, rules that work to cheer—  
Not scourge, to save the People—not destroy.

**“LO! WHERE SHE STANDS FIXED IN A SAINT-LIKE  
TRANCE”**

Published 1842

One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

Lo! where she stands fixed in a saint-like trance,  
One upward hand, as if she needed rest  
From rapture, lying softly on her breast!  
Nor wants her eyeball an ethereal glance;  
But not the less—nay more—that countenance, 5  
While thus illumined, tells of painful strife  
For a sick heart made weary of this life  
By love, long crossed with adverse circumstance.  
—Would She were now as when she hoped to pass  
At God’s appointed hour to them who tread 10  
Heaven’s sapphire pavement, yet breathed well content,  
Well pleased, her foot should print earth’s common grass,  
Lived thankful for day’s light, for daily bread,  
For health, and time in obvious duty spent.

## THE NORMAN BOY

Published 1842

[The subject of this poem was sent me by Mrs. Ogle, to whom I was personally unknown, with a hope on her part that I might be induced to relate the incident in verse; and I do not regret that I took the trouble, for not improbably the fact is illustrative of the boy’s early piety, and may concur with my other little pieces on children to produce profitable reflection among my youthful readers. This is said, however, with an absolute conviction that children will derive most benefit from books which are not unworthy the perusal of persons of any age. I protest with all my heart against those productions, so abundant in the present day, in which the doings of children are dwelt upon as if they were incapable of being interested in anything else. On this subject I have dwelt at length in the poem on the growth of my own mind.—I.F.]

One of the “Poems referring to the Period of Childhood.”—ED.

High on a broad unfertile tract of forest-skirted Down,  
Nor kept by Nature for herself, nor made by man his own,  
From home and company remote and every playful joy,  
Served, tending a few sheep and goats, a ragged Norman boy.

Him never saw I, nor the spot; but from an English Dame, 5  
Stranger to me and yet my friend, a simple notice came,  
With suit that I would speak in verse of that sequestered child  
Whom, one bleak winter's day, she met upon the dreary Wild.

His flock, along the woodland's edge with relics sprinkled o'er  
Of last night's snow, beneath a sky threatening the fall of more, 10  
Where tufts of herbage tempted each, were busy at their feed,  
And the poor Boy was busier still, with work of anxious heed.

There *was* he, where of branches rent and withered and decayed,  
For covert from the keen north wind, his hands a hut had made.  
A tiny tenement, forsooth, and frail, as needs must be 15  
A thing of such materials framed, by a builder such as he.

The hut stood finished by his pains, nor seemingly lacked aught  
That skill or means of his could add, but the architect had wrought  
Some limber twigs into a Cross, well-shaped with fingers nice,  
To be engrafted on the top of his small edifice. 20

That Cross he now was fastening there, as the surest power and best  
For supplying all deficiencies, all wants of the rude nest  
In which, from burning heat, or tempest driving far and wide,  
The innocent Boy, else shelterless, his lonely head must hide.

That Cross belike he also raised as a standard for the true 25  
And faithful service of his heart in the worst that might ensue  
Of hardship and distressful fear, amid the houseless waste  
Where he, in his poor self as weak, by Providence was placed

where he, in his poor self so weak, by Providence was placed.

——Here, Lady! might I cease; but nay, let *us* before we part  
With this dear holy shepherd-boy breathe a prayer of earnest heart, 30  
That unto him, where'er shall lie his life's appointed way,  
The Cross, fixed in his soul, may prove an all-sufficing stay.

**THE POET'S DREAM**[\[227\]](#)  
**SEQUEL TO THE NORMAN BOY**

Published 1842

One of the "Poems referring to the Period of Childhood."—ED.



Just as those final words were penned, the sun broke out in power,  
And gladdened all things; but, as chanced, within that very hour,  
Air blackened, thunder growled, fire flashed from clouds that hid the  
sky,  
And, for the Subject of my Verse, I heaved a pensive sigh.

Nor could my heart by second thoughts from heaviness be cleared, 5  
For bodied forth before my eyes the cross-crowned hut appeared;  
And, while around it storm as fierce seemed troubling earth and air,  
I saw, within, the Norman Boy kneeling alone in prayer.

The Child, as if the thunder's voice spake with articulate call,  
Bowed meekly in submissive fear, before the Lord of All; 10  
His lips were moving; and his eyes, upraised to sue for grace,  
With soft illumination cheered the dimness of that place.

How beautiful is holiness!—what wonder if the sight,  
Almost as vivid as a dream, produced a dream at night?  
It came with sleep and showed the Boy, no cherub, not transformed, 15  
But the poor ragged Thing whose ways my human heart had warmed.

Me had the dream equipped with wings, so I took him in my arms,  
And lifted from the grassy floor, stilling his faint alarms,  
And bore him high through yielding air my debt of love to pay,  
By giving him, for both our sakes, an hour of holiday. 20

I whispered, "Yet a little while, dear Child! thou art my own,  
To show thee some delightful thing, in country or in town.  
What shall it be? a mirthful throng? or that holy place and calm  
St. Denis, filled with royal tombs, [\[228\]](#) or the Church of Notre Dame?

[\[229\]](#)

"St. Ouen's golden Shrine? [\[230\]](#) Or choose what else would please thee

Of any wonder Normandy, or all proud France, can boast!”  
“My Mother,” said the Boy, “was born near to a blessed Tree,  
The Chapel Oak of Allonville;[231] good Angel, show it me!”

On wings, from broad and stedfast poise let loose by this reply,  
For Allonville, o’er down and dale, away then did we fly; 30  
O’er town and tower we flew, and fields in May’s fresh verdure drest;  
The wings they did not flag; the Child, though grave, was not deprest.

But who shall show, to waking sense, the gleam of light that broke  
Forth from his eyes, when first the Boy looked down on that huge oak,  
For length of days so much revered, so famous where it stands 35  
For twofold hallowing—Nature’s care, and work of human hands?

Strong as an Eagle with my charge I glided round and round  
The wide-spread boughs, for view of door, window, and stair that  
wound  
Gracefully up the gnarled trunk; nor left we unsurveyed  
The pointed steeple peering forth from the centre of the shade. 40

I lighted—opened with soft touch the chapel’s iron door,[232]  
Past softly, leading in the Boy; and, while from roof to floor  
From floor to roof all round his eyes the Child with wonder cast,[233]  
Pleasure on pleasure crowded in, each livelier than the last.

For, deftly framed within the trunk, the[234] sanctuary showed, 45  
By light of lamp and precious stones, that glimmered here, there  
glowed,  
Shrine, Altar, Image, Offerings hung in sign of gratitude;  
Sight that inspired accordant thoughts; and speech[235] I thus renewed:

“Hither the Afflicted come, as thou hast heard thy Mother say,  
And, kneeling, supplication make to our Lady de la Paix;[236] 50

What mournful sighs have here been heard, and, when the voice was  
stopt

By sudden pangs; what bitter tears have on this pavement dropt!

“Poor Shepherd of the naked Down, a favoured lot is thine,  
Far happier lot, dear Boy, than brings full many to this shrine;  
From body pains and pains of soul thou needest no release, 55  
Thy hours as they flow on are spent, if not in joy, in peace.

“Then offer up thy heart to God in thankfulness and praise,  
Give to Him prayers, and many thoughts, in thy most busy days;  
And in His sight the fragile Cross, on thy small hut, will be  
Holy as that which long hath crowned the Chapel of this Tree; 60

“Holy as that far seen which crowns the sumptuous Church in Rome  
Where thousands meet to worship God under a mighty Dome;[\[237\]](#)  
He sees the bending multitude, He hears the choral rites,  
Yet not the less, in children’s hymns and lonely prayer, delights.

“God for His service needeth not proud work of human skill; 65  
They please Him best who labour most to do in peace His will:  
So let us strive to live, and to our Spirits will be given  
Such wings as, when our Saviour calls, shall bear us up to heaven.”

The Boy no answer made by words, but, so earnest was his look,  
Sleep fled, and with it fled the dream—recorded in this book, 70  
Lest all that passed should melt away in silence from my mind,  
As visions still more bright have done, and left no trace behind.

But oh! that Country-man of thine, whose eye, loved Child, can see  
A pledge of endless bliss in acts of early piety,  
In verse, which to thy ear might come, would treat this simple theme,

Nor leave untold our happy flight in that adventurous dream.[\[238\]](#)

Alas the dream,[239] to thee, poor Boy! to thee from whom it flowed,  
Was nothing, scarcely can be aught, yet 'twas[240] bounteously  
bestowed,  
If I may dare to cherish hope that gentle eyes will read  
Not loth, and listening Little-ones, heart-touched, their fancies feed. 80

[227] 1845.

The title in 1842 was "SEQUEL TO THE NORMAN BOY."

[228] The Abbey Church of St. Denis, to the north of Paris,—one of the finest specimens of French Gothic,—was the burial-place of the French Kings for many generations.—ED.

[229] In Paris.—ED.

[230] The Church of St. Ouen, in Rouen, is the most perfect edifice of its kind in Europe.—ED.

[231] "Among ancient Trees there are few, I believe, at least in France, so worthy of attention as an Oak which may be seen in the 'Pays de Caux,' about a league from Yvetot, close to the church, and in the burial-ground of Allonville.

The height of this Tree does not answer to its girth; the trunk, from the roots to the summit, forms a complete cone; and the inside of this cone is hollow throughout the whole of its height.

Such is the Oak of Allonville, in its state of nature. The hand of Man, however, has endeavoured to impress upon it a character still more interesting, by adding a religious feeling to the respect which its age naturally inspires.

The lower part of its hollow trunk has been transformed into a Chapel of six or seven feet in diameter, carefully wainscotted and paved, and an open iron gate guards the humble Sanctuary.

Leading to it there is a staircase, which twists round the body of the Tree. At certain seasons of the year divine service is performed in this Chapel.

The summit has been broken off many years, but there is a surface at the top of the trunk, of the diameter of a very large tree, and from it rises a pointed roof, covered with slates, in the form of a steeple, which is surmounted with an iron Cross, that rises in a picturesque manner from the middle of the leaves, like an ancient Hermitage above the surrounding Wood.

Over the entrance to the Chapel an Inscription appears, which informs us it was erected by the Abbé du Détroit, Curate of Allonville, in the year 1696; and over a door is another, dedicating it 'To Our Lady of Peace.'—Vide 14 No. *Saturday Magazine*.—W.W. 1842.

[232] 1845.

... touch a grated iron door,  
1842.

[233] 1845.

... his eyes the wondering creature cast,  
1842.

[234] 1845.

... a ...  
1842.

[235] 1845.

And swift as lightning went the time, ere speech  
1842.

[236] See note, p. 137.—ED.

[237] St. Peter's Church.—ED.

[238] This stanza was added in the edition of 1845.

[239] 1845.

And though the dream, ...  
1842.

[240] 1845.

Was nothing, nor e'er can be aught, 'twas ...  
1842.

**SUGGESTED BY A PICTURE OF THE BIRD OF PARADISE**

Published 1842

[This subject has been treated of in another note. I will here only, by way of comment, direct attention to the fact, that pictures of animals and other productions of Nature, as seen in conservatories, menageries, and museums, etc., would do little for the national mind, nay, they would be rather injurious to it, if the imagination were excluded by the presence of the object, more or less out of a state of Nature. If it were not that we learn to talk and think of the lion and the eagle, the palm-tree, and even the cedar, from the impassioned introduction of them so frequently into Holy Scripture, and by great poets, and divines who wrote as poets, the spiritual part of our nature, and therefore the higher part of it, would derive no benefit from such intercourse with such subjects.—I.F.]

One of the “Poems of the Imagination.”—ED.

The gentlest Poet, with free thoughts endowed,  
And a true master of the glowing strain,  
Might scan the narrow province with disdain  
That to the Painter's skill is here allowed.  
This, this the Bird of Paradise! disclaim 5  
The daring thought, forget the name;  
This the Sun's Bird, whom Glendoveers might own  
As no unworthy Partner in their flight  
Through seas of ether, where the ruffling sway  
Of nether air's rude billows is unknown; 10  
Whom Sylphs, if e'er for casual pastime they  
Through India's spicy regions wing their way,  
Might bow to as their Lord. What character,  
O sovereign Nature! I appeal to thee,  
Of all thy feathered progeny 15  
Is so unearthly, and what shape so fair?  
So richly decked in variegated down,  
Green, sable, shining yellow, shadowy brown,  
Tints softly with each other blended,  
Hues doubtfully begun and ended; 20  
Or intershooting, and to sight  
Lost and recovered, as the rays of light  
Glance on the conscious plumes touched here and there?  
Full surely, when with such proud gifts of life  
Began the pencil's strife, 25  
O'erweening Art was caught as in a snare.

A sense of seemingly presumptuous wrong  
Gave the first impulse to the Poet's song;  
But, of his scorn repenting soon, he drew  
A juster judgment from a calmer view; 30  
And, with a spirit freed from discontent,

Thankfully took an effort that was meant  
Not with God's bounty, Nature's love, to vie,  
Or made with hope to please that inward eye  
Which ever strives in vain itself to satisfy, 35  
But to recal the truth by some faint trace  
Of power ethereal and celestial grace,  
That in the living Creature find on earth a place.

### TO THE CLOUDS[\[241\]](#)

Published 1842

[These verses were suggested while I was walking on the foot-road between Rydal Mount and Grasmere. The clouds were driving over the top of Nab-Scar across the vale: they set my thoughts a-going, and the rest followed almost immediately.—I.F.]

First published (1842) in "Poems chiefly of Early and Late Years," afterwards included in the "Poems of the Imagination."—ED.



Army of Clouds! ye wingèd Host in troops  
Ascending from behind the motionless brow  
Of that tall rock,[\[242\]](#) as from a hidden world,  
O whither with[\[243\]](#) such eagerness of speed?  
What seek ye, or what shun ye? of the gale[\[244\]](#) 5  
Companions, fear ye to be left behind,  
Or racing o'er[\[245\]](#) your blue ethereal field  
Contend ye with each other? of the sea  
Children, thus post ye over vale and height[\[246\]](#)  
To sink upon your mother's lap—and rest?[\[247\]](#) 10  
Or were ye rightlier hailed, when first mine eyes  
Beheld in your impetuous march the likeness  
Of a wide army pressing on to meet  
Or overtake some unknown enemy?—  
But your smooth motions suit a peaceful aim; 15  
And Fancy, not less aptly pleased, compares  
Your squadrons to an endless flight of birds  
Aerial, upon due migration bound  
To milder climes; or rather do ye urge  
In caravan your hasty pilgrimage 20  
To pause at last on more aspiring heights  
Than these,[\[248\]](#) and utter your devotion there  
With thunderous voice? Or are ye jubilant,  
And would ye, tracking your proud lord the Sun,  
Be present at his setting; or the pomp 25  
Of Persian mornings would ye fill, and stand  
Poising your splendours high above the heads  
Of worshippers kneeling to their up-risen God?  
Whence, whence, ye Clouds! this eagerness of speed?  
Speak, silent creatures.—They are gone, are fled, 30  
Buried together in yon gloomy mass  
That loads the middle heaven: and clear and bright

That roads the middle heaven, and clear and bright  
And vacant doth the region which they thronged  
Appear; a calm descent of sky conducting  
Down to the unapproachable abyss, 35  
Down to that hidden gulf from which they rose  
To vanish—fleet as days and months and years,  
Fleet as the generations of mankind,  
Power, glory, empire, as the world itself,  
The lingering world, when time hath ceased to be. 40  
But the winds roar, shaking the rooted trees,  
And see! a bright precursor to a train  
Perchance as numerous, overpeers the rock  
That sullenly refuses to partake  
Of the wild impulse. From a fount of life 45  
Invisible, the long procession moves  
Luminous or gloomy, welcome to the vale  
Which they are entering, welcome to mine eye  
That sees them, to my soul that owns in them,  
And in the bosom of the firmament 50  
O'er which they move, wherein they are contained,  
A type of her capacious self and all  
Her restless progeny.

A humble walk  
Here is my body doomed to tread, this path,  
A little hoary line and faintly traced, [\[249\]](#) 55  
Work, shall we call it, of the shepherd's foot  
Or of his flock?—joint vestige of them both.  
I pace it unrepining, for my thoughts  
Admit no bondage and my words have wings.  
Where is the Orphean lyre, or Druid harp, 60  
To accompany the verse? The mountain blast  
Shall be our *hand* of music; he shall sweep  
The rocks and quivering trees and hilly lake

THE ROCKS, and quivering trees, and shadowy lake,  
And search the fibres of the caves, and they  
Shall answer, for our song is of the Clouds 65  
And the wind loves them; and the gentle gales—  
Which by their aid re-clothe the naked lawn  
With annual verdure, and revive the woods,  
And moisten the parched lips of thirsty flowers—  
Love them; and every idle breeze of air 70  
Bends to the favourite burthen. Moon and stars  
Keep their most solemn vigils when the Clouds  
Watch also, shifting peaceably their place  
Like bands of ministering Spirits, or when they lie,  
As if some Protean art the change had wrought, 75  
In listless quiet o'er the ethereal deep  
Scattered, a Cyclades[\[250\]](#) of various shapes  
And all degrees of beauty. O ye Lightnings!  
Ye are their perilous offspring;[\[251\]](#) and the Sun—  
Source inexhaustible of life and joy, 80  
And type of man's far-darting reason, therefore  
In old time worshipped as the god of verse,[\[252\]](#)  
A blazing intellectual deity—  
Loves his own glory in their looks, and showers  
Upon that unsubstantial brotherhood 85  
Visions with all but beatific light  
Enriched—too transient were they not renewed  
From age to age, and did not, while we gaze  
In silent rapture, credulous desire  
Nourish the hope that memory lacks not power 90  
To keep the treasure unimpaired. Vain thought!  
Yet why repine, created as we are  
For joy and rest, albeit to find them only  
Lodged in the bosom of eternal things?

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[\[241\]](#) The title in the edition of 1842 was *Address to the Clouds*.—Ed.

[242] See the Fenwick note and compare Dorothy Wordsworth's Grasmere Journal, 31st January 1802.—ED.

[243] 1842.

... in ...

MS.

[244] 1842.

... wind

MS.

[245] 1842.

... on ...

MS.

[246] 1842.

... over dale and mountain height

MS.

[247] 1842.

... mother's joyous lap?

MS.

[248] 1842.

Or come ye as I hailed you first, a Flight  
Aerial, on a due migration bound,  
Embodied travellers not blindly led  
To milder climes; or rather do ye urge  
Your Caravan, your hasty pilgrimage  
With hope to pause at last upon the top  
Of some remoter mountains more beloved  
Than these, ...

MS.

[249] Compare, in the “Poems on the Naming of Places” (1805), the lines beginning, “When, to the attractions of the busy world,” l. 48—

A hoary pathway traced between the trees.

ED.

[250] The fifty-three small islands in the Ægean surrounding Delos, as with a circle (κύκλος)—hence the name.—ED.

[251] Compare Coleridge’s *Hymn before Sunrise in the Vale of Chamouni*—

Ye lightnings, the dread arrows of the clouds!

ED.

[252] Sol = Phoebus = Apollo.—ED.

## AIREY-FORCE VALLEY

Published 1842

First published (1842) in “Poems, chiefly of Early and Late Years.”  
Afterwards one of the “Poems of the Imagination.”—ED.

——Not a breath of air  
Ruffles the bosom of this leafy glen.  
From the brook's margin, wide around, the trees  
Are stedfast as the rocks; the brook itself,  
Old as the hills that feed it from afar, 5  
Doth rather deepen than disturb the calm  
Where all things else are still and motionless.  
And yet, even now, a little breeze, perchance  
Escaped from boisterous winds that rage without,  
Has entered, by the sturdy oaks unfelt, 10  
But to its gentle touch how sensitive  
Is the light ash! that, pendent from the brow  
Of yon dim cave,[\[253\]](#) in seeming silence makes  
A soft eye-music of slow-waving boughs,  
Powerful almost as vocal harmony 15  
To stay the wanderer's steps and soothe his thoughts.

The Aira beck rises on the slopes of Great Dodd, passes Dockray, and enters Ullswater between Glencoin Park and Gowbarrow Park, about two miles from the head of the lake. The Force is quite near to *Lyulph's Tower*, where the stream has a fall of about eighty feet. Compare the reference to it in *The Somnambulist* (1833), and Wordsworth's account of "Aira-Force," in his *Guide through the District of the Lakes*, "Here is a powerful Brook, which dashes among rocks through a deep glen, hung on every side with a rich and happy intermixture of native wood; here are beds of luxuriant fern, aged hawthorns and hollies decked with honeysuckles; and fallow deer glancing and bounding over the lawns and through the thickets."—ED.

[\[253\]](#) An ash-tree may still be seen at Aira-Force.—ED.

**“LYRE! THOUGH SUCH POWER DO IN THY MAGIC  
LIVE”**

Composed 1842 (or earlier).—Published 1842  
One of the “Poems of the Imagination.”—ED.



Lyre! though such power do in thy magic live  
As might from India's farthest plain  
Recal the not unwilling Maid,  
Assist me to detain  
The lovely Fugitive: 5

Check with thy notes the impulse which, betrayed  
By her sweet farewell looks, I longed to aid.  
Here let me gaze enrapt upon that eye,  
The impregnable and awe-inspiring fort  
Of contemplation, the calm port 10  
By reason fenced from winds that sigh  
Among the restless sails of vanity.  
But if no wish be hers that we should part,  
A humbler bliss would satisfy my heart.

Where all things are so fair, 15  
Enough by her dear side to breathe the air  
Of this Elysian weather;  
And, on or in, or near, the brook, espy  
Shade upon the sunshine lying  
Faint and somewhat pensively; 20  
And downward Image gaily vying  
With its upright living tree  
'Mid silver clouds, and openings of blue sky  
As soft almost and deep as her cerulean eye.

Nor less the joy with many a glance 25  
Cast up the Stream or down at her beseeching,  
To mark its eddying foam-balls prettily distrest  
By ever-changing shape and want of rest;  
Or watch, with mutual teaching,  
The current as it plays 30  
In flashing leaps and stealthy creeps

Adown a rocky maze;  
Or note (translucent summer's happiest chance!)  
In the slope-channel floored with pebbles bright,  
Stones of all hues, gem emulous of gem, 35  
So vivid that they take from keenest sight  
The liquid veil that seeks not to hide them.[254]

[254] Compare Wordsworth's description of the Duddon as "diaphanous, because it travels slowly,"—ED.

## LOVE LIES BLEEDING

Composed 1842.—Published 1842

[It has been said that the English, though their country has produced so many great poets, is now the most unpoetical nation in Europe. It is probably true; for they have more temptation to become so than any other European people. Trade, commerce, and manufactures, physical science, and mechanic arts, out of which so much wealth has arisen, have made our countrymen infinitely less sensible to movements of imagination and fancy than were our forefathers in their simple state of society. How touching and beautiful were, in most instances, the names they gave to our indigenous flowers, or any other they were familiarly acquainted with!—Every month for many years have we been importing plants and flowers from all quarters of the globe, many of which are spread through our gardens, and some perhaps likely to be met with on the few Commons which we have left. Will their botanical names ever be displaced by plain English appellations, which will bring them home to our hearts by connexion with our joys and sorrows? It can never be, unless society treads back her steps towards those simplicities which have been banished by the undue influence of towns spreading and spreading in every direction, so that city-life with every generation takes more and more the lead of rural. Among the ancients, villages were reckoned the seats of barbarism. Refinement, for the most part false, increases the desire to accumulate wealth; and while theories of political economy are boastfully pleading for the practice, inhumanity pervades all our dealings in buying and selling. This selfishness wars

against disinterested imagination in all directions, and, evils coming round in a circle, barbarism spreads in every quarter of our island. Oh for the reign of justice, and then the humblest man among us would have more power and dignity in and about him than the highest have now!—I.F.]

One of the “Poems of the Fancy.”—ED.

You call it, “Love lies bleeding,”—so you may,[\[255\]](#)  
Though the red Flower, not prostrate, only droops,  
As we have seen it here from day to day,  
From month to month, life passing not away:  
A flower how rich in sadness! Even thus stoops, 5  
(Sentient by Grecian sculpture’s marvellous power)  
Thus leans, with hanging brow and body bent  
Earthward in uncomplaining languishment,  
The dying Gladiator. So, sad Flower!  
(’Tis Fancy guides me willing to be led, 10  
Though by a slender thread,)  
So drooped Adonis bathed in sanguine dew  
Of his death-wound, when he from innocent air  
The gentlest breath of resignation drew;  
While Venus in a passion of despair 15  
Rent, weeping over him, her golden hair  
Spangled with drops of that celestial shower.  
She suffered, as Immortals sometimes do;  
But pangs more lasting far, *that* Lover knew  
Who first, weighed down by scorn, in some lone bower 20  
Did press this semblance of unpitied smart  
Into the service of his constant heart,  
His own dejection, downcast Flower! could share  
With thine, and gave the mournful name which thou wilt ever bear.

[\[255\]](#) Compare *Midsummer Night’s Dream*, act II. scene i. ll. 165-168.—ED.

## **“THEY CALL IT LOVE LIES BLEEDING! RATHER SAY”**

The previous poem was originally composed in sonnet form; and it belongs, in that form, to the year 1833. It occurs in a MS. copy of the sonnets which record the Tour of 1833 to the Isle of Man and to Scotland.—ED.

They call it Love lies bleeding! rather say  
That in this crimson Flower Love bleeding *droops*,  
A Flower how sick in sadness! Thus it stoops  
With languid head unpropped from day to day  
From month to month, life passing not away. 5  
Even so the dying Gladiator leans  
On mother earth, and from his patience gleans  
Relics of tender thoughts, regrets that stay  
A moment and are gone. O fate-bowed flower!  
Fair as Adonis bathed in sanguine dew, 10  
Of his death-wound, *that* Lover's heart was true  
As heaven, who pierced by scorn in some lone bower  
Could press thy semblance of unpitied smart  
Into the service of his constant heart.

## **COMPANION TO THE FOREGOING**

Composed (?)[\[256\]](#)—Published 1845

Never enlivened with the liveliest ray  
That fosters growth or checks or cheers decay,  
Nor by the heaviest rain-drops more deprest,  
This Flower, that first appeared as summer's guest,  
Preserves her beauty 'mid autumnal leaves 5  
And to her mournful habits fondly cleaves.

When files of stateliest plants have ceased to bloom,  
One after one submitting to their doom,  
When her coevals each and all are fled,  
What keeps her thus reclined upon her lonesome bed? 10

The old mythologists, more impress'd than we  
Of this late day by character in tree  
Or herb, that claimed peculiar sympathy,  
Or by the silent lapse of fountain clear,  
Or with the language of the viewless air 15  
By bird or beast made vocal, sought a cause  
To solve the mystery, not in Nature's laws  
But in Man's fortunes. Hence a thousand tales  
Sung to the plaintive lyre in Grecian vales.  
Nor doubt that something of their spirit swayed 20  
The fancy-stricken Youth or heart-sick Maid,  
Who, while each stood companionless and eyed  
This undeparting Flower in crimson dyed,  
Thought of a wound which death is slow to cure,  
A fate that has endured and will endure, 25  
And, patience coveting yet passion feeding,  
Called the dejected Lingerer, *Love lies bleeding*.

[256] The date of the composition of this poem is uncertain, but, as "companion" to *Love lies Bleeding*, it must be placed in immediate succession to it.—ED.

## **THE CUCKOO-CLOCK**

Composed 1842.—Published 1842

[Of this clock I have nothing further to say than what the poem expresses, except that it must be here recorded that it was a present from the dear friend for whose sake these notes were chiefly undertaken, and who has written them from my dictation.—I.F.]

One of the “Poems of the Imagination.”—ED.

Wouldst thou be taught, when sleep has taken flight,  
By a sure voice that can most sweetly tell,  
How far-off yet a glimpse of morning light,  
And if to lure the truant back be well,  
Forbear to covet a Repeater's stroke, 5  
That, answering to thy touch, will sound the hour;  
Better provide thee with a Cuckoo-clock  
For service hung behind thy chamber-door;  
And in due time the soft spontaneous shock,  
The double note, as if with living power, 10  
Will to composure lead—or make thee blithe as bird in bower.

List, Cuckoo—Cuckoo!—oft tho' tempests howl,  
Or nipping frost remind thee trees are bare,  
How cattle pine, and droop the shivering fowl,  
Thy spirits will seem to feed on balmy air: 15  
I speak with knowledge,—by that Voice beguiled,  
Thou wilt salute old memories as they throng  
Into thy heart; and fancies, running wild  
Through fresh green fields, and budding groves among,  
Will make thee happy, happy as a child; 20  
Of sunshine wilt thou think, and flowers, and song,  
And breathe as in a world where nothing can go wrong.

And know—that, even for him who shuns the day  
And nightly tosses on a bed of pain;  
Whose joys, from all but memory swept away, 25  
Must come unhop'd for, if they come again;  
Know—that, for him whose waking thoughts, severe  
As his distress is sharp, would scorn my theme,  
The mimic notes, striking upon his ear  
In sleep, and intermingling with his dream, 30  
Could from sad regions lead him to a dream

Could from sad regions send him to a dear  
Delightful land of verdure, shower and gleam,  
To mock the *wandering* Voice<sup>[257]</sup> beside some haunted stream.<sup>[258]</sup>

O bounty without measure! while the grace  
Of Heaven doth in such wise, from humblest springs, 35  
Pour pleasure forth, and solaces that trace  
A mazy course along familiar things,  
Well may our hearts have faith that blessings come,  
Streaming from founts above the starry sky,  
With angels when their own untroubled home 40  
They leave, and speed on nightly embassy  
To visit earthly chambers,—and for whom?  
Yea, both for souls who God's forbearance try,  
And those that seek his help, and for his mercy sigh.

<sup>[257]</sup> Compare *To the Cuckoo* (vol. ii. p. 289)—

O Cuckoo! shall I call thee Bird,  
Or but a wandering Voice?

ED.

<sup>[258]</sup> Professor Dowden has appropriately called attention to the fact that the cuckoo-clock at Rydal Mount was not stopped during Wordsworth's last illness.—ED.

## **“WANSFELL! THIS HOUSEHOLD HAS A FAVOURED LOT”**

Composed 1842.—Published 1845

One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.



Wansfell![\[259\]](#) this Household has a favoured lot,  
Living with liberty on thee to gaze,  
To watch while Morn first crowns thee with her rays,  
Or when along thy breast serenely float  
Evening's angelic clouds. Yet ne'er a note 5  
Hath sounded (shame upon the Bard!) thy praise  
For all that thou, as if from heaven, hast brought  
Of glory lavished on our quiet days.  
Bountiful Son of Earth! when we are gone  
From every object dear to mortal sight, 10  
As soon we shall be, may these words attest  
How oft, to elevate our spirits, shone  
Thy visionary majesties of light,  
How in thy pensive glooms our hearts found rest.

*Dec. 24, 1842.*

[\[259\]](#) The Hill that rises to the south-east, above Ambleside.—W.W. 1842.

## **“THOUGH THE BOLD WINGS OF POESY AFFECT”**

Composed (?)—Published 1842

One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

Though the bold wings of Poesy affect  
The clouds, and wheel around the mountain tops  
Rejoicing, from her loftiest height she drops  
Well pleased to skim the plain with wild flowers deckt,  
Or muse in solemn grove whose shades protect 5  
The lingering dew—there steals along, or stops  
Watching the least small bird that round her hops,  
Or creeping worm, with sensitive respect.  
Her functions are they therefore less divine,  
Her thoughts less deep, or void of grave intent 10  
Her simplest fancies? Should that fear be thine,  
Aspiring Votary, ere thy hand present  
One offering, kneel before her modest shrine,  
With brow in penitential sorrow bent!

## **“GLAD SIGHT WHEREVER NEW WITH OLD”**

Composed 1842.[\[260\]](#)—Published 1845

One of the “Poems of the Fancy.”—ED.

Glad sight wherever new with old[\[261\]](#)  
Is joined through some dear homeborn tie;

The life[\[262\]](#) of all that we behold  
Depends upon that mystery.  
Vain is the glory of the sky,[\[263\]](#) 5  
The beauty vain of field and grove,  
Unless, while with admiring eye[\[264\]](#)  
We gaze, we also learn to love.[\[265\]](#)

[260] A MS. copy of this fragment in Wordsworth's handwriting, 31st December 1842, fixes the date approximately.—ED.

[261] 1845.

Look up, look round, let things unfold  
Far as they may, their mysteries;  
What profits it if new with old  
Unites not with some homeborn ties.

MS. 31st Dec. 1842.

Welcome the sight when new with old

C.

Glad sight it is when new with old

MS. 1843.

[262] 1845.

The good ...

C.

[263] 1845.

... skies,

MS. 1843.

[264] 1845.

... eyes

MS. 1843.

[265] Compare the lines addressed to Mrs. Wordsworth in 1824, beginning—

True beauty dwells in deep retreats.

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## 1843

Two sonnets, and an *Inscription* for a monument to Southey, were written in 1843.—ED.

### “WHILE BEAMS OF ORIENT LIGHT SHOOT WIDE AND HIGH”

Composed 1st January 1843.—Published 1845

One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

While beams of orient light shoot wide and high,  
Deep in the vale a little rural Town<sup>[266]</sup>  
Breathes forth a cloud-like creature of its own,  
That mounts not toward the radiant morning sky,  
But, with a less ambitious sympathy, 5  
Hangs o’er its Parent waking to the cares  
Troubles and toils that every day prepares.  
So Fancy, to the musing Poet’s eye,  
Endears that Lingerer. And how blest her sway<sup>[267]</sup>  
(Like influence never may my soul reject)<sup>[268]</sup> 10  
If the calm Heaven, now to its zenith decked<sup>[269]</sup>  
With glorious forms in numberless array,  
To the lone shepherd on the hills disclose  
Gleams from<sup>[270]</sup> a world in which the saints repose.

*Jan. 1, 1843.*

[266] Ambleside.—W.W. 1845.

[267] 1845.

... And blessed be her sway

MS.

So Fancy charms the musing Poet's eye  
Fixed on that Lingerer ...

C.

[268] 1845.

Ne'er may my soul like influence reject.

MS.†

[269] 1845.

Endear that Lingerer. And how blest her sway,  
The faith how pure and holy in effect,  
If the calm Heavens, now to their summit deck'd

MS.†

[270]

... of ...

MS.†

† These MS. variants occur in a copy of the sonnet written by Wordsworth for Mrs. Arnold at Foxhowe.

**INSCRIPTION**  
**FOR A MONUMENT IN CROSTHWAITE CHURCH, IN THE VALE OF**  
**KESWICK**

Composed 1843.—Published 1845

One of the “Epitaphs and Elegiac Pieces.”—ED.

Ye vales and hills whose beauty hither drew  
The poet's steps, and fixed him here, on you,  
His eyes have closed! And ye, lov'd books, no more  
Shall Southey feed upon your precious lore,  
To works that ne'er shall forfeit their renown 5  
Adding immortal labours of his own—  
Whether he traced historic truth, with zeal  
For the State's guidance, or the Church's weal,  
Or Fancy, disciplined by studious art,  
Inform'd his pen, or wisdom of the heart, 10  
Or judgments sanctioned in the Patriot's mind  
By reverence for the rights of all mankind.  
Wide were his aims, yet in no human breast  
Could private feelings meet for holier rest.  
His joys, his griefs, have vanished like a cloud 15  
From Skiddaw's top; but he to heaven was vowed  
Through his industrious life, and Christian faith  
Calmed in his soul the fear of change and death.

I received, from the late Lord Coleridge, the following extracts from letters written by Wordsworth to his father, the Hon. Justice Coleridge, in reference to the Southey Inscription in Crosthwaite Church. Wordsworth seems to have submitted the proposed Inscription to Mr. Coleridge's judgment, and the changes he made upon it, in deference to the opinions he received, shew, as Lord Coleridge says, “the extreme care Wordsworth took to have the substance, and the expression also, as perfect as he could make it.” The original draft of the “Inscription” was as follows:—

SACRED TO THE MEMORY OF ROBERT SOUTHEY, WHOSE MORTAL  
REMAINS ARE INTERRED IN THE ADJOINING CHURCHYARD. HE  
WAS BORN AT BRISTOL, OCTOBER YE 4TH, 1774, AND DIED,  
AFTER A RESIDENCE OF NEARLY FORTY YEARS, AT GRETA  
HALL IN THIS PARISH. MARCH 21ST, 1843.

Ye Vales and Hills, whose beauty hither drew  
The Poet's steps, and fixed him here, on you  
His eyes have closed; and ye, loved Books, no more  
Shall Southey feed upon your precious lore,  
To Works that ne'er shall forfeit their renown  
Adding immortal labours of his own,  
As Fancy, disciplined by studious Art  
Informed his pen, or Wisdom of the heart,  
Or judgments rooted in a Patriot's mind  
Taught to revere the rights of all mankind.  
Friends, Family—ah wherefore touch that string,  
To them so fondly did the good man cling!  
His joys, his griefs, have vanished like a cloud  
From Skiddaw's top; but He to Heaven was vowed  
Through a long life; and calmed by Christian faith,  
In his pure soul, the fear of change and death.

This Memorial was erected by friends of Robert Southey.

Alteration in the Epitaph—

... He to Heaven was vowed  
Through a life long and pure; and Christian faith  
Calmed in his soul the fear of change and death.—W.W.



December the 6th.

MY DEAR MR. JUSTICE COLERIDGE,

Notwithstanding what I have written before, I could not but wish to meet *your wishes* upon the points which you mentioned, and, accordingly, have added and altered as on the other side of this paper. If you approve don't trouble yourself to answer.

Ever faithfully yours,

W. WORDSWORTH.

Ye torrents, foaming down the rocky steeps,  
Ye lakes, wherein the spirit of water sleeps,  
Ye vales and hills, etc.  
Or judgments sanctioned in the Patriot's mind  
By reverence for the rights of all mankind.  
Friends, Family—within no human breast  
Could private feelings need a holier nest.  
His joys, his griefs, have vanished.

These alterations are approved of by friends here, and I hope will please you.

MY DEAR MR. JUSTICE COLERIDGE,

Pray accept my thanks for the pains you have taken with the Inscription, and excuse the few words I shall have to say upon your remarks. There are two lakes in the Vale of Keswick; both which, along with the lateral Vale of Newlands immediately opposite Southey's study window, will be included in the words "*Ye Vales and Hills*" by everyone who is familiar with the neighbourhood.

I quite agree with you that the construction of the lines that particularize his writings is rendered awkward by so many participles passive, and the more so on account of the transitive verb *informed*. One of these participles may be got rid of, and, I think, a better couplet produced by this alteration—

Or judgments sanctioned in the Patriot's mind  
By reverence for the rights of all mankind.

As I have entered into particulars as to the character of S.'s writings, and they are so various, I thought his historic works ought by no means to be omitted, and therefore, though unwilling to lengthen the Epitaph, I added the two following—

... Labours of his own,  
Whether he traced historic truth with zeal  
For the State's guidance, or the Church's weal,  
Or Fancy, disciplined by studious Art,  
Informed his pen, or wisdom of the heart,  
Or judgments sanctioned in the Patriot's mind  
By reverence for the rights of all mankind.

I do not feel with you in respect to the word "so"; it refers, of course, to the preceding line, and as the reference is to fireside feelings and intimate friends, there appears to me a propriety in an expression inclining to the colloquial. The couplet was the dictate of my own feelings, and the construction is accordingly broken and rather dramatic,—but too much of this. If you have any objection to the couplet as altered, be so kind as let me know; if not, on no account trouble yourself to answer this letter.

*Prematurely* I object to as you do. I used the word with reference to that decay of faculties which is not uncommon in advanced life, and which often leads to dotage,—but the word must not be retained.

We regret much to hear that Lady Coleridge is unwell, pray present to her our best wishes.

What could induce the Bishop of London to forbid the choral service at St. Mark's? It was in execution, I understand, above all praise.

Ever most faithfully yours,

W. WORDSWORTH.

*December 2nd, '43.*

MY DEAR MR. JUSTICE COLERIDGE,

The first line would certainly have more spirit by reading “your” as you suggest. I had previously considered *that*; but decided in favour of “the,” as “your,” I thought, would clog the sentence in sound, there being “ye” thrice repeated, and followed by “you” at the close of the 4th line. I also thought that “*your*” would interfere with the application of “you” at the end of the fourth line, to the *whole* of the particular previous images as I intended it to do. But I don't trouble you with this Letter on that account, but merely to ask you whether the couplet now standing:—

Large were his aims, yet in no human breast  
Could private feelings find a holier nest,

would not be better thus

Could private feelings meet in holier rest.

This alteration does not quite satisfy me, but I can do no better. The word “*nest*” both in itself and in conjunction with “*holier*” seems to me somewhat bold and rather startling for marble, particularly in a Church. I should not have thought of any alteration in a merely printed poem, but this makes a difference. If you think the proposed alteration better, don’t trouble yourself to answer this; if not, pray be so kind as to tell me so by a single line. I would not on any account have trespassed on your time but for this public occasion. We are sorry to hear of Lady Coleridge’s indisposition; pray present to her our kind regards and best wishes for her recovery, united with the greetings of the season both for her and yourself, and believe me faithfully,

Your obliged,

WM. WORDSWORTH.

RYDAL MOUNT, *December 23rd*, ’43.

TO THE MEMORY OF ROBERT SOUTHEY, A MAN EMINENT FOR GENIUS, VERSATILE TALENTS, EXTENSIVE AND ACCURATE KNOWLEDGE, AND HABITS OF THE MOST CONSCIENTIOUS INDUSTRY. NOR WAS HE LESS DISTINGUISHED FOR STRICT TEMPERANCE, PURE BENEVOLENCE, AND WARM AFFECTIONS; BUT HIS MIND, SUCH ARE THE AWFUL DISPENSATIONS OF PROVIDENCE, WAS PREMATURELY AND ALMOST TOTALLY OBSCURED BY A SLOWLY-WORKING AND INSCRUTABLE MALADY UNDER WHICH HE LANGUISHED UNTIL RELEASED BY DEATH IN THE 69TH YEAR OF HIS AGE.

READER! PONDER THE CONDITION TO WHICH THIS GREAT AND GOOD MAN, NOT WITHOUT MERCIFUL ALLEVIATIONS, WAS DOOMED, AND LEARN FROM HIS EXAMPLE TO MAKE TIMELY

USE OF THY ENDOWMENTS AND OPPORTUNITIES, AND TO WALK  
HUMBLY WITH THY GOD.

### **COPY OF THE PRINTED INSCRIPTION**

SACRED TO THE MEMORY OF ROBERT SOUTHEY, WHOSE MORTAL  
REMAINS ARE INTERRED IN THE ADJOINING CHURCHYARD. HE  
WAS BORN AT BRISTOL, OCTOBER 4TH, 1774, AND DIED  
AFTER A RESIDENCE OF NEARLY 40 YEARS AT GRETA HALL,  
IN THIS PARISH, MARCH 21ST, 1843.

Ye torrents, foaming down the rocky steeps,  
Ye lakes, wherein the spirit of water sleeps,  
Ye vales and hills, whose beauty hither drew  
The Poet's steps and fixed him here, on you  
His eyes have closed! and ye, loved books, no more  
Shall Southey feed upon your precious lore,  
To works that ne'er shall forfeit their renown  
Adding immortal labours of his own—  
Whether he traced historic truth, with zeal  
For the State's guidance or the Church's weal,  
Or Fancy, disciplined by studious art,  
Informed his pen, or wisdom of the heart,  
Or judgments sanctioned in the Patriot's mind  
By reverence for the rights of all mankind.  
Wide were his aims, yet in no human breast  
Could private feelings find a holier nest.  
His joys, his griefs, have vanished like a cloud  
From Skiddaw's top; but he to Heaven was vowed  
Through a long life, and calmed by Christian faith,  
In his pure soul, the fear of change and death.

This Memorial was erected by friends of Robert Southey.

Edward Quillinan wrote, 25th March 1843, “Yesterday I drove Mr. Wordsworth early over to Keswick, that he and I might attend the funeral of Mr. Southey, who was buried in Crosthwaite churchyard there at eleven A.M. It was very affecting to see Kate Southey with her brother Cuthbert, and brother-in-law Herbert Hill, at her father’s grave as the coffin was lowered into it. She looked as if she yearned to be there too. She says she has now got her father back again.”—ED.

**TO THE REV. CHRISTOPHER WORDSWORTH, D.D.,  
MASTER OF HARROW SCHOOL [\[271\]](#)  
After the perusal of his *Theophilus Anglicanus*, recently  
published.**

Composed 1843.—Published 1845

One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

Enlightened Teacher, gladly from thy hand  
Have I received this proof of pains bestowed  
By Thee to guide thy Pupils on the road  
That, in our native isle, and every land,  
The Church, when trusting in divine command 5  
And in her Catholic attributes, hath trod:  
O may these lessons be with profit scanned  
To thy heart's wish, thy labour blest by God!  
So the bright faces of the young and gay  
Shall look more bright—the happy, happier still; 10  
Catch, in the pauses of their keenest play,  
Motions of thought which elevate the will  
And, like the Spire that from your classic Hill  
Points heavenward, indicate the end and way.

RYDAL MOUNT, *Dec. 11, 1843.*

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[271] The poet's nephew, afterwards Canon of Westminster, and Bishop of Lincoln, and the biographer of his uncle.—ED.

**1844**

Only four poems were written in 1844.—ED.

**“SO FAIR, SO SWEET, WITHAL SO SENSITIVE”**

Composed July 1844.—Published 1845

One of the “Poems of Sentiment and Reflection.”—ED.



So fair, so sweet, withal so sensitive,  
Would that the little Flowers were born to live,  
Conscious of half the pleasure which they give;

That to this mountain-daisy's self were known<sup>[272]</sup>  
The beauty of its star-shaped shadow, thrown 5  
On the smooth surface of this<sup>[273]</sup> naked stone!

And what if hence a bold desire should mount  
High as the Sun, that he could take account  
Of all that issues from his glorious fount!

So might he ken how by his sovereign aid 10  
These delicate companionships are made;  
And how he rules the pomp of light and shade;

And were the Sister-power that shines by night  
So privileged, what a countenance of delight  
Would through the clouds break forth on human sight! 15

Fond fancies! wheresoe'er shall turn thine eye  
On earth, air, ocean, or the starry sky,  
Converse with Nature in pure sympathy;<sup>[274]</sup>

All vain desires, all lawless wishes quelled,  
Be Thou to love and praise alike impelled, 20  
Whatever boon is granted or withheld.<sup>[275]</sup><sup>[276]</sup>

<sup>[272]</sup> Compare the lines *To a Child*, written in her Album, in 1834.—ED.

<sup>[273]</sup> 1844.

Is then no nook of English ground secure  
From rash assault?[\[278\]](#) Schemes of retirement sown  
In youth, and 'mid the busy world kept pure  
As when their earliest flowers of hope were blown,  
Must perish;—how can they this blight endure? 5  
And must he too the ruthless change bemoan  
Who scorns a false utilitarian lure  
'Mid his paternal fields at random thrown?  
Baffle the threat, bright Scene, from Orrest-head[\[279\]](#)  
Given to the pausing traveller's rapturous glance: 10  
Plead for thy peace, thou beautiful romance  
Of nature; and, if human hearts be dead,  
Speak, passing winds; ye torrents, with your strong  
And constant voice, protest against the wrong.

*October 12th, 1844.*

[\[277\]](#) In the first edition of his pamphlet "On the projected Kendal and Windermere Railway."—Ed.

[\[278\]](#) The degree and kind of attachment which many of the yeomanry feel to their small inheritances can scarcely be over-rated. Near the house of one of them stands a magnificent tree, which a neighbour of the owner advised him to fell for profit's sake. "Fell it!" exclaimed the yeoman, "I had rather fall on my knees and worship it." It happens, I believe, that the intended railway would pass through this little property, and I hope that an apology for the answer will not be thought necessary by one who enters into the strength of the feeling.—W.W. 1845.

Compare the two letters on the Kendal and Windermere Railway, contributed by Wordsworth to *The Morning Post* in 1844, at Kendal, revised and reprinted in the same year. See *The Prose Works of Wordsworth*, vol. ii. pp. 383-405.—Ed.

[\[279\]](#) Orresthead is the height close to Windermere, to the north of the town.—Ed.

## **“PROUD WERE YE, MOUNTAINS, WHEN, IN TIMES OF OLD”**

Composed 1844.—Published 1845[\[280\]](#)

One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

Proud were ye, Mountains, when, in times of old,  
Your patriot sons, to stem invasive war,  
Intrenched your brows; ye gloried in each scar:  
Now, for your shame, a Power, the Thirst of Gold,  
That rules o’er Britain like a baneful star, 5  
Wills that your peace, your beauty, shall be sold,  
And clear way made for her triumphal car  
Through the beloved retreats your arms enfold!  
Heard YE that Whistle? As her long-linked Train  
Swept onwards, did the vision cross your view? 10  
Yes, ye were startled;—and, in balance true,  
Weighing the mischief with the promised gain,  
Mountains, and Vales, and Floods, I call on you  
To share the passion of a just disdain.

The following by Canon Rawnsley—suggested by an attempt to introduce a mineral railway into Borrowdale—may be read in connection with Wordsworth’s two sonnets.—ED.

## A CRY FROM DERWENTWATER

Shall then the stream of ruinous Lodore  
Not fill the valley with its changeful sound  
Unchallenged! shall grey Derwent's sacred bound  
Hear the harsh brawl and intermittent roar  
Of mocking waves upon an iron shore,  
Whereby nor health nor happiness is found!—  
While steam-wains drag from Honister's heart wound  
The long cooled ashes of its fiery core!

Burst forth ye sulphurous fountains, as ye broke  
On Skiddaw, lick the waters, blast the trees,  
And let men have the earth they would desire,—  
As well go pass our children through the fire  
With shrieks, Cath-Belus, round thine altar's smoke,  
As let old Derwent hear such sounds as these.

H.D. RAWNSLEY.

WRAY VICARAGE, AMBLESIDE.

[280] This sonnet was first published in *The Morning Post*, December 17, 1844.—ED.

## AT FURNESS ABBEY

Composed 1844.—Published 1845

One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

Here, where, of havoc tired and rash undoing,  
 Man left this Structure to become Time's prey  
 A soothing spirit follows in the way  
 That Nature takes, her counter-work pursuing.  
 See how her Ivy clasps the sacred Ruin<sup>[281]</sup> 5  
 Fall to prevent or beautify decay;  
 And, on the mouldered walls, how bright, how gay,  
 The flowers in pearly dew their bloom renewing!  
 Thanks to the place, blessings upon the hour;  
 Even as I speak the rising Sun's first smile 10  
 Gleams on the grass-crowned top of yon tall Tower<sup>[282]</sup>  
 Whose cawing occupants with joy proclaim  
 Prescriptive title to the shattered pile  
 Where, Cavendish,<sup>[283]</sup> *thine* seems nothing but a name!

<sup>[281]</sup> In the chancel of the church at Furness Abbey, ivy almost covers the north wall. In the Belfry and in the Chapter House, it is the same. The "tower," referred to in the sonnet, is evidently the belfry tower to the west. It is still "grass-crowned." The sonnet was doubtless composed on the spot, and if Wordsworth ascended to the top of the belfry tower, he might have seen the morning sunlight strike the small remaining fragment of the central tower. But it is more likely that he looked up from the nave, or choir, of the church to the belfry, when he spoke of the sun's first smile gleaming from the top of the tall tower. "Flowers"—crowfoot, campanulas, etc.—still luxuriate on the mouldered walls. With the line,

Fall to prevent or beautify decay;

compare,

Nature softening and concealing,  
 And busy with a hand of healing,

in the description of Bolton Abbey in *The White Doe of Rylstone*, canto i. I. 118. Compare also the *Address from the Spirit of Cockermouth Castle*, vol. vii. p. 347. —ED.

[\[282\]](#) See preceding note.

[\[283\]](#) Furness Abbey is the property of the Duke of Devonshire, whose family name is Cavendish.—ED.

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## 1845

The Poems of 1845 include one of the group “On the Naming of Places,” *The Westmoreland Girl* (addressed to the Poet’s grandchildren), several fragments addressed to Mrs. Wordsworth, and to friends, with one or two Sonnets.—ED.

### **“FORTH FROM A JUTTING RIDGE, AROUND WHOSE BASE”**

Composed 1845.—Published 1845

One of the “Poems upon the Naming of Places.”—ED.

Forth from a jutting ridge, around whose base  
Winds our deep Vale, two heath-clad Rocks ascend[284][285]  
In fellowship, the loftiest of the pair  
Rising to no ambitious height; yet both,  
O'er lake[286] and stream, mountain and flowery mead, 5  
Unfolding prospects fair as human eyes[287]  
Ever beheld. Up-led with mutual help,  
To one or other brow of those twin Peaks  
Were two adventurous Sisters wont to climb,  
And took no note of the hour while thence they gazed, 10  
The blooming heath their couch, gazed, side by side,  
In speechless admiration. I, a witness  
And frequent sharer of their calm[288] delight  
With thankful heart, to either Eminence  
Gave the baptismal name each Sister bore. 15  
Now are they parted,[289] far as Death's cold hand  
Hath power to part the Spirits of those who love  
As they did love. Ye kindred Pinnacles—  
That, while the generations of mankind  
Follow each other to their hiding-place 20  
In time's abyss, are privileged to endure  
Beautiful in yourselves, and richly graced  
With like command of beauty—grant your aid  
For MARY'S humble, SARAH'S silent, claim,  
That their pure joy in nature may survive 25  
From age to age in blended memory.

[284] 1845.

Winds our sequestered vale, two rocks ascend

MS.



[285] These two rocks rise to the left of the lower high-road from Grasmere to Rydal, after it leaves the former lake and turns eastwards towards the latter. They are still “heath-clad,” and covered with the coppice of the old Bane Riggs Wood, so named because the shortest road from Ambleside to Grasmere used to pass through it; “bain” or “bane” signifying, in the Westmoreland dialect, a short cut. Dr. Cradock wrote of them thus:—“They are now difficult of approach, being enclosed in a wood, with dense undergrowth, and surrounded by a high, well-built wall. They can be well seen from the lower road, from a spot close to the three-mile stone from Ambleside. They are some fifty or sixty feet above the road, about twenty yards apart, and separated by a slight depression of, say, ten feet. The view from the easterly one is now much preferable, as it is less encumbered with shrubs; and for that reason also is more heath-clad. The twin rocks are also well seen, though at a farther distance, from the hill in White Moss Common between the roads, which Dr. Arnold used to call ‘Old Corruption,’ and ‘Bit-by-bit Reform.’ Doubtless the rocks were far more easily approached fifty years ago, when walls, if any, were low and ill-built. It is probable, however, that even then they were enclosed and protected; for heath will not grow on the Grasmere hills, on places much frequented by sheep.” The best view of these “heath-clad” rocks from the lower carriage road is at a spot two or three yards to the west of a large rock on the road-side near the milestone. The view of them from the Loughrigg Terrace walks is also interesting. The two sisters were Mary and Sarah Hutchinson (Mrs. Wordsworth and her Sister); and, in the Rydal household, the rocks were respectively named “Mary-Point,” and “Sarah-Point.”—ED.

[286] 1845.

O’er wood ...

MS.

[287] 1845.

... eye

MS.

[288] 1845.

... that deep ...

MS.

[289] 1845.

Gone to a common home, their duty done,  
In this dear vale the Sisters lived, but long  
Have they been parted ...

C.

True to a common love, their early choice  
In this dear Vale, the sisters lived, but long  
Have they been parted— ...

C.

## **THE WESTMORELAND GIRL**[\[290\]](#)

### **TO MY GRANDCHILDREN**

Composed June 6, 1845.—Published 1845

One of the “Poems referring to the Period of Childhood.”—ED.

## PART I

Seek who will delight in fable  
I shall tell you truth. A Lamb  
Leapt from this steep bank to follow  
'Cross the brook its thoughtless dam.[\[291\]](#)

Far and wide on hill and valley 5  
Rain had fallen, unceasing rain,  
And the bleating mother's Young-one  
Struggled with the flood in vain:

But, as chanced, a Cottage-maiden  
(Ten years scarcely had she told) 10  
Seeing, plunged into the torrent,  
Clasped the Lamb and kept her hold.  
Whirled adown the rocky channel,  
Sinking, rising, on they go,  
Peace and rest, as seems, before them 15  
Only in the lake below.

Oh! it was a frightful current  
Whose fierce wrath the Girl had braved;  
Clap your hands with joy my Hearers,  
Shout in triumph, both are saved; 20

Saved by courage that with danger  
Grew, by strength the gift of love,  
And belike a guardian angel  
Came with succour from above.

## PART II

Now to a maturer Audience. 25

Now, to a maternal audience, 25

Let me speak of this brave Child  
Left among her native mountains  
With wild Nature to run wild.

So, unwatched by love maternal,  
Mother's care no more her guide, 30  
Fared this little bright-eyed Orphan  
Even while at her father's side.

Spare your blame,—remembrance makes him  
Loth to rule by strict command;  
Still upon his cheek are living 35  
Touches of her infant hand,

Dear caresses given in pity,  
Sympathy that soothed his grief,  
As the dying mother witnessed  
To her thankful mind's relief. 40

Time passed on; the Child was happy,  
Like a Spirit of air she moved,  
Wayward, yet by all who knew her  
For her tender heart beloved.

Scarcely less than sacred passions, 45  
Bred in house, in grove, and field,  
Link her with the inferior creatures,  
Urge her powers their rights to shield.

Anglers, bent on reckless pastime,  
Learn how she can feel alike 50  
Both for tiny harmless minnow  
And the fierce and sharp-toothed pike.

Merciful protectress, kindling  
Into anger or disdain;  
Many a captive hath she rescued, 55  
Others saved from lingering pain.

Listen yet awhile;—with patience  
Hear the homely truths I tell,  
She in Grasmere's old church-steeple  
Tolled this day the passing-bell. 60

Yes, the wild Girl of the mountains  
To their echoes gave the sound,  
Notice punctual as the minute,  
Warning solemn and profound.

She, fulfilling her sire's office, 65  
Rang alone the far-heard knell,  
Tribute, by her hand, in sorrow,  
Paid to One who loved her well.

When his spirit was departed  
On that service she went forth; 70  
Nor will fail the like to render  
When his corse is laid in earth.[\[292\]](#)

What then wants the Child to temper,  
In her breast, unruly fire,  
To control the froward impulse 75  
And restrain the vague desire?

Easily a pious training  
And a stedfast outward power  
Would supplant the weeds and cherish,  
In their stead, each opening flower. 80

Thus the fearless Lamb-deliv'rer,  
Woman-grown, meek-hearted, sage,  
May become a blest example  
For her sex, of every age.[\[293\]](#)

Watchful as a wheeling eagle, 85  
Constant as a soaring lark,  
Should the country need a heroine,  
She might prove our Maid of Arc.

Leave that thought; and here be uttered  
Prayer that Grace divine may raise 90  
Her humane courageous spirit  
Up to heaven, thro' peaceful ways.[\[294\]](#)

[\[290\]](#) This Westmoreland Girl was Sarah Mackereth of Wyke Cottage, Grasmere. She married a man named Davis, and died in 1872 at Broughton in Furness. The swollen “flood” from which she rescued the lamb, was Wyke Gill beck, which descends from the centre of Silver Howe. The picturesque cottage, with round chimney,—a yew tree and Scotch fir behind it,—is on the western side of the road from Grasmere over to Langdale by Red Bank. The Mackereths have been a well-known Westmoreland family for some hundred years. They belong to the “gentry of the soil,” and have been parish clerks in Grasmere for generations. One of them was the tenant of the Swan Inn referred to in *The Waggoner*—the host who painted, with his own hand, the “famous swan,” used as a sign. (See vol. iii. p. 81.)

The story of *The Blind Highland Boy*, which gave rise to the poem bearing that name, was told to Wordsworth by one of these Mackereths of Grasmere. (See the Fenwick note, vol. ii. p. 420.) In a letter to Professor Henry Reed (31st July 1845) Wordsworth said this poem might interest him “as exhibiting what sort of characters our mountains breed. It is truth to the letter.”—ED.

[\[291\]](#) 1845.

... its simple dam.

MS.

[\[292\]](#) 1845.

... must lie in earth.

MS.

[293] Compare *Grace Darling*, p. 311 in this volume.—ED.

[294] 1845.

Leave that word—and here be offered  
Prayer that Grace divine would raise  
This humane courageous spirit  
Up to Heaven through peaceful ways.

In a letter to Henry Reed, July 1845.

## AT FURNESS ABBEY

Composed 1845.—Published 1845

One of the “Miscellaneous Sonnets.”—ED.

Well have yon Railway Labourers to THIS ground  
Withdrawn for noontide rest. They sit, they walk  
Among the Ruins, but no idle talk  
Is heard; to grave demeanour all are bound;  
And from one voice a Hymn with tuneful sound 5  
Hallows once more the long-deserted Quire<sup>[295]</sup>  
And thrills the old sepulchral earth, around.  
Others look up, and with fixed eyes admire  
That wide-spanned arch, wondering how it was raised,  
To keep, so high in air, its strength and grace: 10  
All seem to feel the spirit of the place,  
And by the general reverence God is praised:  
Profane Despoilers, stand ye not reprov'd,  
While thus these simple-hearted men are moved?

*June 21st, 1845.*

<sup>[295]</sup> See the note to the previous sonnet on Furness Abbey, p. 168.—ED.

## **“YES! THOU ART FAIR, YET BE NOT MOVED”**

Composed possibly in 1845.—Published 1845

One of the “Poems founded on the Affections.”—ED.



Yes! thou art fair, yet be not moved  
To scorn the declaration,  
That sometimes I in thee have loved  
My fancy's own creation.

Imagination needs must stir; 5  
Dear Maid, this truth believe,  
Minds that have nothing to confer  
Find little to perceive.

Be pleased that nature made thee fit  
To feed my heart's devotion, 10  
By laws to which all Forms submit  
In sky, air, earth, and ocean.

### **“WHAT HEAVENLY SMILES! O LADY MINE”**

Composed 1845.—Published 1845

One of the “Poems founded on the Affections.”—ED.

What heavenly smiles! O Lady mine  
Through my[296] very heart they shine;  
And, if my brow gives back their light,  
Do thou look gladly on the sight;  
As the clear Moon with modest pride  
Beholds her own bright beams  
Reflected from the mountain's side  
And from the headlong streams.

[296] 1845.

... this ...

MS.

**TO A LADY,  
IN ANSWER TO A REQUEST THAT I WOULD WRITE HER A POEM UPON  
SOME DRAWINGS THAT SHE HAD MADE OF FLOWERS IN THE ISLAND OF  
MADEIRA**

Composed 1845.—Published 1845

One of the “Poems of the Fancy.”—ED.

Fair Lady! can I sing of flowers  
That in Madeira bloom and fade,  
I who ne'er sate within their bowers,  
Nor through their sunny lawns have strayed?  
How they in sprightly dance are worn 5  
By Shepherd-groom or May-day queen,  
Or holy festal pomps adorn,  
These eyes have never seen.

Yet tho' to me the pencil's art  
No like remembrances can give, 10  
Your portraits still may reach the heart  
And there for gentle pleasure live;  
While Fancy ranging with free scope  
Shall on some lovely Alien set  
A name with us endeared to hope, 15  
To peace, or fond regret.[\[297\]](#)

Still as we look with nicer care,  
Some new resemblance we may trace:  
*A Heart's-ease* will perhaps be there,  
*A Speedwell* may not want its place. 20  
And so may we, with charmèd mind  
Beholding what your skill has wrought,  
Another *Star-of-Bethlehem* find,  
A new[\[298\]](#) *Forget-me-not*.

From earth to heaven with motion fleet 25  
From heaven to earth our thoughts will pass,  
*A Holy-thistle* here we meet  
And there a *Shepherd's weather-glass*;  
And haply some familiar name  
Shall grace the fairest sweetest plant 30

Shall grace the rarest, sweetest, plant so  
Whose presence cheers the drooping frame  
Of English Emigrant.

Gazing she feels its power beguile  
Sad thoughts, and breathes with easier breath;  
Alas! that meek that tender smile 35  
Is but a harbinger of death:  
And pointing with a feeble hand  
She says, in faint words by sighs broken,  
Bear for me to my native land  
This precious Flower, true love's last token. 40

[297] 1845.

And there in sweet communion live:  
Yet those loved most, in which we own  
A touching likeness which they bear  
To flower or herb, by Nature sown,  
To breathe our English air.

MS.

And there in sweet communion live  
Admired for beauty of their own,  
Loved for the likeness some may bear  
To flower ...

MS.

Thus tempted Fancy with free scope  
Will range, and on these aliens set  
Names among us endeared to none,  
To hearts a fond regret.

MS.

So tempted ...  
May range, ...  
MS.

[\[298\]](#)

Nor miss ...  
MS.

## TO THE PENNSYLVANIANS

Composed 1845.—Published 1845

One of the “Sonnets dedicated to Liberty and Order.”—ED.

Days undefiled by luxury or sloth,  
Firm self-denial, manners grave and staid,  
Rights equal, laws with cheerfulness obeyed,  
Words that require no sanction from an oath,  
And simple honesty a common growth— 5  
This high repute, with bounteous Nature’s aid,  
Won confidence, now ruthlessly betrayed  
At will, your power the measure of your troth!—  
All who revere the memory of Penn  
Grieve for the land on whose wild woods his name [\[299\]](#) 10  
Was fondly grafted with a virtuous aim,  
Renounced, abandoned by degenerate Men  
For state-dishonour black as ever came  
To upper air from Mammon’s loathsome den. [\[300\]](#)

[\[299\]](#) To William Penn, son of Admiral Sir W. Penn, a printer and Quaker, Charles II. granted lands in America, to which he gave the name of Pennsylvania.—ED.

[300] Mr. Ellis Yarnall wrote to me, April 27, 1885: “The three last lines of the Sonnet *To the Pennsylvanians*, in regard to which you inquire, I think refer to what at the time Wordsworth wrote was known as the *repudiation* by Pennsylvania of her State debt. The language, however, is too strong, inasmuch as there was *no* repudiation. For a year or two the *interest* on the debt was unpaid, then payment was resumed. Members of Wordsworth’s family, or his near friends, held, I believe, some of the Pennsylvania bonds. They held also, as appears from the *Memoirs*, Mississippi bonds, and these *were* repudiated, or at least five million dollars of a certain class of Mississippi bonds. No such wrongdoing is chargeable to Pennsylvania. I remember the delight with which Professor Reed showed me the note on the fly-leaf at the end of the fifth volume of the edition of 1850—words written at his request, and the last sentences ever composed by the Poet for the press.”—ED.

## “YOUNG ENGLAND—WHAT IS THEN BECOME OF OLD”

Composed 1845.—Published 1845

One of the “Sonnets dedicated to Liberty and Order.”—ED.

Young England—what is then become of Old  
Of dear Old England? Think they she is dead,  
Dead to the very name? Presumption fed  
On empty air! That name will keep its hold  
In the true filial bosom’s inmost fold 5  
For ever.—The Spirit of Alfred, at the head  
Of all who for her rights watch’d, toil’d and bled,  
Knows that this prophecy is not too bold.  
What—how! shall she submit in will and deed  
To Beardless Boys—an imitative race, 10  
The *servum pecus* of a Gallic breed?  
Dear Mother! if thou *must* thy steps retrace,  
Go where at least meek Innocency dwells;  
Let Babes and Sucklings be thy oracles.

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## 1846

The poems written in 1846 were six sonnets, the lines beginning, “I know an aged man constrained to dwell,” an “Evening Voluntary,” and other two short pieces.—ED.

### SONNET [\[301\]](#)

Composed 1846.—Published 1850

This was placed among the “Epitaphs and Elegiac Poems.”—ED.

Why should we weep or mourn, Angelic boy,  
For such thou wert ere from our sight removed,  
Holy, and ever dutiful—beloved  
From day to day with never-ceasing joy,  
And hopes as dear as could the heart employ 5  
In aught to earth pertaining? Death has proved  
His might, nor less his mercy, as behoved—  
Death conscious that he only could destroy  
The bodily frame. That beauty is laid low  
To moulder in a far-off field of Rome; 10  
But Heaven is now, blest Child, thy Spirit's home:  
When such divine communion, which we know,  
Is felt, thy Roman-burial place will be  
Surely a sweet remembrancer of Thee.

[\[301\]](#) This sonnet refers to the poet's grandchild, who died at Rome in the beginning of 1846. Wordsworth wrote of it thus to Professor Henry Reed, “*Jan. 23, 1846. ... Our daughter-in-law fell into bad health between three and four*



years ago. She went with her husband to Madeira, where they remained nearly a year; she was then advised to go to Italy. After a prolonged residence there, her six children (whom her husband returned to England for), went, at her earnest request, to that country, under their father's guidance; then he was obliged, on account of his duty as a clergyman, to leave them. Four of the number resided with their mother at Rome, three of whom took a fever there, of which the youngest—as noble a boy of five years as ever was seen—died, being seized with convulsions when the fever was somewhat subdued.”—ED.

## “WHERE LIES THE TRUTH? HAS MAN, IN WISDOM’S CREED”

Composed 1846.—Published 1850

One of the “Evening Voluntaries.”—ED.

Where lies the truth? has Man, in wisdom’s creed,  
A pitiable doom; for respite brief  
A care more anxious, or a heavier grief?  
Is he ungrateful, and doth little heed  
God’s bounty, soon forgotten; or indeed, 5  
Must Man, with labour born, awake to sorrow[302]  
When Flowers rejoice and Larks with rival speed  
Spring from their nests to bid the Sun good morrow?  
They mount for rapture as their[303] songs proclaim  
Warbled in hearing both of earth and sky; 10  
But o’er the contrast wherefore heave a sigh?  
Like those aspirants let us soar—our aim,  
Through life’s worst trials, whether shocks or snares,  
A happier, brighter, purer Heaven than theirs.[304]

[302] 1850.

Who that lies down and may not wake to sorrow

MS.

[303] 1850.

They mount for rapture; this their ...

MS.

[304] This sonnet was suggested by the death of Wordsworth's grandson commemorated in the previous sonnet, and by the alarming illness of his brother, the Master of Trinity College, Cambridge, and the expected death of a nephew (John Wordsworth), at Ambleside, the only son of his eldest brother, Richard.—ED.

## TO LUCCA GIORDANO [305]

Composed 1846.—Published 1850

One of the “Evening Voluntaries.”—ED.

Giordano, verily thy Pencil's skill  
Hath here portrayed with Nature's happiest grace  
The fair Endymion couched on Latmos-hill;  
And Dian gazing on the Shepherd's face  
In rapture,—yet suspending her embrace, 5  
As not unconscious with what power the thrill  
Of her most timid touch his sleep would chase,  
And, with his sleep, that beauty calm and still.  
O may this work have found its last retreat  
Here in a Mountain-bard's secure abode, 10  
One to whom, yet a School-boy, Cynthia showed  
A face of love which he in love would greet,  
Fixed, by her smile, upon some rocky seat;  
Or lured along where green-wood paths he trod.

RYDAL MOUNT, 1846.

[305] Lucca Giordano was born at Naples, in 1629. He was at first a disciple of Spagnoletto, next of Pietro da Cortona; but after coming under the influence of Correggio, he went to Venice, where Titian was his inspiring master. In his own work the influence of all of these predecessors may be traced, but chiefly that of Titian, whose style of colouring and composition he followed so closely that many of his works might be mistaken for those of his greatest master. The picture referred to in this sonnet was brought from Italy by the poet's eldest son.—ED.

## **“WHO BUT IS PLEASED TO WATCH THE MOON ON HIGH”**

Composed 1846.—Published 1850

One of the “Evening Voluntaries.”—ED.

Who but is pleased to watch the moon on high  
Travelling where she from time to time enshrouds  
Her head, and nothing loth her Majesty  
Renounces, till among the scattered clouds  
One with its kindling edge declares that soon 5  
Will reappear before the uplifted eye  
A Form as bright, as beautiful a moon,  
To glide in open prospect through clear sky.  
Pity that such a promise e'er should prove  
False in the issue, that yon seeming space 10  
Of sky should be in truth the stedfast face  
Of a cloud flat and dense, through which must move  
(By transit not unlike man's frequent doom)  
The Wanderer lost in more determined gloom.

## **ILLUSTRATED BOOKS AND NEWSPAPERS**

Composed 1846.—Published 1850

One of the "Poems of Sentiment and Reflection."—ED.

Discourse was deemed Man's noblest attribute,  
And written words the glory of his hand;  
Then followed Printing with enlarged command  
For thought—dominion vast and absolute  
For spreading truth, and making love expand. 5  
Now prose and verse sunk into disrepute  
Must lacquey a dumb Art that best can suit  
The taste of this once-intellectual Land.  
A backward movement surely have we here,[306]  
From manhood—back to childhood; for the age— 10  
Back towards caverned life's first rude career.  
Avaunt this vile abuse of pictured page!  
Must eyes be all in all, the tongue and ear  
Nothing? Heaven keep us from a lower stage!

[306] The *Illustrated London News*—the pioneer of illustrated newspapers—was first issued on 14th May 1842. The painter and artist may differ from the poet, in the judgment here pronounced; but had Wordsworth known the degradation to which many newspapers would sink in this direction, his censure would have been more severe.—ED.

**SONNET**  
**TO AN OCTOGENARIAN**

Composed 1846.—Published 1850

Affections lose their object; Time brings forth  
No successors; and, lodged in memory,  
If love exist no longer, it must die,—  
Wanting accustomed food must pass from earth,  
Or never hope to reach a second birth.<sup>[307]</sup> 5  
This sad belief, the happiest that is left  
To thousands, share not Thou; howe'er bereft,  
Scorned, or neglected, fear not such a dearth.  
Though poor and destitute of friends thou art,  
Perhaps the sole survivor of thy race, 10  
One to whom Heaven assigns that mournful part  
The utmost solitude of age to face,  
Still shall be left some corner of the heart  
Where Love for living Thing can find a place.

<sup>[307]</sup> Compare Tennyson's *Lines to J.S.*—

God gives us love. Something to love  
He lends us; but, when love is grown  
To ripeness, that on which it throve  
Falls off, and love is left alone.

ED.

## **“I KNOW AN AGED MAN CONSTRAINED TO DWELL”**

Composed 1846.—Published 1850

One of the “Miscellaneous Poems.”—ED.

I know an aged Man constrained to dwell  
In a large house of public charity,  
Where he abides, as in a Prisoner's cell,  
With numbers near, alas! no company.

When he could creep about, at will, though poor 5  
And forced to live on alms, this old Man fed  
A Redbreast, one that to his cottage door  
Came not, but in a lane partook his bread.

There, at the root of one particular tree,  
An easy seat this worn-out Labourer found 10  
While Robin pecked the crumbs upon his knee  
Laid one by one, or scattered on the ground.

Dear intercourse was theirs, day after day;  
What signs of mutual gladness when they met!  
Think of their common peace, their simple play, 15  
The parting moment and its fond regret.

Months passed in love that failed not to fulfil,  
In spite of season's change, its own demand,  
By fluttering pinions here and busy bill;  
There by caresses from a tremulous hand. 20

Thus in the chosen spot a tie so strong  
Was formed between the solitary pair,  
That when his fate had housed him 'mid a throng  
The Captive shunned all converse proffered there.

Wife, children, kindred, they were dead and gone; 25  
But, if no evil hap his wishes crossed,  
One living Stay was left, and on [\[308\]](#) that one

Some recompense for all that he had lost.

O that the good old Man had power to prove,  
By message sent through air or visible token, 30  
That still he loves the Bird, and still must love;  
That friendship lasts though fellowship is broken!

[308] So all the editions have it; but, as Principal Greenwood suggested to me, the true reading should be “in that one.”—ED.

## “THE UNREMITTING VOICE OF NIGHTLY STREAMS”

Composed 1846.—Published 1850

One of the “Poems of Sentiment and Reflection.”—ED.

The unremitting voice of nightly streams  
That wastes so oft, we think, its tuneful powers,  
If neither soothing to the worm that gleams  
Through dewy grass, nor small birds hushed in bowers,  
Nor unto silent leaves and drowsy flowers,— 5  
That voice of unpretending harmony  
(For who what is shall measure by what seems  
To be, or not to be,[309]  
Or tax high Heaven with prodigality?)  
Wants not a healing influence that can creep 10  
Into the human breast, and mix with sleep  
To regulate the motion of our dreams  
For kindly issues—as through every clime  
Was felt near murmuring brooks in earliest time;  
As at this day, the rudest swains who dwell 15  
Where torrents roar, or hear the tinkling knell  
Of water-breaks, with grateful heart could tell.



## **“HOW BEAUTIFUL THE QUEEN OF NIGHT, ON HIGH”**

Composed 1846.—Published 1850

One of the “Miscellaneous Poems.”—ED.

How beautiful the Queen of Night, on high  
Her way pursuing among scattered clouds,  
Where, ever and anon, her head she shrouds  
Hidden from view in dense obscurity.  
But look, and to the watchful eye  
A brightening edge will indicate that soon  
We shall behold the struggling Moon  
Break forth,—again to walk the clear blue sky.

## **ON THE BANKS OF A ROCKY STREAM**

Composed 1846.—Published 1850

Behold an emblem of our human mind  
Crowded with thoughts that need a settled home  
Yet, like to eddying balls of foam  
Within this whirlpool, they each other chase  
Round and round, and neither find  
An outlet nor a resting-place!  
Stranger, if such disquietude be thine,  
Fall on thy knees and sue for help divine.

**ODE**  
**INTIMATIONS OF IMMORTALITY FROM**  
**RECOLLECTIONS OF EARLY CHILDHOOD**

Composed 1803-6.—Published 1807

[This was composed during my residence at Town-end, Grasmere. Two years at least passed between the writing of the four first stanzas and the remaining part. To the attentive and competent reader the whole sufficiently explains itself; but there may be no harm in adverting here to particular feelings or *experiences* of my own mind on which the structure of the poem partly rests. Nothing was more difficult for me in childhood than to admit the notion of death as a state applicable to my own being. I have said elsewhere—

A simple child,  
That lightly draws its breath,  
And feels its life in every limb,  
What should it know of death!—

But it was not so much from feelings of animal vivacity that my difficulty came as from a sense of the indomitableness of the Spirit within me. I used to brood over the stories of Enoch and Elijah, and almost to persuade myself that, whatever might become of others, I should be translated, in something of the same way, to heaven. With a feeling congenial to this, I was often unable to think of external things as having external existence, and I communed with all that I saw as something not apart from, but inherent in, my own immaterial nature. Many times while going to school have I grasped at a wall or tree to recall myself from this abyss of idealism to the reality. At that time I was afraid of such processes. In later periods of life I have deplored, as we have all reason to do, a subjugation of an opposite character, and have rejoiced over the remembrances, as is expressed in the lines—

Obstinate questionings  
Of sense and outward things,  
Fallings from us, vanishings, etc.

To that dream-like vividness and splendour which invest objects of sight in childhood, every one, I believe, if he would look back, could bear testimony, and I need not dwell upon it here; but having in the poem regarded it as presumptive evidence of a prior state of existence, I think it right to protest against a conclusion, which has given pain to some good and pious persons, that I meant to inculcate such a belief. It is far too shadowy a notion to be recommended to faith, as more than an element in our instincts of immortality. But let us bear in mind that, though the idea is not advanced in revelation, there is nothing there to contradict it, and the fall of man presents an analogy in its favour. Accordingly, a pre-existent state has entered into the popular creeds of many nations; and, among all persons acquainted with classic literature, is known as an ingredient in Platonic philosophy. Archimedes said that he could move the world if he had a point whereon to rest his machine. Who has not felt the same aspirations as regards the world of his own mind?[\[310\]](#) Having to wield some of its elements when I was impelled to write this poem on the “Immortality of the Soul,” I took hold of the notion of pre-existence as having sufficient foundation in humanity for authorizing me to make for my purpose the best use of it I could as a poet.—I.F.]

The Child is Father of the Man;  
And I could wish my days to be  
Bound each to each by natural piety.[\[311\]](#)

## I

There was a time when meadow, grove, and stream,  
The earth, and every common sight,  
    To me did seem  
    Apparelled in celestial light,  
The glory and the freshness of a dream. 5  
It is not now as it hath [\[312\]](#) been of yore;—  
    Turn wheresoe'er I may,  
    By night or day,  
The things which I have seen I now can see no more.

## II

    The Rainbow comes and goes, 10  
    And lovely is the Rose,  
    The Moon doth with delight  
Look round her when the heavens are bare,  
    Waters on a starry night  
    Are beautiful and fair; 15  
    The sunshine is a glorious birth;  
    But yet I know, where'er I go,  
That there hath passed away a glory from the earth.

## III

Now, while the birds thus sing a joyous song,  
    And while the young lambs bound 20  
    As to the tabor's sound,  
To me alone there came a thought of grief:  
A timely utterance gave that thought relief,  
    And I again am strong:  
The cataracts blow their trumpets from the steep; 25

No more shall grief of mine the season wrong;  
I hear the Echoes through the mountains throng,  
The Winds come to me from the fields of sleep,  
    And all the earth is gay;  
        Land and sea 30  
    Give themselves up to jollity,  
    And with the heart of May  
    Doth every Beast keep holiday;—  
    Thou Child of Joy,  
Shout round me, let me hear thy shouts, thou happy Shepherd-boy! 35

#### IV

Ye blessed Creatures, I have heard the call  
    Ye to each other make; I see  
The heavens laugh with you in your jubilee;  
    My heart is at your festival,  
    My head hath its coronal,[\[313\]](#) 40  
The fulness of your bliss, I feel—I feel it all.[\[314\]](#)  
    Oh evil day! if I were sullen  
    While Earth herself is adorning,[\[315\]](#)  
        This sweet May-morning,  
    And the Children are culling[\[316\]](#) 45  
        On every side,  
    In a thousand valleys far and wide,  
    Fresh flowers; while the sun shines warm,  
And the Babe leaps up on his Mother's arm:—  
    I hear, I hear, with joy I hear! 50  
    —But there's a Tree, of many, one,  
A single Field which I have looked upon,  
Both of them speak of something that is gone:  
    The Pansy at my feet  
    Doth the same tale repeat: 55

Whither is fled the visionary gleam?  
Where is it now,[\[317\]](#) the glory and the dream?

## V

Our birth is but a sleep and a forgetting:  
The Soul that rises with us, our life's Star,  
    Hath had elsewhere its setting, 60  
    And cometh from afar:  
    Not in entire forgetfulness,  
    And not in utter nakedness,  
But trailing clouds of glory do we come  
    From God, who is our home: 65  
Heaven lies about us in our infancy!  
Shades of the prison-house begin to close  
    Upon the growing Boy,  
But He beholds the light, and whence it flows  
    He sees it in his joy; 70  
The Youth, who daily farther from the east  
    Must travel, still is Nature's Priest,  
    And by the vision splendid  
    Is on his way attended;  
At length the Man perceives it[\[318\]](#) die away, 75  
And fade into the light of common day.[\[319\]](#)

## VI

Earth fills her lap with pleasures[\[320\]](#) of her own;  
Yearnings she hath in her own natural kind,  
And, even with something of a Mother's mind,  
    And no unworthy aim, 80  
    The homely Nurse doth all she can  
To make her Foster-child, her Inmate Man,  
    Forget the glories he hath known.

And that imperial palace whence he came.

## VII

Behold the Child among his new-born blisses, 85

A six years' Darling<sup>[321]</sup> of a pigmy size!

See, where 'mid work of his own hand he lies,

Fretted by sallies of his mother's kisses,

With light upon him from his father's eyes!

See, at his feet, some little plan or chart, 90

Some fragment from his dream of human life,

Shaped by himself with newly-learned art;

    A wedding or a festival,

    A mourning or a funeral;

    And this hath now his heart, 95

And unto this he frames his song:

    Then will he fit his tongue

To dialogues of business, love, or strife;

    But it will not be long

    Ere this be thrown aside, 100

    And with new joy and pride

The little Actor cons another part;

Filling from time to time his "humorous stage"<sup>[322]</sup>

With all the Persons, down to palsied Age,

That Life brings with her in her equipage; 105

    As if his whole vocation

    Were endless imitation.

## VIII

Thou, whose exterior semblance<sup>[323]</sup> doth belie

    Thy Soul's immensity;

Thou best Philosopher, who yet dost keep 110

Thy heritage, thou Eye among the blind,  
That, deaf and silent, read'st the eternal deep,  
Haunted for ever by the eternal mind,—  
Mighty Prophet! Seer blest!  
On whom those truths do rest, 115  
Which we are toiling all our lives to find,  
In darkness lost, the darkness of the grave;[\[324\]](#)  
Thou, over whom thy Immortality  
Broods like the Day, a Master o'er a Slave,  
A Presence which is not to be put by;[\[325\]](#) 120  
Thou little Child, yet glorious in the might  
Of heaven-born freedom on thy being's height,[\[326\]](#)  
Why with such earnest pains dost thou provoke  
The years to bring the inevitable yoke,  
Thus blindly with thy blessedness at strife? 125  
Full soon thy Soul shall have her earthly freight,  
And custom[\[327\]](#) lie upon thee with a weight,[\[328\]](#)  
Heavy as frost, and deep almost as life!

## IX

O joy! that in our embers  
Is something that doth live, 130  
That nature yet remembers  
What was so fugitive!  
The thought of our past years in me doth breed  
Perpetual benediction;[\[329\]](#) not indeed  
For that which is most worthy to be blest; 135  
Delight and liberty, the simple creed  
Of Childhood, whether busy or at rest,  
With new-fledged hope still fluttering in his breast:—[\[330\]](#)  
Not for these I raise  
The song of thanks and praise; 140



But for those obstinate questionings  
Of sense and outward things,  
Fallings from us, vanishings;  
Blank misgivings of a Creature  
Moving about in worlds not realised, 145  
High instincts before which our mortal Nature  
Did tremble like a guilty Thing surprised:  
But for those first affections,  
Those shadowy recollections,  
Which, be they what they may, 150  
Are yet the fountain light of all our day,  
Are yet a master light of all our seeing;  
Uphold us, cherish, and have power to make [\[331\]](#)  
Our noisy years seem moments in the being  
Of the eternal Silence: truths that wake, 155  
To perish never;  
Which neither listlessness, nor mad endeavour,  
Nor Man nor Boy,  
Nor all that is at enmity with joy,  
Can utterly abolish or destroy! 160  
Hence in a season of calm weather,  
Though inland far we be,  
Our Souls have sight of that immortal sea  
Which brought us hither,  
Can in a moment travel thither, 165  
And see the Children sport upon the shore,  
And hear the mighty waters rolling evermore.

## X

Then sing, ye Birds, sing, sing a joyous song!  
And let the young Lambs bound  
As to the tabor's sound! 170

We in thought will join your throng,  
    Ye that pipe and ye that play,  
    Ye that through your hearts to-day  
    Feel the gladness of the May!  
What though the radiance which was once so bright 175  
Be now for ever taken from my sight,  
    Though nothing can bring back the hour  
Of splendour in the grass, of glory in the flower;  
    We will grieve not, rather find  
    Strength in what remains behind; 180  
    In the primal sympathy  
    Which having been must ever be;  
    In the soothing thoughts that spring  
    Out of human suffering;  
    In the faith that looks through death, 185  
In years that bring the philosophic mind.

## XI

And O, ye Fountains, Meadows, Hills, and Groves,  
Forebode not any severing[332] of our loves!  
Yet in my heart of hearts I feel your might;  
I only have relinquished one delight 190  
To live beneath your more habitual sway.  
I love the Brooks which down their channels fret,  
Even more than when I tripped lightly as they;  
The innocent brightness of a new-born Day  
    Is lovely yet; 195  
The Clouds that gather round the setting sun  
Do take a sober colouring from an eye  
That hath kept watch o'er man's mortality;  
Another race hath been, and other palms are won.[333]  
Thanks to the human heart by which we live, 200

Thanks to its tenderness, its joys, and fears,  
To me the meanest flower that blows<sup>[334]</sup> can give  
Thoughts that do often lie too deep for tears.<sup>[335]</sup>

This great *Ode* was first printed as the last poem in the second volume of the edition of 1807. At that date Wordsworth gave it the simple title *Ode*, prefixing to it the motto, “Paulò majora canamus.” In 1815, when he revised the poem throughout, he named it—in the characteristic manner of many of his titles—diffuse and yet precise, *Ode. Intimations of Immortality from Recollections of Early Childhood*; and he then prefixed to it the lines of his own earlier poem on the Rainbow (March 1802):—

The Child is Father of the Man;  
And I could wish my days to be  
Bound each to each by natural piety.

It retained this longer title and motto in all subsequent editions. In the editions 1807 to 1820, it was placed by itself at the end of the poems, and formed their natural conclusion and climax. In the editions 1827 and 1832, it was inappropriately put amongst “Epitaphs and Elegiac Poems.” The evident mistake of placing it amongst these seems to have suggested to Wordsworth, in 1836, its having a place by itself,—which he gave it then and retained in the subsequent editions of 1842 and 1849,—when it closed the series of minor poems in Volume v., and preceded the *Excursion* in Volume vi. The same arrangement was adopted in the double-columned single volume edition of 1845.

Mr. Aubrey de Vere has urged me to take it out of its chronological place, and let it conclude the whole series of Wordsworth’s poems, as the greatest, and that to which all others lead up. Mr. De Vere’s wish is based on conversations which he had with the poet himself.

The *Ode, Intimations of Immortality*, was written at intervals, between the years 1803 and 1806; and it was subjected to frequent and careful revision. No poem of Wordsworth’s bears more evident traces in its structure at once of inspiration and elaboration; of original flight of thought

and *afflatus* on the one hand, and on the other of careful sculpture and fastidious choice of phrase. But it is remarkable that there are very few changes of text in the successive editions. Most of the alterations were made before 1815, and the omission of some feeble lines which originally stood in stanza viii. in the editions of 1807 and 1815, was a great advantage in disencumbering the poem. The main revision and elaboration of this Ode, however—an elaboration which suggests the passage of the glacier ice over the rocks of White Moss Common, where the poem was murmured out stanza by stanza—was all finished before it first saw the light in 1807. In form it is irregular and original. And perhaps the most remarkable thing in its structure, is the frequent change of the keynote, and the skill and delicacy with which the transitions are made. “The feet throughout are iambic. The lines vary in length from the Alexandrine to the line with two accents. There is a constant ebb and flow in the full tide of song, but scarce two waves are alike.” (Hawes Turner, *Selections from Wordsworth*.)

In the “notes” to the *Selections* just referred to on Immortality, there is an excellent commentary on this *Ode*, almost every line of which is worthy of minute analysis and study. Some of the following are suggested by Mr. Turner’s notes.

(1) *The Winds come to me from the fields of sleep.*

The morning breeze blowing from the fields that were dark during the hours of sleep.

(2) —*But there’s a Tree, of many, one.*

Compare Browning’s *May and Death*—

Only one little sight, one plant  
Woods have in May, etc.

(3) *The Pansy at my feet*  
*Doth the same tale repeat.*

French “Pensée.” “Pansies, that’s for thoughts.” Ophelia in *Hamlet*.

(4) *Our birth is but a sleep and a forgetting.*

This thought Wordsworth owed, consciously or unconsciously, to Plato. Though he tells us in the Fenwick note that he did not mean to *inculcate* the belief, there is no doubt that he clung to the notion of a life pre-existing the present, on grounds similar to those on which he believed in a life to come. But there are some differences in the way in which the idea commended itself to Plato and to Wordsworth. The stress was laid by Wordsworth on the effect of terrestrial life in putting the higher faculties to sleep, and making us “forget the glories we have known.” Plato, on the other hand, looked upon the mingled experiences of mundane life as inducing a gradual but slow remembrance (ἀνάμνησις) of the past. Compare Tennyson’s *Two Voices*, and Wordsworth’s sonnet, beginning—

Man’s life is like a sparrow, mighty king.

(5) *Filling from time to time his “humorous stage”*  
*With all the Persons,*

*i.e.* with the *dramatis personæ*.

(6) ... *thou Eye among the blind,*  
*That, deaf and silent, read’st the eternal deep.*

There is an admirable parallel illustration of Wordsworth's use of this figure (describing one sense in terms of another), in the lines in *Airey-Force Valley*—

A soft eye-music of slow-waving boughs.

(7) *Full soon thy Soul shall have her earthly freight,  
And custom lie upon thee with a weight,  
Heavy as frost, and deep almost as life!*

Compare with this, the lines in the fourth book of *The Excursion*, beginning—

Alas! the endowment of immortal power  
Is matched unequally with custom, time.

(8) *Fallings from us, vanishings.*

The outward sensible universe, visible and tangible, seeming to fall away from us, as unreal, to vanish in unsubstantially. See the explanation of this youthful experience in the Fenwick note. That confession of his boyish days at Hawkshead, “many times, while going to school, have I grasped at a wall or tree, *to recall myself from this abyss of idealism to the reality*” (by which he explains those—

Fallings from us, vanishings, etc.),

suggests a similar experience and confession of Cardinal Newman's in his *Apologia* (see p. 67).

The late Rev. Robert Perceval Graves, of Windermere, and afterwards of Dublin, wrote to me in 1850:—"I remember Mr. Wordsworth saying, that at a particular stage of his mental progress, he used to be frequently so rapt into an unreal transcendental world of ideas that the external world seemed no longer to exist in relation to him, and he *had to reconvince himself of its existence by clasping a tree, or something that happened to be near him*. I could not help connecting this fact with that obscure passage in his great *Ode on the Intimations of Immortality*, in which he speaks of—

Those obstinate questionings  
Of sense and outward things;  
Fallings from us, vanishings; etc."

Professor Bonamy Price further confirms the explanation which Wordsworth gave of the passage, in a letter written to me in 1881, giving an account of a conversation he had with the poet, as follows:—

"OXFORD, April 21, 1881.

"MY DEAR SIR,—You will be glad, I am sure, to receive an interpretation, which chance enabled me to obtain from Wordsworth himself of a passage in the immortal *Ode on Immortality*....

"It happened one day that the poet, my wife, and I were taking a walk together by the side of Rydal Water. We were then by the sycamores under Nab Scar. The aged poet was in a most genial mood, and it suddenly occurred to me that I might, without unwarrantable presumption, seize the golden opportunity thus offered, and ask him to explain these mysterious words. So I addressed him with an apology, and begged him to explain, what my own feeble mother-wit was unable to unravel, and for which I had in vain sought the

assistance of others, what were those ‘fallings from us, vanishings,’ for which, above all other things, he gave God thanks. The venerable old man raised his aged form erect; he was walking in the middle, and passed across me to a five-barred gate in the wall which bounded the road on the side of the lake. He clenched the top bar firmly with his right hand, pushed strongly against it, and then uttered these ever-memorable words: ‘There was a time in my life when I had to push against something that resisted, to be sure that there was anything outside of me. I was sure of my own mind; everything else fell away, and vanished into thought.’ Thought, he was sure of; matter for him, at the moment, was an unreality—nothing but a thought. Such natural spontaneous idealism has probably never been felt by any other man.

“BONAMY PRICE.”

This, however, was not an experience peculiar to Wordsworth, as Professor Price imagined—and its value would be much lessened if it had been so—but was one to which (as the poet said to Miss Fenwick) “every one, if he would look back, could bear testimony.”

The following is from S.T. Coleridge’s *Biographia Literaria* (chap. xxii. p. 29, edition 1817)—

“To the *Ode on the Intimations of Immortality from Recollections of Early Childhood*, the poet might have prefixed the lines which Dante addresses to one of his own Canzoni—



Canzone, i' credo, che saranno radi  
Color che tua ragione intendan bene:  
Tanto lor sei faticoso ed alto.

O lyric song, there will be few, think I,  
Who may thy import understand aright:  
Thou art for them so arduous and so high!

But the Ode was intended for such readers only as had been accustomed to watch the flux and reflux of their inmost nature, to venture at times into the twilight realms of consciousness, and to feel a deep interest in modes of inmost being, to which they know that the attributes of time and space are inapplicable and alien, but which yet cannot be conveyed, save in symbols of time and space. For such readers the sense is sufficiently plain, and they will be as little disposed to charge Mr. Wordsworth with believing the Platonic pre-existence in the ordinary interpretation of the words, as I am to believe, that Plato himself ever meant or taught it.

πολλά μοι ὑπ' ἀγκῶνος ὠκέα βέλη  
ἔνδον ἐντὶ φαρέτρᾳς  
φωνᾶντα συνετοῖσιν ἔς  
δὲ τὸ πᾶν ἐρμηνέων  
χατίζει. σοφὸς ὁ πολλὰ εἰδὼς φυᾶ.  
μαθόντες δὲ λάβροι  
παγγλωσσία, κόρακες ὥς,  
ἄκραντα γαρύετον  
Διὸς πρὸς ὄρνιχα θεῖον.

PINDAR, OLYMP. ii.”[\[336\]](#)

The following parallel passages from *The Excursion*, *The Prelude*, Ruskin's *Modern Painters*, Keble's *Praelectiones de Poeticae vi Medica* (p. 788, Prael. xxxix.), and the *Silex Scintillans* of Henry Vaughan, are quoted,

in an interesting note to the *Ode* on Immortality, in Professor Henry Reed's American edition of the Poems (1851).

## I

Ah! why in age  
Do we revert so fondly to the walks  
Of childhood—but that there the Soul discerns  
The dear memorial footsteps unimpaired  
Of her own native vigour—thence can hear  
Reverberations; and a choral song,  
Commingling with the incense that ascends,  
Undaunted, toward the imperishable heavens,  
From her own lonely altar?

*The Excursion*, book ix. ll. 36-44.

## II

Our childhood sits,  
Our simple childhood, sits upon a throne  
That hath more power than all the elements.  
I guess not what this tells of Being past,  
Nor what it augurs of the life to come; etc.

*The Prelude*, book v. ll. 507-511.

## III

“... There was never yet the child of any promise (so far as the theoretic faculties are concerned) but awaked to the sense of beauty with the first gleam of reason; and I suppose there are few, among those who love Nature otherwise than by profession and at second-hand, who look not back to their youngest and least learned days as those of the most intense, superstitious,

insatiable, and beatific perception of her splendours. And the bitter decline of this glorious feeling, though many note it not, partly owing to the cares and weight of manhood, which leave them not the time nor the liberty to look for their lost treasure, and partly to the human and divine affections which are appointed to take its place, yet have formed the subject, not indeed of lamentation, but of holy thankfulness for the witness it bears to the immortal origin and end of our nature, to one whose authority is almost without appeal in all questions relating to the influence of external things upon the pure human soul.

Not for these I raise  
The song of thanks and praise  
But for those obstinate questionings, etc. etc.

And if it were possible for us to recollect all the unaccountable and happy instincts of the careless time, and to reason upon them with the maturer judgment, we might arrive at more right results than either the philosophy or the sophisticated practice of art has yet attained. But we love the perceptions before we are capable of methodising or comparing them.” (Ruskin’s *Modern Painters*, vol. ii. p. 36, part iii. ch. v. sec. i.)

“ ... Etenim qui velit acutius indagare causas propensae in antiqua saecula voluntatis, mirum ni conjectura incidat aliquando in commentum illud Pythagorae, docentis, animarum nostrarum non tum fieri initium, cum in hoc mundo nascimur; immo ex ignota quadam regione venire eas, in sua quamque corpora; neque tam penitus Lethaeo potu imbui, quin permanet quasi quidam anteactae aetatis sapor; hunc autem excitari identidem, et nescio quo sensu percipi, tacito quidem illo et obscuro, sed percipi tamen. Atque hac ferme sententia extat summi hac memoria Poetae nobilissimum carmen; nempe non aliam ob causam tangi pueritiae recordationem exquisita illa ac pervagata dulcedine, quam propter debilem quendam prioris aevi Deique propioris sensum.

Quamvis autem hanc opinionem vix ferat divinae philosophiae ratio, fatemur tamen eam eatenus ad verum accedere, quo sanctum aliquod et grave tribuit memoriae et caritati puerilium annorum. Nosmet certe infantes

novimus quam prope tetigerit Divina benignitas; quis porro scit, an omnis illa temporis anteacti dulcedo habeat quandam significationem Illius Praesentiae?” (Keble, *Praelectiones de Poeticae vi Medica*, p. 788, Prael. xxxix.)

“CORRUPTION

Sure, it was so. Man in those early days  
Was not all stone and earth;  
He shined a little, and by those weak rays,  
Had some glimpse of his birth.  
He saw Heaven o’er his head, and knew from whence  
He came condemned hither,  
And, as first Love draws strongest, so from hence  
His mind sure progressed thither.”

Henry Vaughan, *Silex Scintillans*.

Mr. Reed also quotes a passage from Vaughan’s poem *Childhood*; but a more apposite passage may be found in *The Retreate*, in *Silex Scintillans*.

Happy those early dayes, when I  
Shined in my Angell-infancy!  
Before I understood this place  
Appointed for my second race,  
Or taught my soul to fancy ought  
But a white celestiall thought;  
When yet I had not walkt above  
A mile or two from my first Love,  
And looking back, at that short space,  
Could see a glimpse of his bright face;  
When on some *gilded Cloud or Flowre*  
My gazing soul would dwell an houre,  
And in those weaker glories spy  
Some shadows of eternity;  
...  
But felt through all this fleshly dresse  
Bright *shootes* of everlastingnesse.

The extent of Wordsworth's debt to Vaughan has been discussed a good deal. There was no copy of the *Silex Scintillans* in the Rydal Mount sale-catalogue. I believe that he had read *The Retreat*, and forgotten it more completely perhaps than Coleridge forgot Sir John Davies' *Orchestra*, a *Poem on Dancing*, when he wrote *The Ancient Mariner*.

The following may be added from *The Friend* (the edition of 1818), vol. i. p. 183:—"To find no contradiction in the union of old and new to contemplate the Ancient of Days with feelings as fresh as if they then sprang forth at his own fiat, this characterizes the minds that feel the riddle of the world, and may help to unravel it! To carry on the feelings of childhood into the powers of manhood, to combine the child's sense of wonder and novelty with the appearances which every day, for perhaps 40 years, had rendered familiar,

With sun and moon and stars throughout the year  
And man and woman——

This is the character and privilege of genius, and one of the marks which distinguish genius from talent.”—ED.

[310] Compare the Atman of the Vedanta Philosophy.—ED.

[311] See vol. ii. p. 292.—ED.

[312] 1820.

... has ...

1807.

[313] Compare *The Idle Shepherd Boys*, ll. 28-30 (vol. ii. p. 138).—ED.

[314] 1807.

Even yet more gladness, I can hold it all.

MS.

[315] 1836.

While the Earth herself ...

1807.

... itself ...

1827.

The text of 1832 returns to that of 1807.

[316] 1836.

... pulling

1807.

[317]

Where is it gone, ...

MS.

[318] 1807.

... beholds it ...

MS.

[319] Compare, in Bacon's *Essay Of Youth and Age*, "A certaine Rabbine upon the Text, *Your Young Men shall see visions, and your Old Men shall dream dreames*, inferreth that Young Men are admitted nearer to God than Old, because *Vision* is a clearer Revelation than a Dreame."

See Professor Max Müller's note to his translation of the Upanishads (*Sacred Books of the East*, vol. xv. p. 164), beginning "Drivudagomga uses a curious argument in support of the existence of another world."—ED.

[320] 1807.

... pleasure ...

MS.

[321] 1815.

A four years' Darling ...

1807.

[322] See, in Daniel's *Musophilus*, the introductory sonnet to Fulke Greville, l. 1.—ED.

[323] 1807.

... presence ...

MS.

[324] This line is not in the editions of 1807 and 1815.

[325] The editions of 1807 and 1815 have, after "put by":

To whom the grave  
Is but a lowly bed without the sense or sight  
Of day or the warm light,  
A place of thought where we in waiting lie;

MS.

The subsequent omission of these lines was due to Coleridge's disapproval of them, expressed in *Biographia Literaria*.—ED.

[326] 1815.

Of untamed pleasures, on thy Being's height,  
1807.

[327] 1807.

The world upon thy noble nature seize  
With all its vanities,  
And custom ...

MS.

[328] Compare *The Excursion*, book iv. ll. 205, 206—

Alas! the endowment of immortal power  
Is matched unequally with custom, time.

ED.

[329] 1827.

Perpetual benedictions: ...  
1807.

[330] 1815.



Of Childhood, whether fluttering or at rest,  
With new-born hope for ever in his breast:

1807.

[331] 1815.

Uphold us, cherish us, and make

1807.

[332] 1836.

Think not of any severing ...

1807.

[333] Professor Dowden writes of this line: "It is a sunset reflection, natural to one who has 'kept watch o'er man's mortality': the day is closing, as human lives have closed; the sun went forth out of his chamber as a strong man to run a race, and now the race is over and the palm has been won: all things have their hour of fulfilment." (See vol. v. p. 365, of his edition of Wordsworth's Poems.)—ED.

[334] Compare the introduction to the first canto of *Marmion*—

The vernal sun new life bestows  
Upon the meanest flower that blows,

ED.

[335] Compare Wither's *The Shepherds Hunting*, the fourth eclogue, ll. 368-380.—ED.

[336] The text of Pindar, as given by S.T.C., is corrected in the above quotation.—ED.

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POEMS  
BY  
WILLIAM WORDSWORTH

AND BY  
DOROTHY WORDSWORTH  
NOT INCLUDED IN THE EDITION OF 1849-50

1787

SONNET, ON SEEING MISS HELEN MARIA WILLIAMS  
WEEP AT A TALE OF DISTRESS[\[337\]](#)

She wept.—Life's purple tide began to flow  
In languid streams through every thrilling vein;  
Dim were my swimming eyes—my pulse beat slow,  
And my full heart was swell'd to dear delicious pain.

Life left my loaded heart, and closing eye; 5  
A sigh recall'd the wanderer to my breast;  
Dear was the pause of life, and dear the sigh  
That call'd the wanderer home, and home to rest.

That tear proclaims—in thee each virtue dwells,  
And bright will shine in misery's midnight hour; 10  
As the soft star of dewy evening tells  
What radiant fires were drown'd by day's malignant pow'r,  
That only wait the darkness of the night  
To chear the wand'ring wretch with hospitable light.

AXIOLOGUS.

[European Magazine, 1787, vol. xi. p. 302.]

S.T.C. addressed some lines to Wordsworth under the name Axiologus. The following is a sample, sent to me by the late Mr. Dykes Campbell, *Ad Vilmum Axiologum*.—ED.[\[338\]](#)

## AD VILMUM AXIOLOGUM

This be the meed, that thy song creates a thousand-fold echo!  
Sweet as the warble of woods, that awakes at the gale of the morning!  
List! the Hearts of the Pure, like caves in the ancient mountains  
Deep, deep *in* the Bosom, and *from* the Bosom resound it,  
Each with a different tone, complete or in musical fragments—  
All have welcomed thy Voice, and receive and retain and prolong it!

This is the word of the Lord! it is spoken and Beings Eternal  
Live and are borne as an Infant, the Eternal begets the Immortal—  
Love is the Spirit of Life, and Music the Life of the Spirit!

[337] The only justification for republishing this sonnet is that it is the earliest authoritative record of Wordsworth's attempts in Verse. It is a much more authentic one than the *Extract from the conclusion of a Poem, composed in anticipation of leaving School*, or than the lines *Written in very early Youth*, and beginning

Calm is all nature as a resting wheel.

Wordsworth dated the former of these poems 1786, but I do not believe that he wrote that poem, and still less that he wrote "Calm is all nature," etc., *as we now have it*, in that year. Doubtless he wrote verses on these two subjects; but the best evidence against the notion that the text, as we now have it, was written in 1786, is this 1787 sonnet on Miss Maria Williams. It is not only dated authoritatively, but it was *published* in 1787; and therefore serves (as nothing else can until we come to 1793) as evidence in regard to the development of his poetic power. The translation of Francis Wrangham's lines—which he called *The Birth of Love*—in 1795, is further evidence in the same direction. No doubt there were many poor poetic utterances by Wordsworth later in life—failures in his manhood, as dismal as the "Walford Tragedy" was in his youth—but I think that the *Lines written in very early Youth*, and the *Extract from the Poem composed in anticipation of leaving School*, were rehandled by him, and the text greatly improved before they were first published. The late Mr. J. Dykes Campbell wrote to me in 1892: "Poets tell dreadful fibs about their early verses—as witness S.T.C. who declared he wrote *The Advent of Love* at fifteen! I *know* he didn't, and am going to print one or two of his prize school verses of that age, which I have found in his own fifteen-year-old fist."—ED.

[338] I should add, in a footnote, that I have no knowledge of the source whence Mr. Campbell derived this; but I am sure that it must have reached him

from an authentic one.—ED.

## **LINES WRITTEN BY WILLIAM WORDSWORTH AS A SCHOOL EXERCISE AT HAWKSHEAD, ANNO ÆTATIS 14**

In the “Autobiographical Memoranda”—dictated at Rydal Mount in 1847—Wordsworth said, “The first verses which I wrote were a task imposed by my master: the subject *The Summer Vacation*, and of my own accord I added others upon *Return to School*. There was nothing remarkable in either poem; but I was called upon, among other scholars, to write verses upon the completion of the second century from the foundation of the school in 1585, by Archbishop Sandys. These verses were much admired, far more than they deserved, for they were but a tame imitation of Pope’s versification, and a little in his style. This exercise, however, put it into my head to compose verses from the impulse of my own mind; and I wrote, while yet a schoolboy, a long poem running upon my own adventures, and the scenery of the county in which I was brought up.”

The *Summer Vacation*, and the *Return to School*, were destroyed by Wordsworth.—ED.

And has the Sun his flaming chariot driven  
Two hundred times around the ring of heaven,  
Since Science first, with all her sacred train,  
Beneath yon roof began her heavenly reign?  
While thus I mused, methought, before mine eyes, 5  
The Power of EDUCATION seemed to rise;  
Not she whose rigid precepts trained the boy  
Dead to the sense of every finer joy;  
Nor that vile wretch who bade the tender age  
Spurn Reason's law and humour Passion's rage; 10  
But she who trains the generous British youth  
In the bright paths of fair majestic Truth:  
Emerging slow from Academus' grove  
In heavenly majesty she seem'd to move.  
Stern was her forehead, but a smile serene 15  
"Softened the terrors of her awful mien."[\[339\]](#)  
Close at her side were all the powers, design'd  
To curb, exalt, reform the tender mind:  
With panting breast, now pale as winter snows,  
Now flushed as Hebe, Emulation rose; 20  
Shame follow'd after with reverted eye,  
And hue far deeper than the Tyrian dye;  
Last Industry appear'd with steady pace,  
A smile sat beaming on her pensive face.  
I gazed upon the visionary train, 25  
Threw back my eyes, return'd, and gazed again.  
When lo! the heavenly goddess thus began,  
Through all my frame the pleasing accents ran.

When Superstition left the golden light  
And fled indignant to the shades of night; 30  
When pure Religion rear'd the peaceful breast

And lull'd the warring passions into rest,  
Drove far away the savage thoughts that roll  
In the dark mansions of the bigot's soul,  
Enlivening Hope display'd her cheerful ray, 35  
And beam'd on Britain's sons a brighter day,  
So when on Ocean's face the storm subsides,  
Hush'd are the winds and silent are the tides;  
The God of day, in all the pomp of light,  
Moves through the vault of heaven, and dissipates the night; 40  
Wide o'er the main a trembling lustre plays,  
The glittering waves reflect the dazzling blaze;  
Science with joy saw Superstition fly  
Before the lustre of Religion's eye;  
With rapture she beheld Britannia smile, 45  
Clapp'd her strong wings, and sought the cheerful isle.  
The shades of night no more the soul involve,  
She sheds her beam, and, lo! the shades dissolve;  
No jarring monks, to gloomy cell confined,  
With mazy rules perplex the weary mind; 50  
No shadowy forms entice the soul aside,  
Secure she walks, Philosophy her guide.  
Britain, who long her warriors had adored,  
And deemed all merit centred in the sword;  
Britain, who thought to stain the field was fame, 55  
Now honour'd Edward's less than Bacon's name.  
Her sons no more in listed fields advance  
To ride the ring, or toss the beamy lance;  
No longer steel their indurated hearts  
To the mild influence of the finer arts; 60  
Quick to the secret grotto they retire  
To court majestic truth, or wake the golden lyre;  
By generous Emulation taught to rise,  
The seats of learning brave the distant skies.

Then noble Sandys, inspir'd with great design, 65  
Rear'd Hawkshead's happy roof, and call'd it mine;  
There have I loved to show the tender age  
The golden precepts of the classic page;  
To lead the mind to those Elysian plains  
Where, throned in gold, immortal Science reigns; 70  
Fair to the view is sacred Truth display'd,  
In all the majesty of light array'd,  
To teach, on rapid wings, the curious soul  
To roam from heaven to heaven, from pole to pole,  
From thence to search the mystic cause of things 75  
And follow Nature to her secret springs;  
Nor less to guide the fluctuating youth  
Firm in the sacred paths of moral truth,  
To regulate the mind's disorder'd frame,  
And quench the passions kindling into flame; 80  
The glimmering fires of Virtue to enlarge,  
And purge from Vice's dross my tender charge.  
Oft have I said, the paths of Fame pursue,  
And all that virtue dictates, dare to do;  
Go to the world, peruse the book of man, 85  
And learn from thence thy own defects to scan;  
Severely honest, break no plighted trust,  
But coldly rest not here—be more than just;  
Join to the rigours of the sires of Rome  
The gentler manners of the private dome; 90  
When Virtue weeps in agony of woe,  
Teach from the heart the tender tear to flow;  
If Pleasure's soothing song thy soul entice,  
Or all the gaudy pomp of splendid Vice,  
Arise superior to the Siren's power, 95  
The wretch, the short-lived vision of an hour;  
Soon fades her cheek her blushing beauties fly



SOON fades her cheek, her blushing cheeks fly,  
As fades the chequer'd bow that paints the sky,  
So shall thy sire, whilst hope his breast inspires,  
And wakes anew life's glimmering trembling fires, 100  
Hear Britain's sons rehearse thy praise with joy,  
Look up to heaven, and bless his darling boy.  
If e'er these precepts quell'd the passions' strife,  
If e'er they smooth'd the rugged walks of life,  
If e'er they pointed forth the blissful way 105  
That guides the spirit to eternal day,  
Do thou, if gratitude inspire thy breast,  
Spurn the soft fetters of lethargic rest.  
Awake, awake! and snatch the slumbering lyre,  
Let this bright morn and Sandys the song inspire. 110

I look'd obedience: the celestial Fair  
Smiled like the morn, and vanished into air.

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[339] This quotation I am unable to trace—ED.



Sweet was the walk along the narrow lane  
At noon, the bank and hedgerows all the way  
Shagged with wild pale green tufts of fragrant hay,  
Caught by the hawthorns from the loaded wain  
Which Age, with many a slow stoop, strove to gain; 5  
And Childhood seeming still more busy, took  
His little rake with cunning sidelong look,  
Sauntering to pluck the strawberries wild unseen.  
Now too, on melancholy's idle dream  
Musing, the lone spot with my soul agrees 10  
Quiet and dark; for through the thick-wove trees  
Scarce peeps the curious star till solemn gleams  
The clouded moon, and calls me forth to stray  
Through tall green silent woods and ruins grey.

### **“WHEN LOVE WAS BORN OF HEAVENLY LINE”**

Composed 1795 (or earlier).—Published 1795

Translated from some French stanzas by Francis Wrangham, and Printed in *Poems by Francis Wrangham*, M.A., Member of Trinity College, Cambridge, London (1795), Sold by J. Mawman, 22 Poultry, pp. 106-111. In the edition of 1795, the original French lines are printed side by side with Wordsworth's translation, which closes the volume.—ED.

When Love was born of heavenly line,  
What dire intrigues disturb'd Cythera's joy!  
Till Venus cried, "A mother's heart is mine;  
None but myself shall nurse my boy."

But, infant as he was, the child 5  
In that divine embrace enchanted lay;  
And, by the beauty of the vase beguiled,  
Forgot the beverage—and pined away.

"And must my offspring languish in my sight?"  
(Alive to all a mother's pain, 10  
The Queen of Beauty thus her court address'd)  
"No: Let the most discreet of all my train  
Receive him to her breast:  
Think all, he is the God of young delight."

Then TENDERNESS with CANDOUR join'd, 15  
And GAIETY the charming office sought;  
Nor even DELICACY stay'd behind:  
But none of those fair Graces brought  
Wherewith to nurse the child—and still he pined.  
Some fond hearts to COMPLIANCE seem'd inclined; 20  
But she had surely spoil'd the boy:  
And sad experience forbade a thought  
On the wild Goddess of VOLUPTUOUS JOY.

Long undecided lay th' important choice,  
Till of the beauteous court, at length, a voice 25  
Pronounced the name of HOPE:—The conscious child  
Stretch'd forth his little arms, and smiled.[\[340\]](#)

'Tis said ENJOYMENT (who averr'd

The charge belong'd to her alone)  
Jealous that HOPE had been preferr'd 30  
Laid snares to make the babe her own.

Of INNOCENCE the garb she took,  
The blushing mien and downcast look;  
And came her services to proffer:  
And HOPE (what has not Hope believed!) 35  
By that seducing air deceived,  
Accepted of the offer.

It happen'd that, to sleep inclined,  
Deluded HOPE for one short hour  
To that false INNOCENCE'S power 40  
Her little charge consign'd.

The Goddess then her lap with sweetmeats fill'd  
And gave, in handfuls gave, the treacherous store:  
A wild delirium first the infant thrill'd;  
But soon upon her breast he sunk—to wake no more. 45

[340] Compare Gray's *Progress of Poesy*, iii. I. 87—

The dauntless child  
Stretch'd forth his little arms, and smiled.

ED.

## THE CONVICT

Composed (?).—Published 1798



The glory of evening was spread through the west;  
—On the slope of a mountain I stood,  
While the joy that precedes the calm season of rest  
Rang loud through the meadow and wood.

“And must we then part from a dwelling so fair?” 5  
In the pain of my spirit I said,  
And with a deep sadness I turned, to repair  
To the cell where the convict is laid.

The thick-ribbed walls that o’ershadow the gate  
Resound; and the dungeons unfold: 10  
I pause; and at length, through the glimmering grate,  
That outcast of pity behold.

His black matted hair on his shoulder is bent,  
And deep is the sigh of his breath,  
And with stedfast dejection his eyes are intent 15  
On the fetters that link him to death.

’Tis sorrow enough on that visage to gaze,  
That body dismiss’d from his care;  
Yet my fancy has pierced to his heart, and pourtrays  
More terrible images there. 20

His bones are consumed, and his life-blood is dried,  
With wishes the past to undo;  
And his crime, through the pains that o’erwhelm him, descried,  
Still blackens and grows on his view.

When from the dark synod, or blood-reeking field, 25  
To his chamber the monarch is led,  
All soothers of sense their soft virtue shall yield,  
And quietness pillow his head

And quietness pillow his head.

But if grief, self-consumed, in oblivion would doze,  
And conscience her tortures appease, 30  
'Mid tumult and uproar this man must repose,  
In the comfortless vault of disease.

When his fetters at night have so press'd on his limbs,  
That the weight can no longer be borne,  
If, while a half-slumber his memory bedims, 35  
The wretch on his pallet should turn,

While the jail-mastiff howls at the dull clanking chain,  
From the roots of his hair there shall start  
A thousand sharp punctures of cold-sweating pain,  
And terror shall leap at his heart. 40

But now he half-raises his deep-sunken eye,  
And the motion unsettles a tear;  
The silence of sorrow it seems to supply,  
And asks of me why I am here.

"Poor victim! no idle intruder has stood 45  
With o'erweening complacence our state to compare,  
But one, whose first wish is the wish to be good,  
Is come as a brother thy sorrows to share.

"At thy name though compassion her nature resign,  
Though in virtue's proud mouth thy report be a stain, 50  
My care, if the arm of the mighty were mine,  
Would plant thee where yet thou might'st blossom again."

---





1798

**“THE SNOW-TRACKS OF MY FRIENDS I SEE”**

The following incomplete stanzas were evidently written when *The Complaint of a Forsaken Indian Woman* was being composed. They were all discarded, but have a biographical interest. I assign them to the year 1798.—ED.

The snow-tracks of my friends I see,  
Their foot-marks do not trouble me,  
For ever left alone am I.  
Then wherefore should I fear to die?  
They to the last my friends did cherish 5  
And to the last were good and kind,  
Methinks 'tis strange I did not perish  
The moment I was left behind.

Why do I watch those running deer?  
And wherefore, wherefore come they here? 10  
And wherefore do I seem to love  
The things that live, the things that move?  
Why do I look upon the sky?  
I do not live for what I see.  
Why open thus mine eyes? To die 15  
Is all that now is left for me,  
If I could smother up my heart  
My life would then at once depart.  
My friends, you live, and yet you seem  
To me the people of a dream; 20  
A dream in which there is no love,  
And yet, my friends, you live and move.

When I could live without a pain,  
And feel no wish to be alive,  
In quiet hopelessness I sleep, 25  
Alas! how quiet, and how deep!

Oh no! I do not, cannot rue,  
I did not strive to follow you.  
I might have dropp'd, and died alone  
On unknown snows. a spot unknown. 30

... ..  
This spot to me must needs be dear,  
Of my dear friends I see the trace.  
You saw me, friends, you laid me here,  
You know where my poor bones shall be,  
Then wherefore should I fear to die? 35  
Alas that one beloved, forlorn,  
Should lie beneath the cold starlight!  
With them I think I could have borne  
The journey of another night,  
And with my friends now far away 40  
I could have lived another day.

## **THE OLD CUMBERLAND BEGGAR**

MS. Variants, not inserted in Vol. I.

(l. 3) On a small pile of humble masonry  
Placed at the foot of ...

(l. 24) He travels on, a solitary man.  
His age has no companion. He is weak,  
So helpless in appearance that, for him  
The sauntering horseman-traveller does not throw  
With careless hand his pence upon the ground  
But stops that he may lodge the coin  
Safe in the old man's hat: nor quits him so,  
But as he goes towards him turns a look  
Sidelong and half-reverted....

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**1800**

**ANDREW JONES**

Composed 1800.—Published 1800

*Andrew Jones* was included in the “Lyrical Ballads” of 1800, 1802, 1805, and in the Poems of 1815. It was also printed in *The Morning Post*, February 10, 1801. It was not republished after 1815. With this poem compare *The Old Cumberland Beggar*.—ED.

I hate that Andrew Jones; he'll breed  
His children up to waste and pillage.  
I wish the press-gang or the drum  
Would with its rattling music come,[\[341\]](#)  
And sweep him from the village! 5

I said not this, because he loves  
Through the long day to swear and tittle;  
But for the poor dear sake of one  
To whom a foul deed he had done,  
A friendless man, a travelling cripple! 10  
For this poor crawling helpless wretch  
Some horseman who was passing by,[\[342\]](#)  
A penny on the ground had thrown;  
But the poor cripple was alone  
And could not stoop—no help was nigh. 15

Inch-thick the dust lay on the ground  
For it had long been drougty weather;  
So with his staff the cripple wrought  
Among the dust till he had brought  
The half-pennies together. 20

It chanced that Andrew passed that way  
Just at the time; and there he found  
The cripple in the mid-day heat  
Standing alone, and at his feet  
He saw the penny on the ground. 25

He stooped and took the penny up:[\[343\]](#)  
And when the cripple nearer drew,  
Quoth Andrew, "Under half-a-crown,  
What a man finds is all his own.

And so, my friend, good-day to you.” 30

And *hence* I said, that Andrew’s boys  
Will all be trained to waste and pillage:  
And wished the press-gang, or the drum  
Would with its rattling music come, [344]  
And sweep him from the village! 35

[341] 1815.

With its tantara sound would come,  
1800.

[342]

It chanc’d some Traveller passing by,  
MS.

[343] In the text of 1800, this line is, “He stopped and took the penny up,” but in the list of *errata*, “stooped” is substituted for “stopped.”—ED.

[344] 1815.

With its tantara sound would come  
1800.

## “THERE IS A SHAPELESS CROWD OF UNHEWN STONES”

Numerous fragments of verse, more or less unfinished, occur in the Grasmere Journals, written by Dorothy Wordsworth. One of these—which is broken up into irregular fragments, and very incomplete—is evidently part of the material which was written about the old Cumbrian shepherd Michael. The successive alterations of the text of the poem *Michael* are in

the Grasmere Journal. These fragments have a special topographical interest, from their description of Helvellyn, and its spring, the fountain of the mists, and the stones on the summit. On the outside leather cover of the MS. book there is written, "May to Dec. 1802."

The following lines come first:—

There is a shapeless crowd of unhewn stones<sup>[345]</sup>  
That lie together, some in heaps, and some  
In lines, that seem to keep themselves alive  
In the last dotage of a dying form.  
At least so seems it to a man who stands  
In such a lonely place.

These are followed by a few lines, some of which were afterwards used in *The Prelude* (see vol. iii. p. 269):—

Shall he who gives his days to low pursuits,  
Amid the undistinguishable crowd  
Of cities, 'mid the same eternal flow  
Of the same objects, melted and reduced  
To one identity, by differences  
That have no law, no meaning, and no end,  
Shall he feel yearning to those lifeless forms,  
And shall we think that Nature is less kind  
To those, who all day long, through a long life,  
Have walked within her sight? It cannot be.

Mary Wordsworth, Dorothy Wordsworth, William Wordsworth.  
Sat. Eve., 20 past 6, May 29.



Other fragments follow, less worthy of preservation. Then the passage, which occurs in book xiii. of *The Prelude*, beginning—

There are who think that strong affection, love,

(see vol. iii. p. 361), with one or two variations from the final text, which were not improvements.

Five lines on Helvellyn, afterwards included in the *Musings near Aquapendente* (see vol. viii. p. 47, ll. 61-65), come next.

The fragments referring to *Michael* are written down, probably just as the brother dictated them to his sister, and would be—if not unintelligible—certainly without any literary connection or unity, were they printed in the order in which they occur. I therefore transpose them slightly, to give something like continuity to the whole; which remains, of course, a torso.

...

At the first falling of the autumnal snows,  
Old Michael and his son one day went forth  
In search of a stray sheep. It was the time  
When from the heights our shepherds drive their flocks  
To gather all their mountain family  
Into the homestalls, ere they send them back  
There to defend themselves the winter long.  
Old Michael for this purpose had driven down  
His flock into the vale, but as it chanced,  
A single sheep was wanting. They had sought  
The straggler during all the previous day  
All over their own pastures, and beyond.  
And now at sunrise, sallying forth again  
Far did they go that morning: with their search  
Beginning towards the south, where from Dove Crag  
(Ill home for bird so gentle), they looked down  
On Deep-dale-head, and Brothers water (named  
From those two Brothers that were drowned therein);  
Thence northward did they pass by Arthur's seat,[\[346\]](#)  
And Fairfield's highest summit, on the right  
Leaving St. Sunday's Crag, to Grisdale tarn  
They shot, and over that cloud-loving hill,  
Seat-Sandal, a fond lover of the clouds;  
Thence up Helvellyn, a superior mount,  
With prospect underneath of Striding edge,  
And Grisdale's houseless vale, along the brink  
Of Sheep-cot-cove, and those two other coves,

|    |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
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|----|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|

Huge skeletons of crags which from the coast  
Of old Helvellyn spread their arms abroad  
And make a stormy harbour for the winds.  
Far went these shepherds in their devious quest,  
From mountain ridges peeping as they passed  
Down into every nook; ...

... and many a sheep  
On height or bottom<sup>[347]</sup> did they see, in flocks  
Or single. And although it needs must seem  
Hard to believe, yet could they well discern  
Even at the utmost distance of two miles  
(Such strength of vision to the shepherd's eye  
Doth practice give) that neither in the flocks  
Nor in the single sheep was what they sought.  
So to Helvellyn's eastern side they went,  
Down looking on that hollow, where the pool  
Of Thirlmere flashes like a warrior's shield  
His light high up among the gloomy rocks,  
With sight of now and then a straggling gleam  
On Armath's<sup>[348]</sup> pleasant fields. And now they came,  
To that high spring which bears no human name,  
As one unknown by others, aptly called  
The fountain of the mists. The father stooped  
To drink of the clear water, laid himself  
Flat on the ground, even as a boy might do,  
To drink of the cold well. When in like sort  
His son had drunk, the old man said to him  
That now he might be proud, for he that day  
Had slaked his thirst out of a famous well,  
The highest fountain known on British land.  
Thence, journeying on a second time, they passed  
Those small flat stones, which, ranged by traveller's hands  
In cyphers on Helvellyn's highest ridge,  
Lie loose on the bare turf, some half a dozen in

Lie loose on the bare turf, some half-erogrown  
By the grey moss, but not a single stone  
Unsettled by a wanton blow from foot  
Of shepherd, man or boy. They have respect  
For strangers who have travelled far perhaps,  
For men who in such places, feeling there  
The grandeur of the earth, have left inscribed  
Their epitaph, which rain and snow  
And the strong wind have revered.

...

But soon as Luke, full ten years old, could stand  
Against the mountain blasts, and to the heights  
Not fearing toil, nor length of weary ways,  
He with his Father daily went, and they  
Were as companions, why should I relate  
That objects which the shepherd lov'd before  
Were dearer now? that from the Boy there came  
Feelings and emanations, things which were  
Light to the sun and music to the wind;  
And that the old man's heart seem'd born again?

Thus in his Father's sight the Boy grew up;  
And now when he had reached his eighteenth year,  
He was his comfort and his daily hope.

...

Though often thus industriously they passed<sup>[349]</sup>  
Whole hours with but small interchange of speech,  
Yet were there times in which they did not want  
Discourse both wise and pleasant,<sup>[350]</sup> shrewd remarks  
Of moral prudence,<sup>[351]</sup> clothed in images  
Lively and beautiful, in rural forms,  
That made their conversation fresh and fair  
As is a landscape; and the shepherd oft  
Would draw out of his heart the mysteries<sup>[352]</sup>

A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

And admirations that were there, of God  
And of his works: or, yielding to the bent  
Of his peculiar humour, would let loose  
His tongue, and give it the wind's freedom; then,  
Discoursing on remote imaginations, strong  
Conceits, devices, plans, and schemes,[\[353\]](#)  
Of alterations human hands might make  
Among the mountains, fens which might be drained,  
Mines opened, forests planted, and rocks split,  
The fancies of a solitary man.[\[354\]](#)  
Not with a waste of words, but for the sake  
Of pleasure which I know that I shall give  
To many living now, have I described  
Old Michael's manners and discourse, and thus  
Minutely spoken of that aged Lamp  
Round which the Shepherd and his household sate  
—The light was famous in the neighbourhood  
And was a public symbol ...

Then follow four pages of Dorothy Wordsworth's Journal (May 4th and 5th, 1802); and then, irregularly written, and with numerous erasures, the remainder of these unpublished lines.



... At length the boy  
Said, "Father, 'tis lost labour; with your leave  
I will go back and range a second time  
The grounds which we have hunted through before."  
So saying, homeward, down the hill the boy  
Sprang like a gust of wind: [and with a heart  
Brimful of glory said within himself,  
"I know where I shall find him, though the storm  
Have driven him twenty miles."  
For ye must know][\[355\]](#) that though the storm  
Drive one of those poor creatures miles and miles,  
If he can crawl, he will return again  
To his own hills, the spots where when a lamb  
He learned to pasture at his mother's side.  
Bethinking him of this, again the boy  
Pursued his way toward a brook, whose course  
Was through that unfenced tract of mountain ground  
Which to his father's little farm belonged,  
The home and ancient birthright of their flock.  
Down the deep channel of the stream he went,  
Prying through every nook. Meanwhile the rain  
Began to fall upon the mountain tops,  
Thick storm, and heavy, which for three hours' space  
Abated not; and all that time the boy  
Was busy in his search, until at length  
He spied the sheep upon a plot of grass,  
An island in the brook. It was a place  
Remote and deep, piled round with rocks, where foot  
Of man or beast was seldom used to tread.  
But now, when everywhere the summer grass  
Began to fail, this sheep by hunger pressed  
Had left his fellows, made his way alone

THE LITTLE FAULT-FINDER

to the green plot or pasture in the brook.  
Before the boy knew well what he had seen  
He leapt upon the island, with proud heart,  
And with a shepherd's joy. Immediately  
The sheep sprang forward to the further shore,  
And was borne headlong by the roaring flood.  
At this the boy looked round him, and his heart  
Fainted with fear. Thrice did he turn his face  
To either bank, nor could he summon up  
The courage that was needful to leap back  
'Cross the tempestuous torrent; so he stood  
A prisoner on the island, not without  
More than one thought of death, and his last hour.  
Meantime the father had returned alone  
To his own home, and now at the approach  
Of evening he went forth to meet his son,  
Nor could he guess the cause for which the boy  
Had stayed so long. The shepherd took his way  
Up his own mountain grounds, where, as he walked  
Along the steep that overhung the brook,  
He seemed to hear a voice, which was again  
Repeated, like the whistling of a kite.  
At this, not knowing why—as often-times  
The old man afterwards was heard to say—  
Down to the brook he went, and tracked its course  
Upwards among the o'erhanging rocks; nor  
Had he gone far ere he espied the boy  
Right in the middle of the roaring stream.  
Without distress or fear the shepherd heard  
The outcry of his son: he stretched his staff  
Towards him, bade him leap, which word scarce said  
The boy was safe....

...



Of Michael it is said—

No doubt if you in terms direct had asked  
Whether he loved the mountains, true it is  
That with blunt repetition of your words  
He might have stared at you, and said that they  
Were frightful to behold, but had you then  
Discoursed with him ...  
Of his own business, and the goings on  
Of earth and sky, then truly had you seen  
That in his thoughts there were obscurities,  
Wonder, and admiration, things that wrought  
Not less than a religion in his heart.  
And if it was his fortune to converse  
With any who could talk of common things  
In an unusual way, and give to them  
Unusual aspects, or by questions apt  
Wake sudden recognitions, that were like  
Creations in the mind (and were indeed  
Creations often), then when he discoursed  
Of mountain sights, this untaught shepherd stood  
Before the man with whom he so conversed  
And looked at him as with a poet's eye.  
But speaking of the vale in which he dwelt,  
And those bare rocks, if you had asked if he  
For other pastures would exchange the same  
And dwell elsewhere, ...

... you then had seen  
At once what spirit of love was in his heart.

...

I have related that this Shepherd loved  
The fields and mountains, not alone for this  
That from his very childhood he had lived  
Among them, with a body hale and stout,  
And with a vigorous mind

And with a vigorous mind ...

... But exclude

Such reasons, and he had less cause to love  
His native vale and patrimonial fields  
Than others have, for Michael had liv'd on  
Childless, until the time when he began  
To look towards the shutting in of life.

In this MS. book there are also some of the original stanzas of *Ruth*, with a few variations of text.—ED.

[345] Compare the first line of those *Written with a Slate Pencil upon a Stone, the largest of a Heap lying near a deserted Quarry, upon one of the Islands at Rydal*, vol. ii. p. 63.—ED.

[346] Stone Arthur. See, in the “Poems on the Naming of Places,” the one beginning—

There is an Eminence,

ED.

[347] Bottom is a common Cumbrian word for valley.—ED.

[348] Armboth, on the western side of Thirlmere.—ED.

[349] Though in these occupations they would pass†

[350] ... prudent, ...†

[351] Of daily Providence ...†

[352] ... obscurities†

[353] Day-dreams, thoughts, and schemes.†

† These variants occur in a letter of Dorothy Wordsworth to Thomas Poole.—ED.

[354] All doubt as to these fragments being originally intended to form part of *Michael* is set at rest by a letter from Wordsworth to Thomas Poole, of Nether Stowey, written from Grasmere on the 9th of April 1801, in which he gives first some new lines to be added to *Michael*, at pp. 210 and 211 of vol. ii. of the “Lyrical Ballads” (ed. 1800); to which letter Dorothy Wordsworth added the postscript, “My brother has written the following lines, to be inserted page 206, after the ninth line—

Murmur as with the sound of summer flies;”

and then follow—

Though in these occupations they would pass  
Whole hours, etc.

as printed above.

Dorothy Wordsworth adds, “Tell whether you think the insertion of these lines an improvement.”—ED.

[\[355\]](#) An erased version.—ED.

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1802

**“AMONG ALL LOVELY THINGS MY LOVE HAD BEEN”**

Composed April 12, 1802.—Published 1807

This poem—known in the Wordsworth household as *The Glowworm*—was written on the 12th of April 1802, during a ride from Middleham to Barnard Castle, and was published in the edition of 1807. It was never reproduced. The “Lucy” of this and other poems was his sister Dorothy. In a letter to Coleridge, written in April 1802, he thus refers to the poem, and to the incident which gave rise to it:—“I parted from M—— on Monday afternoon, about six o’clock, a little on this side Rushyford. Soon after I missed my road in the midst of the storm.... Between the beginning of Lord Darlington’s park at Raby, and two or three miles beyond Staindrop, I composed the poem the opposite page. I reached Barnard Castle about half-past ten.... The incident of this poem took place about seven years ago between my sister and me.”

I think it probable that the “incident” occurred near Racedown, Dorsetshire, where, in the autumn of 1795 Wordsworth settled with his sister. The following is Dorothy’s account of the composition of the poem:—“Tuesday, April 20, 1802.—We sate in the orchard and repeated *The Glowworm*, and other poems. Just when William came to a well, or trough, which there is in Lord Darlington’s park, he began to write that poem of *The Glowworm*; interrupted in going through the town of Staindrop, finished it about two miles and a-half beyond Staindrop. He did not feel the jogging of the horse while he was writing; but, when he had done, he felt the effect of it.... So much for *The Glowworm*. It was written coming from Middleham, on Monday, April 12, 1802.”—ED.

Among all lovely things my Love had been;  
Had noted well the stars, all flowers that grew  
About her home; but she had never seen  
A glow-worm, never one, and this I knew.

While riding near her home one stormy night 5  
A single glow-worm did I chance to espy;  
I gave a fervent welcome to the sight,  
And from my horse I leapt; great joy had I.

Upon a leaf the glow-worm did I lay,  
To bear it with me through the stormy night: 10  
And, as before, it shone without dismay;  
Albeit putting forth a fainter light.

When to the dwelling of my Love I came,  
I went into the orchard quietly;  
And left the glow-worm, blessing it by name, 15  
Laid safely by itself, beneath a tree.

The whole next day I hoped, and hoped with fear;  
At night the glow-worm shone beneath the tree;  
I led my Lucy to the spot, "Look here,"  
Oh! joy it was for her, and joy for me! 20

### **"ALONG THE MAZES OF THIS SONG I GO"**

This, and the next two fragments, by Wordsworth, are extracted from his sister's Grasmere Journal.—ED.

Along the mazes of this song I go  
As inward motions of the wandering thought  
Lead me, or outward circumstance impels.  
Thus do I urge a never-ending way  
Year after year, with many a sleep between,  
Through joy and sorrow; if my lot be joy  
More joyful if it be with sorrow sooth'd.

**“THE RAINS AT LENGTH HAVE CEAS’D, THE WINDS  
ARE STILL’D”**

The rains at length have ceas’d, the winds are still’d,  
The stars shine brightly between clouds at rest,  
And as a cavern is with darkness fill’d,  
The vale is by a mighty sound possess’d

**“WITNESS THOU”**

Witness thou  
The dear companion of my lonely walk,  
My hope, my joy, my sister, and my friend,  
Or something dearer still, if reason knows  
A dearer thought, or in the heart of love  
There be a dearer name.[\[356\]](#)

[\[356\]](#) Compare Byron’s *Epistle to Augusta*—

My sister! my sweet sister! if a name  
Dearer and purer were, it should be thine.

It is a mere coincidence, as Byron could not have seen the Wordsworth MS.—  
ED.

## WILD-FOWL

The order'd troops  
In spiral circles mount aloft, and soar  
In prospect far above the denser air  
That hangs o'er the moist plain. Again they view  
The glorious sun, and while the light of day  
Still gleams upon their polish'd plumes—the bright  
Sonorous squadrons sing their evening hymn.

## WRITTEN IN A GROTTO

Published in *The Morning Post*, March 9, 1802

I cannot affirm, with any certainty, that these lines were written by Wordsworth; but I agree with Mr. Ernest Coleridge in thinking that they were. He showed them to his relative—the late Chief Justice—who said that he did not know who else *could* have written them, at that time. Lord Coleridge said the same to myself.—ED.



O moon! if e'er I joyed when thy soft light  
     Danc'd to the murmuring rill on Lomond's wave,  
 Or sighed for thy sweet presence some dark night  
     When thou wert hidden in thy monthly grave,<sup>[357]</sup>  
 If e'er on wings which active fancy gave 5  
     I sought thy golden vale with dancing flight  
 Then stretcht at ease in some sequestered cave  
     Gaz'd on thy lovely Nymphs with fond delight,  
 Thy Nymphs with more than earthly beauty bright,  
 If e'er thy beam, as Smyrna's shepherds tell, 10  
     Soft as the gentle kiss of amorous maid  
 On the closed eye of young Endymion fell<sup>[358]</sup>  
     That he might wake to clasp thee in the shade,  
 Each night while I recline within this cell  
 Guide hither, O sweet Moon, the maid I love so well. 15

The shepherds of Smyrna show a cave, where, as they say, Luna descended to Endymion, laid on a bed under a large oak which was the scene of their loves. See Chandler's *Travels in Asia Minor*.

<sup>[357]</sup> Compare *To the Moon*, vol. viii. p. 15, l. 64.—ED.

<sup>[358]</sup> Compare, in the "Evening Voluntaries," *To Lucca Giordano* (1846), p. 183.—ED.

## HOME AT GRASMERE

The canto of Wordsworth's autobiographical poem, unpublished in *The Prelude* (1851), and first given to the world in 1888, is appropriately entitled "Home at Grasmere."

The introduction to *The Recluse* was not only kept back by him during his lifetime, but was omitted by his representatives—with what must be regarded as true critical insight—when *The Prelude* was published in 1850. As a whole, it is not equal to *The Prelude*. Certain passages are very

inferior, but there are others that posterity must cherish, and “not willingly let die.” It was probably a conviction of its inequality and inferiority that led Wordsworth to give only one or two selected extracts from this canto to the world, in his own lifetime. Two passages were printed in his *Guide to the District of the Lakes*; another—a description of the flight and movement of birds—was published in 1827, and subsequent editions, under the title of *Water-Fowl*; while the Bishop of Lincoln published other two passages in the *Memoirs* of his uncle, beginning respectively—

On Nature’s invitation do I come,

and

Bleak season was it, turbulent and bleak.

Internal evidence (see the numerous allusions to Dorothy, and the reference to John Wordsworth) shows that this canto of *The Recluse* was written at Grasmere, not long after Wordsworth’s arrival there, and certainly before his marriage. The text, as now printed, has been carefully compared with the original MS. by Mr. Gordon Wordsworth. The MS. heading is—  
THE RECLUSE. BOOK FIRST, PART FIRST.

## HOME AT GRASMERE

Once to the verge of yon steep barrier came  
A roving school-boy; what the Adventurer's age  
Hath now escaped his memory—but the hour,  
One of a golden summer holiday,  
He well remembers, though the year be gone. 5  
Alone and devious from afar he came;  
And, with a sudden influx overpowered  
At sight of this seclusion, he forgot  
His haste, for hasty had his footsteps been  
As boyish his pursuits; and, sighing said, 10  
“What happy fortune were it here to live!  
And, (if a thought of dying, if a thought  
Of mortal separation, could intrude  
With paradise before him), here to die!”  
No prophet was he, had not even a hope, 15  
Scarcely a wish, but one bright pleasing thought,  
A fancy in the heart of what might be  
The lot of others, never could be his.

The station whence he looked was soft and green,  
Not giddy yet aerial, with a depth 20  
Of vale below, a height of hills above.  
For rest of body, perfect was the spot,  
All that luxurious nature could desire,  
But stirring to the spirit. Who could gaze  
And not feel motions there? He thought of clouds 25  
That sail on winds, of breezes that delight  
To play on water, or in endless chase  
Pursue each other through the yielding plain  
Of grass or corn, over and through and through,  
In billow after billow, evermore 30  
Disporting. Nor unmindful was the Boy

Of sunbeams, shadows, butterflies and birds,  
Of fluttering Sylphs, and softly-gliding Fays,  
Genii, and winged Angels that are Lords  
Without restraint of all which they behold. 35  
The illusion strengthening as he gazed, he felt  
That such unfettered liberty was his,  
Such power and joy; but only for this end,  
To flit from field to rock, from rock to field,  
From shore to island, and from isle to shore, 40  
From open ground to covert, from a bed  
Of meadow-flowers into a tuft of wood,  
From high to low, from low to high, yet still  
Within the bound of this high concave; here  
Must be his home, this Valley be his world. 45

Since that day forth the place to him—to *me*  
(For I who live to register the truth  
Was that same young and happy being) became  
As beautiful to thought, as it had been,  
When present, to the bodily sense; a haunt 50  
Of pure affections, shedding upon joy  
A brighter joy; and through such damp and gloom  
Of the gay mind, as oftentimes splenetic youth  
Mistakes for sorrow darting beams of light  
That no self-cherished sadness could withstand: 55  
And now 'tis mine, perchance for life, dear Vale,  
Beloved Grasmere (let the Wandering Streams  
Take up, the cloud-capped hills repeat, the Name),  
One of thy lowly dwellings is my Home.

And was the cost so great? and could it seem 60  
An act of courage, and the thing itself  
A conquest? who must bear the blame? sage man  
Thy prudence, thy experience—thy desires;  
Thy apprehensions—blush thou for them all

my apprehensions—blush thou for them all.

Yes, the realities of life so cold, 65  
So cowardly, so ready to betray,  
So stinted in the measure of their grace  
As we pronounce them, doing them much wrong,  
Have been to me more bountiful than hope,  
Less timid than desire—but that is passed. 70

On Nature's invitation do I come, [\[359\]](#)  
By reason sanctioned—Can the choice mislead,  
That made the calmest, fairest spot of earth,  
With all its unappropriated good,  
My own; and not mine only, for with me 75  
Entrenched, say rather peacefully embowered,  
Under yon orchard, in yon humble cot,  
A younger orphan of a home extinct,  
The only daughter of my parents, dwells.

Aye, think on that, my heart, and cease to stir, 80  
Pause upon that, and let the breathing frame  
No longer breathe, but all be satisfied.  
—Oh if such silence be not thanks to God  
For what hath been bestowed, then where, where then  
Shall gratitude find rest? Mine eyes did ne'er 85  
Fix on a lovely object, nor my mind  
Take pleasure in the midst of happy thoughts,  
But either She whom now I have, who now  
Divides with me this loved abode, was there,  
Or not far off. Where'er my footsteps turned, 90  
Her Voice was like a hidden Bird that sang,  
The thought of her was like a flash of light,  
Or an *unseen* companionship, a breath,  
Or fragrance independent of the wind.  
In all my goings, in the new and old 95  
Of all my meditations, and in this

Favourite of all, in this the most of all.  
—What Being, therefore, since the birth of man  
Had ever more abundant cause to speak  
Thanks, and if favours of the heavenly Muse 100  
Make him more thankful, then to call on verse  
To aid him, and in Song resound his joy.  
The boon is absolute; surpassing grace  
To me hath been vouchsafed; among the bowers  
Of blissful Eden this was neither given, 105  
Nor could be given, possession of the good  
Which had been sighed for, ancient thought fulfilled  
And dear Imaginations realized  
Up to their highest measure, yea and more.

Embrace me then, ye Hills, and close me in, 110  
Now in the clear and open day I feel  
Your guardianship; I take it to my heart;  
'Tis like the solemn shelter of the night.  
But I would call thee beautiful, for mild  
And soft, and gay, and beautiful thou art, 115  
Dear Valley, having in thy face a smile  
Though peaceful, full of gladness. Thou art pleased,  
Pleased with thy crags, and woody steep, thy Lake,  
Its one green Island and its winding shores;  
The multitude of little rocky hills, 120  
Thy Church and cottages of mountain stone  
Clustered like stars some few, but single most,  
And lurking dimly in their shy retreats,  
Or glancing at [\[360\]](#) each other cheerful looks,  
Like separated stars with clouds between. 125  
What want we? have we not perpetual streams,  
Warm woods, and sunny hills, and fresh green fields,  
And mountains not less green, and flocks, and herds,  
And thickets full of songsters, and the voice

Of lordly birds, an unexpected sound 130  
 Heard now and then from morn till latest eve,  
 Admonishing the man who walks below  
 Of solitude, and silence in the sky?  
 These have we, and a thousand nooks of earth  
 Have also these, but *no* where else is found, 135  
 No where (or is it fancy?) *can* be found  
 The one sensation that is here; 'tis here,  
 Here as it found its way into my heart  
 In childhood, here as it abides by day,  
 By night, here only; or in chosen minds 140  
 That take it with them hence, where'er they go.  
 'Tis, but I cannot name it, 'tis the sense  
 Of majesty, and beauty, and repose,  
 A blended holiness of earth and sky,  
 Something that makes this individual Spot, 145  
 This small abiding-place of many men,  
 A termination, and a last retreat,  
 A centre, come from wheresoe'er you will,  
 A whole without dependence or defect,  
 Made for itself; and happy in itself, 150  
 Perfect Contentment, Unity entire.

Bleak season was it, turbulent and bleak,[\[361\]](#)  
 When hitherward we journeyed, side by side,  
 Through bursts of sunshine and through flying showers,  
 Paced the long Vales—how long they were—and yet 155  
 How fast that length of way was left behind,  
 Wensley's rich Vale and Sedbergh's naked heights.  
 The frosty wind, as if to make amends  
 For its keen breath, was aiding to our steps,  
 And drove us onward like two ships at sea, 160  
 Or like two birds, companions in mid air,

Parted and re-united by the diast.  
Stern was the face of Nature. We rejoiced  
In that stern countenance, for our souls thence drew  
A feeling of their strength. The naked trees, 165  
The icy brooks, as on we passed, appeared  
To question us. "Whence come ye? to what end?"  
They seemed to say; "What would ye," said the shower,  
"Wild wanderers, whither through my dark domain?"  
The sunbeam said, "Be happy." When this Vale 170  
We entered, bright and solemn was the sky  
That faced us with a passionate welcoming,  
And led us to our threshold. Daylight failed  
Insensibly, and round us gently fell  
Composing darkness, with a quiet load 175  
Of full contentment, in a little shed  
Disturbed, uneasy in itself as seemed,  
And wondering at its new inhabitants.  
It loves us now, this Vale so beautiful  
Begins to love us! By a sullen storm, 180  
Two months unwearied of severest storm,  
It put the temper of our minds to proof,  
And found us faithful through the gloom, and heard  
The Poet mutter his prelude songs  
With cheerful heart, an unknown voice of joy, 185  
Among the silence of the woods and hills;  
Silent to any gladness of sound  
With all their Shepherds.

But the gates of Spring  
Are opened. Churlish Winter hath given leave  
That she should entertain for this one day, 190  
Perhaps for many genial days to come,  
His guests, and make them jocund. They are pleased,  
But most of all the Birds that haunt the flood



With the mild summons; inmates though they be  
Of winter's household, they keep festival 195  
This day, who drooped, or seemed to droop, so long;  
They shew their pleasure, and shall I do less?  
Happiest of happy though I be, like them  
I cannot take possession of the sky,  
Mount with a thoughtless impulse, and wheel there, 200  
One of a mighty multitude, whose way  
Is a perpetual harmony, and dance  
Magnificent. Behold, how with a grace  
Of ceaseless motion,[\[362\]](#) that might scarcely seem  
Inferior to angelical, they prolong 205  
Their curious pastime, shaping in mid air,  
And sometimes with ambitious wing that soars  
High as the level of the mountain tops,  
A circuit ampler than the lake beneath,  
Their own domain;—but ever, while intent 210  
On tracing and retracing that large round,  
Their jubilant activity evolves  
Hundreds of curves and circlets, to and fro,  
Upwards and downwards, progress intricate  
Yet unperplexed, as if one spirit swayed 215  
Their indefatigable flight. 'Tis done—  
Ten times and more, I fancied it had ceased;  
But lo! the vanished company again  
Ascending, they approach—I hear their wings  
Faint, faint at first; and then an eager sound 220  
Passed in a moment—and as faint again!  
They tempt the sun to sport among[\[363\]](#) their plumes;  
Tempt the smooth water,[\[364\]](#) or the gleaming ice,  
To show them a fair image; 'tis themselves,  
Their own fair forms, upon the glimmering plain, 225  
*Painted more soft and fair as they descend*

Fluttered more soft and fair as they descended,  
Almost to touch;—then up again aloft,  
Up with a sally, and a flash of speed,  
As if they scorned both resting-place and rest![\[365\]](#)  
This day is a thanksgiving, 'tis a day 230  
Of glad emotion and deep quietness;  
Not upon me alone hath been bestowed,  
Me rich in many onward-looking thoughts,  
The penetrating bliss; oh surely these  
Have felt it, not the happy Quires of Spring, 235  
Her own peculiar family of love  
That sport among green leaves, a blither train.

But two are missing—two, a lonely pair  
Of milk-white Swans, wherefore are *they* not seen  
Partaking this day's pleasure? From afar 240  
They came, to sojourn here in solitude,  
Choosing this Valley, they who had the choice  
Of the whole world.[\[366\]](#) We saw them day by day,  
Through these two months of unrelenting storm,  
Conspicuous at the centre of the Lake, 245  
Their safe retreat. We knew them well, I guess  
That the whole Valley knew them; but to us  
They were more dear than may be well believed,  
Not only for their beauty, and their still  
And placid way of life, and constant love 250  
Inseparable, not for these alone,  
But that *their* state so much resembled ours,  
They having also chosen this abode;  
They strangers, and we strangers; they a pair,  
And we a solitary pair like them. 255  
They should not have departed; many days  
Did I look forth in vain, nor on the wing  
Could see them, nor in that small open space

Of blue unfrozen water, where they lodged,  
And lived so long in quiet, side by side. 260  
Shall we behold them, consecrated friends,  
Faithful companions, yet another year  
Surviving—they for us, and we for them—  
And neither pair be broken? Nay perchance  
It is too late already for such hope, 265  
The Dalesmen may have aimed the deadly tube,  
And parted them; or haply both are gone  
One death, and that were mercy given to both.  
Recal my song the ungenerous thought; forgive,  
Thrice favoured Region, the conjecture harsh 270  
Of such inhospitable penalty,  
Inflicted upon confidence so pure.  
Ah, if I wished to follow where the sight  
Of all that is before mine eyes, the voice  
Which speaks from a presiding Spirit here, 275  
Would lead me, I should whisper to myself;  
They who are dwellers in this holy place  
Must needs themselves be hallowed, they require  
No benediction from the stranger's lips,  
For they are blest already. None would give 280  
The greeting "peace be with you" unto them,  
For peace they have, it cannot but be theirs,  
And mercy, and forbearance. Nay—not these,  
Their healing offices a pure goodwill  
Precludes, and charity beyond the bounds 285  
Of charity—an overflowing love,  
Not for the creature only, but for all  
That is around them, love for every thing  
Which in this happy region they behold!  
Thus do we soothe ourselves, and when the thought 290  
Is past we blame it not for having come.

What, if I floated down a pleasant Stream  
And now am landed, and the motion gone,  
Shall I reprove myself? Ah no, the stream  
Is flowing, and will never cease to flow,[\[367\]](#) 295  
And I shall float upon that stream again.  
By such forgetfulness the soul becomes,  
Words cannot say, how beautiful. Then hail,  
Hail to the visible Presence, hail to thee,  
Delightful Valley, habitation fair! 300  
And to whatever else of outward form  
Can give us inward help, can purify,  
And elevate, and harmonise, and soothe,  
And steal away, and for a while deceive  
And lap in pleasing rest, and bear us on 305  
Without desire in full complacency,  
Contemplating perfection absolute  
And entertained as in a placid sleep.

But not betrayed by tenderness of mind  
That feared, or wholly overlooked the truth, 310  
Did we come hither, with romantic hope  
To find, in midst of so much loveliness,  
Love, perfect love; of so much majesty  
A like majestic frame of mind in those  
Who here abide, the persons like the place. 315  
Not from such hope, or aught of such belief  
Hath issued any portion of the joy  
Which I have felt this day. An awful voice,  
'Tis true, hath in my walks been often heard,  
Sent from the mountains or the sheltered fields; 320  
Shout after shout—reiterated whoop  
In manner of a bird that takes delight  
In answering to itself; or like a hound  
Single at chase among the lonely woods.

His yell repeating;<sup>[368]</sup> yet it was in truth 325  
A human voice—a Spirit of coming night,  
How solemn when the sky is dark, and earth  
Not dark, nor yet enlightened, but by snow  
Made visible, amid a noise of winds  
And bleatings manifold of mountain sheep, 330  
Which in that iteration recognise  
Their summons, and are gathering round for food,  
Devoured with keenness ere to grove or bank  
Or rocky *bield* with patience they retire.

That very voice, which, in some timid mood 335  
Of superstitious fancy, might have seemed  
Awful as ever stray Demoniac uttered,  
His steps to govern in the Wilderness;  
Or as the Norman Curfew's regular beat,  
To hearths when first they darkened at the knell: 340  
That Shepherd's voice, it may have reached mine ear  
Debased and under profanation, made  
The ready Organ of articulate sounds  
From ribaldry, impiety, or wrath  
Issuing when shame hath ceased to check the brawls 345  
Of some abused Festivity—so be it.  
I came not dreaming of unruffled life,  
Untainted manners; born among the hills,  
Bred also there, I wanted not a scale  
To regulate my hopes. Pleased with the good, 350  
I shrink not from the evil with disgust,  
Or with immoderate pain. I look for Man,  
The common creature of the brotherhood,  
Differing but little from the Man elsewhere,  
For selfishness, and envy, and revenge, 355  
Ill neighbourhood—pity that this should be—

Flattery and double-dealing, strife and wrong.

Yet is it something gained, it is in truth  
A mighty gain, that Labour here preserves  
His rosy face, a servant only here 360  
Of the fire-side, or of the open field,  
A freeman, therefore, sound and unimpaired;  
That extreme penury is here unknown,  
And cold and hunger's abject wretchedness,  
Mortal to body, and the heaven-born mind; 365  
That they who want, are not too great a weight  
For those who can relieve. Here may the heart  
Breathe in the air of fellow-suffering  
Dreadless, as in a kind of fresher breeze  
Of her own native element, the hand 370  
Be ready and unwearied without plea  
From tasks too frequent, or beyond its power  
For languor, or indifference, or despair.  
And as these lofty barriers break the force  
Of winds, this deep Vale,—as it doth in part 375  
Conceal us from the storm,—so here abides  
A power and a protection for the mind,  
Dispensed indeed to other solitudes,  
Favoured by noble privilege like this,  
Where kindred independence of estate 380  
Is prevalent, where he who tills the field,  
He, happy man! is master of the field,[\[369\]](#)  
And treads the mountains which his fathers trod.

Not less than half-way up yon Mountain's side  
Behold a dusky spot, a grove of Firs, 385  
That seems still smaller than it is. This grove  
Is haunted—by what ghost? a gentle spirit  
Of memory faithful to the call of love;  
For, as reports the dame, whose fire sends up

Yon curling smoke from the grey cot below, 390  
The trees (her first-born child being then a babe)  
Were planted by her husband and herself,  
That ranging o'er the high and houseless ground  
Their sheep might neither want (from perilous storms  
Of winter, nor from summer's sultry heat) 395  
A friendly covert. "And they knew it well,"  
Said she, "for thither as the trees grew up,  
We to the patient creatures carried food  
In times of heavy snow." She then began  
In fond obedience to her private thoughts 400  
To speak of her dead husband. Is there not  
An art, a music, and a strain of words  
That shall be like the acknowledged voice of life,  
Shall speak of what is done among the fields,  
Done truly there, or felt, of solid good 405  
And real evil, yet be sweet withal,  
More grateful, more harmonious than the breath,  
The idle breath of softest pipe attuned  
To pastoral fancies? Is there such a stream,  
Pure and unsullied, flowing from the heart 410  
With motions of true dignity and grace?  
Or must we seek that stream where Man is not?  
Methinks I could repeat in tuneful verse,  
Delicious as the gentlest breeze that sounds  
Through that aerial fir-grove, could preserve 415  
Some portion of its human history  
As gathered from the Matron's lips, and tell  
Of tears that have been shed at sight of it,  
And moving dialogues between this pair,  
Who in their prime of wedlock, with joint hands 420  
Did plant the grove, now flourishing, while they  
No longer flourish, he entirely gone,

She withering in her loneliness. Be this  
A task above my skill; the silent mind  
Has her own treasures, and I think of these, 425  
Love what I see, and honour humankind.  
No, we are not alone, we do not stand,  
My Sister, here misplaced and desolate,  
Loving what no one cares for but ourselves;  
We shall not scatter through the plains and rocks 430  
Of this fair Vale, and o'er its spacious heights  
Unprofitable kindness, bestowed  
On objects unaccustomed to the gifts  
Of feeling, which were cheerless and forlorn  
But few weeks past, and would be so again 435  
Were we not here; we do not tend a lamp  
Whose lustre we alone participate,  
Which shines dependent upon us alone,  
Mortal though bright, a dying, dying flame.  
Look where we will, some human hand has been 440  
Before us with its offering; not a tree  
Sprinkles these little pastures but the same  
Hath furnished matter for a thought; perchance,  
For some one, serves as a familiar friend.  
Joy spreads, and sorrow spreads; and this whole Vale, 445  
Home of untutored shepherds as it is,  
Swarms with sensation, as with gleams of sunshine,  
Shadows or breezes, scents or sounds. Nor deem  
These feelings, though subservient more than ours  
To every day's demand for daily bread, 450  
And borrowing more their spirit, and their shape  
From self-respecting interests, deem them not  
Unworthy therefore, and unhallowed: no,  
They lift the animal being, do themselves  
By Nature's kind and ever-present aid 455



By nature's kind and ever-present aid 455

Refine the selfishness from which they spring,  
Redeem by love the individual sense  
Of anxiousness with which they are combined.  
And thus it is that fitly they become  
Associates in the joy of purest minds, 460  
They blend therewith congenially: meanwhile,  
Calmly they breathe their own undying life  
Through this their mountain sanctuary. Long,  
Oh long may it remain inviolate,  
Diffusing health and sober cheerfulness, 465  
And giving to the moments as they pass  
Their little boons of animating thought  
That sweeten labour, make it seen and felt  
To be no arbitrary weight imposed,  
But a glad function natural to man. 470

Fair proof of this, newcomer though I be,  
Already have I gained. The inward frame  
Though slowly opening, opens every day  
With process not unlike to that which cheers  
A pensive stranger, journeying at his leisure 475  
Through some Helvetian dell, when low-hung mists  
Break up, and are beginning to recede;  
How pleased he is where thin and thinner grows  
The veil, or where it parts at once, to spy  
The dark pines thrusting forth their spiky heads; 480  
To watch the spreading lawns with cattle grazed,  
Then to be greeted by the scattered huts,  
As they shine out; and *see* the streams whose murmur  
Had soothed his ear while *they* were hidden: how pleased  
To have about him, which way e'er he goes, 485  
Something on every side concealed from view,  
In every quarter something visible,

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Half-seen or wholly, lost and found again,  
Alternate progress and impediment,  
And yet a growing prospect in the main. 490

Such pleasure now is mine, albeit forced,  
Herein less happy than the Traveller  
To cast from time to time a painful look  
Upon unwelcome things, which unawares  
Reveal themselves; not therefore is my heart 495  
Depressed, nor does it fear what is to come,  
But confident, enriched at every glance.  
The more I see the more delight my mind  
Receives, or by reflexion can create.

Truth justifies herself, and as she dwells 500  
With Hope, who would not follow where she leads?

Nor let me pass unheeded other loves  
Where no fear is, and humbler sympathies.  
Already hath sprung up within my heart  
A liking for the small grey horse that bears 505  
The paralytic man, and for the brute—  
In Scripture sanctified—the patient brute,  
On which the cripple, in the quarry maimed,  
Rides to and fro: I know them and their ways.[\[370\]](#)  
The famous sheep-dog, first in all the Vale, 510  
Though yet to me a stranger, will not be  
A stranger long; nor will the blind man's guide,  
Meek and neglected thing, of no renown!  
Soon will peep forth the primrose; ere it fades  
Friends shall I have at dawn, blackbird and thrush 515  
To rouse me, and a hundred warblers more;  
And if those eagles to their ancient hold  
Return, Helvellyn's eagles! with the pair  
From my own door I shall be free to claim  
Acquaintance as they sweep from cloud to cloud. 520

The owl that gives the name to Owlet-Crag  
Have I heard whooping, and he soon will be  
A chosen one of my regards. See there  
The heifer in yon little croft belongs  
To one who holds it dear; with duteous care 525  
She reared it, and in speaking of her charge  
I heard her scatter some endearing words  
Domestic, and in spirit motherly  
She being herself a Mother, happy Beast  
If the caresses of a human voice 530  
Can make it so, and care of human hands.

And ye as happy under Nature's care,  
Strangers to me, and all men, or at least  
Strangers to all particular amity,  
All intercourse of knowledge or of love 535  
That parts the individual from his kind,  
Whether in large communities ye keep  
From year to year, not shunning Man's abode,  
A settled residence, or be from far,  
Wild creatures, and of many homes, that come 540  
The gift of winds, and whom the winds again  
Take from us at your pleasure—yet shall ye  
Not want, for this, your own subordinate place  
In my affections. Witness the delight  
With which erewhile I saw that multitude 545  
Wheel through the sky, and see them now at rest,  
Yet not at rest, upon the glassy lake.  
They *cannot* rest, they gambol like young whelps;  
Active as lambs, and overcome with joy.  
They try all frolic motions; flutter, plunge, 550  
And beat the passive water with their wings.  
Too distant are they for plain view, but lo!  
Those little fountains sparkling in the sun

These little fountains, sparkling in the sun,  
Betray their occupation, rising up,  
First one and then another silver spout, 555  
As one or other takes the fit of glee,  
Fountains and spouts, yet somewhat in the guise  
Of play-thing fire-works, that on festal nights  
Sparkle about the feet of wanton boys.  
—How vast the compass of this theatre, 560  
Yet nothing to be seen but lovely pomp  
And silent majesty; the birch-tree woods  
Are hung with thousand thousand diamond drops  
Of melted hoar-frost, every tiny knot  
In the bare twigs, each little budding place 565  
Cased with its several beads, what myriads there  
Upon one tree, while all the distant grove  
That rises to the summit of the steep  
Shows like a mountain built of silver light.  
See yonder the same pageant, and again 570  
Behold the universal imagery  
Inverted, all its sun-bright features touched  
As with the varnish, and the gloss of dreams;  
Dreamlike the blending also of the whole  
Harmonious landscape; all along the shore 575  
The boundary lost, the line invisible  
That parts the image from reality;  
And the clear hills, as high as they ascend  
Heavenward, so piercing deep the lake below.  
Admonished of the days of love to come 580  
The raven croaks, and fills the upper air  
With a strange sound of genial harmony;[\[371\]](#)  
And in and all about that playful band,  
Incapable although they be of rest,  
And in their fashion very rioters, 585

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There is a stillness, and they seem to make  
Calm revelry in that their calm abode.  
Them leaving to their joyous hours I pass,  
Pass with a thought the life of the whole year  
That is to come, the throng of woodland flowers, 590  
And lilies that will dance upon the waves.

Say boldly then that solitude is not  
Where these things are. He truly is alone,  
He of the multitude whose eyes are doomed  
To hold a vacant commerce day by day 595  
With objects wanting life, repelling love;  
He by the vast Metropolis immured,  
Where pity shrinks from unremitting calls,  
Where numbers overwhelm humanity,  
And neighbourhood serves rather to divide 600  
Than to unite. What sighs more deep than his,  
Whose nobler will hath long been sacrificed;  
Who must inhabit, under a black sky,  
A City where, if indifference to disgust  
Yield not, to scorn, or sorrow, living men 605  
Are oftentimes to their fellow-men no more  
Than to the forest hermit are the leaves  
That hang aloft in myriads—nay, far less,  
For they protect his walk from sun and shower,  
Swell his devotion with their voice in storms, 610  
And whisper while the stars twinkle among them  
His lullaby. From crowded streets remote,  
Far from the living and dead wilderness  
Of the thronged world, Society is here [\[372\]](#)  
A true Community, a genuine frame 615  
Of many into one incorporate.  
*That* must be looked for here, paternal sway,  
One household under God for high and low,

One family, and one mansion; to themselves  
Appropriate, and divided from the world 620  
As if it were a cave, a multitude  
Human and brute, possessors undisturbed  
Of this recess, their legislative hall,  
Their Temple, and their glorious dwelling-place.

Dismissing therefore, all Arcadian dreams, 625  
All golden fancies of the golden age,  
The bright array of shadowy thoughts from times  
That were before all time, or is to be  
Ere time expire, the pageantry that stirs  
And will be stirring when our eyes are fixed 630  
On lovely objects, and we wish to part  
With all remembrance of a jarring world,  
—Take we at once this one sufficient hope,  
What need of more? that we shall neither droop,  
Nor pine for want of pleasure in the life 635  
Scattered about us, nor through dearth of aught  
That keeps in health the insatiable mind;  
That we shall have for knowledge and for love  
Abundance; and that, feeling as we do  
How goodly, how exceeding fair, how pure 640  
From all reproach is yon ethereal vault,  
And this deep vale its earthly counterpart,  
By which, and under which, we are enclosed  
To breathe in peace, we shall moreover find  
(If sound, and what we ought to be ourselves, 645  
If rightly we observe and justly weigh)  
The inmates not unworthy of their home  
The dwellers of their dwelling.

And if this

Were otherwise, we have within ourselves  
Enough to fill the present day with joy. 650

—Enough to fill the present day with joy, but  
And overspread the future years with hope,  
Our beautiful and quiet home, enriched  
Already with a stranger whom we love  
Deeply, a stranger of our father's house,  
A never-resting Pilgrim of the Sea,[373] 655  
Who finds at last an hour to his content  
Beneath our roof. And others whom we love  
Will seek us also, sisters of our hearts,[374]  
And one, like them, a brother of our hearts,  
Philosopher and Poet,[375] in whose sight 660  
These mountains will rejoice with open joy.  
—Such is our wealth; O Vale of Peace, we are  
And must be, with God's will, a happy band.

Yet 'tis not to enjoy that we exist,  
For that end only; something must be done. 665  
I must not walk in unreprieved delight  
These narrow bounds, and think of nothing more,  
No duty that looks further, and no care.  
Each being has his office, lowly some  
And common, yet all worthy if fulfilled 670  
With zeal, acknowledgment that with the gift  
Keeps pace, a harvest answering to the seed—  
Of ill-advised Ambition and of Pride  
I would stand clear, but yet to me I feel  
That an internal brightness is vouchsafed 675  
That must not die, that must not pass away.  
Why does this inward lustre fondly seek,  
And gladly blend with outward fellowship?  
Why do *they* shine around me whom I love?  
Why do they teach me whom I thus revere? 680  
Strange question, yet it answers not itself.  
That humble roof embowered among the trees,

That calm tire-side, it is not even in them,  
—Blest as they are—to furnish a reply,  
That satisfies and ends in perfect rest. 685  
Possessions have I that are solely mine,  
Something within which yet is shared by none,  
Not even the nearest to me and most dear,  
Something which power and effort may impart,  
I would impart it, I would spread it wide, 690  
Immortal in the world which is to come.  
Forgive me if I add another claim,  
And would not wholly perish even in this,  
Lie down and be forgotten in the dust,  
I and the modest partners of my days 695  
Making a silent company in death;  
Love, knowledge, all my manifold delights  
All buried with me without monument  
Or profit unto any but ourselves.  
It must not be, if I, divinely taught, 700  
Be privileged to speak as I have felt  
Of what in man is human or divine.

While yet an innocent little-one, with a heart  
That doubtless wanted not its tender moods,  
I breathed (for this I better recollect) 705  
Among wild appetites and blind desires,  
Motions of savage instinct, my delight  
And exaltation. Nothing at that time  
So welcome, no temptation half so dear  
As that which urged me to a daring feat. 710  
Deep pools, tall trees, black chasms, and dizzy crags,  
And tottering towers; I loved to stand and read  
Their looks forbidding, read and disobey,  
Sometimes in act, and evermore in thought.  
With impulses that scarcely were by these 715



Surpassed in strength, I heard of danger, met  
Or sought with courage; enterprize forlorn  
By one, sole keeper of his own intent,  
Or by a resolute few who for the sake  
Of glory, fronted multitudes in arms. 720  
Yea to this hour I cannot read a tale  
Of two brave vessels matched in deadly fight,  
And fighting to the death, but I am pleased  
More than a wise man ought to be. I wish,  
Fret, burn, and struggle, and in soul am there; 725  
But me hath Nature tamed, and bade to seek  
For other agitations, or be calm;  
Hath dealt with me as with a turbulent stream,  
Some nursling of the mountains, which she leads  
Through quiet meadows, after he has learnt 730  
His strength, and had his triumph and his joy,  
His desperate course of tumult and of glee.  
That which in stealth by Nature was performed  
Hath Reason sanctioned. Her deliberate voice  
Hath said, "Be mild and cleave to gentle things, 735  
Thy glory and thy happiness be there.  
Nor fear, though thou confide in me, a want  
Of aspirations that *have* been, of foes  
To wrestle with, and victory to complete,  
Bounds to be leapt, darkness to be explored, 740  
All that inflamed thy infant heart, the love,  
The longing, the contempt, the undaunted quest,  
All shall survive—though changed their office, all  
Shall live,—it is not in their power to die."

Then farewell to the Warrior's schemes, farewell 745  
The forwardness of soul which looks that way  
Upon a less incitement than the cause  
Of Liberty endangered, and farewell

That other hope, long mine, the hope to fill  
The heroic trumpet with the Muse's breath! 750  
Yet in this peaceful Vale we will not spend  
Unheard-of days, though loving peaceful thoughts.  
A voice shall speak, and what will be the theme?[18]

[359] The following lines, 71-97, and 110-125, were first published in the *Memoirs of Wordsworth*, in 1851.—ED.

[360]

... on ...  
1851.

[361] The lines 152-167 were first published in the *Memoirs of Wordsworth* in 1851.—ED.

[362]

Mark how the feathered tenants of the flood  
With grace of motion ...

MS.

[363]

... amid ...  
MS.

[364]

They tempt the water, or ...  
MS.

[365] The foregoing twenty-seven lines were published under the title *Water-Fowl*, in the 1827 edition of Wordsworth's "Poetical Works." They are also printed in the fifth edition of the *Guide through the District of the Lakes in the North of England* (section first).—ED.

[366] Compare *Paradise Lost*, book xii. l. 646.—ED.

[367] Compare, in the *After-Thought* to “The Duddon Sonnets”—

Still glides the Stream, and shall for ever glide.

ED.

[368] Compare, in *An Evening Walk*, l. 378—

Or yell, in the deep woods, of lonely hound.

ED.

[369] Compare Wordsworth’s numerous references to the Cumbrian and Westmoreland “Statesmen,” in his Prose Works, and elsewhere.—ED.

[370] Compare *Peter Bell*.—ED.

[371] Compare *The Excursion*, book iv. ll. 1175-1187.—ED.

[372] Wordsworth says elsewhere that

Solitude is blithe Society.

ED.

[373] John Wordsworth.—ED.

[374] The Hutchinsons.—ED.

[375] Coleridge.—ED.

## “SHALL HE WHO GIVES HIS DAYS TO LOW PURSUITS”

The following lines occur in the experimental efforts made by Wordsworth to write an autobiographical poem. They occur in one of his sister’s Journals, entitled “May to December, 1802”; and were probably either dictated to her in that year, or were copied by her from some earlier fragment. They stand related to passages in *The Prelude*. (See vol. iii. p. 269.)—ED.

Shall he who gives his days to low pursuits  
Amid the undistinguishable crowd  
Of cities, 'mid the same eternal flow  
Of the same objects, melted and reduced  
To one identity, by differences 5  
That have no law, no meaning, and no end,  
Shall he feel yearning to those lifeless forms,  
And shall we think that Nature is less kind  
To those, who all day long, through a busy life,  
Have walked within her sight? It cannot be. 10

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1803

**“I FIND IT WRITTEN OF SIMONIDES”**

Published in *The Morning Post*, October 10, 1803

S.T.C. writing to Tom Poole, October 14, 1803, said that Wordsworth wrote to *The Morning Post* “as W. L. D., and sometimes with no signature.” There is ample evidence that the following sonnet was written by Wordsworth. He had contributed five sonnets to *The Morning Post* before the month of September 1803; and on the 10th of October in that year the following appeared.—ED.

I find it written of Simonides,  
That, travelling in strange countries, once he found  
A corpse that lay expos'd upon the ground,  
For which, with palms, he caus'd due obsequies  
To be perform'd, and paid all holy fees. 5  
Soon after this man's ghost unto him came,  
And told him not to sail, as was his aim,  
On board a ship then ready for the seas.  
Simonides, admonish'd by the ghost,  
Remain'd behind: the ship the following day 10  
Set sail, was wreck'd, and all on board were lost.  
Thus was the tenderest Poet that could be,  
Who sang in antient Greece his loving lay,  
Sav'd out of many by his piety.

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1804

**“NO WHIMSEY OF THE PURSE IS HERE”**

Writing to Sir George Beaumont, on Christmas Day, 1804, Wordsworth said: “We have lately built in our little rocky orchard a circular hut, lined with moss, like a wren’s nest, and coated on the outside with heath, that stands most charmingly, with several views from the different sides of it, of the Lake, the Valley, and the Church.... I will copy a dwarf inscription which I wrote for it” (*i.e.* the circular hut, in his Orchard-Garden) “the other day before the building was entirely finished, which indeed it is not yet.”<sup>[376]</sup>—ED.

No whimsey of the purse is here,  
No pleasure-house forlorn;  
Use, comfort, do this roof endear;  
A tributary shed to cheer  
The little cottage that is near,  
To help it and adorn.

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<sup>[376]</sup> See the *Memorials of Coleorton*, vol. i. p. 81; and Wordsworth’s letter on the subject in a later volume of this edition.—ED.

**1805**

**“PEACEFUL OUR VALLEY, FAIR AND GREEN”**

This is extracted from a copy of an appendix to *Recollections of a Tour in Scotland* by Dorothy Wordsworth, written by Mrs. Clarkson, September-November 1805. It was composed by the poet's sister. In February 1892 it was published in *The Monthly Packet* under the title “Grasmere: a Fragment,” and with the signature “Rydal Mount, September 26, 1829.” It is now printed from the MS. of 1805.—ED.

Peaceful our valley, fair and green;  
And beautiful the cottages  
Each in its nook, its sheltered hold,  
Or underneath its tuft of trees.

Many and beautiful they are; 5  
But there is one that I love best,  
A lowly roof in truth it is,  
A brother of the rest.

Yet when I sit on rock or hill  
Down-looking on the valley fair, 10  
That cottage with its grove of trees  
Summons my heart; it settles there.

Others there are whose small domain  
Of fertile fields with hedgerows green  
Might more seduce the traveller's mind 15  
To wish that there his home had been.

Such wish be his! I blame him not,  
My fancies they, perchance, are wild;  
I love that house because it is  
The very mountain's child. 20

Fields hath it of its own, green fields;  
But they are craggy, steep, and bare;  
Their fence is of the mountain stone,  
And moss and lichen flourish there.

And when the storm comes from the North 25  
It lingers near that pastoral spot,  
And piping through the mossy walls,  
It seems delighted with its lot



it seems delighted with its lot.

And let it take its own delight,  
And let it range the pastures bare 30  
Until it reach that grove of trees  
——It may not enter there!

A green unfading grove it is,  
Skirted with many a lesser tree,  
Hazel and holly, beech and oak, 35  
A fair and flourishing company!

Precious the shelter of those trees!  
They screen the cottage that I love;  
The sunshine pierces to the roof  
And the tall pine trees tower above. 40

When first I saw that dear abode  
It was a lovely winter's day:  
After a night of perilous storm  
The West wind ruled with gentle sway;

A day so mild, it might have been 45  
The first day of the gladsome spring;  
The robins warbled; and I heard  
One solitary throstle sing:

A stranger in the neighbourhood,  
All faces then to me unknown, 50  
I left my sole companion-friend  
To wander out alone.

Lur'd by a little winding path,  
I quitted soon the public road,  
A smooth and tempting path it was 55

By sheep and shepherds trod.

Eastward, toward the mighty hills

This pathway led me on,

Until I reach'd a lofty Rock

With velvet moss o'ergrown. 60

With russet Oak and tufts of Fern

Its top was richly garlanded;

Its sides adorn'd with Eglantine

Bedropp'd with hips of glossy red.

There too in many a shelter'd chink 65

The foxglove's broad leaves flourish'd fair,

And silver birch whose purple twigs

Bend to the softest breathing air.

Beneath that rock my course I stay'd

And, looking to its summit high, 70

"Thou wear'st," said I, "a splendid garb,

Here winter keeps his revelry.

"I've been a dweller on the plains,

Have sigh'd when summer days were gone;

No more I'll sigh; for winter here 75

Hath gladsome gardens of his own.

"What need of flowers? The splendid moss

Is gayer than an April mead;

More rich its hues of various green,

Orange and gold and glowing red." 80

—Beside that gay and lovely rock

There came with merry voice

A foaming streamlet glancing by,  
It seem'd to say "Rejoice!"

My youthful wishes all fulfill'd, 85  
Wishes matured by thoughtful choice,  
I stood an Inmate of this vale,  
How could I but rejoice?

### **"AH! IF I WERE A LADY GAY"**

The following two stanzas were added by Wordsworth to his sister's poem, entitled *The Cottager to her Infant*—composed in 1805, and issued in 1815 (see vol. iii. pp. 74, 75); but they were never published in Wordsworth's lifetime.—ED.

Ah! if I were a lady gay  
I should not grieve with thee to play;  
Right gladly would I lie awake  
Thy lively spirits to partake,  
And ask no better cheer. 5

But, Babe! there's none to work for me,  
And I must rise to industry;  
Soon as the cock begins to crow  
Thy mother to the fold must go  
To tend the sheep and kine. 10

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**1806**

**TO THE EVENING STAR OVER GRASMERE WATER,  
JULY 1806**

The Lake is thine,  
The mountains too are thine, some clouds there are,  
Some little feeble stars, but all is thine,  
Thou, thou art king, and sole proprietor.

A moon among her stars, a mighty vale, 5  
Fresh as the freshest field, scoop'd out, and green  
As is the greenest billow of the sea.

The multitude of little rocky hills,  
Rocky or green, that do like islands rise  
From the flat meadow lonely there. 10

...

Embowering mountains, and the dome of Heaven  
And waters in the midst, a Second Heaven.

**MICHAEL ANGELO IN REPLY TO THE PASSAGE UPON  
HIS STATUE OF NIGHT SLEEPING**

In the first volume of a copy of the edition of 1836,—long kept by Wordsworth at Rydal Mount, and afterwards the property of the late Lord Coleridge—which has been referred to in the Preface to Vol. 1., and very

often in the footnotes to all the volumes, signed C.—Wordsworth wrote in MS. two translations of a fragment of Michael Angelo's on Sleep, and a translation of some Latin verses by Thomas Warton on the same subject. These fragments were never included in any edition of his published works, and it is impossible to say to what year they belong. From their close relation to other translations from Michael Angelo, made by Wordsworth in 1806, I assign them, conjecturally, to the same year. The title is from Wordsworth's own MS.—ED.

## I

Grateful is Sleep, my life, in stone bound fast,  
More grateful still: while wrong and shame shall last,  
On me can Time no happier state bestow  
Than to be left unconscious of the woe.  
Ah then, lest you awaken me, speak low. 5

## II

Grateful is Sleep, more grateful still to be  
Of marble; for while shameless wrong and woe  
Prevail, 'tis best to neither hear nor see.  
Then wake me not, I pray you. Hush, speak low.

## **“COME, GENTLE SLEEP, DEATH'S IMAGE THO' THOU ART”**

Come, gentle Sleep, Death's image tho' thou art,  
Come share my couch, nor speedily depart;  
How sweet thus living without life to lie,  
Thus without death how sweet it is to die.

The Latin verse by Thomas Warton, of which these lines are a translation, is as follows:—

Somne veni! quamvis placidissima Mortis imago es,  
Consortem cupio te tamen esse tori;  
Hue ades, haud abiture citò! nam sic sine vita  
Vivere quam suave est, sic sine morte mori!

Thomas Warton, Fellow of Trinity College, Oxford, and Professor of Poetry in that University, is chiefly known by his *History of English Poetry* (1774-1781).—ED.

### **“BROOK, THAT HAST BEEN MY SOLACE DAYS AND WEEKS”**

The following version of the sonnet beginning “Brook! whose society the Poet seeks,” probably written in 1806 and first published in 1815 (see vol. iv. p. 52), has come to light since that volume was issued. The variants throughout are sufficient to warrant its publication here. Had I received it earlier they would have appeared in vol. iv.—ED.

Brook, that hast been my solace days and weeks,  
And months, and let me add the long year through,  
I come to thee, thou dost my heart renew;  
O happy Thing! among thy flowery creeks,  
And happy, dancing down thy water-breaks: 5  
If I some type of thee did wish to view,  
Thee, and not thee thyself, I would not do  
Like Grecian Poets, give thee human cheeks,  
Channels for tears! No Naiad should'st thou be;  
Have neither wings, feet, feathers, joints, nor hairs. 10  
It seems the Eternal Soul is clothed in thee  
With purer robes than those of flesh and blood,  
And hath bestowed on thee a better good;  
The joy of fleshly life without its cares.

### **TRANSLATION FROM MICHAEL ANGELO**

The date of this is unknown, and the original MS. is difficult to decipher. It is here and there illegible. It may belong to the year of the "Ecclesiastical Sonnets," but I place it beside the other translation from Michael Angelo.—  
ED.

“GRASMERE, *April 20th, 1808.*

“We received your letter this morning, enclosing the half of a £5 note. I am happy to inform you that the orphans have been fixed under the care of very respectable people. The baby is with its sister—she who filled the Mother’s place in the house during their two days of fearless solitude. It has clung to her ever since, and she has been its sole nurse. I went with two ladies of the Committee (in my sister’s place, who was then confined to poor John’s bedside) to conduct the family to their separate homes. The two Girls are together, as I have said; two Boys at another Home; and the third Boy by himself at the house of an elderly man who had a particular friendship for their father. The kind reception that the children met with was very affecting.”

See the letters from Wordsworth to Richard Sharpe, Esq., Mark Lane, London, in a subsequent volume, referring to the catastrophe.—ED.



Who weeps for strangers? Many wept  
For George and Sarah Green;  
Wept for that pair's unhappy fate,  
Whose grave may here be seen.[\[377\]](#)

By night, upon these stormy fells,[\[378\]](#) 5  
Did wife and husband roam;  
Six little ones at home had left,  
And could not find that home.[\[379\]](#)

For *any* dwelling-place of man  
As vainly did they seek. 10  
He perish'd; and a voice was heard—  
The widow's lonely shriek.[\[380\]](#)

Not many steps, and she was left[\[381\]](#)  
A body without life—  
A few short steps were the chain that bound[\[382\]](#) 15  
The husband to the wife.[\[383\]](#)

Now do those[\[384\]](#) sternly-featured hills  
Look gently on this grave;  
And quiet now are the depths[\[385\]](#) of air,  
As a sea without a wave. 20

But deeper lies the heart of peace  
In quiet more profound;[\[386\]](#)  
The heart of quietness is here  
Within this churchyard bound.[\[387\]](#)

And from all agony of mind 25  
It keeps them safe, and far  
From fear and grief. and from all need

Of sun or guiding star.[\[388\]](#)

O darkness of the grave! how deep,[\[389\]](#)

After that living night— 30

That last and dreary living one

Of sorrow and affright!

O sacred marriage-bed of death,

That keeps[\[390\]](#) them side by side

In bond of peace, in bond of love,[\[391\]](#) 35

That may not be untied!

[\[377\]](#) 1839.

Wept for that Pair's unhappy end,

Whose Grave may here be seen.

MS. letter of Dorothy Wordsworth's.

[\[378\]](#) 1839.

... these stormy Heights,

MS.

[\[379\]](#) 1839.

Six little ones the Pair had left,

And could not find their home.

MS.

[\[380\]](#) 1839.

Down the dark precipice he fell,  
And she was left alone,  
Not long to think of her children dear,  
Not long to pray, or groan.

Added in MS.

[381] 1839.

A few wild steps—she too was left,

MS.

[382] 1839.

The chain of but a few wild steps.

MS. in Dorothy Wordsworth's handwriting—sent to Lady Beaumont.

[383] 1839.

Four stanzas are here added in MS., only one of which need be given—

Our peace is of the immortal soul,  
Our anguish is of clay;  
Such bounty is in Heaven: so pass  
The bitterest pangs away.

[384] 1839.

Now do the ...

MS.

[385] 1839.

... is the depth ...

MS.

[386] 1839.

In shelter more profound.

MS.

[\[387\]](#) 1839.

... ground.

MS.

[\[388\]](#) 1839.

From fear, and from all need of hope  
From sun or guiding star.

MS.

[\[389\]](#) 1839.

... how calm,

MS.

[\[390\]](#) 1839.

That holds ...

MS.

[\[391\]](#) 1839.

In bond of love, in bond of God,

MS.

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**1818**

**“THE SCOTTISH BROOM ON BIRD-NEST BRAE”** [\[392\]](#)

The Scottish Broom on Bird-nest brae[\[393\]](#)  
Twelve tedious years ago,  
When many plants strange blossoms bore  
That puzzled high and low,  
A not unnatural longing felt, 5  
What longing would ye know?  
Why, friend, to deck her supple twigs  
With *yellow* in full blow.

To Lowther Castle she addressed  
A prayer both bold and sly, 10  
(For all the Brooms on Bird-nest brae  
Can talk and speechify)  
That flattering breezes blowing thence  
Their succour would supply,  
Then she would instantly put forth 15  
A flag of *yellow* dye.

But from the Castle turret blew  
A chill forbidding blast,  
Which the poor Broom no sooner felt  
Than she shrank up so fast; 20  
Her *wished-for* yellow she forswore,  
And since that time has cast  
Fond looks on colours three or four  
And put forth *Blue* at last.  
And now, my lads, the Election comes 25  
In June's sunshining hours,  
When every field and bank and brae  
Is clad with yellow flowers.  
While faction Blue from shops and booths  
Tricks out her blustering powers, 30

Lo! smiling Nature's lavish hand  
Has furnished wreaths for ours.

[392] "Written, in my opinion, at the General Election of 1818."—(The Rev. Thomas Hutchinson of Kimbolton.)

[393] "Bird-nest" was the old name of Brougham Hall.—ED.

## **PLACARD FOR A POLL BEARING AN OLD SHIRT**

Wordsworth was deeply interested in the successive parliamentary elections for Westmoreland (see his "Addresses to the Freeholders of Westmorland, 1818," in the Prose Works.) He particularly disliked Lord Brougham's candidature. The following squib is in MS. at Lowther Castle. He wrote on the MS.—"For a version of part of B.'s famous London Tower Speech see opposite page."—ED.

If money's slack,  
The shirt on my back  
Shall off, and go to the hammer:  
Though I sell shirt and skin  
By Jove I'll be in,  
And raise up a radical clamor!

## **"CRITICS, RIGHT HONOURABLE BARD, DECREE"**

I have found this in a catalogue of Autograph Letters, and have no knowledge of its date, or of the Bard referred to. Solomon Gesner wrote a poem on *The Death of Abel*, which was translated into English. See footnote to *The Prelude*, book vii. l. 564.—ED.

“Critics, right honourable Bard, decree  
Laurels to some, a night-shade wreath to thee,  
Whose muse a sure though late revenge hath ta’en  
Of harmless Abel’s death, by murdering Cain.”

On Cain, a Mystery, dedicated to Sir Walter Scott:—

“A German Haggis from receipt  
Of him who cooked the death of Abel,  
And sent ‘warm-reeking, rich and sweet,’  
From Venice to Sir Walter’s table.”

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1819

**“THROUGH CUMBRIAN WILDS, IN MANY A MOUNTAIN  
COVE”**

In 1819 Wordsworth wrote the sonnet beginning, “Grief, thou hast lost an ever ready friend.” In the note to that sonnet (vol. vi. p. 196) I have given a different version of its last six lines, from a MS. sonnet. But as these six lines also form the conclusion of another unpublished sonnet, it may be given in full by itself, in this Appendix.—ED.

Through Cumbrian wilds, in many a mountain cove,  
The pastoral Muse laments the Wheel—no more  
Engaged, near blazing hearth on clean-swept floor,  
In tasks which guardian Angels might approve,  
Friendly the weight of leisure to remove, 5  
And to beguile the lassitude of ease;  
Gracious to all the dear dependencies  
Of house and field,—to plenty, peace, and love.  
There too did *Fancy* prize the murmuring wheel;  
For sympathies, inexplicably fine, 10  
Instilled a confidence—how sweet to feel!  
That ever in the night-calm, when the Sheep  
Upon their grassy beds lay couch’d in sleep,  
The quickening spindle drew a trustier line.

**“MY SON! BEHOLD THE TIDE ALREADY SPENT”**

The following sonnet occurs after the above in the same MS. whence both are extracted.—ED.

My Son! behold the tide already spent  
That rose, and steadily advanced to fill  
The shores and channels, working Nature's will  
Among the mazy streams that backward went,  
And in the sluggish Ports where ships were pent. 5  
And now, its task performed, the flood stands still  
At the green base of many an inland hill,  
In placid beauty and entire content.  
Such the repose that Sage and Hero find,  
Such measured rest the diligent and good 10  
Of humbler name, whose souls do like the flood  
Of ocean press right on, or gently wind,  
Neither to be diverted nor withstood  
Until they reach the bounds by Heaven assigned.

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1820

**AUTHOR'S VOYAGE DOWN THE RHINE  
(THIRTY YEARS AGO)**

The confidence of Youth our only Art,  
And Hope gay Pilot of the bold design,  
We saw the living Landscapes of the Rhine,  
Reach after reach, salute us and depart;  
Slow sink the Spires,—and up again they start! 5  
But who shall count the Towers as they recline  
O'er the dark steeps, or in the horizon line  
Striding, with shattered crests, the eye athwart?  
More touching still, more perfect was the pleasure,  
When hurrying forward till the slack'ning stream 10  
Spread like a spacious Mere, we there could measure  
A smooth free course along the watery gleam,  
Think calmly on the past, and mark at leisure  
Features which else had vanished like a dream.

This sonnet was published in the first edition of the *Memorials of this Tour* (1822), but was struck out of the next edition, and never republished. Its rejection by Wordsworth is curious.

It refers to the pedestrian tour which the Poet took, with his friend Jones, in 1790, which he afterwards recorded in full in his *Descriptive Sketches*.

Dorothy Wordsworth, in her *Journal of the Tour in 1820*, refers to it thus: —“Our journey through the narrower and most romantic passages of the

Vale of the Rhine was connected with times long past, when my brother and his Friend (it was thirty years ago) floated down the stream in their little Bark. Often did my fancy place them with a freight of happiness in the centre of some bending reach, overlooked by tower or castle, or (when expectation would be most eager) at the turning of a promontory, which had concealed from their view some delicious winding which we had left behind; but no more of my own feelings, a record of his will be more interesting.”

She then quotes the sonnet, beginning

The confidence of Youth our only Art.

There are also numerous allusions in Mrs. Wordsworth’s Journal to this early tour; *e.g.* under date August 13. “We left Meyringen; soon reached a sort of Hotel, which Wm. pointed out to us with great interest, as being the only spot where he and his friend Jones were ill used, during the course of their adventurous journey—a wild looking building, a little removed from the road, where the vale of Hasli ends.” Again, in describing the sunset from the woody hill Colline de Gibet, overlooking the two lakes of Brienz and Thun, at Interlaken, “with the loveliest of green vallies between us and Jungfrau,” “Surely William must have had this Paradise in his thoughts when he began his *Descriptive Sketches*—

Were there, below, a spot of holy ground,  
By Pain and her sad family unfound, etc.

But no habitation was there among these rocky knolls, and tiny pastures. One fragment, something like a ruined convent, lurked under a steep, woody-fringed crag. What a Refuge for a pious Sisterhood!” Compare also the note to *Stanzas composed in the Simplon Pass*, vol. vi. p. 359.—ED.

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1822

**“THESE VALES WERE SADDENED WITH NO COMMON  
GLOOM”**

In the *Memoirs of William Wordsworth* by his nephew (the late Bishop of Lincoln) vol. i. chap. xxx. the following occurs as an addendum transferred to the footnotes:—

“The first six lines of an epitaph in Grasmere Church were also his composition. The elegant marble tablet on which they were engraved was designed by Sir Francis Chantry, and prepared by Allan Cunningham, 1822. It is over the chancel door.”

The following is the Inscription:—

In the Burial Ground  
of this Church are deposited the remains of  
JEMIMA ANNE DEBORAH,  
second daughter of  
Sir Egerton Brydges, of Denton Court, Kent, Bart.  
She departed this life at the Ivy Cottage, Rydal,  
May 25th 1822, aged 28 years.  
This memorial is erected by her husband  
EDWARD QUILLINAN.

The entire sonnet, of which Wordsworth wrote the “first six lines,” is as follows:—

These vales were saddened with no common gloom  
When good Jemima perished in her bloom;  
When, such the awful will of heaven, she died  
By flames breathed on her from her own fireside.  
On earth we dimly see, and but in part  
We know, yet faith sustains the sorrowing heart;  
And she, the pure, the patient and the meek,  
Might have fit epitaph could feelings speak;  
If words could tell and monuments record,  
How Treasures lost are inwardly deplored, 10  
No name by grief's fond eloquence adorned  
More than Jemima's would be praised and mourned.  
The tender virtues of her blameless life,  
Bright in the daughter, brighter in the wife,  
And in the cheerful mother brightest shone,— 15  
That light hath past away—the will of God<sup>[394]</sup> be done.

<sup>[394]</sup>

... of Heaven ...

MS.

## TRANSLATION OF PART OF THE FIRST BOOK OF THE ÆNEID

Composed 1823 (?).—Published 1836

This translation was included in the *Philological Museum*, edited by Julius Charles Hare, and published at Cambridge in 1832 (vol. i. p. 382, etc.). Three Books were translated by Wordsworth, but the greater portion is still in MS., unpublished. What is now reproduced appeared in the *Museum*. As it was never included by Wordsworth himself in any edition of his

Works, his own estimate of its literary value was slight. It was published by Professor Henry Reed in his American reprint of 1851. Writing to Lord Lonsdale on 9th Nov. 1823, Wordsworth says, "I have just finished a Translation into English rhyme of the First *Æneid*. Would you allow me to send it to you? I would be much gratified if you would take the trouble of comparing some passages with the original. I have endeavoured to be much more literal than Dryden, or Pitt—who keeps more close to the original than his predecessor."—ED.

#### TO THE EDITORS OF THE "PHILOLOGICAL MUSEUM"

Your letter, reminding me of an expectation I some time since held out to you of allowing some specimens of my translation from the *Æneid* to be printed in the *Philological Museum* was not very acceptable; for I had abandoned the thought of ever sending into the world any part of that experiment,—for it was nothing more,—an experiment begun for amusement, and I now think a less fortunate one than when I first named it to you. Having been displeased in modern translations with the additions of incongruous matter, I began to translate with a resolve to keep clear of that fault, by adding nothing; but I became convinced that a spirited translation can scarcely be accomplished in the English language without admitting a principle of compensation. On this point, however, I do not wish to insist, and merely send the following passage, taken at random, from a wish to comply with your request.—W.W.

But Cytherea, studious to invent  
Arts yet untried, upon new counsels bent,  
Resolves that Cupid, chang'd in form and face  
To young Ascanius, should assume his place;  
Present the maddening gifts, and kindle heat 5  
Of passion at the bosom's inmost seat.  
She dreads the treacherous house, the double tongue;  
She burns, she frets—by Juno's rancour stung;  
The calm of night is powerless to remove  
These cares, and thus she speaks to wingèd Love: 10

“O son, my strength, my power! who dost despise  
(What, save thyself, none dares through earth and skies)  
The giant-quelling bolts of Jove, I flee,  
O son, a suppliant to thy deity!  
What perils meet Æneas in his course, 15  
How Juno's hate with unrelenting force  
Pursues thy brother—this to thee is known;  
And oft-times hast thou made my griefs thine own.  
Him now the generous Dido by soft chains  
Of bland entreaty at her court detains; 20  
Junonian hospitalities prepare  
Such apt occasion that I dread a snare.  
Hence, ere some hostile God can intervene,  
Would I, by previous wiles, inflame the queen  
With passion for Æneas, such strong love 25  
That at my beck, mine only, she shall move.  
Hear, and assist;—the father's mandate calls  
His young Ascanius to the Tyrian walls;  
He comes, my dear delight,—and costliest things  
Preserv'd from fire and flood for presents brings. 30  
Him will I take, and in close covert keep,



'Mid groves Idalian, lull'd to gentle sleep,  
Or on Cythera's far-sequestered steep,  
That he may neither know what hope is mine,  
Nor by his presence traverse the design. 35  
Do thou, but for a single night's brief space,  
Dissemble; be that boy in form and face!  
And when enraptured Dido shall receive  
Thee to her arms, and kisses interweave  
With many a fond embrace, while joy runs high, 40  
And goblets crown the proud festivity,  
Instil thy subtle poison, and inspire,  
At every touch, an unsuspected fire."

Love, at the word, before his mother's sight  
Puts off his wings, and walks, with proud delight, 45  
Like young Iulus; but the gentlest dews  
Of slumber Venus sheds, to circumfuse  
The true Ascanius steep'd in placid rest;  
Then wafts him, cherish'd on her careful breast,  
Through upper air to an Idalian glade, 50  
Where he on soft *amaracas* is laid,  
With breathing flowers embraced, and fragrant shade.  
But Cupid, following cheerily his guide  
Achates, with the gifts to Carthage hied;  
And, as the hall he entered, there, between 55  
The sharers of her golden couch, was seen  
Reclin'd in festal pomp the Tyrian queen.  
The Trojans, too (*Æneas* at their head),  
On couches lie, with purple overspread:  
Meantime in canisters is heap'd the bread, 60  
Pellucid water for the hands is borne,  
And napkins of smooth texture, finely shorn.  
Within are fifty handmaids, who prepare,

As they in order stand, the dainty fare;  
And fume the household deities with store 65  
Of odorous incense; while a hundred more  
Match'd with an equal number of like age,  
But each of manly sex, a docile page,  
Marshal the banquet, giving with due grace  
To cup or viand its appointed place. 70  
The Tyrians rushing in, an eager band,  
Their painted couches seek, obedient to command.  
They look with wonder on the gifts—they gaze  
Upon Iulus, dazzled with the rays  
That from his ardent countenance are flung, 75  
And charm'd to hear his simulating tongue;  
Nor pass unprais'd the robe and veil divine,  
Round which the yellow flowers and wandering foliage twine.

But chiefly Dido, to the coming ill  
Devoted, strives in vain her vast desires to fill; 80  
She views the gifts; upon the child then turns  
Insatiable looks, and gazing burns.  
To ease a father's cheated love he hung  
Upon Æneas, and around him clung;  
Then seeks the queen; with her his arts he tries; 85  
She fastens on the boy enamour'd eyes,  
Clasps in her arms, nor weens (O lot unblest!)  
How great a God, incumbent o'er her breast,  
Would fill it with his spirit. He, to please  
His Acidalian mother, by degrees 90  
Blots out Sichæus, studious to remove  
The dead, by influx of a living love,  
By stealthy entrance of a perilous guest.  
Troubling a heart that had been long at rest.

Now when the friends were withdrawn, and ceased to

NOW when the viands were withdrawn, and ceased 95  
 The first division of the splendid feast,  
 While round a vacant board the chiefs recline,  
 Huge goblets are brought forth; they crown the wine;  
 Voices of gladness roll the walls around;  
 Those gladsome voices from the courts rebound; 100  
 From gilded rafters many a blazing light  
 Depends, and torches overcome the night.  
 The minutes fly—till, at the queen's command,  
 A bowl of state is offered to her hand:  
 Then she, as Belus wont, and all the line 105  
 From Belus, filled it to the brim with wine;  
 Silence ensued. "O Jupiter, whose care  
 Is hospitable dealing, grant my prayer!  
 Productive day be this of lasting joy  
 To Tyrians, and these exiles driven from Troy; 110  
 A day to future generations dear!  
 Let Bacchus, donor of soul-quick'ning cheer,  
 Be present; kindly Juno, be thou near!  
 And, Tyrians, may your choicest favours wait  
 Upon this hour, the bond to celebrate!" 115  
 She spake and shed an offering on the board;  
 Then sipp'd the bowl whence she the wine had pour'd  
 And gave to Bitias, urging the prompt lord;  
 He rais'd the bowl, and took a long deep draught;  
 Then every chief in turn the beverage quaff'd. 120

Graced with redundant hair, Iopas sings  
 The lore of Atlas, to resounding strings,  
 The labours of the Sun, the lunar wanderings;  
 Whence human kind, and brute; what natural powers  
 Engender lightning, whence are falling showers. 125  
 He haunts Arcturus,—that fraternal twain

1 ne glittering Bears,—the Pleiads fraught with rain;  
—Why suns in winter, shunning heaven's steep heights  
Post seaward,—what impedes the tardy nights.  
The learned song from Tyrian hearers draws 130  
Loud shouts,—the Trojans echo the applause.  
—But, lengthening out the night with converse new,  
Large draughts of love unhappy Dido drew;  
Of Priam ask'd, of Hector—o'er and o'er—  
What arms the son of bright Aurora wore;— 135  
What steeds the car of Diomed could boast;  
Among the leaders of the Grecian host  
How look'd Achilles, their dread paramount—  
“But nay—the fatal wiles, O guest, recount,  
Retrace the Grecian cunning from its source, 140  
Your own grief and your friends'—your wandering course;  
For now, till this seventh summer have ye rang'd  
The sea, or trod the earth, to peace estrang'd.”

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1823

**“ARMS AND THE MAN I SING, THE FIRST WHO BORE”**

The following version of the first few lines of the *Æneid* were copied by Professor Reed of Philadelphia, with Mrs. Wordsworth's permission, during a visit to Rydal Mount in 1854, four years after the poet's death. Mrs. Reed kindly sent them to me.—ED.

Arms and the Man I sing, the first who bore  
His course to Latium from the Trojan shore,  
A fugitive of fate. Long time was he  
By powers celestial tossed on land and sea  
Thro' wrathful Juno's far-famed enmity;  
Much too from war endured till new abodes  
He planted, and in Latium fixed his Gods,  
Whence flows the Latin people, whence have come  
The Alban Sites and walls of lofty Rome.

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**1826**

**LINES ADDRESSED TO JOANNA H. FROM  
GWERNDWFFNANT IN JUNE 1826**

BY DOROTHY WORDSWORTH[\[395\]](#)

A twofold harmony is here;  
I listen with the bodily ear,  
But dull and cheerless is the sound  
Contrasted with the heart's rebound.

Now at the close of fervid June, 5  
Upon this breathless hazy noon,  
I seek the deepest darkest shade  
Within the covert of that glade,

Which you and I first named our own  
When primroses were fully blown, 10  
Oaks just were budding, and the grove  
Rang with the gladdest songs of love.

Then did the Leader of the Band,  
A gallant thrush, maintain his stand  
Unshrouded from the eye of day 15  
Upon yon Beech's topmost spray.

Within the selfsame lofty tree  
A thrush sings now—perchance 'tis he—  
The lusty joyous gallant bird,  
Which on that April morn we heard. 20

But oh! how different that voice  
Which bade the very hills rejoice.  
Through languid air, through leafy boughs  
It falls, and can no echo rouse.

But on the workings of my heart 25  
Doth memory act a busy part;  
That jocund April morn lives there,  
Its cheering sounds, its hues so fair



its cheering sounds, its hues so fair.

Why mixes with remembrance blithe  
What nothing but the restless scythe 30  
Of Death can utterly destroy,  
A heaviness, a dull alloy?

Ah Friend! thy heart can answer why.  
Even then I heaved a bitter sigh,  
No word of sorrow did'st thou speak, 35  
But tears stole down thy tremulous cheek.

The wished for hour at length was come,  
And thou had'st housed me in thy home,  
On fair Gwerndwffnant's billowy hill,  
Had'st led me to its crystal rill, 40

And led me through the dingle deep  
Up to the highest grassy steep,  
The sheep walk where the snow-white lambs  
Sported beside their quiet dams.

But thou wert destined to remove 45  
From all these objects of thy love,  
In this thy later day to roam  
Far off, and seek another home.

Now thou art gone—belike 'tis best—  
And I remain a passing guest, 50  
Yet for thy sake, beloved Friend,  
When from this spot my way shall tend,

And if my timid soul might dare  
To shape the future in its prayer,  
Then fervently would I entreat 55

Our gracious God to guide thy feet  
Back to the peaceful sunny cot,  
Where thou so oft hast blessed thy lot.

[395] I owe my knowledge of this and the following poem to the nephew of Mrs. Wordsworth, the Reverend Thomas Hutchinson of Kimbolton, Herefordshire, who wrote: "The two following poems were found among his papers on the demise of Mr. Monkhouse—a first cousin of Wordsworth; the first in the hand-writing of Wordsworth's wife, and the second of her daughter."—ED.

## **HOLIDAY AT GWERNDWFFNANT, MAY 1826**

### **IRREGULAR STANZAS**

BY DOROTHY WORDSWORTH

You're here for one long vernal day;  
We'll give it all to social play,  
Though forty years have rolled away  
    Since we were young as you.

Then welcome to our spacious Hall! 5  
Tom, Bessy, Mary, welcome all!  
Though removed from busy men,  
Yea lonesome as the foxes' den,  
'Tis a place for joyance fit,  
For frolic games and inborn wit. 10

'Twas nature built this hall of ours;  
She shap'd the bank; she framed the bowers  
    That close it all around;  
From her we hold our precious right,  
And here, thro' live-long day and night, 15  
    She rules with modest sway.

Our carpet is our verdant sod;  
A richer one was never trod  
    In prince's proud saloon.  
Purple, and gold, and spotless white, 20  
And quivering shade, and sunny light,  
    Blend with the emerald green.

She opened for the mountain brook  
    A gentle winding pebbly way  
Into this placid secret nook. 25  
Its bell-like tinkling—list, you hear—  
'Tis never loud, yet always clear  
    As linnet's song in May.

And we have other music here:  
A thousand songsters through the year 30  
Dwell in these happy groves,  
And in this season of their loves  
They join their voices with the doves  
To raise a perfect harmony.

Thus spake I while with sober pace 35  
We slipped into that chosen place  
And from the centre of our Hall  
The young ones played around,  
Then, like a flock of vigorous lambs,  
That quit their grave and slow-paced dams 40  
To frolic o'er the mead,

That innocent fraternal troop  
Erewhile a steady listening group  
Off starting—Girl and Boy  
In gamesome race with agile bound 45  
Beat o'er and o'er the grassy ground  
As if in motion—perfect joy.

So vanishes my idle scheme  
That we through this long vernal day,  
Associates in their youthful play, 50  
With them might travel in one stream.  
Ah! how should we whose heads are grey?  
Light was my heart, my spirits gay,  
And fondly did I dream.

But now, recalled to consciousness, 55  
With weight of years, of changed estate,  
Thought is not needed to repress  
Those shapeless fancies of delight

That flash before my dazzled sight  
Upon this joy-devoted morn. 60

Gladly we seek the stillest nook  
Whence we may read, as in a book,  
A history of years gone by,  
Recalled to faded memory's eye  
By bright reflection from the mirth 65  
Of youthful hearts—a transient second-birth  
Of our own childish days.

Pleasure unbidden is their guide  
Their leader—faithful to their side  
Prompting each wayward feat of strength: 70  
The ambitious leap, the emulous race,  
The startling shout, the mimic chase,  
The simple half-disguisèd wile  
Detected through the flattering smile.

A truce to this unbridled course 75  
Doth intervene—no need of force.  
We spread upon the flowery grass  
The noontide meal—each lad and lass  
Obeys the call—we form a Round,  
And all are seated on the ground. 80

The sun's meridian hour is passed,  
Again begins the emulous race,  
Again succeeds the sportive chase.  
And thus was spent that vernal day,  
Till twilight checked the noisy play; 85  
Then did they feel a languor spread  
Over their limbs, the beating tread  
Was stilled—the busy throbbing heart—

was stilled – the busy throbbing heart  
And silently we all depart.

The shelter of our rustic cot 90  
Receives us, and we envy not  
The palace, or the stately dome;  
But wish that *all* had such a home.  
Each child repeats his nightly prayer  
That God may bless their parents' care 95  
To guide them in the way of truth  
Through helpless childhood, giddy youth.

The closing hymn of cheerful praise  
Doth yet again their spirits raise;  
But 'tis not now a thoughtless joy. 100  
For tender parents, loving friends,  
And all the gifts God's blessing sends,  
Feelingly do they bless his name.

That homage paid, the young retire  
With no unsatisfied desire; 105  
Theirs is one long, one steady sleep,  
Till the sun, tip-toe on the steep  
In front of our beloved cot,  
Casts on the walls her brightest beams.  
Within, a startling lustre streams. 110  
They all awaken suddenly;  
As at the touch of magic skill,  
Or, as the pilgrim, at the bell  
That summons him to matin-prayer.

And is it sorrow that they feel? 115  
Nay! call it not by such a name,  
The stroke of sadness that doth steal

With rapid motion through their hearts,  
When comes the thought that yesterday  
With all its joys is passed away, 120  
    The long expected happy day.

An instant—and all sadness goes;  
Nor brighter looks the half-blown rose  
Than does the countenance of each child  
Whether of ardent soul or mild. 125  
The hour was fixed—they are prepared—  
And homeward now they must depart,  
And after many a brisk adieu,  
On pony trim, and fleet of limb,  
Their bustling journey they pursue. 130

The fair-hair'd gentle quiet maid,  
And she who is of daring mood,  
The valiant and the timid Boy  
Alike are ranged to hardihood;  
And wheresoe'er the troop appear 135  
They scatter smiles, a hearty cheer  
Comes from both old and young,  
And blessings fall from many a tongue.

They reach the dear paternal roof,  
Nor dread a cold or stern reproof, 140  
While they pour forth the history  
Of three days' mirth and revelry.  
Ah! Children, happy is your lot,  
Still bound together in one knot  
Beneath your tender mother's eye! 145  
Too soon these blessed days shall fly,  
And brothers shall from sisters part;  
And, trust me, whatsoe'er your doom.

Whate'er betide through years to come,  
The punctual pleasures of your home 150  
Shall linger in your thoughts,  
More clear than any future hope  
Though fancy take her freest scope.  
For oh! too soon your hearts shall own  
The past is all that is your own. 155

And every day of *festival*  
Gratefully shall ye then recal,  
Less for their own sakes than for this,  
That each shall be a resting-place  
For memory, and divide the race 160  
Of childhood's smooth and happy years,  
Thus lengthening out that term of life  
Which governed by your parents' care  
Is free from sorrow and from strife.

**COMPOSED WHEN A PROBABILITY EXISTED OF OUR  
BEING OBLIGED TO QUIT RYDAL MOUNT AS A  
RESIDENCE**

The following lines were written by Wordsworth in 1826. He never published them. They were the result of a slight disagreement between the Wordsworth family and the Le Flemings, which led the former to fear that they might have to "quit Rydal Mount as a residence." It was an insignificant difference, and the Wordsworths did not leave their home. The only thing worthy of record, in connection with the matter, is that the fear of being dispossessed led the poet to write what follows.—ED.





The doubt to which a wavering hope had clung  
Is fled; we must depart, willing or not;  
Sky-piercing Hills! must bid farewell to you  
And all that ye look down upon with pride,  
With tenderness, embosom; to your paths, 5  
And pleasant dwellings, to familiar trees  
And wild-flowers known as well as if our hands  
Had tended them: and O pellucid Spring!  
Unheard of, save in one small hamlet, here  
Not undistinguished, for of wells that ooze 10  
Or founts that gurgle from yon craggy steep,  
Their common sire, thou only bear'st his name.  
Insensibly the foretaste of this parting  
Hath ruled my steps, and seals me to thy side,  
Mindful that thou (ah! wherefore by my Muse 15  
So long unthanked) hast cheered a simple board  
With beverage pure as ever fixed the choice  
Of hermit, dubious where to scoop his cell;  
Which Persian kings might envy; and thy meek  
And gentle aspect oft has ministered 20  
To finer uses. They for me must cease;  
Days will pass on, the year, if years be given,  
Fade,—and the moralising mind derive  
No lessons from the presence of a Power  
By the inconstant nature we inherit 25  
Unmatched in delicate beneficence;  
For neither unremitting rains avail  
To swell thee into voice; nor longest drought  
Thy bounty stints, nor can thy beauty mar,  
Beauty not therefore wanting change to stir 30  
The fancy pleased by spectacles unlooked for.  
Nor yet, perchance, translucent Spring, had tolled

The Norman curfew bell when human hands  
First offered help that the deficient rock  
Might overarch thee, from pernicious heat 35  
Defended, and appropriate to man's need.  
Such ties will not be severed: but, when we  
Are gone, what summer loiterer will regard,  
Inquisitive, thy countenance, will peruse,  
Pleased to detect the dimpling stir of life, 40  
The breathing faculty with which thou yield'st  
(Tho' a mere goblet to the careless eye)  
Boons inexhaustible? Who, hurrying on  
With a step quickened by November's cold,  
Shall pause, the skill admiring that can work 45  
Upon thy chance-defilements—withered twigs  
That, lodged within thy crystal depths, seem bright,  
As if they from a silver tree had fallen—  
And oaken leaves that, driven by whirling blasts,  
Sunk down, and lay immersed in dead repose 50  
For Time's invisible tooth to prey upon  
Unsightly objects and uncoveted,  
Till thou with crystal bead-drops didst encrust  
Their skeletons, turned to brilliant ornaments.  
But, from thy bosom, should some venturous<sup>[396]</sup> hand 55  
Abstract those gleaming relics, and uplift them,  
However gently, toward the vulgar air,  
At once their tender brightness disappears,  
Leaving the intermeddler to upbraid  
His folly. Thus (I feel it while I speak), 60  
Thus, with the fibres of these thoughts it fares;  
And oh! how much, of all that love creates  
Or beautifies, like changes undergo,  
Suffers like loss when drawn out of the soul,  
Its silent laboratory! Words should sav 65

(Could they depict the marvels of thy cell)  
How often I have marked a plummy fern  
From the live rock with grace inimitable  
Bending its apex toward a paler self  
Reflected all in perfect lineaments— 70  
Shadow and substance kissing point to point  
In mutual stillness; or, if some faint breeze  
Entering the cell gave restlessness to one,  
The other, glassed in thy unruffled breast,  
Partook of every motion, met, retired, 75  
And met again. Such playful sympathy,  
Such delicate caress as in the shape  
Of this green plant had aptly recompensed  
For baffled lips and disappointed arms  
And hopeless pangs, the spirit of that youth, 80  
The fair Narcissus by some pitying God  
Changed to a crimson flower; when he, whose pride  
Provoked a retribution too severe,  
Had pined; upon his watery duplicate  
Wasting that love the nymphs implored in vain. 85

Thus while my Fancy wanders, thou, clear Spring,  
Moved (shall I say?) like a dear friend who meets  
A parting moment with her loveliest look,  
And seemingly her happiest, look so fair  
It frustrates its own purpose, and recalls 90  
The grieved one whom it meant to send away—  
Dost tempt me by disclosures exquisite  
To linger, bending over thee: for now,  
What witchcraft, mild enchantress, may with thee  
Compare! thy earthly bed a moment past 95  
Palpable to sight as the dry ground,  
Eludes perception, not by rippling air  
Concealed, not through effect of some impure

Concealed, nor through effect of some impure  
Upstirring; but, abstracted by a charm  
Of my own cunning, earth mysteriously 100  
From under thee hath vanished, and slant beams  
The silent inquest of a western sun,  
Assisting, lucid well-spring! Thou revealest  
Communion without check of herbs and flowers,  
And the vault's hoary sides to which they cling, 105  
Imaged in downward show; the flower, the Herbs,[\[397\]](#)  
*These* not of earthly texture, and the vault  
Not *there* diminutive, but through a scale  
Of vision less and less distinct, descending  
To gloom imperishable. So (if truths 110  
The highest condescend to be set forth  
By processes minute), even so—when thought  
Wins help from something greater than herself—  
Is the firm basis of habitual sense  
Supplanted, not for treacherous vacancy 115  
And blank dissociation from a world  
We love, but that the residues of flesh,  
Mirrored, yet not too strictly, may refine  
To Spirit; for the idealising Soul  
Time wears the features of Eternity; 120  
And Nature deepens into Nature's God.

Millions of kneeling Hindoos at this day  
Bow to the watery element, adored  
In their vast stream, and if an age hath been  
(As books and haply votive altars vouch) 125  
When British floods were worshipped, some faint trace  
Of that idolatry, through monkish rites  
Transmitted far as living memory,  
Might wait on thee, a silent monitor,  
On thee, bright Spring, a bashful little one, 130

Yet to the measure of thy promises  
True, as the mightiest; upon thee, sequestered  
For meditation, nor inopportune  
For social interest such as I have shared.  
Peace to the sober matron who shall dip 135  
Her pitcher here at early dawn, by me  
No longer greeted—to the tottering sire,  
For whom like service, now and then his choice,  
Relieves the tedious holiday of age—  
Thoughts raised above the Earth while here he sits 140  
Feeding on sunshine—to the blushing girl  
Who here forgets her errand, nothing loth  
To be waylaid by her betrothed, peace  
And pleasure sobered down to happiness!

But should these hills be ranged by one whose soul 145  
Scorning love-whispers shrinks from love itself  
As Fancy's snare for female vanity,  
Here may the aspirant find a trysting-place  
For loftier intercourse. The Muses crowned  
With wreaths that have not faded to this hour 150  
Sprung from high Jove, of sage Mnemosyne  
Enamoured, so the fable runs; but they  
Certes were self-taught damsels, scattered births  
Of many a Grecian vale, who sought not praise,  
And, heedless even of listeners, warbled out 155  
Their own emotions given to mountain air  
In notes which mountain echoes would take up  
Boldly and bear away to softer life;  
Hence deified as sisters they were bound  
Together in a never-dying choir; 160  
Who with their Hippocrene and grottoed fount  
Of Castaly, attest that Woman's heart  
Was in the limpid age of this stained world

The most assured seat of [ ]  
And new-born waters, deemed the happiest source 165  
Of inspiration for the conscious lyre.

Lured by the crystal element in times  
Stormy and fierce, the Maid of Arc withdrew  
From human converse to frequent alone  
The Fountain of the Fairies. What to her, 170  
Smooth summer dreams, old favours of the place.  
Pageant and revels of blithe elves—to her  
Whose country groan'd under a foreign scourge?  
She pondered murmurs that attuned her ear  
For the reception of far other sounds 175  
Than their too happy minstrelsy,—a Voice  
Reached her with supernatural mandate charged  
More awful than the chambers of dark earth  
Have virtue to send forth. Upon the marge  
Of the benignant fountain, while she stood 180  
Gazing intensely, the translucent lymph  
Darkened beneath the shadow of her thoughts  
As if swift clouds swept o'er it, or caught  
War's tincture, 'mid the forest green and still,  
Turned into blood before her heart-sick eye. 185  
Erelong, forsaking all her natural haunts,  
All her accustomed offices and cares  
Relinquishing, but treasuring every law  
And grace of feminine humanity,  
The chosen Rustic urged a warlike steed 190  
Toward the beleaguered city, in the might  
Of prophecy, accoutred to fulfil,  
At the sword's point, visions conceived in love.

The cloud of rooks descending thro' mid air  
Softens its evening uproar towards a close [\[398\]](#) 195  
Near and more near: for this protracted strain

... and more near, for this protracted strain  
A warning not unwelcome. Fare thee well!  
Emblem of equanimity and truth,  
Farewell!—if thy composure be not ours,  
Yet as thou still, when we are gone, wilt keep 200  
Thy living chaplet of fresh flowers and fern,  
Cherished in shade tho’ peeped at[399] by the sun;  
So shall our bosoms feel a covert growth  
Of grateful recollections, tribute due  
To thy obscure and modest attributes 205  
To thee, dear Spring,[400] and all-sustaining Heaven!

[396] The MS. has a second reading, “covetous hand.”—ED.

[397] In MS. also “its herbs.”—ED.

[398]

... to a close

From a MS. copied at Rydal by Professor Reed in 1854.

[399]

... pecked at ...

From a MS. copied at Rydal by Professor Reed in 1854.

[400]

... clear Spring ...

From a MS. copied at Rydal by Professor Reed in 1854.

## “I, WHOSE PRETTY VOICE YOU HEAR”

These lines were written for Miss Fanny Barlow of Middlethorpe Hall, York. She was first married to the Rev. E. Trafford Leigh, and afterwards to



Dr. Eason Wilkinson of Manchester.—ED.

I, whose pretty Voice you hear,  
Lady (you will think it queer),  
Have a Mother, once a Statue,  
I, thus boldly looking at you,  
Do the name of Paphus bear, 5  
Fam'd Pygmalion's Son and Heir,  
By that wondrous marble wife  
That from Venus took her life.  
Cupid's Nephew then am I,  
Nor unskill'd his darts to ply; 10  
But from Him I crav'd no warrant,  
Coming thus to seek my Parent;  
Not equipp'd with bow and quiver  
Her by menace to deliver,  
But resolv'd with filial care 15  
Her captivity to share.  
Hence, while on your toilet, She  
Is doom'd a Pincushion to be,  
By her side I'll take my place,  
As a humble Needle-case; 20  
Furnish'd too with dainty thread,  
For a Sempstress thorough-bred.  
Then let both be kindly treated,  
Till the Term, for which She's fated  
Durance to sustain, be over; 25  
So will I ensure a Lover  
Lady! to your heart's content;  
But on harshness are you bent  
Bitterly shall you repent,  
When to Cyprus back I go 30  
And take up my Uncle's bow.

*Composed*, and in part transcribed, for Fanny Barlow, by her affectionate  
Friend

WM. WORDSWORTH.

RYDAL MOUNT, *Shortest Day*, 1826.

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**1827**

**TO MY NIECE DORA**

BY DOROTHY WORDSWORTH

The following lines were written in Dora Wordsworth's "Album," in which Sir Walter Scott also wrote some verses.—ED.

Confiding hopes of youthful hearts,  
And each bright visionary scheme,  
Shall here remain in vivid hues  
The hues of a celestial dream.

The farewell of the laurelled Knight 5  
Traced by a brave but tremulous hand,  
Pledge of his truth and loyalty  
Thro' changeful years, unchanged shall stand.

But why should I inscribe my name,  
No Poet I—no longer young? 10  
The ambition of a loving heart  
Makes garrulous the tongue.

Memorials of thy aged Friend  
Dora thou dost not need;  
And when the cold earth covers her 15  
No flattery shall she heed.

Yet still a lurking wish prevails  
That when from life we all have passed  
The friends who loved thy Father's name  
On her's a thought may cast. 20

DOROTHY WORDSWORTH.

*January 1827.*

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1829

**“MY LORD AND LADY DARLINGTON”**

These lines were written by Wordsworth, after reading a sentence in the Stranger’s Book at “The Station,”—not a railway station!—on the western side of Windermere lake, opposite Bowness. Their poetic merit is slight, but they illustrate the honesty and directness of the writer’s mind. The Stranger’s Book at “The Station” contained the following:—

“Lord and Lady Darlington, Lady Vane, Miss Taylor, and Captain Stamp pronounce this Lake superior to Lac de Genève, Lago de Como, Lago Maggiore, L’Eau de Zurich, Loch Lomond, Loch Katerine, or the Lakes of Killarney.”-  
ED.

My Lord and Lady Darlington,  
I would not speak in snarling-tone;  
Nor, to you, good Lady Vane,  
Would I give one moment's pain;  
Nor Miss Taylor, Captain Stamp, 5  
Would I your flights of *memory* cramp.  
Yet, having spent a summer's day  
On the green margin of Loch Tay,  
And doubled (prospect ever bettering)  
The mazy reaches of Loch Katerine, 10  
And more than once been free at Luss,  
Loch Lomond's beauties to discuss,  
And wished, at least, to hear the blarney  
Of the sly boatmen of Killarney,  
And dipped my hand in dancing wave 15  
Of Eau de Zurich, Lac Genève,  
And bowed to many a major domo  
On stately terraces of Como,  
And seen the Simplon's forehead hoary,  
Reclined on Lago Maggiore 20  
At breathless eventide at rest  
On the broad water's placid breast,  
I, not insensible, Heaven knows,  
To all the charms this Station shows,  
Must tell you, Captain, Lord, and Ladies— 25  
For honest worth one poet's trade is—  
That your praise appears to me  
Folly's own hyperbole.

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1833

TO THE UTILITARIANS

These lines were written and sent in a letter to Henry Crabb Robinson, dated 5th May 1833.—ED.

Avaunt this œconomic rage!  
What would it bring?—an iron age,  
Where Fact with heartless search explored  
Shall be Imagination's Lord,  
And sway with absolute controul 5  
The god-like Functions of the Soul.  
Not *thus* can knowledge elevate  
Our Nature from her fallen state.  
With sober Reason Faith unites  
To vindicate the ideal rights 10  
Of human-kind—the tone agreeing  
Of objects with internal seeing,  
Of effort with the end of Being.

Wordsworth added, in the letter to Robinson, “Is the above intelligible? I fear not! I know, however, my own meaning, and that's enough for Manuscripts.”—ED.

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1835

**“THRONED IN THE SUN’S DESCENDING CAR”**

These lines were placed by Wordsworth amongst the “Evening Voluntaries” in the two editions of *Yarrow Revisited and other Poems* (1835, 1836); but they were never afterwards reprinted in his life-time.—ED.

For printing the following Piece, some reason should be given, as not a word of it is original: it is simply a fine stanza of Akenside,<sup>[401]</sup> connected with a still finer from Beattie<sup>[402]</sup> by a couplet of Thomson.<sup>[403]</sup> This practice, in which the author sometimes indulges, of linking together, in his own mind, favourite passages from different authors, seemed in itself unobjectionable; but, as the *publishing* such compilations might lead to confusion in literature, he should deem himself inexcusable in giving this specimen, were it not from a hope that it might open to others a harmless source of *private* gratification.—W. W. 1835.

Throned in the Sun's descending car,  
What Power unseen diffuses far  
This tenderness of mind?  
What Genius smiles on yonder flood?  
What God in whispers from the wood 5  
Bids every thought be kind?

O ever-pleasing solitude,  
Companion of the wise and good.

Thy shades, thy silence, now be mine  
Thy charms my only theme; 10

Why haunt the hollow cliff whose Pine  
Waves o'er the gloomy stream;  
Whence the scared Owl on pinions grey  
Breaks from the rustling boughs,  
And down the lone vale sails away 15  
To more profound repose!

[401] See his Ode V., *Against Suspicion*, stanza viii.—ED.

[402] See his poem, *Retirement*, 1758.—ED.

[403] See his *Hymn on Solitude*, which begins, "Hail, ever-pleasing Solitude!"—ED.

## **"AND OH! DEAR SOOTHER OF THE PENSIVE BREAST"**

The following ten lines were written by Wordsworth in a copy of his works, after the lines *To the Moon* (Rydal) 1835. They may have been intended as a possible sequel to them, or to the lines *To the Moon, composed by the Seaside—on the coast of Cumberland* (1835).—ED.

And oh! dear soother of the pensive breast,  
Let homelier words without offence attest  
How where on random topics as they hit  
The moments' humour, rough Tars spend their wit.  
Thy changes, which to wiser Spirits seem 5  
Dark as a riddle, prove a favourite theme;  
Thy motions, intricate and manifold,  
Oft help to make bold fancy's flight more bold;  
Beget strange themes; and to freaks give birth  
Of speech as wild as ever heightened mirth. 10

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**1836**

**“SAID RED-RIBBONED EVANS”**

On the 26th of March 1836, Wordsworth sent the following lines to Henry Crabb Robinson; written, he tells him, “immediately on reading Evans’s modest self-defence speech the other day.” George de Lacy Evans was radical member of Parliament for Westminster. “In 1835, he took command of the British Legion raised for the service of the Queen Regent of Spain against Don Carlos.” (Professor Dowden.)—ED.

Said red-ribboned Evans:  
“My legions in Spain  
Were at sixes and sevens;  
Now they’re famished or slain:  
But no fault of mine, 5  
For, like brave Philip Sidney,  
In campaigning I shine,  
A true knight of his kidney.  
Sound flogging and fighting  
No chief, on my troth, 10  
E’er took such delight in  
As I in them both.  
Fontarabbia can tell  
How my eyes watched the foe,  
Hernani knows well 15  
That our feet were not slow;  
Our hospitals, too,  
They are matchless in story;  
Where her thousands Fate slew,  
All panting for glory.” 20  
Alas for this Hero!  
His fame touched the skies,  
Then fell below zero,  
Never, never to rise!  
For him to Westminster 25  
Did Prudence convey,  
There safe as a Spinster  
The Patriot to play.  
But why be so glad on  
His feats or his fall? 30  
He’s got his red ribbon,  
And laughs at us all.

---

1837

**ON AN EVENT IN COL. EVANS'S REDOUBTED  
PERFORMANCES IN SPAIN**

Mrs. Wordsworth sent this to Henry Crabb Robinson in 1837, “to show you that we can write an Epigram—we *do not say* a good one.” She then quoted it, and added, “The Producer thinks it not amiss, as being murmured between sleep and awake over the fire, while thinking of you last night!”—Ed.

The Ball whizzed by,—it grazed his ear,  
And whispered as it flew,  
“I only touch—not take—don’t fear,  
For both, my honest Buccaneer!  
Are to the Pillory due.”

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**1838**

**“WOULDST THOU BE GATHERED TO CHRIST’S  
CHOSEN FLOCK”**

The following lines were cut on the face of a rock at Rydal Mount in 1838. There, they still remain.—ED.

Wouldst thou be gathered to Christ’s chosen flock,  
Shun the broad way too easily explored,  
And let thy path be hewn out of the Rock,  
The living Rock of God’s eternal Word.

**PROTEST AGAINST THE BALLOT, 1838**[\[404\]](#)

Composed 1838.—Published 1838



Forth rushed, from Envy sprung and Self-conceit,  
A Power misnamed the SPIRIT OF REFORM,  
And through the astonished Island swept in storm,  
Threatening to lay all Orders at her feet  
That crossed her way. Now stoops she to entreat  
Licence to hide at intervals her head,  
Where she may work, safe, undisquieted,  
In a close Box, covert for Justice meet.  
St. George of England! keep a watchful eye  
Fixed on the Suitor; frustrate her request— 10  
Stifle her hope; for, if the State comply,  
From such Pandorian gift may come a Pest  
Worse than the Dragon that bowed low his crest,  
Pierced by thy spear in glorious victory.

[404] In his notes to the volume of *Collected Sonnets* (1838), Wordsworth writes:—“‘*Protest against the Ballot.*’ Having in this notice alluded only in general terms to the mischief which, in my opinion, the Ballot would bring along with it, without especially branding its immoral and antisocial tendency (for which no political advantages, were they a thousand times greater than those presumed upon, could be a compensation), I have been impelled to subjoin a reprobation of it upon that score. In no part of my writings have I mentioned the name of any contemporary, that of Buonaparte only excepted, but for the purpose of eulogy; and therefore, as in the concluding verse of what follows, there is a deviation from this rule (for the blank will be easily filled up) I have excluded the sonnet from the body of the collection, and placed it here as a public record of my detestation, both as a man and a citizen, of the proposed contrivance.”

Then follows the sonnet beginning—

Said Secrecy to Cowardice and Fraud.

ED.

**“SAID SECRECY TO COWARDICE AND FRAUD”**

Composed, probably, in 1838.—Published 1838[\[405\]](#)

Said Secrecy to Cowardice and Fraud,  
Falsehood and Treachery, in close council met,  
Deep under ground, in Pluto's cabinet,  
"The frost of England's pride will soon be thawed;  
Hooded the open brow that overawed 5  
Our schemes; the faith and honour, never yet  
By us with hope encountered, be upset;—  
For once I burst my bands, and cry, applaud!"  
Then whispered she, "The Bill is carrying out!"  
They heard, and, starting up, the Brood of Night 10  
Clapped hands, and shook with glee their matted locks;  
All Powers and Places that abhor the light  
Joined in the transport, echoed back their shout,  
Hurrah for ——, hugging his Ballot-box![\[406\]](#)

[\[405\]](#) This was first published in a note to the sonnet entitled *Protest against the Ballot*, in the volume of 1838. It was never republished by Wordsworth.

[\[406\]](#) See the note to the previous sonnet. George Grote was the person satirised. "Since that time," adds Mr. Reed, in a note to his American edition, "Mr. Grote's political notoriety, as an advocate of the ballot, has been merged in the high reputation he has acquired as probably the most eminent modern historian of ancient Greece"—ED.

## **A POET TO HIS GRANDCHILD (SEQUEL TO THE FOREGOING)[\[407\]](#)**

Published 1838

“Son of my buried Son, while thus thy hand  
Is clasping mine, it saddens me to think  
How Want may press thee down, and with thee sink  
Thy Children left unfit, through vain demand  
Of culture, even to feel or understand 5  
My simplest Lay that to their memory  
May cling;—hard fate! which haply need not be  
Did Justice mould the Statutes of the Land.  
A Book time-cherished and an honoured name  
Are high rewards; but bound they Nature’s claim 10  
Or Reason’s? No—hopes spun in timid line  
From out the bosom of a modest home  
Extend through unambitious years to come,  
My careless Little-one, for thee and thine!” [\[408\]](#)[\[409\]](#)

[\[407\]](#) “The foregoing” was the Sonnet named *A Plea for Authors*, May 1838.  
—ED.

[\[408\]](#) 1836.

Son of my buried Son, whose tiny hand  
Thus clings to mine, it {saddens} me to think  
                                {troubles}  
That thou pressed down by poverty mayst sink  
Even till thy children shall in vain demand  
{Culture and neither feel nor} understand  
{Culture required to feel and}  
{My simplest lay that to their memory}  
{My least recondite lay, which memory}  
{Perchance may cleave}; hard fate, which need not be  
{May keep in trust }  
Did justice mould the statutes of the land.  
{A book time-cherished} and an honoured name  
{A cherished volume }  
Are high rewards, but bound not {Reason's} claim.  
                                               {Nature's}  
No—hopes {in fond hereditary line }  
                            {and wishes in a living line}  
Spun from the bosom of a modest home  
Extend thro' unambitious years to come,  
My careless Little-one, for thee and thine!

MS.

[409] The author of an animated article, printed in the *Law Magazine*, in favour of the principle of Serjeant Talfourd's Copyright Bill, precedes me in the public expression of this feeling; which had been forced too often upon my own mind, by remembering how few descendants of men eminent in literature are even known to exist.—W.W. 1838.

This sonnet was not addressed to any grandson of the Poet's.—ED.

1840

ON A PORTRAIT OF I.F., PAINTED BY MARGARET  
GILLIES<sup>[410]</sup>

Composed 1840.—Published 1850

We gaze—nor grieve to think that we must die,  
But that the precious love this friend hath sown  
Within our hearts, the love whose flower hath blown  
Bright as if heaven were ever in its eye,  
Will pass so soon from human memory; 5  
And not by strangers to our blood alone,  
But by our best descendants be unknown,  
Unthought of—this may surely claim a sigh.  
Yet, blessèd Art, we yield not to dejection:  
Thou against Time so feelingly dost strive; 10  
Where'er, preserved in this most true reflection,  
An image of her soul is kept alive,  
Some lingering fragrance of the pure affection,  
Whose flower with us will vanish, must survive.

WILLIAM WORDSWORTH.

RYDAL MOUNT, *New Year's Day, 1840.*

<sup>[410]</sup> See the note to the next sonnet.—ED.

## TO I.F.[\[411\]](#)

Composed 1840.—Published 1850

The star which comes at close of day to shine  
More heavenly bright than when it leads the morn,  
Is friendship's emblem,[\[412\]](#) whether the forlorn  
She visiteth, or, shedding light benign  
Through shades that solemnize Life's calm decline, 5  
Doth make the happy happier. This have we  
Learnt, Isabel, from thy society,  
Which now we too unwillingly resign  
Though for brief absence. But farewell! the page  
Glimmers before my sight through thankful tears, 10  
Such as start forth, not seldom, to approve  
Our truth, when we, old yet unchill'd by age,  
Call thee, though known but for a few fleet years,  
The heart-affianced sister of our love!

WILLIAM WORDSWORTH.

RYDAL MOUNT, *Feb. 1840.*

[\[411\]](#) This and the preceding sonnet, beginning "We gaze—nor grieve to think that we must die," were addressed to Miss Fenwick, to whom we owe the invaluable "Fenwick Notes." Were it not that the date is very minutely given, I would believe that they belong to 1841, as Miss Gillies told me she resided at Rydal Mount in that year, when she painted Mrs. Wordsworth's portrait.—ED.

[\[412\]](#) 1850.

Bright is the star which comes at eve to shine  
More heavenly bright than when it leads the morn,  
And such is Friendship, whether the forlorn, etc. 1840.

## “OH BOUNTY WITHOUT MEASURE, WHILE THE GRACE”

In his copy of the edition of 1845 at the close of the poem, *Animal Tranquillity and Decay* (1798) (see the “Poem referring to the Period of Old Age,” vol. i. p. 307), Henry Crabb Robinson wrote the following lines, sent to him by Wordsworth.—ED.

Oh Bounty without measure, while the Grace  
Of Heaven doth in such wise from humblest springs  
Pour pleasures forth, and solaces that trace  
A mazy course along familiar things,  
Well may our hearts have faith that blessings come 5  
Streaming from points above the starry sky,  
With angels, when their own untroubled home  
They leave, and speed on mighty embassy  
To visit earthly chambers,—and for whom?  
Yea, both for souls who God’s forbearance try, 10  
And those that seek his help and for his mercy sigh.

*7th April 1840. My 70th Birthday.*

W.W.

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1842

**THE EAGLE AND THE DOVE**[\[413\]](#)

The following poem was contributed to, and printed in, a volume entitled “*La Petite Chouannerie, ou Histoire d’un Collège Breton sous l’Empire*. Par A. F. Rio. Londres: Moxon, Dover Street, 1842,” pp. 62, 63. The Hon. Mrs. Norton, Walter Savage Landor, and Monckton Milnes (Lord Houghton), were among the other English contributors to the volume, the bulk of which is in French. It was printed at Paris, and numbered 398 pages, including the title. It was a narrative of “the romantic revolt of the royalist students of the college of Vannes in 1815, and of their battles with the soldiers of the French Empire.” (H. REED.)—ED.

Composed (?).—Published 1842



Shade of Caractacus, if spirits love  
The cause they fought for in their earthly home,  
To see the Eagle ruffled by the Dove  
May soothe thy memory of the chains of Rome.

These children claim thee for their sire; the breath 5  
Of thy renown, from Cambrian mountains, fans  
A flame within them that despises death,  
And glorifies the truant youth of Vannes.

With thy own scorn of tyrants they advance,  
But truth divine has sanctified their rage, 10  
A silver cross enchased with flowers of France  
Their badge, attests the holy fight they wage.

The shrill defiance of the young crusade  
Their veteran foes mock as an idle noise;  
But unto Faith and Loyalty comes aid 15  
From Heaven, gigantic force to beardless boys.

[413] In the volume from which the above is copied, the original French lines (commencing at p. 106) are printed side by side with Wordsworth's translation, which ends on p. 111, and closes the volume.—ED.

## GRACE DARLING[414]

Composed 1842.—Published 1845

Wordsworth's lines on Grace Darling were printed privately, and anonymously, at Carlisle, before they were included in the 1845 edition of his works. A copy was sent to Mr. Dyce, and is preserved in the Dyce Library at South Kensington. Another was sent to Professor Reed (March 27, 1843), with a letter, in which the following occurs: "I threw it off two or three weeks ago, being in a great measure impelled to it by the desire I felt

to do justice to the memory of a heroine, whose conduct presented, some time ago, a striking contrast to the inhumanity with which our countrymen, shipwrecked lately upon the French coast, have been treated.”

Edward Quillinan, writing on 25th March 1843, enclosed a copy, adding, “Mr. Wordsworth desires me to send you the enclosed eulogy on Grace Darling, recently composed. He begs me to say that he wishes it kept out of the newspapers, as he has printed it only for some of his friends, and his friends’ friends more peculiarly interested in the subject, for the present. Do not therefore give a copy to any one.”

“Almost immediately after I had composed my tribute to the memory of Grace Darling, I learnt that the Queen and Queen Dowager had both just subscribed towards the erection of a monument to record her heroism, upon the spot that witnessed it.” (Wordsworth to Sir W. Gomm, March 24, 1843.)  
—ED.

Among the dwellers in the silent fields  
The natural heart is touched, and public way  
And crowded streets resound with ballad strains,  
Inspired by ONE whose very name bespeaks  
Favour divine, exalting human love; 5  
Whom, since her birth on bleak Northumbria's coast,  
Known unto few but prized as far as known,  
A single Act endears to high and low  
Through the whole land—to Manhood, moved in spite  
Of the world's freezing cares—to generous Youth— 10  
To Infancy, that lisps her praise—to Age  
Whose eye reflects it, glistening through a tear  
Of tremulous admiration. Such true fame  
Awaits her *now*; but, verily, good deeds  
Do no imperishable record find 15  
Save in the rolls of heaven, where hers may live  
A theme for angels, when they celebrate  
The high-souled virtues which forgetful earth  
Has witness'd. Oh! that winds and waves could speak  
Of things which their united power called forth 20  
From the pure depths of her humanity!  
A Maiden gentle, yet, at duty's call,  
Firm and unflinching, as the Lighthouse reared  
On the Island-rock, her lonely dwelling-place;  
Or like the invincible Rock itself that braves, 25  
Age after age, the hostile elements,  
As when it guarded holy Cuthbert's cell.[\[415\]](#)

All night the storm had raged, nor ceased, nor paused,  
When, as day broke, the Maid, through misty air,  
Espies far off a Wreck, amid the surf, 30  
Beating on one of those disastrous isles—

Half of a Vessel, half—no more; the rest  
Had vanished, swallowed up with all that there  
Had for the common safety striven in vain,  
Or thither thronged for refuge.[\[416\]](#) With quick glance 35  
Daughter and Sire through optic-glass discern,  
Clinging about the remnant of this Ship,  
Creatures—how precious in the Maiden's sight!  
For whom, belike, the old Man grieves still more  
Than for their fellow-sufferers engulfed 40  
Where every parting agony is hushed,  
And hope and fear mix not in further strife.  
“But courage, Father! let us out to sea—  
A few may yet be saved.” The Daughter's words,  
Her earnest tone, and look beaming with faith, 45  
Dispel the Father's doubts: nor do they lack  
The noble-minded Mother's helping hand  
To launch the boat; and with her blessing cheered,  
And inwardly sustained by silent prayer,  
Together they put forth, Father and Child! 50  
Each grasps an oar, and struggling on they go—  
Rivals in effort; and, alike intent  
Here to elude and there surmount, they watch  
The billows lengthening, mutually crossed  
And shattered, and re-gathering their might; 55  
As if the tumult, by the Almighty's will  
Were, in the conscious sea, roused and prolonged,[\[417\]](#)  
That woman's fortitude—so tried, so proved—  
May brighten more and more!

True to the mark,  
They stem the current of that perilous gorge, 60  
Their arms still strengthening with the strengthening heart,  
Though danger, as the Wreck is near'd, becomes  
More imminent. Not unseen do they approach;

And rapture, with varieties of fear  
Incessantly conflicting, thrills the frames 65  
Of those who, in that dauntless energy,  
Foretaste deliverance; but the least perturbed  
Can scarcely trust his eyes, when he perceives  
That of the pair—tossed on the waves to bring  
Hope to the hopeless, to the dying, life— 70  
One is a Woman, a poor earthly sister,  
Or, be the Visitant other than she seems,  
A guardian Spirit sent from pitying Heaven,  
In woman's shape. But why prolong the tale,  
Casting weak words amid a host of thoughts 75  
Armed to repel them? Every hazard faced  
And difficulty mastered, with resolve  
That no one breathing should be left to perish,  
This last remainder of the crew are all  
Placed in the little boat, then o'er the deep 80  
Are safely borne, landed upon the beach,  
And, in fulfilment of God's mercy, lodged  
Within the sheltering Lighthouse.—Shout, ye Waves!  
Send forth a song of triumph. Waves and Winds,  
Exult in this deliverance wrought through faith 85  
In Him whose Providence your rage hath served![\[418\]](#)  
Ye screaming Sea-mews, in the concert join!  
And would that some immortal Voice—a Voice  
Fitly attuned to all that gratitude  
Breathes out from floor or couch, through pallid lips 90  
Of the survivors—to the clouds might bear—  
Blended with praise of that parental love,  
Beneath whose watchful eye the Maiden grew  
Pious and pure, modest and yet so brave,  
Though young so wise, though meek so resolute— 95  
Might carry to the clouds and to the stars

might carry to the clouds and to the stars,  
Yea, to celestial Choirs, GRACE DARLING's name!

[414] Grace Darling was the daughter of William Darling, the lighthouse keeper on Longstone, one of the Farne Islands on the Northumbrian coast. On the 7th of September 1838, the Forfarshire steamship was wrecked on these islands. At the instigation of his daughter, and accompanied by her, Darling went out in his lifeboat through the surf, to the wreck, and —by their united strength and daring—rescued the nine survivors.—ED.

[415] St. Cuthbert of Durham, born about 635, was first a shepherd boy, then a monk in the monastery of Melrose, and afterwards its prior. He left Melrose for the island monastery of Lindisfarne; but desiring an austerer life than the monastic, he left Lindisfarne, and became an anchorite, in a hut which he built with his own hands, on one of the Farne Islands. He was afterwards induced to accept the bishopric of Hexham, but soon exchanged it for the see in his old island home at Lindisfarne, and after two years there resigned his bishopric, returning to his cell in Farne Island, where he died in 687. His remains were carried to Durham, and placed within a costly shrine.—ED.

[416] Fifty-four persons had perished, before Grace Darling's lifeboat reached the wreck.—ED.

[417] 1845.

As if the wrath and trouble of the sea  
Were by the Almighty's sufferance prolonged,  
In privately printed edition.

[418] 1845.

For the last three lines, the privately printed edition has the single one—

Pipe a glad song of triumph, ye fierce Winds.

## **“WHEN SEVERN'S SWEEPING FLOOD HAD OVERTHROWN”**

Composed 23rd January 1842.—Published 1842

In 1842 a bazaar was held in Cardiff Castle to aid in the erection of a Church, on the site of one which had been washed away by a flood in the river Severn (and a consequent influx of waters into the estuary of the

British Channel) two hundred years before. Wordsworth and James Montgomery were asked to write some verses, which might be printed and sold to assist the cause. They did so. The following was Wordsworth's contribution.—ED.

When Severn's sweeping flood had overthrown  
St. Mary's Church, the preacher then would cry:—  
“Thus, Christian people, God his might hath shown  
That ye to him your love may testify;  
Haste, and rebuild the pile.”—But not a stone 5  
Resumed its place. Age after age went by,  
And Heaven still lacked its due, though piety  
In secret did, we trust, her loss bemoan.  
But now her Spirit hath put forth its claim  
In Power, and Poesy would lend her voice; 10  
Let the new Church be worthy of its aim,  
That in its beauty Cardiff may rejoice!  
Oh! in the past if cause there was for shame,  
Let not our times halt in their better choice.

RYDAL MOUNT, 23rd Jan. 1842.

## THE PILLAR OF TRAJAN

The Fenwick note to *The Pillar of Trajan* mentions that the author's son having declined to attempt to compete for the Oxford prize poem on “The Pillar of Trajan,” his father wrote it, to show him how the thing might be done. This son—the Rev. John Wordsworth of Brigham—wrote Latin verse with considerable success; and as specimens of the poetic work of Dorothy Wordsworth and of Sarah Hutchinson are included in these volumes, the following *Epistola ad Patrem suum*, written at Madeira by John Wordsworth in 1844, may be reproduced.—ED.

I pete longinquas, non segnis Epistola, terras,  
I pete, Rydaliae conscia saxa lyrae:  
I pete quà valles rident, sylvaeque lacusque,  
Quamvis Arctoo paenè sub axe jacent.  
Parvos quaere Lares, non aurea Tecta, poetae, 5  
Qui tamen ingenii sceptraque mentis habet.  
Quid faciat genitor? valeatne, an cura senilis  
Opprimat? Ista refer, filius ista rogat.  
Scire velit, quare venias tu scripta *latine*?  
Dic “fugio linguam, magne poeta, tuam! 10  
Quem Regina jubet circumdare tempora lauro,  
Quem verè vatem saecula nostra vocant.”  
Inde refer gressus responsaque tradita curae  
Fida tuae, numeris in loca digna senis,  
Haec ego tradiderim, majoribus ire per altum 15  
Nunc velis miserum me mea musa rapit.  
Solvimus è portu, navisque per aequora currit  
Neptuni auxilio fluctifragisque rotis.  
Neptunus videt attonitus, Neptunia conjux,  
Omnis et aequorei nympha comata chori. 20  
Radimus Hispanum litus, loca saxea crebris  
Gallorum belli nobilitata malis.  
Haud mora, sunt visae Gades,[\[419\]](#) urbs fabula quondam,  
Claraque ab Herculeo nomine, clara suo.  
Hanc magnam cognovit Arabs, Romanus candem, 25  
Utraque gens illi vimque decusque tulit.  
Hora brevis, fragilisque viris! similisque ruina  
Viribus humanis omnia facta manet  
Pulchra jaces, olim Carthaginis aemula magnae,  
Nataque famosae non inhonesta Tyri! 30  
En! ratibus navale caret, nautis caret alnus,  
Mercatorque fugit dives inane Forum.



Templa vacant pompâ, nitidisque theatra catervis,  
Tristis et it foedâ foemina virque via.  
Segnis in officiis, nec rectus ad aethera miles 35  
Pauperis et vestes, armaque juris habet.  
Sic gens quaeque perit,[420] quando civilia bella  
Viscera divellunt, jusque fidesque fugit.  
Auspiciis laetam nostris lux proxima pandit  
Te, Calpe[421] celsis imperiosa jugis. 40  
Urbs munimen habet nullo quassabile bello,  
Clastrum Tyrrhenis, clastrum et Atlantis, aquis.  
Undique nam vastae sustentant moenia rupes,  
Quae torvè in terras inque tuentur aquas.  
Arteque sunt mirâ sectae per saxa cavernae, 45  
Atria sanguineo saeva sacrata Deo.  
Urbs invicta tamen populis commercia tuta  
Praebet, et in portus illicit inque Forum.  
Hic Mercator adest Maurus cui rebus agendis.  
Ah! nimis est cordi Punica prisca fides; 50  
Afer et è mediis Libyae sitientis arenis,  
Suetus in immundâ vivere barbarie;  
Multus et aequoreis, ut quondam, Graius in undis,  
Degener, antiquum sic probat ille genus;  
Niliacae potator aquae, Judaeus, et omne 55  
Litus Tyrrhenum quos, et Atlantis, alit.  
Hos quàm dissimiles (linguae sive ora notentur)  
Hos quàm felices pace Britannus habet!  
Anglia! dum pietas et honos, dum nota per orbem  
Sit tibi in intacto pectore prisca fides; 60  
Dum pia cura tibi, magnos meruisse triumphos,  
Justaque per populos jura tulisse feros;  
Longinquas teneat tua vasta potentia terras,  
Et maneat Calpe gloria magna Tibi!  
Inscula Atlanteis assurgit ab aequoris undis 65

Insula flammigero assurgit ab aequoris undis, 65

Insula flammigero semper amata Deo,  
Seu teneat celsi flagrantia signa Leonis,  
Seu gyro Pisces interiore petat.

“Hic ver assiduum atque alienis mensibus aestas,”  
Flavus et autumnus frugibus usque tumet. 70

Non jacet Ionio felicior Insula ponto  
Ulla, nec Eoi fluctibus oceani.

Vix, Madeira! tuum nunc refert dicere nomen,  
Floribus, et Bacchi munere pingue solum.

Te vetus haud vanis cumulavit laudibus aetas, 75  
O fortunato conspicienda choro!

Haec nunc terra sinu nos detinet alma, proculque  
A Patriae curis, anxietate domi.

Sic cepisse ferunt humanae obliviae curae  
Quisquis Lethaeae pocula sumpsit aquae: 80

Sic semota sequi studiisque odiisque docebas  
Otia discipulos, docte Epicure, tuos.

Sed non ulla dies grato sine sole, nec ullo  
Frugae carens hortus tempore, [\[422\]](#) fronde nemus; [\[423\]](#)

Nec levis ignotis oneratus odoribus aer, 85

Quales doctus equum flectere novit Arabs;  
Nec caecae quaecumque jacent sub rupe cavernae, [\[424\]](#)

Quem nunquam radiis Phoebus adire potest;  
Nec currentis aquae strepitus, [\[425\]](#) nec saxa, petensque

Mons [\[426\]](#) excelsa suis sidera culminibus; 90  
Nec tranquilla quies, rerumque obliviae, ponti

Suadebunt iterum sollicitare vias!  
Rideat at quamvis haec vultu terra sereno,  
Tabescit pravo gens malefida jugo:  
Dum sedet heu! tristis morborum pallor in ore, 95

Crebraque anhelanti pectore tussis inest.  
Ambitus et luxus, totoque accersita mundo,

[419] Cadiz.

[420] Hispania hoc tempore bello civili divulsa fuit.

[421] Gibraltar.

[422] Sunt hibernis mensibus aurea mala.

[423] Laureae sylvae sunt.

[424] Antris abundat Insula.

[425] Multos rivos naturâ, mirâque humani ingenii arte constructos continet Madeira.

[426] Pace Lusitanorum Insula nil nisi mons est, rectis culminibus mari conspicua.

[427] Ventus ex Africa.—*Leste*.

See also the *Carmen Maiis calendis compositum*, the *Carmen ad Maium mensem*, and the *Somnivaga*,—evidently by the same writer,—in the appendix to the second edition of *Yarrow Revisited*, 1836.—ED.

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**1846**

**“DEIGN, SOVEREIGN MISTRESS! TO ACCEPT A LAY”**

In January 1846 Wordsworth sent a copy of his Poems to the Queen, for the Royal Library at Windsor, and inscribed the following lines upon the fly-leaf. For their republication I am indebted to the gracious permission of Her Majesty.—ED.

Deign, Sovereign Mistress![\[428\]](#) to accept a lay,  
No Laureate offering of elaborate art;  
But salutation taking its glad way  
From deep recesses of a loyal heart.

Queen, Wife, and Mother! may All-judging Heaven 5  
Shower with a bounteous hand on Thee and Thine  
Felicity that only can be given  
On earth to goodness blest by grace divine.

Lady! devoutly honoured and beloved  
Through every realm confided to thy sway; 10  
Mayst thou pursue thy course by God approved,  
And He will teach thy people to obey.

As thou art wont, thy sovereignty adorn  
With woman's gentleness, yet firm and staid;  
So shall that earthly crown thy brows have worn 15  
Be changed for one whose glory cannot fade.

And now, by duty urged, I lay this Book  
Before thy Majesty, in humble trust  
That on its simplest pages thou wilt look  
With a benign indulgence more than just. 20

Nor wilt thou blame an aged Poet's prayer,  
That issuing hence may steal into thy mind  
Some solace under weight of royal care,  
Or grief—the inheritance of humankind.

For know we not that from celestial spheres, 25  
When Time was young, an inspiration came  
(Oh, were it mine!) to hallow saddest tears,

A . . . . .

And help life onward in its noblest aim.

W.W.

*9th January 1846.*

[\[428\]](#) Compare the address presented by the Deputies of the Kingdom of Italy to Buonaparte, on Oct. 27, 1808, beginning, “Deign, Sovereign Master of all Things.”—ED.

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**1847**

**ODE, PERFORMED IN THE SENATE-HOUSE,  
CAMBRIDGE, ON THE 6TH OF JULY 1847, AT THE FIRST  
COMMENCEMENT AFTER THE INSTALLATION OF HIS  
ROYAL HIGHNESS THE PRINCE ALBERT,  
CHANCELLOR OF THE UNIVERSITY.**[\[429\]](#)

**INSTALLATION ODE**

Composed 1847.—Published 1847.

## INTRODUCTION AND CHORUS

For thirst of power that Heaven disowns,  
For temples, towers, and thrones,  
Too long insulted by the Spoiler's shock,  
    Indignant Europe cast  
    Her stormy foe at last  
To reap the whirlwind on a Libyan rock.

## SOLO.—TENOR

War is passion's basest game  
    Madly played to win a name;  
Up starts some tyrant, Earth and Heaven to dare;  
    The servile million bow;  
But will the lightning glance aside to spare  
    The Despot's laurelled brow?

## CHORUS

War is mercy, glory, fame,  
Waged in Freedom's holy cause;  
Freedom, such as Man may claim  
Under God's restraining laws.  
Such is Albion's fame and glory:  
Let rescued Europe tell the story.

## RECIT. (*accompanied*).—CONTRALTO

But lo, what sudden cloud has darkened all  
    The land as with a funeral pall?  
The Rose of England suffers blight,  
The flower has drooped, the Isle's delight,  
    Flower and bud together fall—



A Nation's hopes lie crushed in Claremont's desolate hall.

AIR.—SOPRANO

Time a chequered mantle wears;—  
    Earth awakes from wintry sleep;  
Again the Tree a blossom bears,—  
    Cease, Britannia, cease to weep!  
Hark to the peals on this bright May-morn!  
They tell that your future Queen is born!

SOPRANO SOLO AND CHORUS

    A Guardian Angel fluttered  
    Above the Babe, unseen;  
    One word he softly uttered—  
    It named the future Queen:  
And a joyful cry through the Island rang,  
As clear and bold as the trumpet's clang,  
    As bland as the reed of peace—  
    “VICTORIA be her name!”  
For righteous triumphs are the base  
Whereon Britannia rests her peaceful fame.

QUARTETT

Time, in his mantle's sunniest fold,  
Uplifted in his arms the child;  
And, while the fearless Infant smiled,  
Her happier destiny foretold:—  
    “Infancy, by Wisdom mild,  
    Trained to health and artless beauty;  
    Youth, by Pleasure unbeguiled  
    From the lore of lofty duty;  
    Womanhood in pure renown.

Remained in pure renown,  
Seated on her lineal throne:  
Leaves of myrtle in her Crown,  
Fresh with lustre all their own.  
Love, the treasure worth possessing  
More than all the world beside,  
This shall be her choicest blessing,  
Oft to royal hearts denied.”

RECIT. (*accompanied*).—BASS

That eve, the Star of Brunswick shone  
With stedfast ray benign  
On Gotha’s ducal roof, and on  
The softly flowing Leine;  
Nor failed to gild the spires of Bonn,  
And glittered on the Rhine.—  
Old Camus too on that prophetic night  
Was conscious of the ray;  
And his willows whispered in its light,  
Not to the Zephyr’s sway,  
But with a Delphic life, in sight  
Of this auspicious day:

CHORUS

This day, when Granta hails her chosen Lord,  
And proud of her award,  
Confiding in the Star serene  
Welcomes the Consort of a happy Queen.

AIR.—CONTRALTO

Prince, in these Collegiate bowers,  
Where Science, leagued with holier truth,

Guards the sacred heart of youth,  
Solemn monitors are ours.  
These reverend aisles, these hallowed towers,  
Raised by many a hand august,  
Are haunted by majestic Powers,  
The memories of the Wise and Just,  
Who, faithful to a pious trust,  
Here, in the Founder's spirit sought  
To mould and stamp the ore of thought  
In that bold form and impress high  
That best betoken patriot loyalty.  
Not in vain those Sages taught.—  
True disciples, good as great,  
Have pondered here their country's weal,  
Weighed the Future by the Past,  
Learned how social frames may last,  
And how a Land may rule its fate  
By constancy inviolate,  
    Though worlds to their foundations reel,  
The sport of factious Hate or godless Zeal.

AIR.—BASS

Albert, in thy race we cherish  
A Nation's strength that will not perish  
While England's sceptered Line  
True to the King of Kings is found;  
Like that Wise<sup>[430]</sup> Ancestor of thine  
Who threw the Saxon shield o'er Luther's life,  
When first, above the yells of bigot strife,  
    The trumpet of the Living Word  
Assumed a voice of deep portentous sound  
From gladdened Elbe to startled Tiber heard.

## CHORUS

What shield more sublime  
E'er was blazoned or sung?  
And the PRINCE whom we greet  
From its Hero is sprung.  
    Resound, resound the strain  
    That hails him for our own!  
Again, again, and yet again;  
For the Church, the State, the Throne!—  
And that Presence fair and bright,  
Ever blest wherever seen,  
Who deigns to grace our festal rite,  
The pride of the Islands, VICTORIA THE QUEEN!

[429] This “Ode” was printed and sung at Cambridge on the occasion of the installation of His Royal Highness Prince Albert as Chancellor of the University. It was published in the newspapers of the following day, as “written for the occasion by the Poet Laureate, by royal command.”

There is no evidence, however, that Wordsworth wrote a single line of it. Dr. Cradock used to attribute the authorship to the poet's nephew, the late Bishop of Lincoln. It is much more likely that Edward Quillinan was the author of the whole, although Christopher Wordsworth may have revised it. Mr. Aubrey de Vere wrote to me, November 12, 1893, “It was from Miss Fenwick that I heard that the Laureate poem (*Ode, etc.*), was written by Quillinan, at Wordsworth's request, he having himself wholly failed in a reluctant attempt to write one. If he *had* written it, I doubt much whether he would ever have admitted it to a place among his works, for he did not hold ‘Laureate Odes’ in honour, and had only taken the Laureateship on the condition that he was to write none. Tennyson made the same condition: which could not, of course, interfere with either poet addressing lines to the Queen, if they felt specially moved from within to do so.”

Miss Frances Arnold writes, “Miss Quillinan was my authority for saying that the Cambridge Ode had been written by her father, owing to the deep depression in which Wordsworth then was.”—ED.

[430] Frederic the Wise, Elector of Saxony (1847).

## TO MISS SELLON

This sonnet exists, *in Wordsworth's handwriting*; but it is doubtful whether it was written by him, or not. Possibly Mr. Quillinan wrote it. The place, and the date of composition—given in MS.—are, “Ambleside, 22nd February, 1849.” Miss Sellon was a relation of the late Count Cavour.—ED.

The vestal priestess of a sisterhood who knows  
No self, and whom the selfish scorn—  
She seeks a wilderness of weed and thorn,  
And, undiverted from the blessed mood  
By keen reproach or blind ingratitude, 5  
A wreath she twines of blossoms lowly born—  
An amaranthine crown of flowers forlorn—  
And hangs her garland on the Holy Rood.  
Sister of Mercy, bravely hast thou won  
From men who winnow charity from Faith 10  
The Pharasaic sneer that treats as dross  
The works by faith ordained. Pursue thy path,  
Till, at the last, thou hear the voice—“Well done,  
Thou good and faithful servant of the Cross.”

## **“THE WORSHIP OF THIS SABBATH MORN”**

BY DOROTHY WORDSWORTH

These lines were published in *The Monthly Packet*, in July 1891, where the following note is appended by Miss Christabel Coleridge:—“Written *circa* 1852-3, and given to Mrs. Derwent Coleridge.” But Miss Edith Coleridge, and Mr. E. H. Coleridge, tell me that they think they “belong to an earlier period.” Mr. Coleridge writes, “I have heard Miss Wordsworth repeat the lines now printed, seated in her arm-chair, on the terrace at Rydal Mount.”—ED.

The worship of this Sabbath morn,  
How sweetly it begins!  
With the full choral hymn of birds  
Mingles no sad lament for sins.

Alas! my feet no more may join 5  
The cheerful Sabbath train;  
But if I inwardly lament,  
Oh! may a will subdued all grief restrain.

No prisoner am I on this couch,  
My mind is free to roam, 10  
And leisure, peace, and loving friends,  
Are the best treasures of an earthly home.

Such gifts are mine, then why deplore  
The body's slow decay?  
A warning mercifully sent 15  
To fix my hopes upon a surer stay.

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[\[431\]](#) These two editions of 1798 are the same; but as Cottle sold to Arch most of the copies printed, the majority bear the name of Arch as publisher.

Four of the poems were by S.T. Coleridge, viz. *The Rime of the Ancyent Marinere*; *The Foster-Mother's Tale*; *The Nightingale, a Conversational Poem*; and *The Dungeon*.—ED.

[\[432\]](#) The first volume of this edition is a reprint of the editions of 1798, *The Convict* being left out. In it there is one poem by Coleridge entitled *Love*, which was not in the edition of 1798. The poems in the second volume are new. The preface to Volume 1. contains Wordsworth's poetical theory in its original form. This preface was included in the 1802 and 1805 editions of *Lyrical Ballads*, and also—in an expanded form—in almost every subsequent edition of his poems.—ED.

[\[433\]](#) This was almost a reproduction of the two volumes of 1800, with a few variations of text. The preface, however, was much enlarged. The poem *A Character in the Antithetical Manner* was left out, also Coleridge's poem *The Dungeon*.—ED.

[\[434\]](#) A reprint of the edition of 1802, with slight variations of text.—ED.

[\[435\]](#) The *Essay on Epitaphs* inserted in the notes to this volume was originally published in *The Friend*, February 22, 1810.—ED.

[\[436\]](#) This was the first edition of Wordsworth's Poems arranged by him under distinctive headings, viz. "Poems referring to the Period of Childhood," "Juvenile Pieces," "Poems founded on the Affections," "Poems of the Fancy," "Poems of the Imagination," "Poems proceeding from Sentiment and Reflection," "Miscellaneous Sonnets," "Sonnets, etc., dedicated to Liberty," "Poems on the Naming of Places," "Inscriptions," "Poems referring to the Period of Old Age," "Epitaphs and Elegiac Poems," "Ode, Intimations of Immortality from Recollections of Childhood." In it, he gave *dates* to his poems.

In Volume I. is an engraving by Mr. Bromley from a picture by Sir George Beaumont; Volume II. has an engraving by Mr. Reynolds from Sir George's picture of Peele Castle in a storm.—ED.

[\[437\]](#) The poem *The Force of Prayer; or, the Founding of Bolton Priory* follows the *White Doe of Rylstone*; and the volume contains an engraving by Mr. Bromley from a painting of Bolton Abbey by Sir George Beaumont.—ED.

[\[438\]](#) The "Friend" was Mr. James Gray, Edinburgh.—ED.

[\[439\]](#) The volume contains an engraving by Mr. Bromley from a painting by Sir George Beaumont. In addition to *Peter Bell*, this volume contained four sonnets.—ED.

[\[440\]](#) This volume was dedicated to Charles Lamb.—ED.

[\[441\]](#) In 1820 the four separate publications, *The Waggoner*, etc., *Thanksgiving Ode*, etc., *Peter Bell*, etc., and *The River Duddon, Vaudracour and Julia*, etc., were bound up together with their separate title-pages, and issued



under the title, *Poems by William Wordsworth*, making Volume III. of the *Miscellaneous Poems*.—ED.

[442] Each of these volumes contained an engraving from a picture by Sir George Beaumont. They were “Lucy Gray,” “Peter Bell,” “The White Doe of Rylstone,” and “Peele Castle.” All had appeared in previous editions. The “Advertisement” states that this edition contains the whole of the published poems of the Author, with the exception of *The Excursion*, and that a few Sonnets “are now first published.”

It is worthy of note that, in this edition, Wordsworth for the first time abandoned the practice of putting in an apostrophe, instead of a vowel letter, in words ending with “ed,” and in similar cases of contraction.—ED.

[443] Wordsworth added to this series of Sonnets, in the one-volume edition of 1845 which contained 132. In the first edition, there were 102 sonnets.—ED.

[444] This originally appeared as an Introduction to Wilkinson’s *Select Views in Cumberland, Westmoreland, and Lancashire*, which was published in 1810. In 1820 it was included (see No. 18) in *The River Duddon: A Series of Sonnets*. In 1823 a fourth edition appeared which was a reprint of that of 1822.—ED.

[445] To this edition Wordsworth prefixed the following “Advertisement”:—“In these volumes will be found the whole of the Author’s published poems, for the first time collected in a uniform edition, with several new pieces interspersed.”—ED.

[446] In this edition—copied without authority, from the poet or his publishers, and with many errata, from the issue of 1827—there is an engraving of Wordsworth by Mr. Wedgewood, after the portrait by Carruthers, now in the possession of Mr. Hutchinson at Kimbolton. The Galignani edition of Southey is even worse; three poems, not by Southey, being included in it.—ED.

[447] The editor of these selections was Joseph Hine.—ED.

[448] The “Advertisement” to this edition is as follows:—“The contents of the last edition in five volumes are compressed into the present of four, with some additional pieces reprinted from miscellaneous publications.”—ED.

[449] As this volume (No. 32 in the list) was the last printed for the Messrs. Longman, and issued by that firm and by Mr. Moxon jointly, it is desirable to mention here, in a footnote, that, with the exception of *The Evening Walk* and *Descriptive Sketches* (which were published by J. Johnson) every one of Wordsworth’s works from 1798 to 1836—thirty in number—were introduced to the world by the Messrs. Longman. It is questionable if any firm has ever had a similar “record” in connection with the works of any great poet.—ED.

[450] A reprint of the sixth volume of the 1836-37 edition. It was again reprinted in 1841, 1844, and 1847.—ED.

[451] Volumes one and two are dated 1836; the remaining four 1837. This edition was stereotyped. It was reprinted in 1840, 1841, 1842, 1843, 1846, 1849, etc.; and some of the reprints contain slight variations of text, etc. All the editions issued after 1841 include the volume, *Poems of Early and Late Years* (see No. 37) as a seventh volume. After 1850 *The Prelude* was added as an eighth volume.

In the first volume of this edition there is a steel engraving by Mr. Watt of a portrait of the Poet by W. Pickersgill, which is in St. John's College, Cambridge. This engraving was reproduced in the editions of 1840, 1841, and following ones.—ED.

[452] This edition includes (as its "Advertisement" tells us) "twelve new Sonnets which were composed while the sheets were going through the press."—ED.

[453] Mr. Tutin writes in his Wordsworth Bibliography:—"This Pocket edition of *Yarrow Visited*, etc., is the third separate issue of the Poem. It seems to have been intended as a supplementary volume to the four vol. edition of 1832, as the sheets of it are all imprinted 'Vol. v.,' but I have no direct proof that it was ever so issued."—ED.

[454] In his "Advertisement" the Author states that about one-third of the Poem *Guilt and Sorrow* was written in 1794, and was published in the year 1798 under the title of *The Female Vagrant*.—ED.

[455] This volume is dedicated "To her Most Sacred Majesty, Victoria."—ED.

[456] Frequently republished. After 1851 *The Prelude* was included. The edition of 1869 has "nine additional poems," dated 1846. All the editions which I have seen contain an engraving by Mr. Finden from the bust of Wordsworth by Chantrey—the original of which is at Coleorton Hall—and a picture of Rydal Mount engraved by Mr. House after Finden. Professor Dowden tells us that, in some later editions "the Pickersgill portrait, engraved by J. Skelton, replaces Chantrey's bust." In this edition, as in that of 1815, Wordsworth gave dates to his poems.—ED.

[457] Volumes I. and II. are dated 1849, and Volumes III.-VI. 1850. *The Excursion* formed the sixth volume. It was reprinted separately in 1851, 1853, and 1857.—ED.

## II

### EDITIONS OF THE POEMS, AND OF SELECTIONS FROM THEM, PUBLISHED AFTER THE POET'S DEATH.

#### 1

1850. THE PRELUDE, OR GROWTH OF A POET'S MIND; an Autobiographical Poem; by William Wordsworth. London: Edward Moxon, Dover Street. Demy 8vo.

#### 2

1851. THE PRELUDE, OR GROWTH OF A POET'S MIND; an Autobiographical Poem; By William Wordsworth. Second Edition. London: Edward Moxon, Dover Street. Fcap. 8vo.

3

1855. SELECT PIECES FROM THE POEMS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. London: Edward Moxon. Sq. 12mo.

4

1857. THE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. In six volumes. A new Edition. London: Edward Moxon, Dover Street. 8vo.[\[458\]](#)

5

THE EARLIER POEMS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. Corrected as in the latest Editions. With Preface, and Notes showing the text as it stood in 1815. By William Johnston. London: Edward Moxon, Dover Street. Fcap. 8vo.

6

1859. THE DESERTED COTTAGE. By William Wordsworth. Illustrated with twenty-one designs by Birket Foster, J. Wolf, and John Gilbert, engraved by the Brothers Dalziel. London: George Routledge and Co., Farringdon Street. New York: 18 Beekman Street. Small 4to.[\[459\]](#)

7

POEMS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. Selected and Edited by Robert Aris Willmott, Incumbent of Bear Wood. Illustrated with one hundred designs by Birket Foster, J. Wolf, and John Gilbert, Engraved by the Brothers Dalziel. London: George Routledge

and Co., Farringdon Street. New York: 18 Beekman Street,  
MDCCCLIX. Small 4to.

8

THE WHITE DOE OF RYLSTONE; OR, THE FATE OF THE NORTONS. By  
William Wordsworth. London: Longman, Brown, Green,  
Longmans, and Roberts. Small 4to.[\[460\]](#)

9

PASSAGES FROM "THE EXCURSION," by William Wordsworth,  
Illustrated with Etchings on Steel by Agnes Fraser. London:  
published by Paul and Dominic Colnaghi and Co., publishers to  
Her Majesty, 13 and 14 Pall Mall East. Oblong 4to.[\[461\]](#)

10

THE WHITE DOE OF RYLSTONE; OR, THE FATE OF THE NORTONS. With  
Illustrations by Birket Foster, and others. London: Longman,  
Brown, Green, Longmans, and Roberts.

11

PASTORAL POEMS, by William Wordsworth. London: Sampson, Low,  
etc.

12

1864. THE SELECT POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. Copyright  
Edition. In two volumes. Leipzig, Bernhard Tauchnitz.[\[462\]](#)

13

1865. A SELECTION FROM THE WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH, Poet  
Laureate. Moxon's Miniature Poets. Selected and arranged by

Francis Turner Palgrave. Published in London: Edward Moxon & Co., Dover Street. Sq. 12mo.[\[463\]](#)

14

THE POEMS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. A new Edition. London: Edward Moxon & Co., Dover Street.

15

1867. THE WHITE DOE OF RYLSTONE; OR, THE FATE OF THE NORTONS. By William Wordsworth. London: Bell and Daldy, 186 Fleet Street. 8vo.[\[464\]](#)

16

1869. THE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. A new Edition. London: Edward Moxon, Son, & Co., 44 Dover Street, Piccadilly.

17

1870. THE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. Edited, with a critical Memoir, by William Michael Rossetti. Illustrated by artistic etchings by Edwin Edwards. London: E. Moxon, Son, & Co., Dover Street. Small 4to.

18

THE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. Edited, with a critical Memoir, by William Michael Rossetti. Illustrated by Henry Dell. London: E. Moxon, Son, & Co., Dover Street. 8vo.  
[\[465\]](#)

19

1876. THE PROSE WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. For the first time collected, with additions from unpublished manuscripts. Edited, with Preface, Notes and Illustrations, by the Rev. Alexander B. Grosart, St. George's, Blackburn, Lancashire. In three volumes. Volume I. Political and Ethical. Volume II. Æsthetical and Literary. Volume III. Critical and Ethical. London: Edward Moxon, Son, and Co., 1 Amen Corner, Paternoster Row. 8vo.

20

1879. POEMS OF WORDSWORTH, chosen and edited by Matthew Arnold. London: Macmillan and Co. 18mo.[\[466\]](#)

21

THE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. Edited by William Knight, LL.D., Professor of Moral Philosophy, St. Andrews. Edinburgh: William Paterson. MDCCCLXXXII. [MDCCCLXXXII.—MDCCCLXXXVI.] 8 vols. Demy 8vo.[\[467\]](#)

22

SELECTIONS FROM WORDSWORTH. Edited, with an Introductory Memoir, by J. S. Fletcher. London: Alex. Gardner, 12 Paternoster Row, and Paisley. MDCCCLXXXIII. Fcap. 8vo. Parchment.[\[468\]](#)

23

1883. WINNOWINGS FROM WORDSWORTH. Edited by J. Robertson. Simpkin & Co. 1883.

24

THE BROTHERS, AND OTHER POEMS FOUNDED ON THE AFFECTIONS. 18mo.  
Collins.

25

1884. THE RIVER DUDDON. A Series of Sonnets. By William Wordsworth.  
With ten Etchings by R. S. Chattock, The Fine Art Society, 148  
New Bond Street, London. Folio.

26

THE SONNETS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. Collected in one volume,  
with an Essay on The History of the English Sonnet by Richard  
Chenevix Trench, D.D., Archbishop of Dublin, Chancellor of  
the Order of St. Patrick. London: Suttaby and Co., Amen  
Corner. MDCCCLXXXIV. 8vo.[\[469\]](#)

27

SELECTIONS FROM WORDSWORTH. By Misses Wordsworth. London:  
Kegan Paul, & Co. April 8, 1884.

28

THE WORDSWORTH BIRTHDAY BOOK. Edited by Adelaide and Violet  
Wordsworth. London: Kegan Paul, Trench, & Co.

29

BIRTHDAY TEXTS FROM WORDSWORTH. Edinburgh: W. P. Nimmo. N. D.

30

THE GOLDEN POETS. "Wordsworth." London: Marcus Ward & Co. N.  
D.

1885. THE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH, With a Prefatory Notice, Biographical and Critical. By Andrew James Symington. London: Walter Scott, 14 Paternoster Square and Newcastle-on-Tyne. 16mo.[\[470\]](#)

WORDSWORTH'S EXCURSION. THE WANDERER. Edited, with Notes, etc., by H. H. Turner. London: Rivingtons. N. D.

ODE ON IMMORTALITY, AND LINES ON TINTERN ABBEY. Illustrated. Cassell. 4to.

TINTERN ABBEY, ODES, AND THE HAPPY WARRIOR. 8vo. Chambers. (Republished in 1892.)

1887. THROUGH THE WORDSWORTH COUNTRY. By Harry Goodwin and Professor Knight. London: Swan Sonnenschein, Lowrey & Co., Paternoster Square. Imperial 8vo.[\[471\]](#)

WORDSWORTH AND KEATS, Selections. In 16mo. M. Ward.

1888. THE COMPLETE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. With an Introduction by John Morley. With a Portrait. London:



Macmillan & Co. Crown 8vo.

38

1888. SELECTIONS FROM WORDSWORTH. By William Knight, and other Members of the Wordsworth Society. With Preface and Notes. London: Kegan Paul, Trench, & Co., 1 Paternoster Square. MDCCCLXXXVIII. Large Crown 8vo.[\[472\]](#)

39

1888. THE RECLUSE. By William Wordsworth. London: Macmillan and Co. [\[473\]](#)

40

1888. THE POETICAL WORKS OF WORDSWORTH. With Memoir, Explanatory Notes, etc. London: Griffith, Farren, & Co., Newbury House, Charing Cross Road.

41

PROSE WRITINGS OF WORDSWORTH: Selected and Edited, with an Introduction, by William Knight. London: Walter Scott. No date.

42

1889. WE ARE SEVEN. Illustrated by Agnes Gardner King. 16mo.

43

1891. LYRICS AND SONNETS OF WORDSWORTH. With Introduction and Bibliography. By Clement R. Shorter. Scott Library. 32mo.

44

THE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. Edited, with  
Memoir, by Edward Dowden. London: George Bell & Sons.  
1892-1893.[\[474\]](#)

45

1891. LYRICAL BALLADS, ETC. A reprint of the original edition of 1798.  
Edited by Edward Dowden. London: David Nutt. 16mo.

46

1891. THE WHITE DOE OF RYLSTONE, WITH THE SONG AT THE FEAST OF  
BROUGHAM CASTLE. Edited, with introduction and notes, by  
William Knight. Oxford: At the Clarendon Press.

47

THE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. Edinburgh: W.P.  
Nimmo, Hay, and Mitchell. 1892.

48

WORDSWORTH FOR THE YOUNG. With notes by J.C. Wright. 8vo. 1893.

49

1895. THE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH, with introductions  
and notes. Edited by Thomas Hutchinson, M.A. London: Henry  
Froude, Oxford University Press Warehouse, Amen Corner,  
E.C.

50

THE PENNY POETS, in "The Masterpiece Library." Wordsworth. Nos.  
XXXII. and XXXVII.

1896. LYRIC POEMS. Edited by Ernest Rhys. 8vo. London: Dent & Co.

THE PRELUDE; OR, GROWTH OF A POET'S MIND. 18mo. London: Dent & Co.

“The Lansdowne Poets” included one of Wordsworth. The “Albion” edition was published by Messrs. Froude, Oxford University Press.[\[475\]](#)

[\[458\]](#) In this edition—reprinted as “The Centenary Edition” in 1870, 1881, and 1882—the Fenwick notes were printed, for the first time in full, as prefatory notes to the poems.—ED.

[\[459\]](#) Reproduced in 1864.—ED.

[\[460\]](#) It contains illustrations by H. N. Humphreys and Birket Foster.—ED.

[\[461\]](#) This volume contains eleven etchings of varying merit.—ED.

[\[462\]](#) These are volumes 707 and 708 of Tauchnitz’s “Collection of British Authors.”—ED.

[\[463\]](#) It contains a steel engraving from Chantrey’s bust of the Poet. This selection was re-issued in 1866, and 1869; and, recently, in a small pocket edition.—ED.

[\[464\]](#) This is a reprint, in a different form, of No. 8.—ED.

[\[465\]](#) In this edition, which is a reprint, on smaller paper, of No. 19. there is an engraving from one of the portraits of the Poet by Miss Gillies. The engraving first appeared in Volume I. of *The New Spirit of the Age*, edited by R. H. Horne.—ED.

[\[466\]](#) It contains an idealised engraving of one of Haydon’s portraits of Wordsworth, after Lupton, by C. H. Jeens, and on the outside cover a drawing of Dove Cottage.—ED.

[\[467\]](#) In this edition the Poems were arranged for the first time in the chronological order of composition; the changes of text, in the successive editions, were given in footnotes, with the dates of these changes; many new readings, or suggested changes of text—which were written by the Poet on the margins of a copy of the edition of 1836-37, kept at Rydal Mount, and afterwards in the possession of Lord Coleridge—were added; all the Fenwick notes were printed as Prefatory notes; Topographical notes—containing allusions to localities in the English Lake District, and elsewhere—were given; several

Poems and Fragments hitherto unpublished were printed; a Bibliography of the Poems, and of editions published in England and America from 1793 to 1850 was added. Etchings of localities associated with the Poet, from drawings by Mr. MacWhirter, were given as frontispieces to Volumes I., II., III., IV., V., VI., and VII. The text adopted was Wordsworth's final text of 1849-50.—ED.

[468] It contains an engraving of Rydal Mount on the fly-leaf.—ED.

[469] This volume is a reprint of Wordsworth's own edition of his Sonnets, published in 1838, with the addition of Archbishop Trench's *History of the English Sonnet*.—ED.

[470] This is one of the volumes of *The Canterbury Poets*. It is only a selection, though described on the title as "The Poetical Works."—ED.

[471] This volume contains fifty-five engravings from drawings by Harry Goodwin of scenes in the English Lake District associated with Wordsworth, with the poems, or portions of poems, referring to the places.—ED.

[472] The poems are arranged in chronological order of composition; and there is, as frontispiece, an etched portrait of the Poet from a miniature by Margaret Gillies in the possession of Sir Henry Doulton. Amongst those who contributed to it were Robert Browning, James Russell Lowell, the late Lord Selborne, Mr. R. H. Hutton, the Dean of Salisbury, the late Lord Coleridge, the Rev. Stopford Brooke, Mr. Aubrey de Vere, the late Lord Houghton, Canon Rawnsley, the late Principals Shairp and Greenwood and Professor Veitch, Mr. Spence Watson, Mr. Rix, Mr. Heard, Mr. Cotterill, the late Bishop Wordsworth of St. Andrews, and the Editor.—ED.

[473] In the prefatory advertisement to the first edition of *The Prelude* 1850, it is stated that that poem was designed to be introductory to *The Recluse*, and that *The Recluse* if completed, would have consisted of three parts. The second part is *The Excursion*. The third part was only planned. The first book of the first part was left in manuscript by Wordsworth. It was published for the first time *in extenso* in 1888.—ED.

[474] This Aldine edition, by Professor Dowden, is one of great merit, and permanent value. Although it is not immaculate—as no literary work ever is—as a contribution to Wordsworthian Literature it will hold an honoured place. Its "critical apparatus" is succinct and admirable.—ED.

[475] Mr. Andrew Lang tells me that he is about to edit a *Selection* of the Poems, for the Messrs. Longman; which will, no doubt, be as useful, and popular, as Matthew Arnold's *Selection* has been.—ED.

### III

#### ESTIMATES OF WORDSWORTH IN VARIOUS BOOKS[476]

1811. SEWARD, ANNA. Letters written between the Years 1784 and 1807.  
Edited by A. Constable, vol. vi. No. 66.[477] 8vo. Edinburgh.

1817. COLERIDGE, S. T. *Biographia Literaria; or, Biographical Sketches of my Literary Life and Opinions*. 2 vols. 8vo. London: Rest Fenner. Second Edition. London: William Pickering. 1847. Bohn's Standard Library. 1866.

COLERIDGE, S. T. In *The Friend, passim*. Second Edition. London: Rest Fenner.

HAZLITT, WILLIAM. *The Round Table: a Collection of Essays on Literature, Men, and Manners. Observations on Mr. Wordsworth's Poem, "The Excursion."* 12mo. London: Templeman. Also in Bohn's Standard Library. Edited by W. Carew Hazlitt. Pp. 158-176. London. 1871.

1818. HAZLITT, WILLIAM. *Lectures on the English Poets*. 8vo. London: Taylor and Hessey. Also in Bohn's Standard Library. 1870.

1819. HAZLITT, WILLIAM. *Political Essays, with Sketches of Public Characters. My First Acquaintance with Poets*. 8vo. London: Templeman. Also in Winterslow, pp. 255-277. Bohn's Standard Library. 1872.

1823. SOLIGNY, VICTOIRE DE, COUNT, *pseud.* (i.e. Peter George Patmore, father of the late Coventry Patmore). *Letters on England*, vol. ii. pp. 7-19. 8vo. London: Henry Colburn and Co.

1824. LANDOR, W. S. *Imaginary Conversations of Literary Men and Statesmen*. Southey and Porson, i. 39. 8vo. London: Taylor and Hessey. New Edition, i. 11, 68, 182. London: Edward Moxon. 1846. New Edition, iv. 18. London: Chapman and Hall. 1876.

1825. HAZLITT, WILLIAM. *The Spirit of the Age; or, Contemporary Portraits*. 8vo. London: Henry Colburn and Co.; Fourth Edition. George Bell and Sons. 1886.

1827. HONE, WILLIAM. *The Table Book*. Wordsworth, ii. 275. 8vo. London: Hunt and Clarke.

COLERIDGE, S. T. *Table Talk*. July 21, 1832; July 31, 1832; February 16, 1833.

1833. MONTGOMERY, JAMES. *Lectures on Poetry and General Literature, delivered at the Royal Institution in 1830 and 1831*.

Wordsworth's Theory of Poetic Diction, pp. 134-141. 8vo. London: Longmans.

1836. Conversations at Cambridge. The Poet Wordsworth and Professor Smythe, pp. 235-252. 8vo. London: John W. Parker.

1837. COTTLE, JOSEPH. Early Recollections; chiefly relating to the late Samuel Taylor Coleridge, during his long Residence in Bristol. 2 vols. 8vo. London: Longman, Rees and Co.

1838. CHORLEY, H. F. The Authors of England. 4to. London. New Edition, revised (by G. B.) London. 1861.

HARE, JULIUS C. and AUGUSTUS W. Guesses at Truth, by Two Brothers. Second Series. 8vo. London: Taylor and Walton. The Dedication of this edition is to William Wordsworth. New Edition, in one volume. Macmillan and Co. 1866.

1840. HUNT, LEIGH. The Seer. "Wordsworth and Milton," pp. 5-53. London: Edward Moxon.

RUSKIN, JOHN. Modern Painters (1843-1860), *passim* in all the five volumes. London: George Allen.

1843. CHAMBERS, ROBERT. Cyclopædia of English Literature. Wordsworth, ii. 322-333. Fourth Edition, revised by Robert Carruthers, LL.D. 1888. 8vo. Edinburgh: William and Robert Chambers.

1844. HORNE, R. H. A New Spirit of the Age. William Wordsworth and Leigh Hunt, vol. i. pp. 307-332. 12mo. London: Smith, Elder and Co.

KEBLE, JOHN. Praelectiones Academicæ Oxonii habitæ, annis MDCCCXXXII.-MDCCCXLI., tom. ii. pp. 615, 789. 8vo. Oxonii: J. H. Parker.

1845. GILFILLAN, GEORGE. A Gallery of Literary Portraits. 12mo. Edinburgh: Groombridge.

CRAIK, E. L. Sketches of the History of Literature and Learning in England. Vol. vi., pp. 114-139. London: Charles Knight.

1847. HOWITT, WILLIAM. Homes and Haunts of the most eminent British Poets, vol. ii. pp. 259-291. 8vo. London: Richard Bentley.

Third Edition. Routledge and Sons. 1862.

TUCKERMAN, HENRY T. Thoughts on the Poets. 8vo. London: J. Chapman.

1849. GILFILLAN, GEORGE. A Second Gallery of Literary Portraits. 8vo. Edinburgh: Groombridge.

SHAW, THOMAS B. Outlines of English Literature. Wordsworth, pp. 518-526. 8vo. London: John Murray. Sixteenth Edition, edited by William Smith, D.C.L. 1887.

TAYLOR, HENRY. Notes from Books. In four Essays. Wordsworth's Poetical Works and Sonnets, pp. 1-186. 8vo. London: John Murray. Works: Author's Edition, vol. v. London: C. Kegan Paul and Co. 1878.

1849-50. SOUTHEY, ROBERT. Life and Correspondence. Edited by the Rev. Charles Cuthbert Southey. 6 vols. Comments on Wordsworth in chaps, ix.-xiii.

xv. xix. xxvi. xxxii. and xxxvi. 8vo. London: Longman, Brown, Green and Longmans.

1851. GILLIES, R. P. Memoirs of a Literary Veteran; including Sketches and Anecdotes of the most distinguished Literary Characters from 1794 to 1849. Wordsworth, vol. ii. pp. 136-173. 8vo. London: Richard Bentley.

The Poetic Companion, vol. i., pp. 168-173. A Biographical and Critical Sketch of William Wordsworth.

MOIR, D. M. Sketches of the Poetical Literature of the past Half-Century, pp. 59-81; 120. Edinburgh: William Blackwood and Sons. Third Edition, 1856.

WORDSWORTH, CHRISTOPHER. Memoirs of William Wordsworth, Poet-Laureate, D.C.L. 2 vols. 8vo. London: Edward Moxon. 1851.

1852. JANUARY SEARLE (George S. Phillips). Memoirs of William Wordsworth, compiled from Authentic Sources. 12mo. London: Partridge and Oakey.

MITFORD, M. R. *Recollections of a Literary Life; or, Books, Places, and People*, vol. iii. chap. i. 8vo. London: Richard Bentley.

1853. *An Essay on the Poetry of Wordsworth*, 72 pp. 8vo. Liverpool.

AUSTIN, W. S., and JOHN RALPH. *The Lives of the Poets-Laureate. With an Introductory Essay on the Title and Office*. William Wordsworth, pp. 396-428. 8vo. London: Richard Bentley.

WRIGHT, JOHN. *The Genius of Wordsworth harmonised with the Wisdom and Integrity of his Reviewers*. 8vo. London: Longman, Brown, Green and Longmans.

SPALDING, WILLIAM. *The History of English Literature*. 8vo. Edinburgh: Oliver & Boyd.

1854. DE QUINCEY, THOMAS. *Autobiographic Sketches*. Early Memorials of Grasmere, vol. ii. pp. 104-141; William Wordsworth, pp. 227-314; William Wordsworth and Robert Southey, pp. 315-345. 8vo. Edinburgh: James Hogg. Also *Collected Writings*. New and Enlarged Edition. By David Masson. Edinburgh: Adam and Charles Black. 1889-90.

SPALDING, WILLIAM. Wordsworth, pp. 849-851. *Cyclopædia of Biography*, edited by Elihu Rich. 8vo. Glasgow: Richard Griffin and Co.

MOORE, THOMAS. *Memoirs, Journal, and Correspondence of*. Edited by the Right Honourable Lord John Russell, vol. iii. pp. 161, 163; vol. iv. pp. 48, 335; vol. vii pp. 72, 85, 197-8; vol. viii. pp. 69, 73, 291.

1856. CARLYON, CLEMENT. *Early Years and Late Reflections*, vol. i. 8vo. London: Whittaker and Co.

HOOD, E. P. *William Wordsworth: a Biography*. 8vo. London: W. and F. G. Cash.

MASSON, DAVID. *Essays, Biographical and Critical: chiefly on English Poets*. Wordsworth, pp. 346-390. 8vo. Cambridge: Macmillan and Co. Reprinted from *The North British Review*, August 1850.



- ROGERS, SAMUEL. *Recollections of the Table Talk of Samuel Rogers*. 8vo. London: Edward Moxon.
- WILSON, JOHN. *Noctes Ambrosianae*, vols. i.-iii. 8vo. Edinburgh: William Blackwood and Sons. New Edition, 1864.
- WILSON, JOHN. *Essays, Critical and Imaginative*. Wordsworth, vol. i. pp. 387-408. 8vo. Edinburgh: William Blackwood and Sons.
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[476] There are numerous notes and letters on Wordsworth in such Journals as *The Athenæum*, *The Academy*, *Notes and Queries*, the examination of which will repay perusal. In *Notes and Queries* there are at least twenty-four valuable ones which cannot be recorded here.—ED.

[477] A criticism of the “dancing daffodils.”—ED.

#### IV CRITICAL ESTIMATES IN BOOKS, PAMPHLETS, MAGAZINES, AND REVIEWS

In the following section when the name of an author is placed within brackets, it is to be understood that the name was not given on the

publication of the Review, but that it is otherwise known.—ED.

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1807. "Poems." In 2 vols. *The Edinburgh Review*, xi. 214. By Francis Jeffrey. *Monthly Literary Recreations*, 65. (By Lord Byron.)

1808. "Poems." In 2 vols. *The Eclectic Review*, vii. 35.

1809. "Poems." In 2 vols. *The British Critic*, xxxiii. 298.

1810. "Concerning the relations of Great Britain, Spain, and Portugal, to each other, and to the Common Enemy, at this Crisis, etc." *The British Critic*, xxxiv. 305.

1814. "The Excursion; being a portion of The Recluse, a Poem." *The Edinburgh Review*, xxiv. 1. (By Francis Jeffrey); *The Quarterly Review*, xii. 100. (By Charles Lamb.)

1815. "Poems; including Lyrical Ballads, and the miscellaneous pieces of the Author. With additional Poems, a new Preface, and a supplementary Essay." *The Monthly Review*, lxxviii. 225; *The Quarterly Review*, xiv. 201. (By W. Gifford.)

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1818. "Essays on the Lake School of Poetry. I. Wordsworth's White Doe of Rylstone." *Blackwood's Magazine*, iii. 369.
1819. "Peter Bell: a Tale in Verse." *The Edinburgh Monthly Review*, ii. 654; *Blackwood's Magazine*, v. 130; *The Eclectic Review*, xxx. 62; *The Monthly Review*, lxxxix. 419; *The Literary Gazette*, 273.
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- “Wordsworth and the *Morning Post*.” *The Athenæum*, No. 3445. E. H. C.
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## VI

### POEMS ADDRESSED TO WORDSWORTH, AND ALLUSIONS TO HIM BY CONTEMPORARY AND SUBSEQUENT POETS

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4. KEATS, JOHN. In his Sonnets [the 2nd addressed to Haydon].
5. SHELLEY, PERCY B. *To Wordsworth*. Another reference occurs in *Alastor*.
6. MOIR, D. M. *To Wordsworth*. In *Blackwood's Magazine*, viii. 542; afterwards included amongst his "Poems," vol. ii. p. 28. 1852.
- 7, 8. BROWNING, MRS. *On a Portrait of Wordsworth by B. R. Haydon*. (Sonnets.) 1866. Vol. ii. p. 264. Also in *Lady Geraldine's Courtship*, vol. ii. p. 109. 1866.
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10. TENNYSON, ALFRED LORD. In the Dedication of his *Poems* "To the Queen." March 1851.

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13. LOWELL, JAMES RUSSELL. In *A Fable for Critics*, p. 133. 1873.
- 14, 15. BYRON, LORD. In *English Bards and Scotch Reviewers*. Also in *Don Juan*.
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17. HEMANS, MRS. *To Wordsworth*, in her "Miscellaneous Poems."
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19. HALLAM, A. H. *Meditative Fragments*. No. vi. 1863.
- 20, 21, 22. ARNOLD, MATTHEW. *Memorial Verses*. April 1850. Also in *Youth and Nature*, and in *Obermann Once More*. p. 203. 1869.
- 23, 24, 25. DE VERE, SIR AUBREY. In *Rydal with Wordsworth* (Sonnets). p. 208. 1842. *Wordsworth*. Composed at Rydal, 1st Sept. 1860. p. 392. *Wordsworth, on Visiting the Duddon*, p. 393.
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27. TOLLEMACHE, The Hon. BEATRIX L. *To Wordsworth*, in "Engleberg, and other Verses." 1890.
28. BELL, GEORGE. *Rydal Mount*, in "Descriptive and other Miscellaneous Pieces in Verse." Penrith, 1835.
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- 32, 33. SCOTT, W. B. Poems (three Sonnets), pp. 180-182. 1875. Also in "A Poet's Harvest Home," 1893. *Wordsworth*, p. 123.

- 34, 35, 36. RAWNSLEY, H. D. In "Sonnets at the English Lakes." IX. *Wordsworth's Seat, Rydal*; LI. *A Tree planted by William Wordsworth at Wray Castle*; LXII. *Wordsworth's Tomb*.
37. PAYNE, JAMES. *Wordsworth's Grave*, in "Lakes in Sunshine." 1870.
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39. ALLINGHAM, WILLIAM. *On reading of the Funeral of the Poet Wordsworth*, p. 258 of "Poems." 1850.
40. PALGRAVE, FRANCIS TURNER. *William Wordsworth*, in his "Lyrical Poems." 1871.
41. ANDERSON, G. F. R. *Wordsworth*, in "The White Book of the Muses," p. 67. 1895.
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## II.—AMERICA

BIBLIOGRAPHY of the Various Editions of WORDSWORTH'S POETICAL WORKS, which have been printed and published in the United States of America, from 1801 to 1895, arranged in Chronological Order: also a BIBLIOGRAPHY OF CRITICAL ESSAYS, and BIOGRAPHICAL SKETCHES, of Wordsworth's Life and Works in Books, Reviews, and Periodicals; with Notes, by Mrs. HENRY A. ST. JOHN, Ithaca, New York.

## PREFATORY NOTE

My ideal in attempting to prepare a *Bibliography of Wordsworth in America* was high. I hoped to see each edition, or at least to identify the editions hinted at in the various catalogues. I determined to read every article, in criticism, or review; and to know if the many references, given by Poole and other authorities, were correct. As is usually the case, the reality has fallen far short of the ideal. But, while the results are not what were desired, there have been many fortunate discoveries.

Two things were learned to begin with. First, that astonishingly little care had been taken to preserve the history of the early American Editions, or to preserve, even, the earlier American Periodicals. Most of our larger libraries are amazingly deficient in these works. Second, it was found that existing Catalogues or Lists are not only far from complete, but full of gross blunders. Roorbach (the Addenda, Supplements, etc.) was found to be a mere rehash of the old trade sales Catalogues, swarming with blunders. In the matter of dates, imprints, the particular editions, the size of books, Roorbach is utterly untrustworthy. Allibone (so far as Wordsworth is concerned) is also confusing and incomplete. I did not find much in the various Public or College Library Catalogues.

I wrote to the librarians of some of the older libraries, after I had made out a preliminary list, to ascertain if they could add thereto any editions, from their cards or manuscript catalogues. From these sources I was enabled several times to solve seemingly insolvable problems.

I had assistance from, and in some instances visited, the following libraries: Cornell University, Boston Public Library, Boston Athenæum, Harvard College, Philadelphia Public Library, the Library College of Philadelphia, Mercantile Library College, Philadelphia; the Public Library, St. Louis; that of Lennox and Astor, the University of Virginia, the State Library, Richmond, Va., and one or two other Southern libraries. I have written more than one hundred letters to publishers, editors, authors, the descendants of early American Wordsworthians, Professors of Literature, and professed Wordsworthians in Seminaries and Colleges. I have examined, or employed others to examine, the following works for editions of Wordsworth: the *New York Literary World*, *Norton's Literary Gazette*, *American Publishers' Circular*, *Publishers' Weekly*, *Catalogues of Congress*

*Library, The Port Folio, American Quarterly Review, Knickerbocker Magazine, New York Quarterly Review, American Review, North American Review.* And this is but half of my story.

Poole's "Index," of course, was a great assistance. But I did not rely altogether on him, after I had discovered several mistakes in titles and numbering—mistakes which were confusing in the extreme. I have consulted all other Indexes and Reference Lists that I could procure, and have carefully examined the periodicals in which it was possible that such articles could be found.

My greatest light, however, came from responses to personal appeals, to those in the North, South, East, and West of the Country, who enlightened me in particular directions. I needed assistance, not only to discover the articles, but more particularly to secure the articles to read, or to procure proper persons to read the few articles that I could not obtain. When valuable books were sent me, by express, from distant College Libraries, that I might read for myself, I realised the bond there is between Wordsworthians.

I cannot begin to speak of the delight that I have had in this work, delight because of the response I have met with, and in opening up unknown and rich veins of criticism. I have learned too, that Wordsworth has many enthusiastic followers in America.

I have included in the Bibliography the accounts of visits paid to Wordsworth by certain well-known Americans, a half-dozen poems on Wordsworth, and three or four unpublished Lectures.

I am exceedingly grateful to the many who (to my surprise) have answered my questions, and have given me of their valuable time. I am especially indebted to Mr. George P. Philes, of Philadelphia, and also to Mr. F. Saunders of the Astor Library, New York. Dean Murray of Princeton rendered me exceedingly gracious service, and but for Mr. Edwin H. Woodruff of Stanford University, California, I should not have known how or where to begin my investigations.

In all probability my work is not perfect. I would that it were. I only know that I have been enabled, by enthusiasm alone, to lay a foundation for Wordsworth Bibliography in America, that may be an assistance to future

scholars, and will aid the next Wordsworthian who is brave enough to build enduringly.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

## **I AMERICAN EDITIONS OF WORDSWORTH**

### **INCLUDING A FEW WORKS WHICH ARE NOT STRICTLY EDITIONS OF WORDSWORTH**

I have endeavoured to include in this list every distinctive American edition of Wordsworth, published during the poet's lifetime, and since his death. There are many others, issued with the imprints of honourable publishers; which, upon investigation, were found to be English reprints; to say nothing of those editions made from worn-out plates, and issued by houses of less reputation for honourableness. I was puzzled to account for so many editions of Matthew Arnold's Selections, some of them bearing the imprint of Harper Brothers, some of Macmillan, and several of Crowell. The Harpers wrote me that these various publications were possible in view of the fact that there was no copyright of the work, and that all of them might properly be called American Editions. I have not placed those bearing the Macmillan imprint, of course, among purely American editions. Nor have I included the several cheap ones of Crowell. The one of Crowell, given in the list, is copyrighted by the Crowell Company.

The fact that the introduction of Wordsworth's poetry into America is so easily authenticated, and that the history of it is so concise, is my apology for deviating from ordinary bibliographical rule in including among the regular editions certain numbers of America's first Literary Journal, and two or three other volumes.

I have confined myself to a simple chronological arrangement of the Editions, with place of imprint, name of publisher, number, and size of volumes. This makes the most convenient list for easy reference, especially as I have tried to mention technical points of difference.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

1801. THE PORT FOLIO. (Edited by Joseph Dennie.) Philadelphia. 4to.

The following poems appeared in “The Port Folio,” vol. i., before the publication of the First American Edition of “Lyrical Ballads”—

- (1) *Simon Lee*, p. 24.[\[478\]](#)
- (2) *The Last of the Flock*, p. 48.
- (3) *The Thorn*, p. 94.
- (4) *The Mad Mother*, p. 232.
- (5) *Anecdote for Fathers*, p. 232.
- (6) *Ellen Irwin*, p. 391.
- (7) *Strange Fits of Passion*, etc., p. 392.
- (8) *The Waterfall and the Eglantine*, p. 408.
- (9) *Lucy Gray*, p. 408.
- (10) *Andrew Jones*, p. 408.

1801. INTRODUCTION TO THE ENGLISH READER. By Lindley Murray. Philadelphia: Johnson and Warner. 12mo.[\[479\]](#)

1802. LYRICAL BALLADS, with Other Poems. In two volumes. By W. Wordsworth.

Quam nihil ad genium, Papiniane, tuum!



From the London second edition. Philadelphia: Printed and sold by  
James Humphreys. 2 vols. in one. 12mo.[\[480\]](#)

4

1823. THE AMERICAN FIRST CLASS BOOK. By John Pierpont. Boston: William  
B. Fowle. 1 vol. 12mo.[\[481\]](#)

5

1824. THE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. Boston: published by  
Cummings, Hilliard and Co. 4 vols. 12mo.[\[482\]](#)

6

1833. SKETCH OF THE GENIUS AND CHARACTER OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. With  
Selections from his "Lyrical Ballads."[\[483\]](#) Philadelphia:  
Greenbak's Periodical Library. Vol. ii. pp. 181-202.

7

1835. YARROW REVISITED, and Other Poems. New York: R. Bartlett and S.  
Raynor. 16mo. pp. 17-244.

1835. Same Title. Boston: R. Bartlett and S. Raynor. 16mo; also, Boston:  
James Munroe and Co. 16mo.

1835. Same Title. Philadelphia. 12mo.

8

1836. YARROW REVISITED. Second Edition. Boston: William D. Ticknor.  
16mo.

9

1836. THE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. The first complete American, from the last London, edition. New Haven: Peck and Newton. In 1 vol. Royal 8vo.[\[484\]](#)

10

1836. THE COMPLETE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH, together with a Description of the Country of the Lakes, etc. Edited by Henry Reed. With Portrait. Philadelphia: Kay and Brother. Royal 8vo; also, by James Kay and Brother.[\[485\]](#)
1839. Same Title. Philadelphia: Kay and Brother. Boston: Munroe and Co. Pittsburg: Kay and Co.
1844. Same Title. Philadelphia: James Kay jun.[\[486\]](#)

11

1842. WORDSWORTH'S POEMS. In "The New World," vol. iv. No. 16. New York: Park Benjamin, Editor. Sat. April 9, *Sonnet Written at Florence*; April 16, *Address to the Clouds, Suggested by a Picture of the Bird of Paradise*; *Maternal Grief* ("New Poems, never before published"). May 7, *Guilt and Sorrow* ("From proof sheets received in advance").[\[487\]](#)

12

1843. POEMS FROM THE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. Selected by Henry Reed.

Go forth, my little Book; pursue thy way;  
Go forth, and please the gentle and the good.

Philadelphia: John Locken. 32mo.

(Entered according to the Act of Congress in 1841.)

1846. Same Title. Philadelphia: Uriah Hunt and Son. 32mo.

Same Title. New York: Leavitt and Co.[\[488\]](#)

1853. Same Title. New York: Leavitt and Allen. 24mo.

1856. Same Title.[\[489\]](#) New York: Leavitt and Allen.

13

1847. WORDSWORTH'S COMPLETE POETICAL AND PROSE WORKS.[\[490\]](#) In 5 vols.  
(In Press.) Philadelphia: Kay and Troutman. 12mo.

14

1849. POEMS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH: with an Introductory Essay on his  
Life and Writings. By H. T. Tuckerman. New York: C. S.  
Francis and Co. 12mo. pp. 21-356; also, Boston: J. H. Francis.  
[\[491\]](#)

15

1849. THE EXCURSION: a Poem. New York: C. S. Francis and Co. 12mo.

1850. THE EXCURSION, etc. New York: C. S. Francis and Co. 12mo.

1852-55. The above was again republished.

16

1850. THE PRELUDE; or, Growth of a Poet's Mind. New York: Appleton and  
Co. 12mo.

1850. THE PRELUDE, etc. Philadelphia: George S. Appleton and Co. 12mo.

17

1850. THE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. Boston: Phillips,  
Sampson and Co. 12mo. Reprinted in 1857 and 1859.

1859. Same Title. Boston: Phillips, Sampson and Co. 16mo.

18

1851. THE COMPLETE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. Edited by Henry Reed. Royal 8vo. Philadelphia: James Kay jun. and Brother. Also, Kay and Troutman. Also, Troutman and Hayes. Also, Hayes and Zell. Also, Porter and Coates.[\[492\]](#)

1852. THE COMPLETE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. Edited by Henry Reed. 8vo. Philadelphia: Troutman and Hayes.

1860. THE COMPLETE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. Edited by Henry Reed. Royal 8vo. pp. 727.[\[493\]](#)

19

1854. THE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH, with a Memoir.[\[494\]](#) Boston: Little, Brown and Co. Also, New York: Evans and Dickenson. Also, Philadelphia: Lippincott, Grant and Co. 18mo. 7 vols.

20

1855. POETICAL WORKS OF W. WORDSWORTH. Portrait. Boston: Crosby and Nichols(?) 12mo.

21

1855. THE PRELUDE. New York: Appleton and Co. 12mo. Second Edition.

22

1860. POETICAL WORKS OF WORDSWORTH.[\[495\]](#) 2 vols. New York: 12mo.

23

1863. SELECTIONS FROM WORDSWORTH, with an Essay by H. T. Tuckerman.  
Philadelphia. 32mo.[\[496\]](#)

1863. Same Title. Boston.

24

1865. POEMS OF NATURE AND SENTIMENT. By William Wordsworth. Elegantly  
illustrated. Philadelphia: E. H. Butler and Co.[\[497\]](#)

25

THE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH.[\[498\]](#) A new edition.  
Boston: Crosby and Nichols. 12mo.

1867. THE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. A new edition.  
Boston: Crosby and Ainsworth. New York: Oliver S. Felt.  
16mo. pp. 539.[\[499\]](#)

26

1870. THE EXCURSION: a Poem. A new edition. New York: J. Miller. 16mo.

27

1871-75. THE HOWE MEMORIAL PRIMER, in raised letters for the Blind.  
WORDSWORTH'S POETICAL WORKS, with a Memoir. Boston. 7  
vols. 16mo. Portrait.

28

1876. WORDSWORTH'S POEMS. Selected and Prepared for Schools. Edited by  
H. N. Hudson. Boston: Ginn and Co. 12mo. "Text-book of  
Prose and Poetry Series."

1882. Same Title. In paper. Hudson's Pamphlet Selections of Poetry. (No.  
VI. Wordsworth.)

1877. FAVORITE POEMS. Vest-pocket Series. Boston: Osgood. Illustrated. 32mo.

1877. FAVORITE POEMS. Illustrated. Boston, Massachusetts. (Printed at Cambridge.) 16mo.

1877. THE POETICAL WORKS. New edition. Boston: Hurd and Houghton. 8vo. 3 vols.

1878. THE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH, with Memoir. 7 vols. in 3. Boston: Houghton, Osgood and Co. Riverside Press. 8vo; also,

1880. Same Title.[\[500\]](#)

1879. WORDSWORTH'S POEMS. Chosen and Edited by Matthew Arnold. Franklin Square Library. New York: Harper and Brother. Paper 4to.

1880. Another Edition.

1891. Another Edition.

1881. THE EXCURSION, with a Biographical Sketch. English Classic Series. New York: Clark and Maynard. 16mo.

1889. Same Title. With Explanatory Notes. New York: Effingham, Maynard and Co.

1881-82. FAVORITE POEMS. By William Wordsworth. In Modern Classics, No. VII. Illustrated. Boston: Houghton, Mifflin and Co. 32mo.

1884. ODE, INTIMATIONS OF IMMORTALITY. By William Wordsworth. Illustrated. Boston: D. Lothrop Company. Small 4to. Copyright by D. Lothrop.

1884. POEMS BY WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. Selected and Prepared for use in Schools. (From Hudson's *Text-Book of Poetry*.) Section I. Boston: Ginn, Heath and Co. 12mo.

1888. PRELUDE; or, Growth of a Poet's Mind. With Notes by A. J. George. Boston: D. C. Heath and Co. 12mo.

1888. BITS OF BURNISHED GOLD, from William Wordsworth. Compiled by Rose Porter. New York: A. D. F. Randolph and Co. 12mo.

1889. SELECTIONS FROM WORDSWORTH. With Notes by A. J. George. Boston: D. C. Heath and Co. 12mo.

1889. MELODIES FROM NATURE. (From Wordsworth.) Illustrated. Boston: D. Lothrop Company. 4to.

1889. SELECT POEMS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH.[\[501\]](#) Edited, with Notes, by W. J. Rolfe. With Engravings. New York: Harper Brothers. Square 16mo.

1889. POEMS BY WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. Selected and Prepared for use in School. Paper. (From Hudson's *Text-Book of Poetry*.) Section II. 12mo. Boston: Ginn and Co.

1890. SELECT POEMS FROM WORDSWORTH, with Explanatory Notes. Edited by James H. Dillard. New York: Effingham, Maynard and Co. 12mo.

1890. PASTORALS, LYRICS AND SONNETS FROM THE POETIC WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. Boston and New York: Houghton, Mifflin and Co. 16mo. White and Gold Series.

1891. A SELECTION OF THE SONNETS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH.[\[502\]](#) With numerous Illustrations. By A. Parsons. New York: Harper Brothers. 4to.

1891. WORDSWORTH FOR THE YOUNG. Selections. Illustrated. With an Introduction for parents and teachers by Cynthia Morgan St. John. Boston: D. Lothrop Company. Small 4to. 153 pp.



1892. WORDSWORTH'S PREFACES AND ESSAYS ON POETRY. Edited by A. J. George. (Heath's English Classics.) Boston: D. C. Heath and Co. 12mo.

1892. POEMS OF WORDSWORTH. Chosen and Edited by Matthew Arnold. Illustrated by Edmund H. Garrett. New York: Thomas Y. Crowell and Co. (Copyright 1892 by T. Y. Crowell.)

[478] *Simon Lee* was probably the first poem of Wordsworth's published in a Literary Journal in America, and is the beginning of Wordsworth's Bibliography in U.S.A. A note in "The Port Folio" (vol. i. p. 24) is as follows: "The public may remember reading in some of the newspapers the interesting little ballads, *We are Seven*, and *Goody Blake and Harry Gill*. They were extracted from the 'Lyrical Ballads,' a collection remarkable for originality, simplicity, and nature.... The following, *Simon Lee*, is from the same work."

It is evident from this that two, at least, of Wordsworth's poems were copied into American newspapers as early as 1800, and that Joseph Dennie, the founder, as well as editor, of "The Port Folio"—the first purely Literary Journal established in this country—was the first American champion of Wordsworth.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[479] *The Pet Lamb* appeared in this Book almost immediately after its publication in England. It was the first poem of Wordsworth's published in a book in America. It was also the first instance of the introduction of a poem of Wordsworth's into a School Book.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[480] The first American edition, and the first work by Wordsworth, printed in America. It looks as if the Poet found appreciative readers in America sooner than in England; the first edition of "Lyrical Ballads," which had fallen dead in his own country in 1798, being published in Philadelphia in 1802. The American edition was delayed in the press, in order to include certain pieces which first appeared in the second (English) edition of 1802. See Humphreys' Preface.

A copy of "Lyrical Ballads," 1802, is in the possession of Judge Henry Reed, with exactly the same title-page as the above, except that it reads—

"Printed by James Humphreys for Joseph Groff."

It is believed that the work was printed at the joint expense of Humphreys and Groff, each bookseller taking a certain number of copies upon which was placed his individual imprint. Both book-sellers advertised the volumes almost simultaneously. I know of another copy of (1802) "Lyrical Ballads," of which the first volume contains the imprint of Humphreys, and the second volume that of Groff. The two volumes are bound together, and are *identical* in type, paper, etc.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[481] Amongst the contents there are four long extracts from *The Excursion*, with titles attributed to W.W. *Goody Blake and Harry Gill* is amongst the extracts from “Lyrical Ballads,” and there is a long note to the former poem by Joseph Dennie.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[482] The first collected edition of Wordsworth’s Poems printed in America.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[483] The sketch is by R. H. Home. The poems are *The Last of the Flock*, *The Dungeon*, *The Mad Mother*, *Anecdote for Fathers*, *We are Seven*, *Lines Written in Early Spring*, *The Female Vagrant*, *Goody Blake and Harry Gill*, *The Waterfall and the Eglantine*, *The Oak and the Broom*, *Lucy Gray*, *Hart-Leap Well*, *Lucy*, *Nutling*, *Ruth*.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[484] Printed and published by Peck and Newton.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[485] First double-column edition of the poems, adopted by Moxon in 1845 edition.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[486] The Boxall portrait was engraved for the above. I could not find the 1844 imprint, but presume that it is the same as that of 1837 and 1839.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[487] In an editorial of April 16 of “The New World” is the following: “We are enabled by the purchase of the printed sheets considerably in advance of their publication in England to present the first and only American Editions of new poems by William Wordsworth.”

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[488] This is spoken of in Ellis Yarnall’s *Reminiscences* as having no date. When John Locken—the first publisher—failed, the plates passed into the possession of Messrs. Uriah Hunt and Son. They retired from business, and Messrs. Leavitt and Co. took the plates. It is possible that there was an edition earlier than 1843.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[489] The last two named are exactly as in 1843, except that they are printed on larger paper. Why one is put down 32mo and the other 24mo is a mystery!

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[490] If this edition was published, it seems to have disappeared. It is advertised in A. V. Blake’s *American Booksellers’ Complete Trade List*, published at Claremont, N.H., 1847.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[491] Copyright in 1848. It contains about one-fifth of all Wordsworth’s poems. The Essay, which occupies ten pages, is taken “by permission” from Tuckerman’s *Thoughts on Poets*.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[492] In connection with this edition, I can vouch for the five firms of Publishers in Philadelphia, but I cannot explain it.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[493] “This edition contains some pieces omitted—inadvertently it is believed—from the latest London edition.” Additional poems have been introduced, and the arrangement changed since the 1839 edition.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[494] This edition contains a remarkable “Sketch of Wordsworth’s Life,” by James Russell Lowell, which was afterwards embodied, with additions, in *Among my Books*. Mr. Ellis Yarnall believed that this edition was an English reprint. I doubt this from the fact that it is “Entered according to the Act of Congress in 1854,” and was “Printed at Cambridge by H.O. Houghton.”

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[495] This edition is mentioned in some lists, but I am inclined to doubt if it can be authenticated.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[496] The size is given as 32mo. I have not seen the book.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[497] Edited by Waldron J. Cheney, though not credited to him. C. M. ST. JOHN.

[498] No date is given to this edition. The firm-name and place of business according to the Boston Directory would limit the date of the title page at least to 1863-65. It is in the New Haven Library. Allibone notes a volume of “Selections,” Boston, 12mo, 1863, which may be this.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[499] I have placed the two works together, as they are closely related, if not identical. The edition contains *The Excursion* and fifty-seven other poems.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[500] From plates of the 1854 edition, with changes.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[501] This excellent edition—as to selection, size, paper, binding, and illustrations—is the best handy edition of Wordsworth issued in America.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[502] Eighty-eight of the sonnets are here illustrated with rare skill and artistic effect. The illustrations first appeared in wood-cuts in Harper’s *Monthly Magazine*.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

## II

### REPRINTS, AND BOOKS, BOTH ENGLISH AND AMERICAN

A Bibliography of Wordsworth in America is not complete without some reference to the many editions of Wordsworth, and of works pertaining to him, which have—for the most part—appeared simultaneously in England and America. These works cannot properly be termed American, but they have been welcomed, and they have also supplied a want, on this side of the Atlantic. The editions are confined, for the most part, to the last twenty years. I have endeavoured to select those which are of most value.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

#### 1

1859. WORDSWORTH'S PASTORAL POEMS. Illustrated. New York: D. Appleton and Co. 12mo.

1875. Same Title. New York: Putnam. 12mo.

#### 2

1859. POEMS BY WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. Selected and Edited by Robert Aris Willmott. Illustrated with 100 Designs by Birket Foster and others. London and New York: George Routledge and Co. 4to.

1870. The above republished.

#### 3

1869. THE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. Globe Edition. Square 12mo. Philadelphia: Lippincott and Co.

#### 4

1874. RECOLLECTIONS OF A TOUR MADE IN SCOTLAND. By Dorothy Wordsworth. Edited by J. C. Shairp. New York: G. P. Putnam's Sons. (Printed at the Edinburgh University Press.) 12mo.

5

1880. WORDSWORTH'S POEMS. Chosen and Edited by Matthew Arnold. Large Paper Edition. London and New York: Macmillan and Co. 8vo.
1892. Same Title. With Steel Portrait. Printed on India paper. London and New York: Macmillan and Co. 8vo.

6

1881. WILLIAM WORDSWORTH: a Biography with Selections from Prose and Poetry. By A. J. Symington. Boston: Roberts Brothers. 2 vols. 16mo.

7

1885. ODE ON IMMORTALITY AND LINES ON TINTERN ABBEY. London and New York: Cassell and Co. 12mo. (Popular Illustrated Series.)

8

1886. PASTORAL POEMS. London and New York: Cassell and Co. 4to.

9

1887. MEMORIALS OF COLEORTON. Edited, with Introduction and Notes, by William Knight. Boston and New York: Houghton, Mifflin and Co. 12mo. (Printed at the Edinburgh University Press.)

10

1887. THROUGH THE WORDSWORTH COUNTRY. By William Knight. London and New York: Scribner and Welford. Engraving. 8vo.

11

1888. THE COMPLETE POETICAL WORKS OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. With an Introduction by John Morley. London and New York: Macmillan and Co. Crown 8vo.

12

1888. THE RECLUSE. London and New York: Macmillan and Co. 16mo.

13

1889. WORDSWORTHIANA. Edited by William Knight. London and New York: Macmillan and Co. 16mo.

14

1889. POETICAL WORKS, with Memoir. Illustrated. 8 vols. New York: A. C. Armstrong and Son. 16mo. (Printed at the University Press, Glasgow.)

15

1889. SELECTIONS FROM WORDSWORTH. By William Knight, and other Members of the Wordsworth Society. With Preface and Notes. New York: Scribner and Welford. 8vo.

16

1889. WORDSWORTH'S POETICAL WORKS. Edited by William Knight. New York: Macmillan and Co. 8 vols. 8vo. (First published in Edinburgh 1882-89.)

17

1889. LIFE OF WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. By William Knight. New York (and London): Macmillan and Co. 3 vols. 8vo. (First published in Edinburgh, in 1889.)

18

1891. WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. By Elizabeth Wordsworth. New York: Scribner. 18mo. (Also London: Percival and Co.)

19

1889. EARLY POEMS BY WILLIAM WORDSWORTH. Edited by J. R. Tutin. London, etc., and New York: George Routledge and Sons. (Routledge's Pocket Library.)

20

1890. DOVE COTTAGE, Wordsworth's Home from 1800 to 1808. By Stopford A. Brooke. Small paper. London and New York: Macmillan and Co.

21

1891. WORDSWORTH'S THE WHITE DOE OF RYLSTONE, etc. Edited with Introduction and Notes by William Knight. (Clarendon Press Series.) London and New York: Macmillan and Co.

22

1892. WORDSWORTH'S LYRICS AND SONNETS. Selected and Edited by C. K. Shorter. London: David Stott. New York: Macmillan and Co. 32mo.

23

1892. WORDSWORTH'S POETICAL WORKS. Edited with Memoir by E. Dowden. 7 vols. 16mo. London: George Bell and Sons. New York: 112 Fourth Avenue.

24

GLEANINGS FROM WORDSWORTH. Edited by J. Robertson. Vest-pocket Edition. New York: White, Stokes and Allen. (Printed at the University Press, Glasgow.)

25

WE ARE SEVEN. By William Wordsworth.[\[503\]](#) With Drawings by Mary L. Grow. Small 4to. New York: E. P. Dutton and Co.

26

ODE. INTIMATIONS OF IMMORTALITY. With Biographical Sketch and Notes. Boston: Houghton, Mifflin and Co., "Riverside Literature Series," No. 76. March 1895.

[\[503\]](#) This was lithographed and printed by Ernest Nister at Nuremberg.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

### III BOOKS CONTAINING BIOGRAPHICAL SKETCHES, AND CRITICAL ESSAYS

THE WRITERS ARE ARRANGED IN ALPHABETICAL ORDER

1

1867. ALGER, W. R. *The Genius of Solitude*. Boston: Roberts Brothers. 16mo. *Wordsworth*, p. 277.

2

1859-71. ALLIBONE, S. A. *Critical Dictionary of English Literature, and British and American Authors*. Philadelphia: J. B. Lippincott Co. 3 vols. Imperial 8vo. *Wordsworth*, vol. iii. pp. 2843-2849.

3



1884. BURROUGHS, J. "Fresh Fields." Boston: Houghton, Mifflin and Co.  
16mo. *In the Wordsworth Country*, p. 161.[\[504\]](#)

4

1878. CALVERT, G. H. *Wordsworth; A Biographic, Aesthetic Study*. Boston:  
Lee-Sheperd. 16mo.

5

1863. CALVERT, G. H. *Scenes and Thoughts in Europe*. Boston: 16mo.[\[505\]](#)

6

1873. CHANNING, W. ELLERY. Address before the Mercantile Library  
Company of Philadelphia, May 11, 1841. Also in his  
"Complete Works." Boston.[\[506\]](#)

7

1895. CHENEY, JOHN VANCE. *Thoughts on Poetry and the Poets*. Chicago.  
Chapter x. is on Wordsworth.

8

1879. DESHLER, C. D. *Afternoons with the Poets*. New York: Harper and  
Brothers. 12mo. *Wordsworth*.

9

1871. FIELDS, J. T. *Yesterdays with Authors*. Boston: Houghton, Mifflin and  
Co.; also,

1889. *Wordsworth, A Sketch*, p. 253.

1838. FROST, JOHN. *Select Works of the British Poets, with Biographical Sketches*. Philadelphia: Thomas Wardle. Wordsworth.

11

1849. GRAHAM, G. F. *English Synonyms*. New York: D. Appleton and Co. Edited with an Introduction and Illustrative Authorities. By Henry Reed.[\[507\]](#)

12

1854. GILES, H. T. *Illustrations of Genius*. Boston: Ticknor and Fields. 16mo. *William Wordsworth*, pp. 239-266.

13

1886. GRISWOLD, H. T. *Home Life of Great Authors*. Chicago. 18mo. *William Wordsworth*, p. 43.

14

1849. GRISWOLD, R. W. *Sacred Poets of England and America*. New York. Wordsworth.

15

1842. GRISWOLD, R. W. *Poets and Poetry of England*. Philadelphia: Carey and Hunt. A Review and Selections.

16

- HODGKINS, LOUISE M. *Guide to Nineteenth Century Authors*. Boston. Wordsworth Bibliography.

17

1884. HUDSON, H. N. *Studies in Wordsworth*. Boston: Little, Brown and Co.  
[\[508\]](#)

18

1886. JOHNSON, C. F. *Three Americans and Three Englishmen*. New York.  
*Wordsworth*.

19

1864. LOWELL, J. R. *The Poetical Works of William Wordsworth*. Boston:  
Little, Brown and Co. 4 vols. Vol. 1.—*A Sketch of*  
*Wordsworth's Life*.

20

1876. LOWELL, J. R. *Among my Books*. Boston: Houghton, Mifflin and Co.  
*Wordsworth*,[\[509\]](#) pp. 201-251.

21

1887. LOWELL, J. R. *Democracy and other Addresses*. Boston: Houghton,  
Mifflin and Co. *Wordsworth*,[\[510\]](#) 22 pp.

22

1885. MASON, E. T. *Personal Traits of British Authors*. New York: Charles  
Scribner's Sons. *William Wordsworth*, pp. 7-55.

What follows is due to American Enterprise, but it is, of course, not  
strictly American.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

23

1883. MACDONALD, GEORGE. *The Imagination and other Essays* ("Wordsworth's Poetry," pp. 245-263). Boston: D. Lothrop and Co.

24

1881. MYERS, F. W. H. *William Wordsworth*. ("English Men of Letters Series.") New York: Harper and Brothers. 12mo.

1884. Same Title. New York: J. W. Lovell. 12mo.

1889. Same Title. New York. Harper and Brothers.

25

1838. OSBORN, LAUGHTON. *The Vision of Rubeta*.[\[511\]](#) Boston: Weeks, Jordan and Co. 8vo.

26

1846. OSSOLI, MARGARET FULLER. *Art, Literature, and the Drama*. Boston. *Wordsworth*.[\[512\]](#)

27

1885. PHILLIPS, MAUD GILLETTE. *A Popular Manual of English Literature*. New York: Harper and Brothers. Vol. ii. pp. 217-264.

28

1851. REED, HENRY. *Memoirs of Wordsworth*. By C. Wordsworth. Edited by Henry Reed. Boston: Ticknor, Reed, and Fields.[\[513\]](#)

29

1857. REED, HENRY. *Lectures on the British Poets*. In two vols. Philadelphia: Claxton, Remsen and Haffelfinger. Vol. ii. pp. 199-231. Lecture

XV.—Wordsworth.

30

1870. REED, HENRY. *Lectures on the British Poets*. Philadelphia: Claxton, Reinsen and Haffelfinger. *Essay on the English Sonnet*, vol. ii. pp. 235-272.[\[514\]](#)

31

1887. SAUNDERS, FREDERICK. *Story of some Famous Books*. New York: Armstrong and Son. *William Wordsworth*, p. 125.

32

- SAUNDERS, FREDERICK. *Evenings with Sacred Poets*. New York: Randolph and Co. *Wordsworth*.[\[515\]](#)

33

1894. SCUDDER, HORACE E. *Childhood in Literature and Art*. Boston: Houghton, Mifflin and Co. In the chapter entitled "In English Literature and Art," Wordsworth is dealt with (chap. vi. pp. 145-157).[\[516\]](#)

34

1895. SCUDDER, VIDAD. *The Life of the Spirit in Modern English Poets*. Boston: Houghton, Mifflin and Co. Crown 8vo.

35

1892. STEDMAN, C. E. *Nature and Elements of Poetry*. Boston: Houghton, Mifflin and Co.[\[517\]](#)

36

1846. TUCKERMAN, H. T. *Thoughts on the Poets*. New York. *Genius and Writings of Wordsworth*.

37

1882. WELSH, A. H. *Development of English Literature and Language*. Chicago. *Wordsworth*, vol. ii. pp. 330-339.

38

1850. WHIPPLE, E. P. *Essays and Reviews*. Boston: Houghton, Mifflin and Co. *Wordsworth*, vol. i. p. 222.[\[518\]](#)

39

1871. WHIPPLE, E. P. *Literature and Life*. Boston: Houghton, Mifflin and Co. *Wordsworth*, p. 253.[\[519\]](#)

40

1854. WILLIS, N. P. *Famous Persons and Places*. New York: Charles Scribner.[\[520\]](#)

[\[504\]](#) A reprint of the article was published in *The Century Magazine*, 1884.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[\[505\]](#) Not of much importance—the author praises Wordsworth and criticises Jeffrey.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[\[506\]](#) About the same in the “Address” as in the “Complete Works.”

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[\[507\]](#) Contains four hundred quotations from Wordsworth.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[\[508\]](#) Contains 258 pages on Wordsworth.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[\[509\]](#) The same as above with some corrections, and twenty-three new pages added.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[510] The above was first given as an address to “The Wordsworth Society,” 1884, and appeared in *Wordsworthiana* in 1889.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[511] In the Appendix are about twenty pages containing a ferocious criticism on “Wordsworth, his Poetry and his Misrepresentations.”

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[512] In the Memoirs of M. F. Ossoli (Boston, vol. iii. p. 84) there is a short reference to Wordsworth.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[513] Introduction and Editorial Notes by H. R., interesting and valuable.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[514] In the Lecture on the Sonnet, there are interesting allusions to Wordsworth’s Sonnets.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[515] This book and the previous one have about half a dozen pages each on Wordsworth.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[516] The substance of this chapter on Wordsworth as a revealer of Childhood, first appeared in *The Atlantic Monthly*, October 1885.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[517] In this volume there are many references to Wordsworth of interest—especially at pp. 202, 206, 210 and 263—on *Subjective Interpretation*, *The Pathetic Fallacy*, etc.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[518] This essay was also published in *The Complete Poetical Works*. Philadelphia: James Kay jun. and Brothers, 1837. Also in *The North American Review*, 1844.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[519] The above appeared first in *The North American Review*. It was “written when the news came of Wordsworth’s death.” It is not given elsewhere in this list.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[520] Letter V. contains some characteristic remarks on Wordsworth by “Christopher North,” who gave Willis a note of introduction to Wordsworth and Southey. Willis did *not* write about Wordsworth in this book. As it is inserted in some of the lists, I include it, with this explanation.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

# IV REVIEW AND MAGAZINE ARTICLES ON WORDSWORTH PUBLISHED IN AMERICA

FROM 1801 TO 1840

In examining American Reviews and Magazines, for articles on Wordsworth, I find—after much laborious search—only some insignificant notices of his poems, of no critical or literary merit.

I have carefully read each article which appears in this list, and I add brief explanatory notes, indicative of the general tenor of the articles. It was disheartening to find that many of the references to Wordsworth, in Poole's elaborate *Index to Periodical Literature*, were inaccurate and misleading; and that nearly all the articles on Wordsworth published in *Harper's Monthly Magazine* for 1850 were "conveyed" from contemporary English journals.

## 1

1801. *The Port Folio*. Vol. i.

Memoranda regarding the first publication of "Lyrical Ballads" in America.

1801. December, p. 407. The Original Prospectus of "Lyrical Ballads."[\[521\]](#)  
(James Humphreys publisher.)

1801. P. 408.[\[522\]](#)

1802. Vol. ii. p. 62.[\[523\]](#)

1803. Vol. iii. p. 288.[\[524\]](#)

1803. P. 320. Note on the poem beginning,

"A whirl-blast from behind the hill."

1804. Vol. iv. p. 87. Announcement that the editor wishes to obtain a copy of *Descriptive Sketches* (1798) from some publisher or reader.

1804. P. 96.[\[525\]](#)



1802. *The Philadelphia Gazette and Daily Advertiser*. (Published by Samuel Relf.) Friday, Jan. 15, “Wordsworth’s Lyrical Ballads.” (The publisher’s advertisement of the First American Edition.)

1819. DANA, R. H.[\[526\]](#) *North American Review*. Vol. xxiii. p. 276. In review of Hazlitt’s *English Poets*.

1824. *North American Review*. Vol. xviii. p. 356.[\[527\]](#)

1824. *United States Literary Gazette*. Vol. i. p. 245.[\[528\]](#)

1825. *The Atlantic Magazine*, vol. ii. pp. 334-348.

1827. *Christian Monthly Spectator*. Vol. ix. p. 244. (A short article on Wordsworth.)

1832. PRESCOTT, W. H. *North American Review*. Vol. xxxv. pp. 171, 173-176. (In a “Review of English Literature of Nineteenth Century,” is an important reference to Wordsworth.)

1836. EDWARDS, B. B. *American Biblical Repository*. Vol. vii. pp. 187-204.  
[\[529\]](#)

10

1836. *American Quarterly Review*. Vol. xix. p. 66.[\[530\]](#)

11

1836. *American Quarterly Review*. Vol. xix. pp. 420-442.[\[531\]](#)

12

1836. FELTON, C. C. *The Christian Examiner*. Vol. xix. p. 375.[\[532\]](#)

13

1836. PORTER, NOAH. *Christian Quarterly Spectator*.[\[533\]](#) Vol. viii. pp. 127-151.

14

*Christian Monthly Spectator*. Vol xviii. p. 1.[\[534\]](#)

15

1837. “Waldie’s” *Octavo Library*. (Edited by John J. Smith.)[\[535\]](#)

16

1837. “Waldie’s” *Octavo Library*. March 21.[\[536\]](#)

17

1837. *Southern Literary Messenger*. Vol. iii. p. 705. “By a Virginian.”[\[537\]](#)

1837. WHIPPLE, E. P. *The Complete Poetical Works of William Wordsworth*[\[538\]](#) (1837).

1839. *New York Review*. Vol. iv. pp. 1-71.[\[539\]](#)

1839. *American Biblical Repository*.[\[540\]](#) Vol. i. pp. 206-239. (Second edition.)

1839. *Boston Quarterly Review*. Vol. ii. pp. 137-169. (A review of "Wordsworth's Poetical Works," London, 1832.)

1839. *American Methodist Review*.[\[541\]](#) Vol. xxi. p. 449.

[\[521\]](#) An enthusiastic announcement.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[\[522\]](#) An appreciatory and critical Introductory Note to *The Waterfall and the Eglantine*.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[\[523\]](#) Editorial reporting the increasing popularity of "Lyrical Ballads," and further commendation of the poems.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[\[524\]](#) Note on *The Fountain*.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[\[525\]](#) An editorial announcement that "Lyrical Ballads" had reached a third edition, and containing one of the most ardent tributes to Wordsworth in the language.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[\[526\]](#) Not long, but of much interest.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[527] An unsigned and excellent review of the 1824 (Boston) edition of the poems. The writer remarks that not a volume of Wordsworth's poems has been published in America since 1802. Attributed to F.W.P. Greenwood.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[528] Anonymous review of the 1824 (Boston) edition of the poems. One of the very best.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[529] Sectarian in spirit, but on the whole fair to Wordsworth.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[530] Anonymous. A well-written article of about twenty-four pages, reviewing *Yarrow Revisited*. It was one of the earliest reviews in an American journal that claimed for Wordsworth a high order of genius. It was probably written by Robert Walsh, the editor of the *Review*.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[531] An article on Wordsworth's sonnets on Capital Punishment, in an article on "The English Sonnet." Judge Henry Reed found this to have been written by his father, Professor Henry Reed.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[532] An appreciative criticism of eight pages.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[533] Entitled "Wordsworth and his Poetry." A review of the 1824 edition and of *Yarrow Revisited*, Boston, 1835. An estimate of Wordsworth's claims as a poet, and as a man. A more comprehensive, stronger, more inviting criticism (in appealing to those to whom the poetry is unknown) has not been written. It ranks, in my opinion, among the best criticisms on Wordsworth written in America.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[534] H. Tuckerman wrote an article on Wordsworth for his magazine. This may be the article.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[535] The number for 7th March contains a notice of Wordsworth, in a review of Reed's *Complete Poetical Works of Wordsworth* (1837).

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[536] Another mention of Reed's edition, and of the discovery that "a fellow-townsmen," Dr. T. C. James, anticipated the fact of Wordsworth's popularity. A quotation from "Memoirs of Historical Society of Pennsylvania" to prove Dr. James' prophecy.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[537] Writer unknown.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[538] To class this review with others of an early date, I have placed it among Periodical Reviews. It appeared in *The North American Review*, 1844; and again, in 1850, in *Essays and Reviews*.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[539] A review of Reed's 1837 edition of "Wordsworth's Poetical Works." Professor Henry Reed's son—Judge Henry Reed of Philadelphia—informs me that it was written by his father.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[540] This article is entitled "Modern English Poetry—Byron, Shelley, and Wordsworth."

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[541] By an unknown author.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

## V CRITICISMS AND REVIEWS IN PERIODICALS FROM 1840 TO 1870

Arranged as far as possible according to merit. It is difficult to distinguish between the first twelve or fifteen. After them I have placed the articles in the *Literary World*. Most of them have not been noted in other lists, and are especially interesting, as being additional tributes of Wordsworth's intimate friend, Henry Reed. I am indebted to Judge Henry Reed of Philadelphia, for more carefully examining his father's papers, and to the *Literary World* for ascertaining, as far as possible, all that his father wrote on Wordsworth. The criticisms that immediately follow are not without interest. The last half dozen are given, for the most part, because they appear in *Poole's Index*, or in other lists. I have omitted two or three which are of no value whatever.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

1

1844. WHIPPLE, E. P. *North American Review*. [542] Vol. lix. pp. 352-384.

2

1857. HAVEN, GILBERT. *Methodist Quarterly Review*. Vol. xxxix. p. 362.[\[543\]](#)

3

1851. PASSMORE, J. C. *The Church Review*. Vol. iv. pp. 169-188.[\[544\]](#)

4

1866. ALGER, W. R. *Monthly Religious Magazine*. Vol. xxxvi. p. 294.

5

1850. MUZZEY, A. B. *The Christian Examiner*. Vol. xlix. p. 100. (The title of this article is “Wordsworth, the Christian Poet.”)

6

1851. GOODWIN, H. M. *The New Englander*. Vol. xlvii. p. 309. (Title, “Wordsworth as a Spiritual Teacher.”)

7

1851. *North American Review*. Vol. lxxiii. p. 473.[\[545\]](#)

8

1851. MOUNTFORD, W. *The Christian Examiner*. Vol. li. p. 275.[\[546\]](#)

9

1851. PORTER, NOAH. *The New Englander Magazine*. Vol. ix. p. 583.[\[547\]](#)

10

1851. WIGHT, ORLANDO WILLIAMS. *American Whig Review*. Vol. xiv. pp. 68-81.[\[548\]](#)

11

1851. WIGHT, ORLANDO WILLIAMS. *American Whig Review*. Vol. xiii. pp. 448-458.[\[549\]](#)

12

1854. *Presbyterian Quarterly Review*. Vol. ii. pp. 643-663.[\[550\]](#) Article 1.

13

1854. *Presbyterian Quarterly Review*. Vol. iii. pp. 69-88.[\[551\]](#) Article 2.

14

1841. TUCKERMAN, H. *Southern Literary Messenger*. Vol. vii. p. 105.

15

1850. *Literary World*. Vol. vi. p. 485. "William Wordsworth."[\[552\]](#)

16

1850. REED, HENRY. *Literary World*. Vol. vi. pp. 581, 582. On Wordsworth.

17

1850. REED, HENRY. *Literary World*. Vol. vii. pp. 205, 206. A second short article.

18

1850. *Literary World*. "The Prelude." Vol. vii. p. 167.[\[553\]](#)

19

1850. *Literary World*. "Visit to Wordsworth's Grave." Vol. vii. p. 225.[\[554\]](#)

20

1850. SPENCER, J. A. *Literary World*. "Visit to Wordsworth." November 23.  
[\[555\]](#)

21

1851. *Literary World*. Vols. viii. ix. (May 24, June 14, July 12, August 2.)  
[\[556\]](#) Reviews of Christopher Wordsworth's *Memoirs* of his  
uncle.

22

1853. REED, HENRY. *Literary World*. Vol. xii. June 25.[\[557\]](#)

23

1850. *Southern Quarterly Review*. Vol. xviii. p. 1. Review of the *Poetical  
Works of Wordsworth*. London: Moxon, 1845.

24

1856. *United States Democratic Review*. Vol. vi. pp. 281-295. (New Series.)  
Article 1. "Of Wordsworth's life, beginning at Bristol."

25

1856. *United States Democratic Review*. Vol. vi. p. 363. (New Series.)  
Article 2.

26

1850. *Graham Magazine*. Vol. i. pp. 105-116. Supposed to be written by  
Charles J. Peterson. (Signed P.) Review of the life and poetry



of Wordsworth, written by one who confessed to an admiration for Wordsworth's genius bordering on veneration.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

27

1878. *American Journal of Education*. Wordsworth and Cambridge. Vol. xxviii. p. 426.[\[558\]](#)

28

1843. *United States Democratic Review*. Vol. xii. p. 158.[\[559\]](#)

29

1836-63. *Christian Review*. Vol. xvi. p. 434. "Wordsworth as a Religious Poet."

30

1844. CUYLER, T. L. *Godey's Lady's Book*. Vol. xxviii. (January). "On the English Lakes and Wordsworth."

31

1850. *International Magazine*. Vol. i. p. 271. "A Review of *The Prelude*, from *The Examiner*."

32

1855. *Brownson's Quarterly Review*. Vol. xii. p. 525. "Wordsworth's Poetical Works."

33

1850. *Graham Magazine*. Vol. i. pp. 322, 323.[\[560\]](#)

1842. *United States Democratic Review*. Vol. x. pp. 272-288. (New Series.)  
[\[561\]](#)

1865. *North American Review*. Vol. c. p. 508. Boston: Little, Brown and Co.

1850. *Southern Literary Messenger*. Vol. xvi. p. 474.[\[562\]](#)

1851. *Harper's Monthly Magazine*. Vol. iii. p. 502.[\[563\]](#)

1845. BOWEN, F. *North American Review*. Vol. lxi. p. 217.[\[564\]](#)

1863. ALGER, W. R. *North American Review*. Vol. xcvi. p. 141.[\[565\]](#)

1850. *Southern Literary Messenger*. Vol. xvi. p. 637.[\[566\]](#)

1863. WARD, J. H. *North American Review*. Vol. xcvi. p. 387.

1853. *The National Magazine*. Vol. iii. No. 7, "An Estimate of Wordsworth."

43

1853. *The Christian Observer*. Vol. 1. pp. 307-381.[\[567\]](#)

44

1858. "The Genius of Wordsworth," in the "Editor's Table" of *Russell's Magazine*. Charleston, S.E. Vol. iii. pp. 271-274.

[\[542\]](#) A review of the 1837 edition of Wordsworth's poems. Perhaps no abler or more comprehensive review of Wordsworth's life and writings has been written than this, by America's foremost critic.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[\[543\]](#) One of the best of the early American criticisms.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[\[544\]](#) A review of the 1851 edition. Contains an earnest plea for the study of Wordsworth's poetry in America. One of the noblest criticisms written.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[\[545\]](#) On the "Life and Poetry of Wordsworth." A review of *The Prelude*. Unsigned; but the name is given elsewhere, as T. Chase.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[\[546\]](#) A review of the *Memoirs of Wordsworth*, by his nephew, the Bishop of Lincoln.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[\[547\]](#) A review of Professor Reed's edition of the *Memoirs of Wordsworth*, Boston, 1851.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[\[548\]](#) A review of the *Memoirs*, signed O. W.W.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[\[549\]](#) A review of *The Prelude*.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[\[550\]](#) Anonymous. A short review of *The Prelude*, and, at greater length, of *The Life* (edited by Reed). An estimate of his work and influence.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[\[551\]](#) Traces the literary life of the poet. Claims for Wordsworth the precedence to Coleridge in the utterance of a spiritual Philosophy.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[552] A notice of Wordsworth's death, unsigned; but Mr. Wilberforce Eames—of the Lenox Library—informs me, that their library now owns Mr. Evert A. Duyckinck's copy of the *Literary World*, and that gentleman's own initials are appended in pencil to this article. Mr. Duyckinck was editor of the *Literary World*.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[553] Judge Reed, Professor Henry Reed's son, does not attribute this article to his father. There is an impression that Professor Reed published an article on *The Prelude*. His lecture on that poem was never published.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[554] Signed by R. F. Correspondence, *London Literary Gazette*, August 31.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[555] Possibly the same as in that scarce number of the *Southern Literary Messenger*. Vol. xvi. p. 474.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[556] These articles, in the opinion of Judge Henry Reed, are not by his father, Professor Henry Reed.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[557] Notice to those who wish to subscribe to the Memorial to Wordsworth, signed.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[558] An article on the University of Cambridge, and an account of Wordsworth's residence at St. John's College, 1787-1791.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[559] Six pages on Wordsworth's *Sonnet to Liberty*.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[560] A brief review of *The Prelude* and *Excursion*, and a comparison between the two poems.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[561] On Wordsworth's sonnets in favour of Capital Punishment.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[562] On the house at Rydal.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[563] An unsigned, four paged article on Wordsworth, Byron Scott, and Shelley.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[564] In a "Review of Longfellow's *Poets and Poetry of Europe*," a page on Wordsworth's influence.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[565] In "The Origin and Uses of Poetry," a few lines on Wordsworth.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[566] A notice, with extracts from *The Prelude*.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[567] "The Religion of Wordsworth's Poetry."

C. M. ST. JOHN.

## VI CRITICISMS AND REVIEWS IN PERIODICALS FROM 1870 TO 1895

These are not chronologically arranged by Mrs. St. John, but see her note to Section V.—ED.

### 1

1882. DEWITT, DR. JOHN. *Presbyterian Review*. Vol. iii. p. 241. [568]

### 2

1884. BURROUGHS, JOHN. *The Century Magazine*. Vol. v. p. 418. This is entitled "Wordsworth's Country."

### 3

1880. CRANCH, C. P. *The Atlantic Monthly*. Vol. xlv. p. 241. Entitled "Wordsworth." A review of the 1880 Poetical Works (Boston). The writer notes what he considers the chief excellency as well as defects of Wordsworth's poetry.

### 4

1888. MURRAY, J. O. *The Homiletic Review*. Vol. xvi. pp. 295-304. Title, "The Study of Wordsworth's Poetry."

5

1890. PATTISON, T. H. *The Baptist Review*. Vol. xii. p. 265. "The Religious Influence of Wordsworth."

6

1889. HUTTON, LAWRENCE. *Harper's Monthly Magazine*. Vol. lxxviii.[\[569\]](#) (in Literary Notes).

7

- 1880-1. CONWAY, MONCURE D. *Harper's Monthly Magazine*. "The English Lakes and their Genii." Vol. lxii. pp. 7, 161, 339.

8

1883. PEDDER, H. C. *The Manhattan*. Vol. ii. pp. 418-433.[\[570\]](#)

9

1876. YARNALL, ELLIS. *Lippincott's Magazine*. Vol. xviii. pp. 543-554, 669-683. "Walks and Visits in Wordsworth's Country." Written in the summer of 1855 and 1857.

10

1871. FIELDS, J. T. *The Atlantic Monthly*. Vol. xxviii. p. 750. On Wordsworth, in an article entitled "Our Whispering Gallery." The same article is cut down in *Yesterdays with Authors*.[\[571\]](#)

11

1892. PARSONS, EUGENE. *The Examiner*. Vol. lxx. p. 1. On "Tennyson and Wordsworth."

1888. WILLIAMS, T. C. *Andover Review*. Vol. ix. p. 30.

1889. NOBLE, FRED PERRY. *The Homiletic Review*. Vol. xviii. p. 306. "The Value of Wordsworth to the Preacher."

1873. HIMES, JOHN A. *Lutheran Quarterly Review*. Vol. iii. p. 252. "The Religious Faith of Wordsworth and Tennyson as shown in their Poems."

1881. JOHNSON, E. E. *American Church Review*. Vol. xxxiii. p. 139. "Influence of Wordsworth's Poetry."

1886. COAN, T. M. *The New Princeton Review*. Vol. i. pp. 297-319. "Wordsworth's Passion."

1889. VEDDER, H. C. *The New York Examiner*, August 28. "The Decline of Wordsworth." [\[572\]](#)

1877. COAN, T. M. *The Galaxy*. Vol. xxiii. pp. 322-336. "Wordsworth's Corrections." [\[573\]](#)

1881. BOWEN, F. F. *The Dial*. Vol. i. p. 21. "A Review of Myers' Wordsworth."

20

1881. GERHART, R. L. *Reformed Quarterly Review*. Vol. xxviii. p. 344. "Wordsworth and his Art."

21

1887. WOODBERRY, G. E. *The Nation*. Vol. xlv. p. 487. "Wordsworth and the Beaumonts."

22

1881. BROWNELL, W. C. *The Nation*. Vol. xxxii. p. 153. "Myers' Account of Wordsworth."

23

1872. CROFFUT, W. A. *Lakeside Monthly*. Vol. viii. pp. 418-425. "Wordsworth."

24

1895. THORPE, F. W. *The Philadelphia Call*. "The Home of Wordsworth." Autobiographic and critical.

25

1879. *Appleton's Journal*. Vol. xxii. p. 223. "How to Popularise Wordsworth."

26



1874. DE-VERE, A. *The Catholic World*. Vol. xix. p. 795. "Recollections of Wordsworth."

27

1875. DE-VERE, A. *The Catholic World*. Vol. xxii. p. 329.

28

1891. PAGE, H. A. *The Century Magazine*. No. 1. pp. 453-864. "Wordsworth and De Quincey. With hitherto unpublished letters." [\[574\]](#)

29

1853. *The National Magazine*. Vol. iii. pp. 36-40.

30

1853. *Brownson's Quarterly Review*. Vol. xii. 525.

31

1896. THEODORE W. HUNT in *Bibliotheca Sacra*. No. 66. "William Wordsworth."

32

1896. J. W. BRAY. *The Literary Democracy of Wordsworth* in "Poet Love." Vol. iii. No. 6.

[\[568\]](#) On "The Homiletic Value of Wordsworth's Poetry." One of the ablest papers ever written on Wordsworth. It contains the best reply to Matthew Arnold's estimate of his poetry.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[\[569\]](#) This is a review of Rolf's *Wordsworth's Selected Poems*. It contains one of the most appreciative tributes to Wordsworth's influence which has appeared in America.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[570] On "Wordsworth and the Modern Age." Illustrated by W. St. J. Harper, and other artists. It deals with the especial need of Wordsworth's "calming influence in the exacting competition for success," and gives a comparison between Virgil and Wordsworth.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[571] Of interest to Americans.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[572] It aims to give some explanation of the lack of interest in Wordsworth's poetry in later days.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[573] An attempt, the writer says, to point out the corrections, leaving their interpretation to the reader.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

[574] Written by an Englishman, but published first in an American magazine.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

## VII VISITS TO WORDSWORTH BY EMINENT AMERICANS

The following books record visits made by eminent Americans to Wordsworth.

C. M. ST. JOHN.

### 1

1863. HAWTHORNE, N. *Our Old Home, and English Note-Books*. Vol. ii. pp. 24-56, etc.; also,

1883. Boston: Houghton, Mifflin and Co. "A Visit to Wordsworth."

### 2

1856. EMERSON, R. W. *English Traits*. Boston: James Munroe and Co. pp. 24-31; also,

1881. Boston: Houghton, Mifflin and Co. Visit to Wordsworth, in chapter entitled "First Visit to England."

3

1876. TICKNOR, GEORGE. *Life, Letters, and Journals*. Boston: James R. Osgood and Co. 2 vols. Vol. i. pp. 287, 288, etc. Vol. ii. p. 167, etc.

4

1836. DEWEY, ORVILLE. *The Old World and the New*. Boston: 2 vols. pp. 89-96.

5

1884. BRYANT, W. C. Prose Works. In a chapter on "Poets and Poetry of the English Language" (New York: D. Appleton and Co.) a few pages deal with Wordsworth.

**VIII**  
**A FEW POEMS ON WORDSWORTH**

1

1846. WALLACE, W. *Poem on Wordsworth*. New York: 12mo.

2

1850. FIELD, JAMES T. *Graham Magazine* (October). "Wordsworth."

3

1850. ALEXANDER, W. *Graham Magazine* (November), p. 221.  
"Wordsworth. (A Sonnet.)"

4

1850. H. M. R. *Harpers Magazine*. "Sonnet on the Death of Wordsworth."  
Vol. i. p. 218.

5

1850. E. A. W. *Literary World*. "Sonnet on Wordsworth." Vol. vii. p. 255.

6

1874. WHITTIER, J. G. Whittier's Works. Boston: Houghton, Mifflin and Co.  
"Poem on Wordsworth. Written on a blank leaf of *Wordsworth's*  
*Memoirs*, 1851." Vol. iv. p. 66.

7

1890. SCOLLARD, CLINTON (?) *Northern Christian Advocate*. "The Poet's  
Seat. A Sonnet on Wordsworth. Written at Ambleside, 1890."

8

1893. "To Wordsworth, after reading his XXX Ecclesiastical Sonnets" in  
*The Echo and the Poet*, by William Cushing Bamburgh. N. Y.  
1893.

## IX

### UNPUBLISHED LECTURES ON WORDSWORTH

#### ESSAYS OF SPECIAL INTEREST

1

1892. CORSON, HIRAM. "The Divine Immanence in Nature, and the  
relationship of the human spirit thereto, as presented in  
Wordsworth's Poetry."

WINCHESTER, C. T. "The Lake District and Wordsworth."

PRENTISS, GEORGE L. "Hurstmonceaux Rectory and Rydal Mount."  
(Personal Recollections.)

HOYT, A. S. "Wordsworth, the Man and the Poet." (Imperfectly  
reported in *The Houghton Record*.)

### III.—*FRANCE*

#### WORDSWORTH IN FRANCE

By ÉMILE LEGOUIS, Professeur à la Faculté de Lettres, Université de Lyon,  
France

#### I

#### BIBLIOGRAPHY

There is no separate or whole book on Wordsworth that I know of.

#### ARTICLES IN MAGAZINES, OR CHAPTERS IN BOOKS

*Voyage historique et littéraire en Angleterre et en Écosse*, par Amédée  
Pichot (*passim*). 3 vols. in 8. Paris, 1829.[\[575\]](#) An English  
translation was published in London in 1825.

*Revue Britannique*.

Mai 1827. Wordsworth, Crabbe, and Campbell, pp. 61-79, a  
criticism translated from the *New Monthly Magazine*.

Février 1835. Poésie domestique de la grande Bretagne, translated from the *New Monthly Magazine*.

Janvier 1836, p. 190. Compte-rendu de “Yarrow Revisited and other Poems,” translated from the *Repository of Knowledge*.

*Revue des Deux Mondes*. 1er Août 1835. William Wordsworth, par A. Fontaney.[\[576\]](#)

*Revue Contemporaine*. 15 Décembre 1853. Poètes contemporains de l’Angleterre: William Wordsworth et John Wilson, par L. Étienne.

*Littérature anglaise* de H. Taine.[\[577\]](#) 1864. Vol. iv. pp. 311-324.

*Études sur la Littérature contemporaine*, par Éd. Schérer.[\[578\]](#)

*Revue critique d’histoire et de littérature*. 16 Janvier 1882. Article de James Darmesteter sur la Biographie de Wordsworth, par Myers.[\[579\]](#)

*Essais de Littérature anglaise*, par James Darmesteter. Paris, 1883.[\[580\]](#)

*Histoire de la Littérature anglaise*, par M. Léon Boucher. Paris, 1890. pp. 355-363.

*La Renaissance de la Poésie anglaise*, par Gabriel Sarrazin. 1887.

*Études et Portraits*, par Paul Bourget. Vol. ii. Études anglaises.[\[581\]](#) 1888.

*Étude sur la Vie et les Œuvres de Robert Burns*, par Auguste Angellier. Paris, 1892. (*Passim*, et surtout vol. ii. pp. 362-393, Étude sur le sentiment de la nature dans Wordsworth et autres poètes anglais contemporains.)

*Le général Michel Beaupuy*, par Georges Bussière et Émile Legouis. Paris, 1891.

[\[575\]](#) Vol. ii. pp. 363-394.—ED.

[\[576\]](#) This was signed Y, which was Fontaney’s pseudonym.—E.L.

[\[577\]](#) Wordsworth et la poésie moderne de l’Angleterre.—*Histoire de la Littérature anglaise*, par H. Taine.—ED.

[\[578\]](#) Vol. vi. pp. 127, 128, and vol. vii. pp. 1-59.—ED.

[\[579\]](#) pp. 227-236.—ED.

[\[580\]](#) pp. 227-236.—ED.

[\[581\]](#) Vol. ii. pp. 83; 126-134.—ED.

## II TRANSLATIONS

Pas de traduction complète, ni de volume spécial de traductions de Wordsworth.

Une traduction par Fontaney annoncée en 1837 comme devant paraître dans le *Bibliothèque anglo-française*, n'a pas paru.

En dehors des poèmes ou parties de poèmes traduit par les critiques énumérés plus haut, il n'y a guère de traduction en prose de quelque importance.

### TRADUCTIONS EN VERS

MADAME AMABLE TASTU. *We are Seven*.

SAINTE-BEUVE. *Joseph Delorme*. 1829.

“Le plus long jour de l’année,” p. 88.

Sonnet, “Personal Talk,” p. 123.

“Sonnet sur le Sonnet,” p. 124.

*Consolations*. 1830.

Sonnet, “It is a beauteous evening,” p. 234.

Sonnet, “Not Love, nor War,” p. 239.

Sonnet, “Quand le poète en pleurs,” p. 236.

*Pensées d’Août*. Trois sonnets imités de Wordsworth.

I. “Reposez-vous et remerciez.”

II. “La Cabane du Highlander.”

III. “Le Château de Bothwell.”

Sainte-Beuve cite en outre dans ses *Nouveaux Lundis* des 21 et 22 Avril 1862, trois sonnets de Wordsworth traduits en vers, par l’Abbé Roussel. Ces

traductions assez pauvres de poésie sont celles des sonnets suivants—

“Nuns fret not....”

“Dark and more dark....”

“These words were uttered as in pensive mood.”

JEAN AICARD a traduit *We are Seven* dans *La Chanson de l'Enfant*.

PAUL BOURGET (*Études et Portraits*, vol. ii. *op. cit.*) a traduit l'un des sonnets au Duddon.

“What aspect bore the Man ...?”

### III INFLUENCE

Wordsworth's influence on French literature was altogether very slight, nor did it make itself felt till about 1830; when, after a very limited period, it silently died away.

Wordsworth was but little known by his contemporary Châteaubriand, who merely names him among other poets in his *Essai sur la Littérature anglaise*. Byron, Walter Scott, and in a lesser degree Thomas Moore, were the only writers of Great Britain whose works told on our literature at that time. Villemain, in his criticism of Byron, contemptuously dismisses all the so-called lake-poets to fix on his hero. He calls them: “Des métaphysiciens, raisonneurs sans invention, mélancoliques sans passion, qui, dans l'éternelle rêverie d'une vie étroite et peu agitée, n'avaient produit que des singularités sans puissance sur l'imagination des autres hommes. Tel était Woodsworth (*sic*) et le subtil mais non touchant Coléridge.”

To Byron also, and to him alone (Ossian being excepted) among the poets of England, was Lamartine indebted. I am not sure that he names Wordsworth once; but still the striking analogy between the ideas and imaginative style of both cannot fail to be noticed by the reader. Without insisting on a parallel that might be drawn between many pages of *The*



*Excursion* and of *Jocelyn*, I will only point out two short pieces of Lamartine that bear strong resemblance to two poems of Wordsworth, so much so that they almost read like free imitations—

| Lamartine                                               | Wordsworth's                       |
|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| "A Augusta," <i>Recueils Poétiques</i> , xx.            | <i>Nightingale and Stock-dove.</i> |
| "Le Fontaine du Foyard," <i>Nouvelles Confidences</i> . | <i>The Fountain.</i>               |

Victor Hugo, so far as I know, only names Wordsworth once, in *L'Âne*—

...Young le pleureur des nuits,  
Wordsworth l'esprit des lacs ...

M. Sully Prudhomme when he wrote *A l'Hirondelle* (stanzas, la vie intérieure) appears to have borne in mind *To a Skylark*, "Ethereal minstrel," etc.

M. Coppée has often been called a French Wordsworth, owing to his poetical collection called *Les Humbles*, wherein he shows the same partiality as the English Poet does for humble themes and characters, together with a bold attempt to naturalise trivial or ludicrous details in serious poetry; but there is no proof, as far as I know, of Wordsworth's influence having been strong upon him.

If we except two or three disciples of Wordsworth, neither he, nor the lake-poets taken as a whole, seem to have been much thought of, or even read, by our contemporary verse-writers. The word *Lakist* has generally been used as a synonym for "weak and doleful mysticism." Ex.:—

(a) *Revue Encyclopédique*. 1831. Article de Pierre Leroux, sur la "Poésie de notre Époque." "L'Angleterre a entendu autour de ses lacs bourdonner comme des ombres plaintives un essaim de poètes abîmés dans une mystique contemplation."

(b) *Journal d'un Poète*, par Alfred de Vigny. (Ed. Michel Lévy. 1867. p. 80.) "Barbier vient de publier *Il Pianto*. Les délices de Capone ont amolli son caractère de poésie et Brizeux a déteint sur lui ses douces couleurs virgiliennes et laquistes (*sic*) dérivant de Sainte-Beuve."

(c) THÉOPHILE GAUTIER (*Portraits Contemporains*, p. 174) almost seems to derive the word *Lakiste* from Lamartine's poem called *Le Lac*. He has just mentioned the poem and goes on: "Il ne faut pas croire que Lamartine, parce qu'il y a toujours chez lui une vibration et une résonnance de harpe éolienne, ne soit qu'un mélodieux *lakiste* et ne sache que soupirer mollement la mélancolie et l'amour. S'il a le soupir, il a la parole et le cri ..." (*Journal Officiel*, 8 Mars 1869.)

I now come to the man who, first and foremost among our poets and critics, paid due homage to Wordsworth, *i.e.* Sainte-Beuve. I have already enumerated his several translations in verse from Wordsworth. Strange to say, the voluminous critic has no single article with Wordsworth for its main subject; but, whoever will go through his many volumes will find many judicious and admiring references to the poet.

Moreover, as a poet, Sainte-Beuve has endeavoured to naturalise in France the poetic style that has been associated with the name of Wordsworth. He expressly claims Wordsworth as one of his masters in his *Consolations* xviii. "A Antony Deschamps." Among his bosom-poets he reckons—

...Wordsworth peu connu, qui des lacs solitaires  
Sait tous les bleus reflets, les bruits et les mystères,  
Et qui, depuis trente ans vivant au même lieu,  
En contemplation devant le même Dieu,  
A travers les soupirs de la mousse et de l'onde,  
Distingue, au soir, des chants venus d'un meilleur monde.

The original attempt of Sainte-Beuve (for he was original in his very choice of Wordsworth as a model at a time when Byron engrossed all the admiration of the French poets) has been ably characterised by Théophile

Gautier in his “Portraits Contemporains” (pp. 208, 209), an article reprinted from *La Gazette de Paris*, 19 Novembre 1871:—

“(Sainte-Beuve) avait été en poésie un inventeur. Il avait donné une note nouvelle et toute moderne, et de tout le cénacle c’était à coup sûr le plus réellement romantique. Dans cette humble poésie qui rappelle par la sincérité du sentiment et la minutie du détail observé sur nature, les vers de Crabbe, de Wordsworth, et de Cowper, Sainte-Beuve s’est frayé de petits sentiers à mi-côte, bordés d’humbles fleurettes, où nul en France n’a passé avant lui. Sa facture un peu laborieuse et compliquée vient de la difficulté de réduire à la forme métrique des idées et des images non exprimées encore ou dédaignées jusque-là, mais que de morceaux merveilleusement venus où l’effort n’est plus sensible!”

Sainte-Beuve’s admiration of Wordsworth is a well-known fact. Less generally known is the influence of this admiration on several poets of that time (*circa* 1830-40), who, either through Sainte-Beuve’s imitations, or with a direct knowledge of Wordsworth’s poems, to the reading of which they had thus been stimulated, offer great marks of resemblance with Wordsworth. I have quoted a judgment of De Vigny that considers Brizeux and Barbier as having turned *laquistes* through Sainte-Beuve. I know no other immediate proof of this influence. Perhaps Barbier and Brizeux have consigned it somewhere. Anyhow Brizeux with his glorification of his youthful years and school-time, with his intense love of his native Brittany, his fond attachment to local customs and habits, his lamentations on the death of the poetical poet as embodied in his own province (*Élégie de la Bretagne*), is to all extent and purposes the most thoroughly Wordsworthian of all our poets. There may be more of Wordsworth’s *philosophy* in Lamartine, but there is more of his *poetry* proper in Brizeux.

The influence of Wordsworth on Maurice de Guérin and Hippolyte de la Morvonnais, is more easily ascertained than the preceding. Here, again, Sainte-Beuve appears to have been the intermediate agent.[\[582\]](#)

In 1832-33 Maurice de Guérin, fresh from the reading of the *Consolations*, and De la Morvonnais, who came to be a direct admirer of the Lake Poets, and chiefly of Wordsworth, set to write short poems which they aspired to make as little different from prose as possible, rejecting all traditional ornaments, and making little of the rhythmical improvements of the *Romantiques* proper. Some of those pieces were inserted in a local paper as downright prose (no stop intervening at the end of the lines), whereas the said paper would not have made room for verse.<sup>[583]</sup> This looks like trifling, but the earnestness of this attempted revolution is shown in the interesting poems of Maurice de Guérin. Another outcome of this was an intended publication on Wordsworth, of which it is impossible to say whether it was to be a criticism, or a translation, of the English Poet. It is thus mentioned in a letter of Guérin to De la Morvonnais of June 30, 1836: “Nous avons adressé des circulaires à un grand nombre d’éditeurs pour l’impression Wordsworth. Nous attendons la réponse d’un moment à l’autre.” The answer must have been unfavourable, as nothing more was heard of the intended publication.

The early death of Guérin left it for De la Morvonnais alone to spread the influence of Wordsworth’s poetry in France. Of him we read in Sainte-Beuve’s *Étude sur Maurice de Guérin*:—

“La Morvonnais, vers ce temps même (1834), en était fort préoccupé (des lakistes et de leur poésie), au point d’aller visiter Wordsworth à sa résidence de Rydal Mount, près des lacs du Westmoreland, et de rester en correspondance avec ce grand et pacifique esprit, avec ce patriarche de la Muse intime. Guérin, sans tant y songer, ressemblait mieux aux Lakistes en ne visant nullement à les imiter.”

Of the supposed correspondence between Wordsworth and De la Morvonnais no trace remains. M. Hippolyte de la Blanchardière, De la Morvonnais’ grandson, has informed me that in the collection of his grandfather’s letters there is no letter of Wordsworth to be found. That at least a Study of Wordsworth existed at the time is proved by the following

preface to his poem *La Thébaïde des Grèves*, written by his friend A. Duquesnel (ed. by Didier, Quai des Augustins. 1864. p. xxvii.)

“Nous avons trouvé dans les *Reliquiae* du poète de l’Arguenon<sup>[584]</sup> de précieuses études sur les lakistes. Il s’était passionné pour ces hommes dans les dix dernières années de sa vie (1843-53).<sup>[585]</sup> Wordsworth lui semblait plus grand que Byron, qu’il trouvait trop emphatique, trop solennel, pas assez près de la nature. L’auteur de *l’Excursion* a exercé une pénétrante influence sur l’esprit et le cœur de la Morvonnais, nous trouvons dans ses cahiers des traductions en vers de Wordsworth, de Colérige, de Crabbe, qui, lui, ne faisait pas partie de ce groupe. Nous les publierons peut-être un jour; elles ont d’autant plus d’intérêt que l’on ne connaît guère les lakistes en France, que par de rares extraits. Il s’était livré, comme on le verra, à une étude approfondie de la littérature anglaise. Son admiration pour Walter Scott était inexprimable.”

The study and translations above-mentioned have also been lost, many manuscripts of De la Morvonnais having been destroyed.

It remains for me to point out some allusions to, or imitations of, Wordsworth in the existing verse of De la Morvonnais.

In the *Thébaïde des Grèves* (1838), “Le Petit Patour” is a close imitation of *We are Seven*, the conclusion being—

Cet enfant en sait plus que moi sur l’existence;  
Savoir vivre est savoir souffrir avec constance.

“Le Vagabond,” a story of a vagrant by whom the poet is taught resignation, is an imitation of *Resolution and Independence*.

In “A Sainte-Beuve” are found these two lines—

J'ai posé sous mon bras mon penseur solitaire,  
Mon Wordsworth tant aimé de l'amant du mystère.

In "Dispersion, à Mistress Hemans," etc., we read this—

Nous primes un poète, une femme angélique  
Dont peu savent chez nous la voix mélancolique,  
Disciple de Wordsworth, le sublime penseur,  
Des lakistes chéris je la nomme la sœur.

In "Dernières Paroles" we find this praise of Wordsworth—

Or, ce soir-là, je lus un homme de génie;  
Celui dont la mystique et profonde harmonie  
Sonne pour les élus des poétiques dons,  
Et soulève notre âme en ses grands abandons ...  
...Oh! ne pourrai-je voir  
Ces lacs du Westmoreland, mon désir, mon espoir?  
...  
Cet homme est honoré des puissances secrètes;  
Lui mort, à ses beaux lacs, romantiques retraites,  
Des pèlerins viendront, penseurs religieux.  
Le monde méconnut l'homme mélodieux.

I pass over many sonnets, and divers other poems, in which the influence of Wordsworth is unmistakable, and come to a last quotation which is useful to elucidate an allusion in Wordsworth's *The Poet's Dream: Sequel to the Norman Boy*. In this poem, written in 1842, Wordsworth says—

But oh! that Country-man of thine, whose eye, loved Child, can see  
A pledge of endless bliss in acts of early piety,  
In verse, which to thy ear might come, would treat this simple theme,  
Nor leave untold our happy flight in that adventurous dream.

As Wordsworth read very little French poetry in his old age, I think he here alludes to a poem of his admirer De la Morvonnais, who very likely sent him that *Thébaïde des Grèves* (1838), in which Wordsworth was so highly praised. The passage alluded to is taken from “Solitude,” and reads thus—

Enfant, Il (Dieu) te promet le domaine de l’ange  
Si tu gardes l’amour et la foi des aïeux,  
Et sa mère, aujourd’hui loin de l’humaine fange,  
Que tu n’as pas connue et qui t’attend aux cieux.

As a whole, De la Morvonnais, though he imitates Wordsworth, is very unlike him. Of course I do not mean to compare the two, but even in like subjects he differs from Wordsworth, owing to a sort of constitutional nervousness and brooding melancholy.[\[586\]](#)

[\[582\]](#) Voir Maurice de Guérin, *Journal, Lettres et Poèmes*, publiés par J. S. Trébutien avec Préface de Sainte-Beuve (1860).—E.L.

[\[583\]](#) In the above work—*Séjour de M. de Guérin en Bretagne; Impressions et Souvenirs de M. François du Breil de Marzan*, pp. 434-441.—E.L.

[\[584\]](#) H. de la Morvonnais.—E.L.

[\[585\]](#) A mistake: his admiration of Wordsworth began before 1832.—E.L.

[\[586\]](#) In *Voyage historique et littéraire en Angleterre et en Écosse*, par Amédée Puchot, Lettre xxiv. there are numerous references to Wordsworth. It begins with a quotation from *Tintern Abbey*. In Lettre lxxv. there is additional critical reference to Wordsworth and Coleridge. In the *Album poétique des jeunes personnes*, par Mme. Tastu, there is a “Sonnet imité de Wordsworth,” by St. Beuve, pp. 101, 102.

C'est un beau soir, un soir paisible et solennel,  
A la fin du saint jour la nature en prière  
Le tait, comme Marie à genoux sur la pierre, etc.—ED.

See also the *Nouveaux Lundis* of St. Beuve, 21 and 22 Avril 1862, where there are “trois sonnets traduits en vers par l'Abbé Roussel” from Wordsworth.

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# ERRATA AND ADDENDA LIST

## REFERRING TO VOLUMES I. TO VIII.

1. *Inistar omnium*.—I wish to explain the accidental omission of Mr. T. Hutchinson's name amongst those who helped me in Volumes I. and II. (see the prefatory note to this volume), and also that of Mr. Hill. It was due to my returning, "for press," an uncorrected copy of my Preface.

2. Vol. ii. p. 106, *Ruth*, l. 54—The following extract from Bartram's *Travels*, etc., illustrates Wordsworth's debt to him:—

Proceeding on our return to town in the cool of the evening ... we enjoyed a most enchanting view; ... companies of young innocent Cherokee virgins, some busy gathering the rich fragrant fruit, others having already filled their baskets, lay reclined under the shade of floriferous and fragrant native bowers ... disclosing their beauties to the fluttering breeze ... whilst other parties, more gay and libertine, were yet collecting strawberries, or wantonly chasing their companions, tantalising them, staining their lips and cheeks with the ripe fruit.

3. In vol. ii. p. 348, the date of publication should be Sept. 17, 1802, not 1803.

4. In *The Prelude* (vol. iii. p. 202, book v. l. 26) the quotation which I could not trace is from Shakespeare, Sonnet No. 64—

This thought is as a death, which cannot choose  
But weep to have that which it fears to lose.

5. Vol. v. p. 113 (*The Excursion*, book iii. l. 187).—Mr. William E. Walcott—Laurence, Mass. U.S.A.—sends me the following variant readings, which he has found in a copy of the edition of 1814—

... crystal tube  
Be lodged therein ...

P. 151, book iv. l. 187—

Nor sleep, nor ...

6. Vol. vii. p. 276.—This sonnet first appeared in the *New Monthly Magazine*, part ii. p. 26, under the title, *To B. R. Haydon. Composed on seeing his Picture of Napoleon, musing at St. Helena*; and it is dated “Saturday, June 11th, 1831.”

7. Vol. vii. p. 336.—This poem was published in the *Saturday Magazine*, May 18, 1844, in which the fifth line is—

Woe to the purblind men who fill.

8. It may be worth mentioning (1) that the quotation (not noted, unfortunately, where it occurs)—

Some natural tears she drops, but wipes them soon,

is from *Paradise Lost*, book xii. l. 645. See also *An Elegy delivered at the Hot Wells*, Bristol, July 1789. (2) That the phrase “numerous verse” is from *Paradise Lost*, book v. l. 150; and (3) that “lenient hand of Time” is from Bowles’ sonnet—

O Time, who know'st a lenient hand to lay  
Softest on sorrow's wound.

Amongst those which I have failed to trace are the following:  
*Ecclesiastical Sonnets*, II. xxxiv.—

... murderer's chain partake,  
Corded, and burning at the social stake.

xliv.—

... in the painful art of dying

*The Russian Fugitive*, Part II. l. 51—

... if house it be or bower.

*Elegiac Musings*, l. 41—

Let praise be mute where I am laid.

*Stanzas suggested in a Steamboat off Saint Bees' Heads*, l. 37—

Cruel of heart were they, bloody of hand.

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| Happy the feeling from the bosom thrown                | vii  | 159                 |
| Hard task! exclaim the undisciplined, to lean          | viii | <a href="#">86</a>  |
| Hark! 'tis the Thrush, undaunted, undeprest,           | viii | <a href="#">93</a>  |
| Harmonious Powers with Nature work                     | viii | <a href="#">125</a> |
| Harp! could'st thou venture, on thy boldest string     | vii  | 72                  |
| Hast thou seen, with flash incessant,                  | vi   | 174                 |
| Hast thou then survived—                               | iii  | 14                  |
| Haydon! let worthier judges praise the skill           | vii  | 277                 |
| Here closed the Tenant of that lonely vale             | v    | 145                 |
| <i>Here Man more purely lives, less oft doth fall,</i> | vii  | 37                  |

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|---------------------------------------------------------|------|---------------------|
| Here, on our native soil, we breathe once more          | ii   | 341                 |
| Here on their knees men swore; the stones were black,   | vii  | 381                 |
| Here pause: the poet claims at least this praise,       | iv   | 255                 |
| Here stood an Oak, that long had borne affixed          | vii  | 305                 |
| Here, where, of havoc tired and rash undoing,           | viii | <a href="#">168</a> |
| Her eyes are wild, her head is bare,                    | i    | 258                 |
| Her only pilot the soft breeze, the boat                | vii  | 160                 |
| “High bliss is only for a higher state,”                | vii  | 156                 |
| High deeds, O Germans, are to come from you!            | iv   | 59                  |
| High in the breathless Hall the Minstrel sate,          | iv   | 83                  |
| High is our calling, Friend!—Creative Art               | vi   | 61                  |
| High on a broad unfertile tract of forest-skirted Down, | viii | <a href="#">133</a> |
| High on her speculative tower                           | vi   | 345                 |
| His simple truths did Andrew glean                      | ii   | 174                 |
| Holy and heavenly Spirits as they are,                  | vii  | 67                  |
| Homeward we turn. Isle of Columba’s Cell,               | vii  | 382                 |
| Hope rules a land for ever green:                       | vii  | 190                 |
| Hope smiled when your nativity was cast,                | vii  | 378                 |
| Hopes, what are they?—Beads of morning                  | vi   | 170                 |
| How art thou named? In search of what strange land,     | vii  | 129                 |
| How beautiful the Queen of Night, on high               | viii | <a href="#">188</a> |
| How beautiful, when up a lofty height                   | viii | <a href="#">90</a>  |
| How beautiful your presence, how benign,                | vii  | 19                  |
| How blest the Maid whose heart—yet free                 | vi   | 351                 |
| How clear, how keen, how marvellously bright            | vi   | 63                  |
| “How disappeared he?” Ask the newt and toad;            | vii  | 297                 |
| How fast the Marian death-list is unrolled!             | vii  | 61                  |
| How profitless the relics that we cull,                 | vii  | 308                 |
| How richly glows the water’s breast                     | i    | 32                  |
| How rich that forehead’s calm expanse!                  | vii  | 123                 |
| How sad a welcome! To each voyager                      | vii  | 380                 |
| How shall I paint thee?—Be this naked stone,            | vi   | 232                 |

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| How soon—alas! did Man, created pure—            | vii  | 35                  |
| How sweet it is, when mother Fancy rocks         | iv   | 36                  |
| Humanity, delighting to behold                   | vi   | 107                 |
| Hunger, and sultry heat, and nipping blast       | iv   | 248                 |
| I am not One who much or oft delight             | iv   | 31                  |
| I come, ye little noisy Crew,                    | ii   | 84                  |
| I dropped my pen; and listened to the Wind       | iv   | 211                 |
| I find it written of Simonides,                  | viii | <a href="#">258</a> |
| If from the public way you turn your steps       | ii   | 215                 |
| If Life were slumber on a bed of down,           | vii  | 351                 |
| If money's slack,                                | viii | <a href="#">271</a> |
| If Nature, for a favourite child,                | ii   | 88                  |
| If there be prophets on whose spirits rest       | vii  | 5                   |
| If these brief Records, by the Muses' art        | vii  | 177                 |
| If the whole weight of what we think and feel,   | vii  | 165                 |
| If this great world of joy and pain              | vii  | 336                 |
| If thou indeed derive thy light from Heaven,     | vii  | 175                 |
| If thou in the dear love of some one Friend      | ii   | 210                 |
| If to Tradition faith be due                     | vii  | 311                 |
| If with old love of you, dear Hills! I share     | viii | <a href="#">95</a>  |
| I grieved for Buonaparté, with a vain            | ii   | 323                 |
| I hate that Andrew Jones; he'll breed            | viii | <a href="#">221</a> |
| I have a boy of five years old;                  | i    | 234                 |
| I heard (alas! 'twas only in a dream)            | vi   | 198                 |
| I heard a thousand blended notes,                | i    | 269                 |
| I know an aged Man constrained to dwell          | viii | <a href="#">186</a> |
| I listen—but no faculty of mine,                 | vi   | 326                 |
| Imagination—ne'er before content,                | vi   | 88                  |
| I marvel how Nature could ever find space        | ii   | 208                 |
| I met Louisa in the shade,                       | ii   | 362                 |
| Immured in Bothwell's Towers, at times the Brave | vii  | 299                 |
| In Brugès town is many a street                  | vii  | 198                 |

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| In days of yore how fortunately fared                | v    | 67                  |
| In desultory walk through orchard grounds,           | viii | <a href="#">123</a> |
| In distant countries have I been,                    | i    | 279                 |
| In due observance of an ancient rite,                | iv   | 241                 |
| Inland, within a hollow vale, I stood;               | ii   | 343                 |
| Inmate of a mountain-dwelling,                       | vi   | 135                 |
| In my mind's eye a Temple, like a cloud              | vii  | 173                 |
| In one of those excursions (may they ne'er           | iii  | 367                 |
| Intent on gathering wool from hedge and brake        | viii | <a href="#">122</a> |
| In these fair vales hath many a Tree                 | vii  | 269                 |
| In the sweet shire of Cardigan,                      | i    | 262                 |
| In this still place, remote from men,                | ii   | 393                 |
| In trellised shed with clustering roses gay,         | iv   | 102                 |
| Intrepid sons of Albion! not by you                  | vi   | 111                 |
| In youth from rock to rock I went,                   | ii   | 353                 |
| I rose while yet the cattle, heat-opprest,           | vi   | 257                 |
| I saw a Mother's eye intensely bent                  | vii  | 92                  |
| I saw an aged Beggar in my walk;                     | i    | 300                 |
| I saw far off the dark top of a Pine,                | viii | <a href="#">58</a>  |
| I saw the figure of a lovely Maid                    | vii  | 74                  |
| Is <i>Death</i> , when evil against good has fought, | viii | <a href="#">106</a> |
| I shiver, Spirit fierce and bold,                    | ii   | 379                 |
| Is it a reed that's shaken by the wind,              | ii   | 331                 |
| Is then no nook of English ground secure,            | viii | <a href="#">166</a> |
| Is then the final page before me spread,             | vi   | 382                 |
| Is there a power that can sustain and cheer          | iv   | 228                 |
| Is this, ye Gods, the Capitolian Hill,               | viii | <a href="#">59</a>  |
| <i>I thought of Thee, my partner and my guide,</i>   | vi   | 263                 |
| It is a beauteous evening, calm and free,            | ii   | 335                 |
| It is no Spirit who from heaven hath flown,          | ii   | 376                 |
| It is not to be thought of that the Flood            | ii   | 347                 |
| It is the first mild day of March:                   | i    | 271                 |



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| I travelled among unknown men,                                        | ii   | 80                  |
| It seems a day                                                        | ii   | 70                  |
| It was a beautiful and silent day                                     | iii  | 311                 |
| It was a dreary morning when the wheels                               | iii  | 168                 |
| It was a <i>moral</i> end for which they fought;                      | iv   | 217                 |
| It was an April morning: fresh and clear                              | ii   | 154                 |
| I've watched you now a full half-hour,                                | ii   | 297                 |
| I wandered lonely as a cloud                                          | iii  | 4                   |
| I was thy neighbour once, thou rugged Pile!                           | iii  | 54                  |
| I watch, and long have watched, with calm regret                      | vi   | 197                 |
| I, who accompanied with faithful pace                                 | vii  | 4                   |
| I, whose pretty Voice you hear,                                       | viii | <a href="#">295</a> |
| I will relate a tale for those who love                               | viii | <a href="#">224</a> |
| Jesu! bless our slender Boat,                                         | vi   | 301                 |
| Jones! I as from Calais southward you and I                           | ii   | 332                 |
| Just as those final words were penned, the sun broke out in<br>power, | viii | <a href="#">135</a> |
| Keep for the Young the Impassioned smile                              | vi   | 218                 |
| Lady! a Pen (perhaps with thy regard,                                 | viii | <a href="#">8</a>   |
| Lady! I rifled a Parnassian cave                                      | vi   | 211                 |
| Lady! the songs of Spring were in the grove                           | iv   | 58                  |
| Lament! for Diocletian's fiery sword                                  | vii  | 8                   |
| Lance, shield, and sword relinquished—at his side                     | vii  | 20                  |
| Last night, without a voice, that Vision spake                        | vii  | 74                  |
| Let other bards of angels sing,                                       | vii  | 121                 |
| Let thy wheel-barrow alone                                            | ii   | 95                  |
| Let us quit the leafy arbour,                                         | vi   | 153                 |
| Lie here, without a record of thy worth,                              | iii  | 50                  |
| Life with yon Lambs, like day, is just begun,                         | viii | <a href="#">97</a>  |
| Like a shipwreck'd Sailor tost                                        | vii  | 328                 |
| List, the winds of March are blowing;                                 | vii  | 331                 |
| List—'twas the Cuckoo.—O with what delight,                           | viii | <a href="#">68</a>  |

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| List, ye who pass by Lyulph's Tower                 | vii  | 394                 |
| Lo! in the burning west, the craggy nape            | vi   | 377                 |
| Lone Flower, hemmed in with snows and white as they | vi   | 191                 |
| Long-favoured England! be not thou misled,          | viii | <a href="#">131</a> |
| Long has the dew been dried on tree and lawn,       | viii | <a href="#">63</a>  |
| Long time have human ignorance and guilt            | iii  | 345                 |
| Lonsdale! it were unworthy of a Guest,              | vii  | 392                 |
| Look at the fate of summer flowers,                 | vii  | 124                 |
| Look now on that Adventurer who hath paid           | iv   | 228                 |
| Lord of the vale! astounding Flood;                 | vi   | 26                  |
| Loud is the Vale! the Voice is up                   | iv   | 47                  |
| Loving she is, and tractable, though wild;          | iv   | 252                 |
| Lo! where she stands fixed in a saint-like trance,  | viii | <a href="#">132</a> |
| Lo! where the Moon along the sky,                   | viii | <a href="#">88</a>  |
| Lowther! in thy majestic Pile are seen              | vii  | 392                 |
| Lulled by the sound of pastoral bells,              | vi   | 372                 |
| Lyre! though such power do in thy magic live,       | viii | <a href="#">147</a> |
| "Man's life is like a Sparrow, mighty King!"        | vii  | 16                  |
| Mark how the feathered tenants of the flood,        | iv   | 278                 |
| Mark the concentrated hazels that enclose           | vi   | 71                  |
| Meek Virgin Mother, more benign                     | vi   | 318                 |
| Men of the Western World! in Fate's dark book,      | viii | <a href="#">112</a> |
| Men, who have ceased to reverence, soon defy        | vii  | 68                  |
| Mercy and Love have met thee on thy road,           | vii  | 7                   |
| Methinks that I could trip o'er heaviest soil,      | vii  | 66                  |
| Methinks that to some vacant hermitage              | vii  | 21                  |
| Methinks 'twere no unprecedented feat               | vi   | 255                 |
| Methought I saw the footsteps of a throne           | iv   | 46                  |
| 'Mid crowded obelisks and urns                      | ii   | 387                 |
| Mid-noon is past;—upon the sultry mead              | vi   | 254                 |
| Milton! thou should'st be living at this hour:      | ii   | 346                 |
| Mine ear has wrung, my spirit sunk subdued,         | vii  | 104                 |

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| “ <i>Miserrimus!</i> ” and neither name nor date, | vii  | 201                 |
| Monastic Domes! following my downward way,        | vii  | 100                 |
| Most sweet it is with unuplifted eyes             | vii  | 401                 |
| Mother! whose virgin bosom was uncrost,           | vii  | 54                  |
| Motions and Means, on land and sea at war,        | vii  | 389                 |
| My frame hath often trembled with delight         | vi   | 250                 |
| My heart leaps up when I behold                   | ii   | 292                 |
| My Lord and Lady Darlington                       | viii | <a href="#">298</a> |
| My Son! behold the tide already spent,            | viii | <a href="#">273</a> |
| Nay, Traveller! rest. This lonely Yew-tree stands | i    | 109                 |
| Near Anio’s stream, I spied a gentle Dove,        | viii | <a href="#">65</a>  |
| Never enlivened with the liveliest ray,           | viii | <a href="#">150</a> |
| Next morning Troilus began to clear               | ii   | 264                 |
| No fiction was it of the antique age:             | vi   | 241                 |
| No more: the end is sudden and abrupt,            | vii  | 309                 |
| No mortal object did these eyes behold            | iii  | 381                 |
| No record tells of lance opposed to lance,        | vi   | 258                 |
| Nor scorn the aid which Fancy oft doth lend       | vii  | 18                  |
| Nor shall the eternal roll of praise reject       | vii  | 78                  |
| Nor wants the cause the panic-striking aid        | vii  | 12                  |
| Not a breath of air,                              | viii | <a href="#">146</a> |
| Not envying Latian shades—if yet they throw       | vi   | 230                 |
| Not hurled precipitous from steep to steep;       | vi   | 261                 |
| Not in the lucid intervals of life                | vii  | 402                 |
| Not in the mines beyond the western main,         | vii  | 400                 |
| Not, like his great Compeers, indignantly         | vi   | 303                 |
| Not Love, not War, nor the tumultuous swell       | vii  | 118                 |
| Not ’mid the World’s vain objects that enslave    | iv   | 210                 |
| Not sedentary all: there are who roam             | vii  | 23                  |
| Not seldom, clad in radiant vest,                 | vi   | 175                 |
| Not so that Pair whose youthful spirits dance     | vi   | 240                 |
| Not the whole warbling grove in concert heard     | vii  | 169                 |

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| Not to the clouds, not to the cliff, he flew;    | vii  | 372                 |
| Not to the object specially designed,            | viii | <a href="#">106</a> |
| Not utterly unworthy to endure                   | vii  | 55                  |
| Not without heavy grief of heart did He          | iv   | 236                 |
| No whimsey of the purse is here,                 | viii | <a href="#">259</a> |
| Now that all hearts are glad, all faces bright,  | iv   | 282                 |
| Now that the farewell tear is dried,             | vi   | 338                 |
| Now we are tired of boisterous joy,              | ii   | 420                 |
| Now when the primrose makes a splendid show,     | viii | <a href="#">116</a> |
| Nuns fret not at their convent's narrow room;    | iv   | 28                  |
| Oak of Guernica! Tree of holier power            | iv   | 245                 |
| O blithe New-comer! I have heard,                | ii   | 289                 |
| O dearer far than light and life are dear,       | vii  | 122                 |
| O'er the wide earth, on mountain and on plain,   | iv   | 223                 |
| O'erweening Statesmen have full long relied      | iv   | 247                 |
| O Flower of all that springs from gentle blood,  | iv   | 235                 |
| Of mortal parents is the Hero born               | iv   | 214                 |
| O for a dirge! But why complain?                 | vii  | 132                 |
| O, for a kindling touch from that pure flame,    | vi   | 110                 |
| O for the help of Angels to complete             | vi   | 297                 |
| O Friend! I know not which way I must look       | ii   | 345                 |
| Oft have I caught, upon a fitful breeze,         | vii  | 373                 |
| Oft have I seen, ere Time had ploughed my cheek, | vii  | 163                 |
| Oft I had heard of Lucy Gray:                    | ii   | 99                  |
| Oft is the medal faithful to its trust           | iv   | 77                  |
| Oft, through thy fair domains, illustrious Peer! | v    | 20                  |
| O gentle Sleep! do they belong to thee,          | iv   | 42                  |
| O happy time of youthful lovers (thus            | iii  | 24                  |
| Oh Bounty without measure, while the Grace       | viii | <a href="#">308</a> |
| Oh Life! without thy chequered scene             | vi   | 315                 |
| Oh! pleasant exercise of hope and joy!           | iii  | 35                  |
| Oh what a Wreck! how changed in mien and speech, | viii | <a href="#">36</a>  |

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| Oh! what's the matter? what's the matter?          | i    | 254                 |
| "O Lord, our Lord! how wondrously," (quoth she)    | ii   | 240                 |
| O Moon! if e'er I joyed when thy soft light        | viii | <a href="#">235</a> |
| O mountain Stream! the Shepherd and his Cot        | vi   | 245                 |
| Once did She hold the gorgeous east in fee;        | ii   | 336                 |
| Once I could hail (howe'er serene the sky)         | vii  | 152                 |
| Once in a lonely hamlet I sojourned                | ii   | 285                 |
| Once more the Church is seized with sudden fear,   | vii  | 49                  |
| Once on the top of Tynwald's formal mound          | vii  | 366                 |
| Once to the verge of yon steep barrier came        | viii | <a href="#">236</a> |
| One might believe that natural miseries            | ii   | 431                 |
| One morning (raw it was and wet—                   | ii   | 270                 |
| One who was suffering tumult in his soul           | vi   | 187                 |
| On his morning rounds the Master                   | iii  | 48                  |
| O Nightingale! thou surely art                     | iv   | 67                  |
| On, loitering Muse—the swift Stream chides us—on!  | vi   | 242                 |
| "On Man, on Nature, and on Human Life,"            | v    | 23                  |
| On Nature's invitation do I come,                  | ii   | 118                 |
| O now that the genius of Bewick were mine,         | ii   | 60                  |
| On to Iona!—What can she afford                    | vii  | 379                 |
| Open your gates, ye everlasting Piles!             | vii  | 105                 |
| O there is blessing in this gentle breeze,         | iii  | 132                 |
| O thou who movest onward with a mind               | iv   | 231                 |
| O thou! whose fancies from afar are brought;       | ii   | 351                 |
| Our bodily life, some plead, that life the shrine, | viii | <a href="#">109</a> |
| Our walk was far among the ancient trees:          | ii   | 167                 |
| Outstretching flame-ward his upbraided hand        | vii  | 62                  |
| Pansies, lilies, kingcups, daisies,                | ii   | 301                 |
| Part fenced by man, part by a rugged steep         | vii  | 286                 |
| Pastor and Patriot!—at whose bidding rise          | vii  | 349                 |
| Patriots informed with Apostolic light             | vii  | 85                  |
| Pause, courteous Spirit!—Balbi supplicates         | iv   | 237                 |

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| Pause, Traveller! whosoe'er thou be                 | vi   | 173                 |
| Peaceful our valley, fair and green;                | viii | <a href="#">259</a> |
| Pelion and Ossa flourish side by side,              | ii   | 238                 |
| "People! your chains are severing link by link;"    | vii  | 290                 |
| Perhaps some needful service of the State           | iv   | 230                 |
| Pleasures newly found are sweet                     | ii   | 303                 |
| Portentous change when History can appear,          | viii | <a href="#">130</a> |
| Praised be the Art whose subtle power could stay    | iv   | 272                 |
| Praised be the Rivers, from their mountain springs  | vii  | 45                  |
| Prejudged by foes determined not to spare,          | vii  | 71                  |
| Presentiments! they judge not right                 | vii  | 266                 |
| Prompt transformation works the novel Lore;         | vii  | 17                  |
| Proud were ye, Mountains, when, in times of old,    | viii | <a href="#">167</a> |
| Pure element of waters! wheresoe'er                 | vi   | 184                 |
| Queen of the Stars!—so gentle, so benign,           | viii | <a href="#">15</a>  |
| Ranging the heights of Scawfell or Black-Comb,      | vii  | 358                 |
| Rapt above earth by power of one fair face,         | viii | <a href="#">81</a>  |
| Realms quake by turns: proud Arbitress of grace,    | vii  | 32                  |
| Record we too, with just and faithful pen,          | vii  | 39                  |
| Redoubted King, of courage leonine,                 | vii  | 31                  |
| Reluctant call it was; the rite delayed;            | vii  | 323                 |
| "Rest, rest, perturbèd Earth!"                      | vi   | 95                  |
| Return, Content! for fondly I pursued,              | vi   | 255                 |
| Rid of a vexing and a heavy load,                   | viii | <a href="#">265</a> |
| Rise!—they <i>have</i> risen: of brave Aneurin ask  | vii  | 11                  |
| Rotha, my Spiritual Child! this head was grey       | vii  | 171                 |
| Rude is this Edifice, and Thou hast seen            | ii   | 213                 |
| Sacred Religion! "mother of form and fear,"         | vi   | 249                 |
| Sad thoughts, avaunt!—partake we their blithe cheer | vi   | 253                 |
| Said red-ribboned Evans:                            | viii | <a href="#">302</a> |
| Said Secrecy to Cowardice and Fraud,                | viii | <a href="#">304</a> |
| Say, what is Honour?—'Tis the finest sense          | iv   | 225                 |

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| Say, ye far-travelled clouds, far-seeing hills—      | vii  | 287                 |
| Scattering, like birds escaped the fowler's net,     | vii  | 64                  |
| Scorn not the Sonnet; Critic, you have frowned,      | vii  | 163                 |
| Screams round the Arch-druid's brow the seamew—white | vii  | 6                   |
| Seek who will delight in fable,                      | viii | <a href="#">172</a> |
| See the Condemned alone within his cell,             | viii | <a href="#">110</a> |
| See what gay wild flowers deck this earth-built Cot, | vii  | 296                 |
| See, where his difficult way that Old Man wins,      | viii | <a href="#">83</a>  |
| Serene, and fitted to embrace,                       | vi   | 117                 |
| Serving no haughty Muse, my hands have here,         | viii | <a href="#">102</a> |
| Seven Daughters had Lord Archibald,                  | ii   | 204                 |
| Shade of Caractacus, if spirits love,                | viii | <a href="#">309</a> |
| Shall he who gives his days to low pursuits          | viii | <a href="#">257</a> |
| Shame on this faithless heart! that could allow      | vi   | 214                 |
| She dwelt among the untrodden ways                   | ii   | 79                  |
| She had a tall man's height or more;                 | ii   | 278                 |
| She was a Phantom of delight                         | iii  | 2                   |
| She wept.—Life's purple tide began to flow           | viii | <a href="#">209</a> |
| Shout, for a mighty Victory is won!                  | ii   | 436                 |
| Show me the noblest Youth of present time,           | vii  | 181                 |
| Shun not this rite, neglected, yea abhorred,         | vii  | 96                  |
| Since risen from ocean, ocean to defy,               | vii  | 369                 |
| Six changeful years have vanished since I first      | iii  | 247                 |
| Six months to six years added he remained,           | viii | <a href="#">39</a>  |
| Six thousand veterans practised in war's game,       | ii   | 435                 |
| Small service is true service while it lasts,        | viii | <a href="#">8</a>   |
| Smile of the Moon!—for so I name                     | vi   | 163                 |
| So fair, so sweet, withal so sensitive,              | viii | <a href="#">164</a> |
| Soft as a cloud is yon blue Ridge—the Mere           | vii  | 405                 |
| Sole listener, Duddon! to the breeze that played     | vi   | 234                 |
| Son of my buried Son, while thus thy hand,           | viii | <a href="#">305</a> |
| Soon did the Almighty Giver of all rest              | iv   | 267                 |

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| Spade! with which Wilkinson hath tilled his lands, | iv   | 3                   |
| Stay, bold Adventurer; rest awhile thy limbs       | iv   | 281                 |
| Stay, little cheerful Robin! stay,                 | viii | <a href="#">38</a>  |
| Stay near me—do not take thy flight!               | ii   | 283                 |
| Stern Daughter of the Voice of God!                | iii  | 38                  |
| Strange fits of passion have I known:              | ii   | 78                  |
| Stranger! this hillock of mis-shapen stones        | ii   | 63                  |
| Stretched on the dying Mother's lap, lies dead     | vii  | 387                 |
| Such age how beautiful! O Lady bright,             | vii  | 172                 |
| Such fruitless questions may not long beguile      | vi   | 246                 |
| Surprised by joy—impatient as the Wind             | vi   | 72                  |
| Sweet Flower, belike one day to have               | iii  | 51                  |
| Sweet Highland Girl, a very shower                 | ii   | 390                 |
| “Sweet is the holiness of Youth”—so felt           | vii  | 59                  |
| Sweet was the walk along the narrow lane,          | viii | <a href="#">215</a> |
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END OF VOL. VIII

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